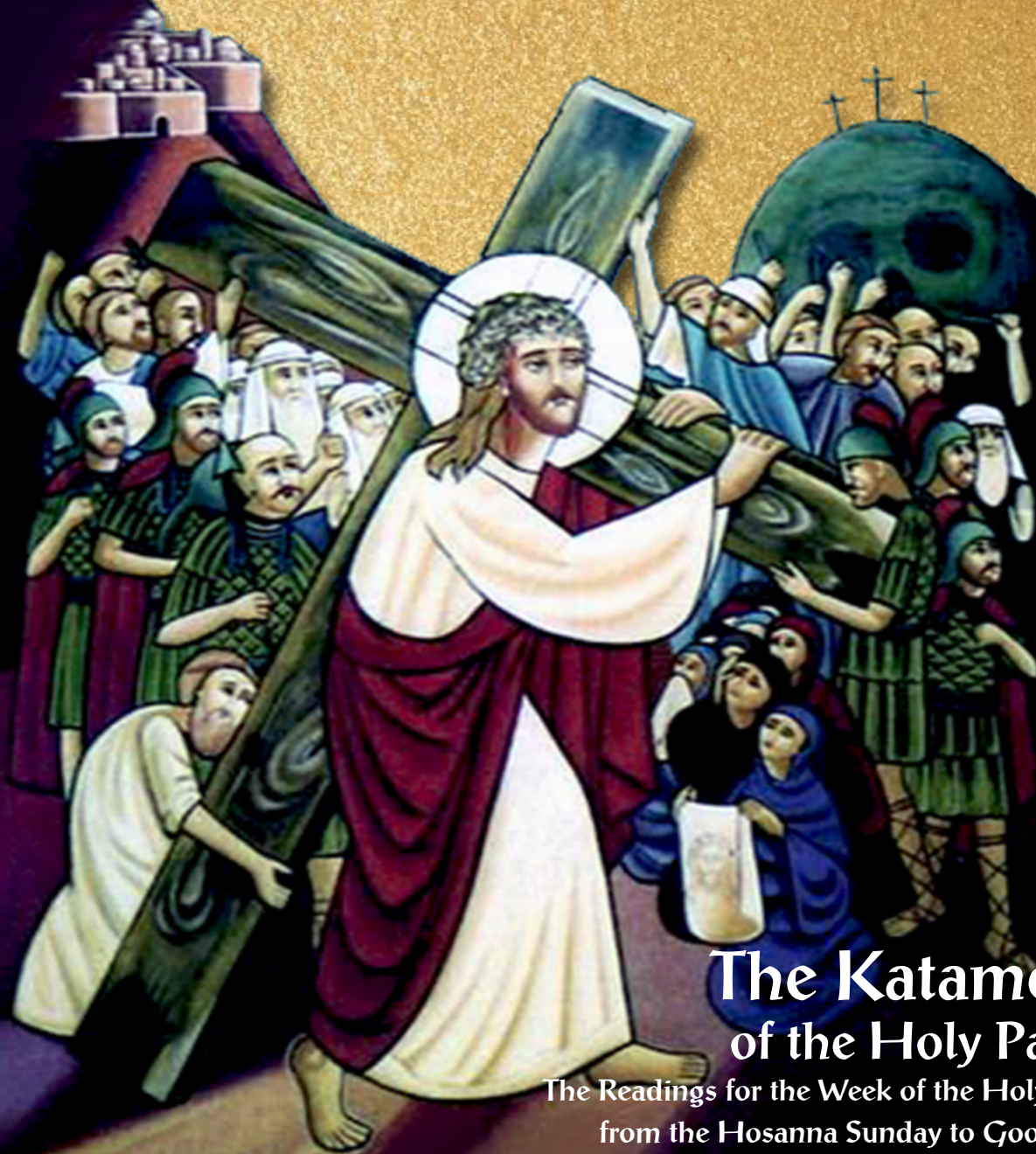


Πιχωμ ἡτε Πιπαςχα εθοϋαβ



The Katameros of the Holy Pascha

The Readings for the Week of the Holy Pascha
from the Hosanna Sunday to Good Friday
According to the Coptic Orthodox Church

English
eBook Edition

Πατριάρχης Ὑπερῶνυμι Πρωτοζου
بطيركية الأقباط الأرثوذكس
Coptic Orthodox Patriarchate

THE KATAMEROS OF THE HOLY PASCHA

Readings for the Week of Holy Pascha
from the Hosanna Sunday to Good Friday

Lent 1734 A.M., 2018 A.D.
eBook Edition

Πιχω ἡτε
Πιπασχα εθοραβ



The Holy Pascha

English





H. H. Pope Tawadros II
118th Pope of Alexandria,
Patriarch of the See of St. Mark



His Grace Bishop Boulos
Bishop of the Dioceses of Ottawa,
Montreal and Eastern Canada

Ⲁⲣⲏ ⲑⲉⲱ ⲓⲥⲭⲣⲟⲥ



PREFACE

*In the name of the Father, the Son, and
the Holy Spirit One God. Amen*

I am pleased to write the preface for this electronic book prepared by a deacon at St Mary's church in Ottawa, Ontario, Canada.

This eBook is the fifth book of the Katameros series, they were published as a book from many years ago, now they were also published as electronic books, and they are:

1. Katameros of the Sundays throughout the whole Coptic year
2. Katameros of the Days
3. Katameros of the Lent
4. Katameros of the Pentecost.

At the outset, I would like to congratulate the priests of St Mary's church: Hegumen Abouna Shenouda Boutros for the 51st anniversary of his ordination and Abouna Marcos Abdelmesih for the 10th anniversary of his ordination. May the Lord bless all services for the glory of His Holy name.

The deacon started working diligently on this book few years ago and I followed up on the progress until it is finished this year.

The book includes excellent features, e.g.

- ✦ "Contents in Illustration" in which one presses on the hour and occasion and opens directly.
- ✦ Detailed "Table of Contents". By pressing on the item, it leads the content of the page.

- ✕ At the bottom of each page, there are three coloured items: “Table of contents” in orange, “Index” in blue, and “Contents in Illustration” in green. By pressing on any of them one reaches the corresponding item.
- ✕ Also by pressing in any page number mentioned inside the book, you can reach the corresponding page.

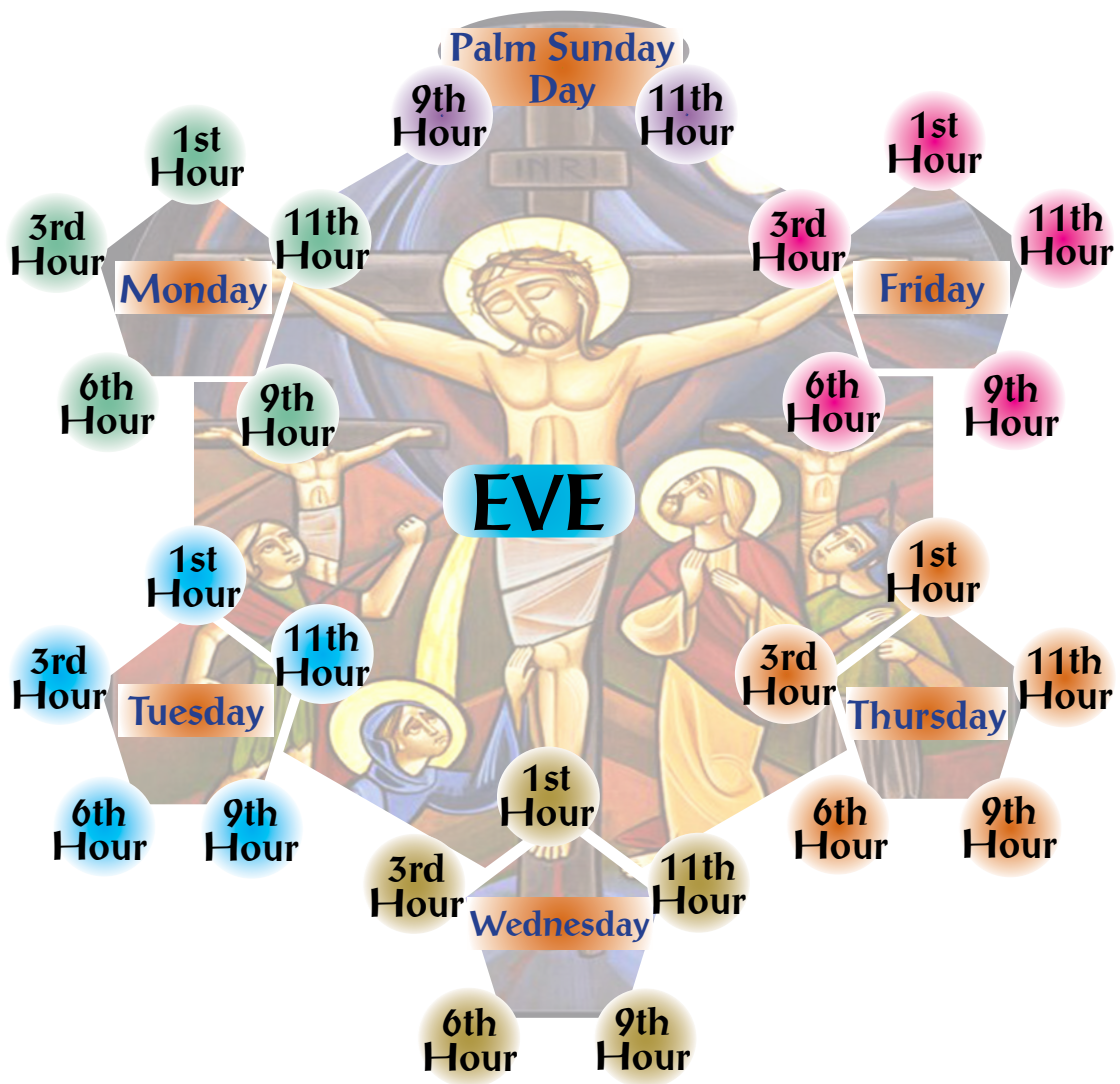
May our Lord Jesus Christ make us all benefit from using this book during the Holy Pascha week.

Bishop Abba Boulos

*Bishop of the Diocese of Ottawa,
Montreal, and Eastern Canada*



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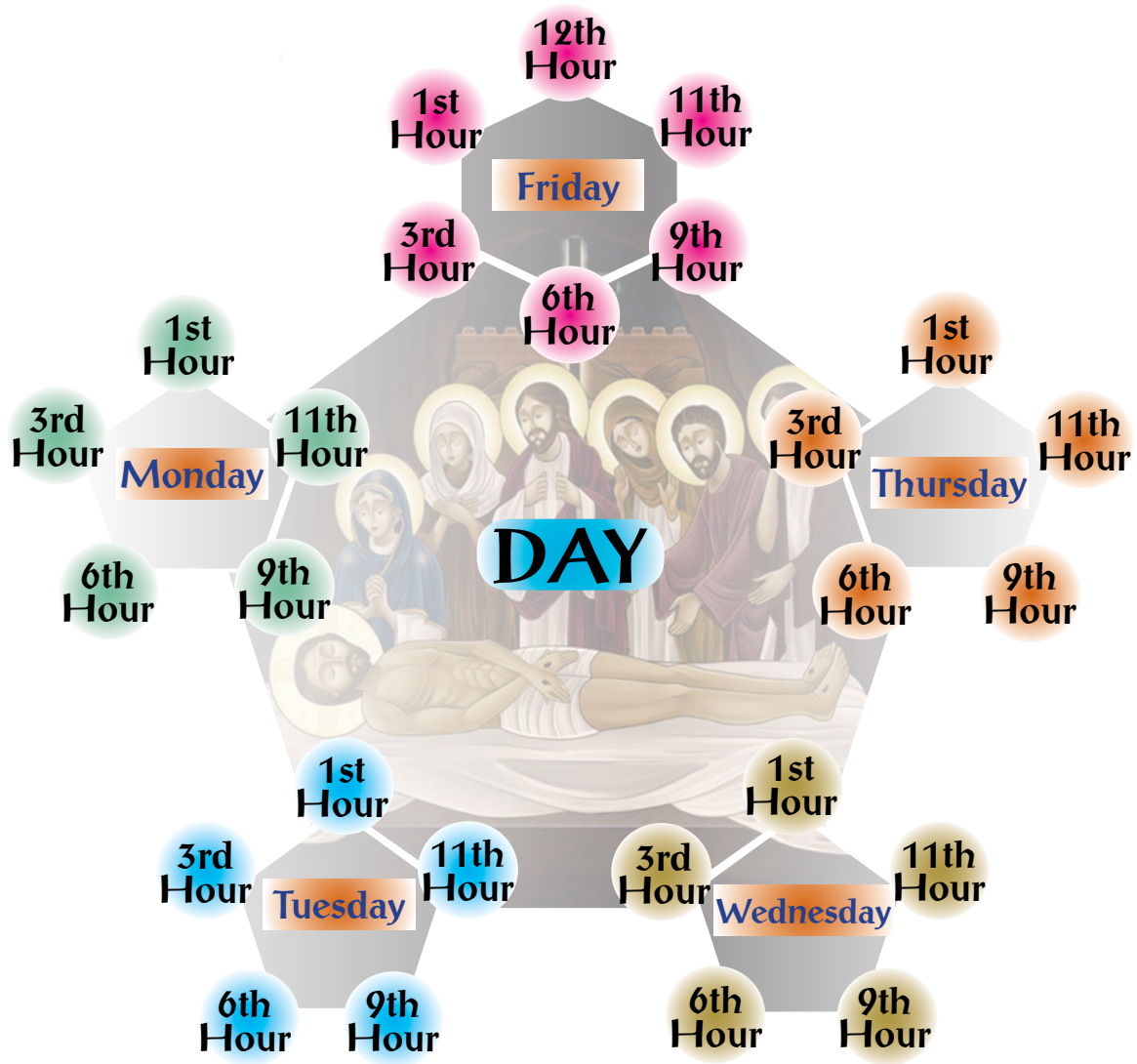


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INTRODUCTION

RITE OF THE HOLY PASCHA

PASSION WEEK

Passion Week, also known as the Holy Pascha, is considered to be the most important week in the life of the Church. During this week, the Church re-lives the moments of salvation and the release of Mankind from the chains of sin and Satanís bondage. These are truly moments patiently waited for by humanity in its entirety.

Passion week commences on Palm Sunday and is concluded at the end of Joyous Saturday and the beginning of the rite of the Feast of the Resurrection. Following the General Funeral Prayers, the Church leaves the sanctuary and prays in the second chorus level. In the same way as the Lord Christ was taken out of Jerusalem, and was hung on the wood of the Cross, likewise we too leave the first chorus, which symbolizes Jerusalem. The Rite of Passion Week starts with the prayers of the ninth and eleventh hours of Palm Sunday. The veil of the sanctuary is then covered in black, as well as the north and south lecterns, which are also placed in the second chorus.

During Passion Week, the Church celebrates Maundy Thursday, also known as the Maundy (Covenant) Thursday, as well as the Friday of Crucifixion, commonly known as Good Friday, and Joyous (Bright) Saturday. Throughout the week, while the Church is fasting, the entire Four Gospels are read. The Gospel of St. Matthew is read on Tuesday, St. Mark on Wednesday, St. Luke on Thursday and St. John on Easter Sunday. In the past, the Book of Job was read on Wednesday, since the pains of Job remind us of the pains of Christ. The Mimar of Job was also read at the

sixth hour of Wednesday. For this reason, it is known as Job's Wednesday. Furthermore, the Copts had an old tradition of bathing in water containing plants known as "flourishing Job" (ra3-ra3 Ayoub), as a reminder of the pains of Job.

Rituals of the Passion Week

In this Rite, the prayers are divided between morning and evening. In every prayer, there are five hours, that is, five morning hours and five evening hours. The hourly prayers of the Agpeya are not prayed throughout the week because they include psalms that prophesize on the life, death and resurrection of Christ. Meanwhile, the Church is only focusing its attention on the pains and death of Christ. For this reason, the Church has arranged a specific order of prayers for this great week.

The word Pascha is a Hebrew word meaning "Passover", referring to the passing of the Angel of Death over the Israelites when killing the firstborn of Egypt. In the rite of the Holy Pascha, the prayers of every hour start with the prophecies, followed by the homilies of the hour, if any. This is followed by the Paschal hymn $\Theta\omega\kappa\ \tau\epsilon\ \dagger\chi\omicron\upsilon\omega$, which is chanted 12 times, instead of the Psalms of the hour. The Psalm is then read in the mournful tune, followed by the Gospel and the Exposition of the Hour. At the conclusion of the five hours, the Litanies (Morning or Evening) are prayed, followed by the Concluding Prayers of the Passion Week. It is of merit to be aware that for the prophecies, homilies and expositions, there are specific hymns for the introduction and conclusion of each. In addition, there are specific rites for each of Maundy Thursday, Good Friday, and Joyous Saturday.

GREAT (MAUNDY) THURSDAY

Maundy Thursday is one of the holiest days of the Paschal week. This is the day on which Christ celebrated the Passover with His disciples, washed their feet, and also instituted the Sacrament of the Eucharist. On this day also, Judas betrayed His Master, surrendering Him to the Jews.

After Peter and John had prepared for the Passover, the disciples began to ask which of them would be first in the Kingdom of Heaven. The Lord in His reply knelt down and began to wash their feet. This was not only teaching humility by example, but it was also the institution of a great work: service. Service is not simply preaching or rebuking, but in truth it is washing the feet (of the served).

When they had finished the meal, Christ began to institute the Sacrament of the Eucharist. He took bread, blessed it, broke it, and gave it to His disciples saying, "Take eat of it all of you, for this is My body which shall be given for you, do this in remembrance of Me." Likewise, also He took the cup after supper and said, "This is My Blood of the New Covenant, which shall be shed for you." Satan, however, entered Judas' heart, and he, being a traitor, went to deliver His Master to the Jews. It is during this time also, that the Lord warned Peter that he would deny Christ three times before the rooster had crowed twice.

That evening, the Lord retreated to the Garden of Gethsemane, and as He prayed, His sweat became like drops of blood falling to the ground. An angel of the Lord came to strengthen Him proclaiming, "Yours is the power, Yours is the glory, Yours is the blessing, Yours is the majesty, O Emmanuel, our God and King". For this reason, the Church has established this praise in every hour of the prayers of the Paschal week.

The First, Third, Sixth and Ninth hours of this day are all related to the Preparation of the Passover. This is evident in the readings of each hour. The Liturgy of the Lakkan itself is a commemoration of the service the Lord performed when washing

the disciples' feet. As for the Liturgy of the Eucharist, it commemorates the institution of the Sacrament of the Eucharist itself.

Rituals of the Maundy Thursday

The Rite of Covenant Thursday begins with the judgment of Judas in the Prime hour, where he is excommunicated by the Church, and denounced from amongst the rank of the Apostles. He is dealt with in such a manner for breaking the law and delivering His Master and God into the hands of the Jews with a kiss. The prayer begins in the first chorus as the priest open the veil of the sanctuary and commences with the Prime Raising of Incense. During the Doxologies, the priest proceeds around the Church, censuring without greeting, thus condemning Judas' kiss. The complete Creed is then chanted (as outlined in the decision made by the Holy Synod on June 2, 2001). Following Φ† ΝΑΙ ΝΑΝ , the deacons chant Κῥιὲ ἐλῆκον in the long tune three times, followed by the hymns ΦΑΙ ΕΤΑΥΕΝΥ ΑΝΔ Κῶ-μαρωοῦτ . The Praxis is then read from the raised podium of the church. In reading it, Judas is both judged and condemned. These were the words spoken by St. Peter the Apostle saying, "Friends, the scripture had to be fulfilled, which the Holy Spirit through David foretold concerning Judas, who became a guide for those who arrested Jesus – for he was numbered among us and was allotted his share in this ministry. (Now this man acquired a field with the reward of his wickedness; and falling headlong, he burst open in the middle and all his bowels gushed out. This became known to all the residents of Jerusalem, so that the field was called in their language Hakeldama, that is, Field of Blood.) For it is written in the book of Psalms, 'Let his homestead become desolate, and let there be no one to live in it'; and 'Let another take his position of overseer'" (Acts 1:16-20).

Following this, the priests and deacons of the Church denounce Judas by proceeding around the church twice in a clockwise rotation, the opposite direction to which processions are normally conducted. During the procession, they chant a Greek hymn rebuking Judas for dishonoring the Law. After this, Ἀστιος is chanted in the mournful tune. In the first Ἀστιος , the congregation chants ὁ εκπάρθενος γενεθιο

ἐλῆενσον ἡμᾶς . In the second and third however, ὁ σταυρωθῆς δι ἡμᾶς ἐλῆενσον ἡμᾶς is chanted instead. The reasoning for this is that the Church, through the rite, desires to tell the faithful that the complete Redemption through the Cross has not yet been completed, but will be fulfilled on Good Friday. Only then will we chant ὁ σταυρωθῆς δι ἡμᾶς ἐλῆενσον ἡμᾶς three times.

After this, the Litany of the Gospel is prayed, and the Psalm is chanted in the Shamy tune. Through this psalm, the Church declares its reasoning for denouncing Judas, saying, “with speech smoother than butter, but with a heart set on war; with words that were softer than oil, but in fact were drawn swords. Cast your burden on the Lord, and he will sustain you; he will never permit the righteous to be moved” (Ps. 55:21-22). This is to say that Judas used deceit to betray his Master. The Gospel is then read, followed by the exposition, the litanies, and the conclusion. With this, the excommunication of Judas from the Church is completed in the First hour of Maundy Thursday.

The Third, Sixth and Ninth hours are prayed according to the standard rite. During these prayers, the Church is preparing Herself for the Passover. This is evident in the reading of the prophecies, where several references are made to Judas’ betrayal and the new Passover. The readings also reveal to us many symbols of the Passover in the Old Testament. Two examples are Abraham offering Isaac as a sacrifice, and Melchizedek the High Priest offering bread and wine. When the prayers of the hours are completed, the priests and deacons wear their liturgical vestments as worn during the annual days. They proceed to the second chorus and begin with the prayers of the Liturgy of Lakkan. The prayers are conducted in the annual tune, following the order outlined in the Lakkan Book of Prayers. In its conclusion, Psalm 150 is chanted, also in the annual tune, during which the priests will wash the feet of the faithful, in commemoration of what the Lord did to His disciples on that day.

The Divine Liturgy of Maundy Thursday begins with the offering of the Lamb without the normal prayers or **Κ**ϣϣϣ ἐλῆενσον because the hourly prayers are not prayed during the week of Pascha. **Α**λ φαι πε πι is not said either because the Day of the

Lord (His Resurrection) has not yet come, nor is $\overline{\Delta\lambda} \chi\epsilon \phi\upsilon\epsilon\tau\iota$ chanted because the True Sacrifice and Eternal Offering has not yet been raised on the wood of the Cross. Following the prayers of Thanksgiving, the congregation remains silent, since the hymn $\text{C}\omega\theta\epsilon\iota\varsigma$ is not chanted, as Redemption has not yet been accomplished (but will on Good Friday when the Lord Jesus Christ gives up the spirit on the Cross). The $\text{Θ}\iota\tau\epsilon\tau\epsilon\iota$ are not said, rather $\text{I}\epsilon\text{n}\omega\sigma\tau\epsilon\upsilon$ is chanted immediately, followed by the Pauline reading in the annual tune. There are no readings from the Catholic Epistle, Praxis or Synexarium. The Trisagion is chanted thereafter in the same manner as the Prime hour, except in the annual tune. After this, the Litany of the Gospel is prayed, followed by the reading of the Psalm and Gospel, also in the annual tune, as well as the Gospel Response.

The Prayer of Reconciliation is not prayed, this is omitted so as to denounce Judas' kiss again, and also because reconciliation between God and Man has not yet been fulfilled through God the Word, the Son of Man, our Lord Jesus Christ, on the wood of the Cross. This will not happen until Good Friday. Also, the Rite of reconciliation reminds us of the resurrection because of the raising of the Prospherin from the altar, which is a symbol of the rock that the Archangel Michael rolled from the door of the tomb. The bells on the Prospherin also serve as a symbol of the earth quaking at the Lord's Resurrection. Since the Resurrection has not yet occurred, the congregation chants the Adam Aspasmos for the Divine Liturgy.

During the liturgy, it is preferred that the words "You have come to the slaughter..." be used instead of "He rose from the dead...." When the litany of oblations is prayed, the priest does not recite the Commemoration of the Saints nor does he mention the names of the departed, since the Church is completely focused only on the sufferings of Christ. Instead, the congregation chants Wcperyn . The priest continues the prayers from "Lead us throughout the way into Your Kingdom, as in this also...", followed by the Fraction of the Sacrifice of Isaac.

As for the rite of prayers during Communion, there are two views with respect to this rite.

The first and most commonly accepted, is that the veil of the altar is closed, without chanting Psalm 150, and the Prayers of the Eleventh Hour of Covenant Thursday are prayed instead. The prophecies are read and the Attriby Psalm is chanted. The prayers of the Eleventh Hour are therefore completed during Holy Communion. Also, no prostrations should be made during the Litanies because the congregation has partaken of the Body and Blood of Christ.

The second opinion is based on the fact that since the Lord Christ is present on the altar, the Church should not be in a sad state. Rather, the veil should not hide the Body, and Psalm 150 should be chanted, followed by the hymn Πῶικ . No other annual hymns however may be chanted during Communion. It is only after Communion is concluded that the prayers of the Eleventh Hour of Covenant Thursday are prayed.

The Prayers of the Eleventh hour are concluded in the same manner as all the hours of the Paschal week, after which the priest dismisses the congregation.

GOOD FRIDAY

In the beginning, God created Man on the sixth day of creation. It was also on the sixth day that Adam and Eve sinned, and fell from the presence of the Lord. Humanity was condemned to death and eternal separation from God. For this reason, mankind became in need of a redemptive death to purify all people of sin. God the Logos accepted this upon Himself, and took the body of Man; and was incarnate of the Virgin Mary through the Holy Spirit.

Christ redeemed us on the wood of the Cross, on the sixth hour of the sixth day of the week. The first Adam sinned on the sixth day of Creation, and Christ, the second Adam, redeemed him and died on his behalf also on the sixth day of the week. The sixth day is Friday, the day on which we celebrate our salvation and freedom from the bondage of Satan and Sin. The hymns of Good Friday are deep and mournful, moving one's spirit to live and experience the true purpose of Christ's many passions, which He willingly endured for our sakes. The hymns reflect the Church's love and gratefulness for this great Divine work, which has saved us from Satan and his followers.

Rituals of the Good Friday

The Rite of Good Friday begins with the usual Paschal Prime Prayers. The Icon of Crucifixion is then adorned with roses, with lit candles and censers around it. The Rite continues with the prayers of the Third Hour in the same manner as the rest of the Pascha Week. The priests will then wear their dark cloaks and the deacons their liturgical vestments with their blue stoles as a sign of mourning. Following this, the prayers of the Sixth Hour commence with the reading of the prophecies in Coptic and/or the languages of understanding and the Paschal Praise. The priest will then raise incense before the Icon while the deacons chant *Tai soury* in the mournful tune, followed by *Φαί ἑταρενῇ* and *Πεντηωῶτ*, after which the Pauline is read in Coptic and/or the language of understanding. This is concluded by the hymn, *ἦ ἐπιστολῇ*. After praying the Litanies of the Sixth Hour with its responses, the deacons chant the Greek hymn *ὁ Ὑμνος ἐν ἡμῖν*, followed by the Trisagion in

the mournful tune. Afterwards, the Psalm is chanted in the Attribi tune, commonly known as **Κε ὑπερτοῦ**, and the reading of the Gospel in Coptic and/or the language of understanding. As soon as the reader says the words “and there was darkness on the earth,” the candles are blown out and the lights of the Church switched off, in remembrance of the darkness that fell upon the earth during the Crucifixion of our Lord. The exposition is then read, followed by the litanies and the melismatic **Κυριὲ ἐλεησον**, which is chanted three times. The prayer is then concluded with the blessing, and the Thief’s Faithfulness is read with its appropriate responses.

The prayer of the Ninth Hour begins with the Raising of Incense before the Icon of the Crucifixion, during which the deacons chant the hymns **Ἰϣοῦρι**, **Φαι ἐταφην** **ἀνδ** **Ἰενοῦωῡτ**, followed by the reading of the Pauline in Coptic, which is the hymn **Εἰς τὴν ἀνάστασιν**, and its translation in the language of understanding. The litanies of the hour and the appropriate responses are then chanted, followed by the mournful Trisagion. The Psalm is then chanted in the Attribi tune, commonly known as **Κε ὑπερτοῦ**. Then, the Gospel is read in Coptic and/or the language of understanding. In conclusion, the exposition is read, then the litanies, and the melismatic **Κυριὲ ἐλεησον**, which is chanted three times. The prayer concludes with the blessing.

The prayer of the Eleventh Hour is similar to that of the Third Hour except that the melismatic **Κυριὲ ἐλεησον** is chanted.

In commencing the prayer of the Twelfth Hour, the deacons move up to the first chorus, and the veil of the sanctuary is opened. The black curtain covering the veil of the sanctuary, as well as those on the lecterns, are lifted and the candles are lit once more. As the priests wear their seasonal garments, the Lamentations of Jeremiah are read, followed by the Paschal Praise, one verse from the raised podium and the other from lower podium. In churches without podiums, the Paschal Praise is chanted one verse inside the sanctuary and the other from outside. The Psalm **Πεῖθρονος** is then chanted in the Shamy tune from the podium of the church, if one is present, followed by the hymn **Κε ὑπερτοῦ** and the Gospel reading in Coptic and/or the language of understanding. Following this, the exposition is read and the litanies are

prayed, concluded with *ΚῙΡΙΕ ἔΛΕΗSON* , to be chanted four hundred times with full prostrations (metanoias). These prostrations are done periodically with one hundred in each direction, starting with the east, then west, north, and ending with south.

The priest and deacons then begin the procession three times around the altar, then three times around the church's nave, ending with one final procession around the altar. The Icon of the Crucifixion is carried throughout the procession, during which *ΚῙΡΙΕ ἔΛΕΗSON* is chanted in a melismatic tune. When the procession is completed, the deacons begin to chant the hymn *ΣΟΛΥΘΕΑ* , during which the senior priest buries the Icon while anointing it with spices, fragrances and roses. All one hundred and fifty psalms are then read, and the prayer is concluded with the blessing. It is of interest to note that the Rite of the Twelfth Hour is both mournful and joyous. This is because the Church joins in the mourning of the slain Christ for our sins, meanwhile, it also rejoices as mankind is granted Salvation from the bondage of Satan by Christ's death.

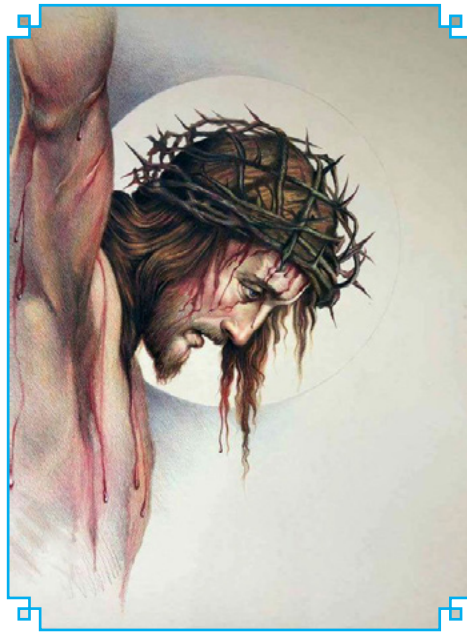
Some points regarding the Rite of Good Friday:

1. The mournful *ΠΟΡΡΟ* is chanted in the conclusion of the First and Third Hours, however, it is not chanted in the rest of the hours.
2. The hymn *†ΨΩΡΡΙ* may be chanted in two alternative tunes. The late Cantor Mikhail Girgis El-Batanony the Great has handed down both these tunes.
3. The music of the hymn *ΣΟΛΥΘΕΑ* has its roots from the Ancient Egyptians. It was used during their burials ceremonies, and the Church incorporated its music into this rite, with lyrics suited for the burial of Christ. Similarly, the music of the hymn *ΠΕΚΘΡΟΝΟΣ* was chanted by the Ancient Egyptians to express their grief for the dead separating from them, which is evident in the first half of the hymn. With this music also, they rejoiced that the deceased had boarded the Sun-Ship that would take the soul to the god Ra to grant it eternal life. The joyous music is evident in the second half of *ΠΕΚΘΡΟΝΟΣ* .

4. Psalms that are chanted using the tune $\text{Κε \u03c7\u03c0\u03b5\u03c1\u03c4\u03bf\u03c1}$ are referred to as Attribi Psalms. The word Attribi is taken from Attrib, an Ancient Egyptian city which St. Shenouda the Archimandrite had transformed into a church, which is currently St. Shenouda's Monastery in Sohag.
5. The Byzantine Church believes that the words of $\text{\u0399 \u039d\u0399\u039d\u0399\u03a3\u0395\u039d\u039d\u0399\u03a3}$ were written by Emperor Justinian I (527-565 A.D), known as the righteous Emperor. The Church also believes that the hymn was chanted when St. Severus, the Patriarch of Antioch, visited him. The Syrian Church, on the other hand, believes that St. Severus himself is the author of the hymn, written between 512 and 518 A.D. It seems that St. Severus wrote this hymn particularly to protect that Church against heresies of Nestorius and Eutyches. It is also speculated that St. Severus, while visiting Justinian I, revealed to him this hymn. The Emperor became fond of it, and began to labor in spreading the hymn to surrounding churches. In the Greek Church, $\text{\u0399 \u039d\u0399\u039d\u0399\u03a3\u0395\u039d\u039d\u0399\u03a3}$ is chanted in the Divine Liturgy during the Great Entry (the procession of the Lamb proceeding the raising of the Lamb).

Source

- ✧ *Mikhail, Deacon Albair Gamal, The Essentials in the Deacon's Service, (Shobra, Egypt: Shikolani, 2002),*
- ✧ *Fr. Mathias Farid; St. Mary Church El-Fagalla, cairo, Egypt. The Order and the Readings of the Holly Week; April 1986.*
- ✧ *The Heritage of the Orthodox Coptic Church; copticheritage.org.*
- ✧ *Saint Mark Coptic Orthodox Church, Holy Pascha; Order of Holy Week Services in the Coptic Orthodox Church; NJ, USA. Feb. 2004.*



THE REPEATED
PRAYERS OF
HOLY PASCHA

PROPHECIES

The prophecies are read before the Gospel denoting that the Old Testament was before the New Testament and to reveal what the prophets prophesied about regarding the sufferings of Christ.

Introduction to the Prophecies

Priest:

In the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

The Prophecies of the Hour of *Hosanna Sunday* of Holy Pascha, May its blessings be with us. Amen.

The Prophecies of the Hour of (Eve of) of Holy Pascha, May its blessings be with us. Amen.

THE PASCHAL PRAISE

Introduction to the Paschal Praise

Priest:

Lord have mercy upon us. Amen, Alleluia.

In the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

**The doxology of the Hour of (eve of) of Holy Pascha,
May its blessings be with us. Amen.**

Priest:

Make us worthy to pray thankfully:

Our Father Who art in heaven;

This is chanted 12 times and after each they recite “Our Father...”

Congregation:

LORD have mercy.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen.
Emmanuel our God and our King.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen. O my
Lord Jesus Christ.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen.

Our Father Who art in heaven;

Starting from the Eleventh hour on Tuesday, “my good Savior” is added after the second paragraph. This is a symbol of the Lord starting his passion, for on Wednesday, the chief priests and the scribes discussed arresting and killing Jesus.

Congregation:

LORD have mercy.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen.
Emmanuel our God and our King.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen. O my
Lord Jesus Christ my good Savior.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen.

Our Father Who art in heaven;

Starting from the Eve of Friday, the following phrase is added after the second paragraph. Here the church focuses on the Lord's Salvation that He showed in strength on Good Friday on the cross.

Congregation:

LORD have mercy.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen.
Emmanuel our God and our King.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen. O my Lord Jesus Christ my good Savior. The Lord is my strength, my praise, and has become my holy salvation.

Thine is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever Amen.

Our Father Who art in heaven;

PSALM AND GOSPEL

Reader:

A Psalm of David.

Introduction to the Gospel

We beseech our Lord and God, that we may be worthy to hear the Holy Gospel. In wisdom and uprightness, let us attend to the Holy Gospel.

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

The Psalm & the Gospel is then read in English or in Arabic with this introduction:

Reader: (in English)

From the Psalms of David the Prophet. May his blessings be with us. Amen.

The Psalm is read

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (Matthew, Mark, Luke or John), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

The Gospel is read**Congregation:**

Glory be to God.

THE EXPOSITION

A commentary is arranged for each hour. The appropriate commentary is either read after each Gospel or they are all read after the last Gospel of the Eve or Day.

Introduction to the Exposition

- In the name of the Trinity,
- One in essence,
- The Father, the Son,
- And the Holy Spirit.

Evening Hours

- Hail to you, Mary,
- The fair dove,
- Who has born unto us,
- God the Logos.

**The Exposition of the Hour of (eve of) of Holy Pascha,
May its blessings be with us. Amen.**

The Exposition is read

Daytime Hours

- O true light,
- Who enlightens,
- Every man,
- Who comes into the world.

Conclusion of Exposition

- Christ our Savior,
- Has come and has borne suffering,
- That through His Passion,
- He may save us.

- Let us glorify Him,
- And exalt His Name,
- For He has done us mercy,
- According to His great mercy.

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies

Priest:

Let us bow our knees.

Congregation:

Have mercy upon us O God, the Father, the Pantocrator.

Priest:

Let us stand. Let us bow our knees.

Congregation:

Have mercy upon us O God, our Savior.

Priest:

And Let us stand. Let us bow our knees.

Congregation:

Have mercy upon us O God, have mercy upon us.

DAYTIME LITANIES

*The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with **Lord have mercy** and kneel.*

1. Let us pray that God may have mercy and compassion upon us, hear us, help us and accept the supplications and prayers of His saints, for that which is good on our behalf at all times; **and forgive us our sins.**
2. Let us pray for the peace of the one, holy, catholic, and apostolic Church and for God's salvation and comfort to abide in all places, **and forgive us our sins.**
3. Let us pray for our fathers and our brethren who are sick with any sickness, whether in this place or in any place, that the Lord our God may grant us, with them, health and healing, **and forgive us our sins.**
4. Let us pray and ask for our fathers and our brethren in all places who are traveling, or planning to travel, that God may ease their ways, whether by sea, rivers, lakes, roads, (air,) or other means, and may the Lord our God guide them, return them in safety, **and forgive us our sins.**
5. Let us pray and ask for the air of heaven, the fruits of the earth, the trees and vineyards and all fruit-bearing trees everywhere, that Christ our God may bless them, **and forgive us our sins.**

6. Let us pray and ask that God may grant us mercy and compassion before leading authorities incline their hearts with goodwill towards us always, ***and forgive us our sins.***

7. Let us pray and ask for our fathers and brethren who have fallen asleep and reposed in the faith of Christ since the beginning. Our holy fathers the patriarchs, metropolitans, bishops, hegumens, priests, our brethren the deacons, our fathers the monks, and our fathers the laymen, and for the rest of all departed Christians, that the Lord our God may repose all their souls, ***and forgive us our sins.***

8. Let us pray and ask for those who care for the sacrifices, offerings, first fruits, oil, incense, coverings, reading books, and altar vessels, that the Lord our God may reward their labors in the heavenly Jerusalem, ***and forgive us our sins.***

9. Let us pray and ask for the catechumens of our people, that our Lord may bless them, open the eyes of their hearts, and confirm them in the Orthodox faith until the last breath, ***and forgive us our sins.***

10. Let us pray and ask for this church, and for all churches of the orthodox people, for the desert monasteries, and their elders, and for the peace of the whole world, that the Lord our God may protect both them and us from all evil, ***and forgive us our sins.***

11. Let us pray and ask for the life and standing of our honorable father, the Patriarch and Archbishop Pope Abba (.....). And his partner in the apostolic liturgy, our father the bishop (metropolitan) Abba (.....). And to confirm him (them) upon his (their) see(s) for many years and peaceful times, ***and forgive us our sins.***

12. Let us pray and ask for our orthodox fathers everywhere, the metropolitans and bishops, hegumens, priests, deacons, and all the orders of the Church that Christ our God may preserve and strengthen them, ***and forgive us our sins.***

13. Let us pray and ask for this assembly of ours and for all assemblies of the Orthodox people, that the Lord our God may bless them and fulfill them in peace, ***and forgive us our sins.***

14. Let us pray and ask for all hierarchs of the Holy Church, and all the orders of the clergy, that the Lord our God may bless and strengthen them, ***and forgive us our sins.***

15. Let us pray and ask for those who toil in the Holy Church and for the Orthodox people, that the Lord our God may have mercy on them, ***and forgive us our sins.***

16. Let us pray and ask for all Christ-loving rulers who asked us to pray for them by name, that the Lord our God may remember them in His mercy and

grant them favor before powerful rulers, ***and forgive us our sins.***

17. Let us pray and ask for the poor, the weak, the farmers, and for every soul in any type of hardship, that the Lord our God may have compassion on them and on us, ***and forgive us our sins.***

18. Let us pray and ask for those in the distress of jails, prisons, captivity or exile, and for those bound by devils, that the Lord our God may free them from their hardships, ***and forgive us our sins.***

19. Let us pray and ask for all those gathered with us today, in this place, seeking mercy for their souls, that the Lord's mercy might encompass both them and us, ***and forgive us our sins.***

20. Let us pray and ask for those each person by name, who asked us to remember them in our prayers, that the Lord our God may always remember them in His goodness, ***and forgive us our sins.***

21. Let us pray and ask for the rising of the waters of the rivers this year, that Christ our God may bless them and raise them according to their measure, give joy to all the earth with the Nile, sustain us, and deliver man and animal, and spare the world from death, scarcity, plagues, devastation, the sword of the enemies. And that He may grant calm, peace and security to our holy church and raise the state of Christians in every place on earth until the last breath, ***and forgive us our sins.***

22. Let us pray and ask for this Holy Pascha of our Good Savior, that He may complete it for us in peace and bring us the joy of His holy Resurrection in safety, ***and forgive us our sins.***

During the commemoration of a pope/pope's departure, replace litany 11 with:

Ask and pray for the reposal of the soul of our father the patriarch pope abba (.....), and that God may grant and appoint for us a good shepherd to shepherd His people in purity and righteousness, and to keep the life of our honoured father the bishop abba (.....), that God may keep him for many years and peaceful times, ***and to forgive us our sins.***

EVENING LITANIES

*The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with **Lord have mercy** without kneeling.*

1. We ask and entreat You O Lord, God the Father the Pantocrator, and the Holy Only Begotten Son, who created and ordered all things, and the Holy Spirit Giver of life, the Holy Trinity, before whom every knee bows in heaven and on earth. **We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.**
2. We pray for the heavenly peace and unity of all churches in the world, monasteries, and for those dwelling in the caring for all holy places. O God, have compassion on Your creation and deliver it from all evil. **We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.**
3. O You who by Your power planned the life of man before his creation and created all that exists by Your wisdom and adorned the heavens with stars, and the earth with plants, trees, and vineyards, and the valleys with meadows and flowers. O our King, accept now the supplication of Your servants who place themselves in Your hands and say, **We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.**
4. O Great and Holy God, who created man in His image and likeness and gave him a living and a reasoning soul, have mercy O Lord, on Your creation which You have made, show us compassion, and send down upon us Your

mercy from the height of Your holiness and Your prepared dwelling. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

5. O You, who saved Your servant Noah, the righteous, and delivered him from the flood, with his sons and their wives, and also the clean and unclean animals for the sake of the earth's renewal. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

6. O Maker and Provider of all, deliver Your people from the flood of the sea of this passing world, and protect them and all animals from harm, and provide for the needs of the birds for You give to all birds, animals, and ravens their sustenance. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

7. O You, who was received as a guest by Your servant Abraham the Patriarchs, and ate at his table, and blessed his Seed. O our King, accept now the supplications of Your servants and priests who place themselves in your hands, have compassion on the world and save Your people from every hardship, abide in them, and accompany them. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

8. We ask You, O Lord, to guard us from all evil to have compassion on Your creation and all Your people, for the eyes of everyone wait upon you, for You give them their food in due season. O sustainer of all flesh, the help of the helpless and the hope of the hopeless. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

9. O You, who looks to the humble with watchful eyes of protection, who saved Joseph from his master's wife, set him as a ruler over Egypt, and spared him in the days of hardship. So that his brothers and father Jacob came and knelt before him and took from him wheat for the sustenance of their children and animals. we bow down with our heads and kneel before You O our Creator and Provider, and we thank You for everything, concerning everything, and in everything. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

10. O God, Logos of the Father, who works in the Law, the prophets, and the Old Testament, and fulfills them, save Your people from every hardship, manage their lives according to Your goodwill, and spare them from famines and calamities. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

11. O You, who supported the people of Israel for forty years in the desert of Sinai, though they had no houses or storehouses, O my Lord, keep now Your people, and bless their houses and storehouses with Your heavenly blessings. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

12. O You, who accepted the prayer of Elijah the Tishbite when the sky rained and the earth produced vegetation, and blessed the barrel of wheat and the vessel of oil in the widow's house, accept the prayers of Your people through the intercessions of Your holy saints and prophets. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

13. O God, have compassion on the world with kind and merciful eyes, bless

their crops and storehouses, and the little they may have. raise the waters of the rivers according to their measure, grant moderation to the winds. Bless the Nile of Egypt this year and every year. Give joy to the face of the earth and to us men. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

14. O You, who accepted the repentance of the Ninivites, when they fasted together and received the confession of the right-hand thief upon the cross, make us also worthy of pleasing You and receiving Your compassion, crying and saying, “Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your kingdom.” And receive from Your servants, their repentance, their confessions, their fasting, and their offerings, which are offered upon Your Holy altars as acceptable incense and have mercy on them. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

15. O You the Mighty Provider, Chastiser, Healer and Physician of our souls and bodies, who tested his servant Job, and healed him of his calamities, and recompensed him for his losses with more than what he had, have mercy on Your people and save them all from calamities, tribulations, trials, and hardships, O up-holder of those who trust in You. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

16. O Christ our God, the Logos of the Father, who sanctified His pure disciples, washed their feet and made them leaders of the believers, and a light for the faith, who by them satisfied hungry souls, and taught them to pray saying, “Our Father who art in the heaven... Lead us not into temptation but deliver us from the evil one.” ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

17. O worker of wonders and miracles, who fed the thousands with five loaves, raised the dead, blessed the wedding of Cana of Galilee, O Lord, bless now the bread, oil, plants, bee-hives, trades, products and all the works of Your servants. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

18. O Lord, save Your people and surround them on every side by the sign of Your life-giving Cross. Raise the state of the Christians in all the world, and fill the hearts of their rulers with kindness towards them, soften their hearts toward our poor and needy brethren, and keep every evil thing far from them. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

19. O You, who entrusted us with Your Holy covenant, Your Body and Blood present with us every day upon the altar through the descending of Your Holy Spirit on the bread and wine, and commanded us, saying, “This do in remembrance of Me.” ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

20. O Christ our God, have mercy on Your people and the successors of Your Apostles. Bless the fruits of the earth, and give gladness to the heart of man through abundance of fruits and blessings. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

21. O Begotten of the Father, who was incarnate of the blessed Virgin Saint Mary, in the fullness of time, who said to His saintly disciples, “Go and make disciples of all the nations and baptize them, teaching them all that I have commanded you; and behold, I am with you always even unto the end of the world.” Be also

with Your people who cry out to You saying: ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

22. O forgiver of sins and giver of all things, forgive the sins of Your people and purify them from every blemish, and cleanse them from every deceit, and keep them from bearing false witness and from all envy and slander. And uproot from their hearts every evil thought, murmuring, doubts, and hardness of heart arising from pride. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

23. You are the rampart of our salvation, O Theotokos, the invincible fortress, bring to naught the counsels of the adversaries, turn the mourning of Your servants into joy. Defend our cities, fight for the Orthodox kings and leaders, and intercede for the peace of the world and the churches. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

24. O God of mercy and compassion, Lord of all comfort, do not be angry with us. nor rebuke us for our wicked deeds nor for our many sins. Do not be wrathful with us nor let Your wrath endure forever. Hear us, O God of Jacob, and look on us, O God our helper. Spare the world from death, scarcity, plagues, devastation, the sword of enemies, earthquakes, horror, and all fearsome events. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

25. For the sake of our protection under Your high and mighty hand, O God, we ask You to keep for us the life of our honored father, and Patriarch Pope Abba (.....). And his partner in the apostolic liturgy, our father

the bishop (metropolitan) Abba (.....). And to confirm him (them) upon his (their) throne(s) for many years and quiet and peaceful times. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear and have mercy on us***

26. O Christ our God, we ask of Your graciousness and Your great mercy to keep for us the life of our fathers: the metropolitans, the bishops, and all the leaders of the flock. Confirm the sheep of Your flock, grant protection to the priests, purity to the deacons, strength to the elders, understanding to the young, chastity to the virgins, asceticism to the monks and nuns, purity to the married, and protection for women. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

27. Again we ask for the safe return of travelers; support for widows and orphans; abundance for the poor; and those who are in debt, pay their debts and forgive them; and those who are in prisons and distress, give them release. Heal the sick and repose the departed. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

28. O God of our holy fathers, do not forsake those whom You have created with Your Holy hands. O You who manifested Your love for mankind, O Merciful One, accept from Your Mother an intercession on our behalf and save. O Savior, a humble people. Do not leave us to the end, nor forsake us forever. For the sake of Your Holy Name, do not break Your covenant nor take away from us Your mercy for the sake of Abraham Your beloved, Isaac Your servant, and Jacob Your saint. ***We ask You, O Lord, hear us and have mercy on us.***

During the commemoration of a pope/pope's departure, replace litany 25 with:

Ask and pray for the reposal of the soul of our father the patriarch pope abba (.....), and that God may grant and appoint for us a good shepherd to shepherd His people in purity and righteousness, and to keep the life of our honoured father the bishop abba (.....), that God may keep him for many years and peaceful times. ***We ask You O Lord to hear us and have mercy upon us***

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

Priest:

O God, have mercy upon us. settle mercy upon us. show us mercy in Your kingdom.

*The congregation alternate in chanting Lord Have mercy.
Each side 3 times for a total of 12 times.*

The Refrain

Congregation:

Lord have mercy.

Lord have mercy.

Lord have mercy.

O King of peace, grant us Your peace, establish for us Your peace, and forgive us our sins.

The Refrain

Disperse the enemies, of the Church, fortify her that she may not be shaken forever.

The Refrain

Immanuel our God, is now in our midst, with the glory of His Father, and the Holy Spirit.

The Refrain

May He bless us all, purify our hearts, and heal the sicknesses, of our souls and bodies.

The Refrain

We worship You O Christ, with Your Good Father, and the Holy Spirit, for You were crucified and saved us.

CONCLUSION OF SERVICE HYMN

Congregation:

Amen. Alleluia. Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

We proclaim and say, O our LORD Jesus Christ,

Who was crucified on the cross: trample Satan under our feet.

Save us and have mercy on us*.

LORD have mercy. LORD have mercy. LORD bless us. Amen. Bless me. [Bless me.] Lo, the repentance (metanoia). Forgive me. Say the blessing.

CONCLUSION OF SERVICE HYMN

in the presence of the Pope or a Bishop.

Congregation:

Amen. Alleluia. Glory Save us and have mercy on us.

You have received the grace of Moses, the priesthood of Melchizedek, the old age of Jacob, the long life of Methuselah, the excellent understanding of David, the wisdom of Solomon, and the Spirit, the Paraclete who came upon the Apostles.

May the LORD preserve the life and rising of our honored father, the archpriest, Pope Abba (.....).

If a bishop is present:

(And our father the metropolitan (bishop), Abba (...)).

May the God of heaven confirm him (them) on his (their) throne(s) for many years and peaceful times.

May He subdue all his (their) enemies under his (their) feet speedily.

Pray to Christ on our behalf that He may forgive us our sins, in peace, according to His great mercy.

LORD have mercy.....

THE SHORT BLESSING

Priest:

May Jesus Christ our true God, who deigned to suffer of His own will, and was crucified upon the Cross on our behalf, bless us with every spiritual blessing, help us, and conclude for us this holy Pascha in peace, and reveal to us the joy of His holy Resurrection for many years and peaceful times.

Through the never-ending intercessions of the holy Theotokos, Saint Mary, and of all the choirs of the angels and archangels. and through the prayers of the patriarchs, prophets, apostles, martyrs, righteous, holy ones, cross-bearers, ascetics, confessors and anchorites. and through the blessing of the Holy Pascha of our good Saviour.

May their holy blessing, their grace, their power, their gift, their love, and their help rest upon us all for ever. Amen.

O Christ our God.

Congregation:

Amen. So be it.

Priest:

O King of peace, grant us Your peace, establish for us Your peace, and forgive us our sins. For Yours is the power, the glory, the blessing, and the majesty, forever. Amen.

Make us worthy to pray thankfully:

Our Father Who art in heaven;

Priest:

The grace of our LORD, God, and Saviour Jesus Christ be with you all. Go in peace. The LORD be with you all. Amen.

Or he says:

The love of God the Father; the grace of the only-begotten Son, our LORD, God, and Saviour Jesus Christ; and the communion and gift of the Holy Spirit be with you all. Go in peace. The peace of the LORD be with you all. Amen.

Congregation:

And with your spirit.



THE HOLY PASCHA OF HOSANNA SUNDAY

THE NINTH HOUR OF HOSANNA SUNDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Lamentations 1:1-4

A reading from the Lamentations of Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

It came to pass after the captivity of Israel and the destruction of Jerusalem that Jeremiah wept on Jerusalem and said: How lonely sits the city That was full of people! How like a widow is she, Who was great among the nations! The princess among the provinces Has become a slave! She weeps bitterly in the night, Her tears are on her cheeks; Among all her lovers She has none to comfort her. All her friends have dealt treacherously with her; They have become her enemies. Judah has gone into captivity, Under affliction and hard servitude; She dwells among the nations, She finds no rest; All her persecutors overtake her in dire straits. The roads to Zion mourn Because no one comes to the set feasts. All her gates are desolate; Her priests sigh, Her virgins are afflicted, And she is in bitterness.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Zephaniah 3:11-20

**A reading from Zephaniah the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

The Lord says: "In that day you shall not be shamed for any of your deeds In which you transgress against Me; For then I will take away from your midst Those who rejoice in your pride, And you shall no longer be haughty In My holy mountain. I will leave in your midst A meek and humble people, And they shall trust in the name of the Lord. The remnant of Israel shall do no unrighteousness And speak no lies, Nor shall a deceitful tongue be found in their mouth; For they shall feed their flocks and lie down, And no one shall make them afraid."

Sing, O daughter of Zion! Shout, O Israel! Be glad and rejoice with all your heart, O daughter of Jerusalem! The Lord has taken away your judgments, He has cast out your enemy. The King of Israel, the Lord, is in your midst; You shall see disaster no more. In that day it shall be said to Jerusalem: "Do not fear; Zion, let not your hands be weak. The Lord your God in your midst, The Mighty One, will save; He will rejoice over you with gladness, He will quiet you with His love, He will rejoice over you with singing." "I will gather those who sorrow over the appointed assembly, Who are among you, To whom its reproach is a burden. Behold, at that time I will deal with all who afflict you; I will save the lame, And gather those who were driven out; I will appoint them for praise and fame In every land where they were put to shame. At that time I will bring you

back, Even at the time I gather you; For I will give you fame and praise.
Among all the peoples of the earth, When I return your captives before
your eyes," Says the Lord.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

***The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of the Hosanna Sunday of Holy
Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.***

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 8:2,3

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

From of the mouth of babes and nursing infants, You Prepared praise because of Your enemies, that You may destroy the enemy and the avenger. For I shall look at the heavens the works of Your fingers, the moon and the stars You established. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 21:10-17

And when He had come into Jerusalem, all the city was moved, saying, "Who is this?" So the multitudes said, "This is Jesus, the prophet from Nazareth of Galilee."

Then Jesus went into the temple of God and drove out all those who bought and sold in the temple, and overturned the tables of the money changers and the seats of those who sold doves. And He said to them,

"It is written, 'My house shall be called a house of prayer,' but you have made it a 'den of thieves.' "Then the blind and the lame came to Him in the temple, and He healed them. But when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that He did, and the children crying out in the temple and saying, "Hosanna to the Son of David!" they were indignant and said to Him, "Do You hear what these are saying!" And Jesus said to them, "Yes. Have you never read, 'Out of the mouth of babes and nursing infants You have perfected praise'?" Then He left them and went out of the city to Bethany, and He lodged there.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of Hosanna Sunday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Exposition
9th Hour

O come all of you today, O blessed, pious, Christian, church-loving people; Let us glorify the one God, who, in this week received the sufferings on our behalf for the salvation of our father Adam and our mother Eve, the mother of all the living.

Exposition
11th Hour

On this day, the Lord entered Jerusalem together with His disciples. And when He entered, all the city was moved and shaken, saying, "Who is this?" And the great multitudes said, this is the great prophet from Nazareth.

Then the blind and the lame came to Him, and He healed them all, and all the children cried out saying, "Hosanna to the Son of David!" But when the chief priests saw it, they murmured saying, what shall we do? And Jesus said to them, "Yes. Have you never read in the scripture, "Out of the mouth of babes and nursing infants You have perfected praise?" when the infidel and treacherous jews heard this, they all took counsel to kill Him.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THE ELEVENTH HOUR OF HOSANNA SUNDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Isaiah 48:12-22

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us
Amen.**

Listen to Me, O Jacob, And Israel, My called: I am He, I am the First, I am also the Last. Indeed My hand has laid the foundation of the earth, And My right hand has stretched out the heavens; When I call to them, They stand up together." All of you, assemble yourselves, and hear! Who among them has declared these things? The Lord loves him; He shall do His pleasure on Babylon, And His arm shall be against the Chaldeans. I, even I, have spoken; Yes, I have called him, I have brought him, and his way will prosper." Come near to Me, hear this: I have not spoken in secret from the beginning; From the time that it was, I was there. And now the Lord God and His Spirit Have sent Me."

Thus says the Lord, your Redeemer, The Holy One of Israel: "I am the Lord your God, Who teaches you to profit, Who leads you by the way you should go. Oh, that you had heeded My commandments! Then your peace would have been like a river, And your righteousness like the waves of the sea. Your descendants also would have been like the sand, And the offspring of your body like the grains of sand; His name would not have been cut off Nor destroyed from before Me."

Go forth from Babylon! Flee from the Chaldeans! With a voice of singing, Declare, proclaim this, Utter it to the end of the earth; Say, "The Lord has redeemed His servant Jacob!" And they did not thirst When He led them through the deserts; He caused the waters to flow from the rock for them; He also split the rock, and the waters gushed out." There is no peace," says the Lord, "for the wicked."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Nahum 1:2-8

**A reading from Nahum the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

God is jealous, and the Lord avenges; The Lord avenges and is furious. The Lord will take vengeance on His adversaries, And He reserves wrath for His enemies; The Lord is slow to anger and great in power, And will not at all acquit the wicked. The Lord has His way In the whirlwind and in the storm, And the clouds are the dust of His feet.

He rebukes the sea and makes it dry, And dries up all the rivers. Bashan and Carmel wither, And the flower of Lebanon wilts. The mountains quake before Him, The hills melt, And the earth heaves at His presence, Yes, the world and all who dwell in it. Who can stand before His indignation? And who can endure the fierceness of His anger? His fury is poured out like fire, And the rocks are thrown down by Him.

The Lord is good, A stronghold in the day of trouble; And He knows those who trust in Him. But with an overflowing flood He will make an utter end of its place, And darkness will pursue His enemies.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of the Hosanna Sunday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Psalm 22: 22- 23

I will declare Your name to My brethren; In the midst of the assembly I will praise You. You who fear the Lord, praise Him! All you descendants of Jacob, glorify Him, And fear Him, all you offspring of Israel! Alleluia.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 20: 20- 28

Then the mother of Zebedee's sons came to Him with her sons, kneeling down and asking something from Him. And He said to her, "What do you wish?" She said to Him, "Grant that these two sons of mine may sit, one on Your right hand and the other on the left, in Your kingdom." But Jesus answered and said, "You do not know what you ask. Are you able to drink the cup that I am about to drink, and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with?" They said to Him, "We are able."

So He said to them, "You will indeed drink My cup, and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with; but to sit on My right hand and on My left is not Mine to give, but it is for those for whom it is prepared by My Father." And when the ten heard it, they were greatly displeased with the two brothers. But Jesus called them to Himself and said, "You know that the rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and those who are great exercise authority over them.

Yet it shall not be so among you; but whoever desires to become great among you, let him be your servant. And whoever desires to be first among you, let him be your slave-- just as the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give His life a ransom for many."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Eleventh Hour of Hosanna Sunday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

In the minds of the antagonizing Jews, our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ was surrounded by people, troops, soldiers and warriors, similar to the kings of this world. These were the thoughts of the mother of John and James, sons of Zebedee. She came to our Savior while He was surrounded by the people and His disciples. She worshipped Him with her sons and said, "Grant that my two sons may sit, one on Your right hand, and the other on Your left, in Your kingdom."

Hear then what the merciful and most compassionate Lord, who desires salvation for the whole world, said, "Are you able to drink of the cup that I shall drink of and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with?" They said to Him, "We are able." He answered them, "You will indeed be able to, but to sit at My right hand and at My left is not Mine to give. It shall be given to those chosen by My omnipresent Father." The two brothers were quiet when they heard these words and departed because of the magnitude of His glory.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

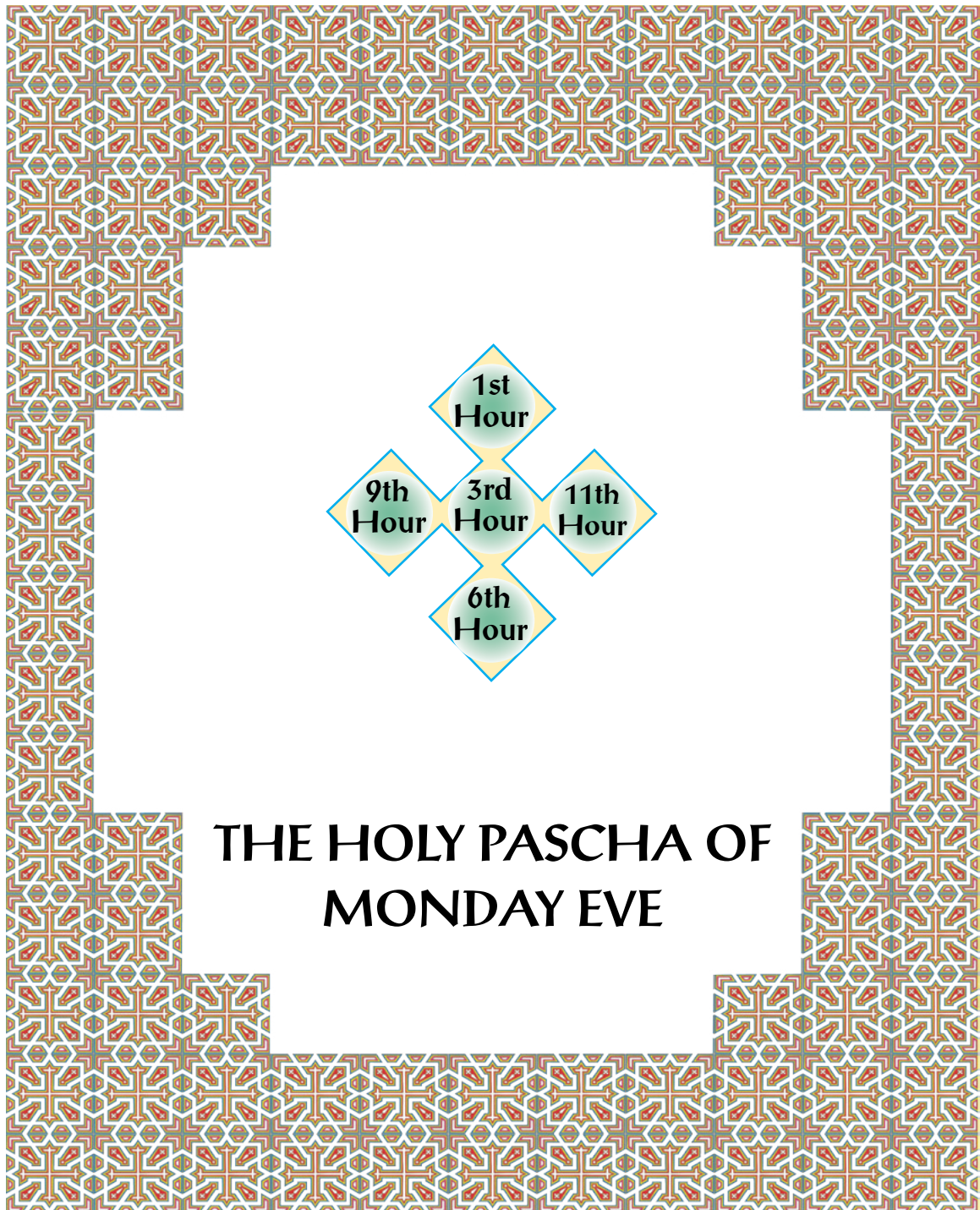
See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



FIRST HOUR OF EVE OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Zephaniah 1:2-12

A reading from the Zephaniah the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

I will utterly consume everything From the face of the land," Says the LORD; "I will consume man and beast; I will consume the birds of the heavens, The fish of the sea, And the stumbling blocks along with the wicked. I will cut off man from the face of the land," Says the LORD."

"I will utterly consume everything From the face of the land," Says the LORD; "I will consume man and beast; I will consume the birds of the heavens, The fish of the sea, And the stumbling blocks along with the wicked. I will cut off man from the face of the land," Says the LORD."

I will stretch out My hand against Judah, And against all the inhabitants of Jerusalem. I will cut off every trace of Baal from this place, The names of the idolatrous priests with the pagan priests Those who worship the

host of heaven on the housetops; Those who worship and swear oaths by the LORD, But who also swear by Milcom; Those who have turned back from following the LORD, And have not sought the LORD, nor inquired of Him."

Be silent in the presence of the Lord GOD; For the day of the LORD is at hand, For the LORD has prepared a sacrifice; He has invited His guests." And it shall be, In the day of the LORD's sacrifice, That I will punish the princes and the king's children, And all such as are clothed with foreign apparel. In the same day I will punish All those who leap over the threshold, Who fill their masters' houses with violence and deceit."

And there shall be on that day," says the LORD, "The sound of a mournful cry from the Fish Gate, A wailing from the Second Quarter, And a loud crashing from the hills. Wail, you inhabitants of Maktesh! For all the merchant people are cut down; All those who handle money are cut off." And it shall come to pass at that time That I will search Jerusalem with lamps, And punish the men Who are settled in complacency, Who say in their heart, "The LORD will not do good, Nor will He do evil.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour: of the Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Psalm 27:6,7

I will sing, yes, I will sing praises to the LORD. Hear, O Lord, when I cry with my voice! Have mercy also upon me, and answer me. Alleluia.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 12:20-36

Now there were certain Greeks among those who came up to worship at the feast. Then they came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida of Galilee, and asked him, saying, "Sir, we wish to see Jesus." Philip came and told Andrew, and in turn Andrew and Philip told Jesus. But Jesus answered them, saying, "The hour has come that the Son of Man should be glorified. Most assuredly, I say to you, unless a grain of wheat falls into the ground and dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it produces much grain. He who

loves his life will lose it, and he who hates his life in this world will keep it for eternal life.

If anyone serves Me, let him follow Me; and where I am, there My servant will be also. If anyone serves Me, him My Father will honor." Now My soul is troubled, and what shall I say? "Father, save Me from this hour"? But for this purpose I came to this hour. Father, glorify Your name."

Then a voice came from heaven, saying, "I have both glorified it and will glorify it again." Therefore the people who stood by and heard it said that it had thundered. Others said, "An angel has spoken to Him." Jesus answered and said, "This voice did not come because of Me, but for your sake. Now is the judgment of this world; now the ruler of this world will be cast out. And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all peoples to Myself."

This He said, signifying by what death He would die. The people answered Him, "We have heard from the law that the Christ remains forever; and how can You say, "The Son of Man must be lifted up"? Who is this Son of Man?" Then Jesus said to them, "A little while longer the light is with you. Walk while you have the light, lest darkness overtake you; he who walks in darkness does not know where he is going. While you have the light, believe in the light, that you may become sons of light."

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The First Hour of Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

If in the beginning of the month, people became eager and long to see the moon’s brightness, then how much more is Christ our God, the Sun of Righteousness, who shared in the walking with the people and was found in the likeness of a servant; more so when the Greeks who came to the feast and saw His great glory.

They said to Phillip, who was from Bethsaida: “Sir, we would like to see Jesus.” Then Phillip came and told Andrew, again they came and told Jesus. Then Jesus, our Lord, said: “The hour has come when the Son of man will be glorified.” By these words He was signifying His life-giving death.

When all the multitudes heard His Divine oracles, they came to Jesus our Savior. He taught them with parables. “Believe in the light while you have the light so that you may become the children of the light.” We, too, believe that He is truly the Light of the Father, whom He sent into the world. His divine glory illuminated us, we who are sitting in the darkness and shadow of death. And, He raised us to the original dignity from the abyss of our sins.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF EVE OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Zephaniah 1:14 - 2:1-2

**A reading from Zephaniah the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

The great day of the LORD is near; It is near and hastens quickly. The noise of the day of the LORD is bitter; There the mighty men shall cry out. That day is a day of wrath, A day of trouble and distress, A day of devastation and desolation, A day of darkness and gloominess, A day of clouds and thick darkness, A day of trumpet and alarm Against the fortified cities And against the high towers." I will bring distress upon men, And they shall walk like blind men, Because they have sinned against the LORD; Their blood shall be poured out like dust, And their flesh like refuse." Neither their silver nor their gold Shall be able to deliver them In the day of the LORD's wrath; But the whole land shall be devoured By the fire of His jealousy, For He will make speedy riddance Of all those who dwell in the land.

Gather yourselves together, yes, gather together, O undesirable nation,
 Before the decree is issued, Or the day passes like chaff, Before the LORD's
 fierce anger comes upon you, Before the day of the LORD's anger comes
 upon you!

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

***The Doxology of the Third Hour: of the Eve of Monday of Holy
 Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy
 Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 28:9 & 2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Save Your people, And bless Your inheritance; Shepherd them also,
And bear them up forever. Hear the voice of my supplications When
I cry to You. **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

Luke 9:18-22

And it happened, as He was alone praying, that His disciples joined Him, and He asked them, saying, "Who do the crowds say that I am?" So they answered and said, "John the Baptist, but some say Elijah; and others say that one of the old prophets has risen again." He said to them, "But who do you say that I am?" Peter answered and said, "The Christ of God." And He strictly warned and commanded them to tell this to no one, saying, "The Son of Man must suffer many things, and be rejected by the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised the third day."

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Third Hour of the eve of Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Our Savior prayed in order to teach us to be always awake for prayers. After He finished, He asked His disciples, “Who do the crowds say that I am?” They answered: “Some say John the Baptist, but others say Elijah; or one of the old prophets.” He, the omniscient, was testing them. Then He asked, “But who do you say that I am?” Peter answered saying, “You are Christ, the Son of God, who came to the world to save us.”

“Blessed are you Peter, the solid rock, because flesh and blood did not reveal this to you but My Father did, so that you preach it to the world. As for the accursed Jews, they are rejecting Me because of their envy, and will deliver Me to death. I shall expose, and defame them; and will cause them eternal disgrace and shame.”

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF EVE OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Joel 1:5-15

A reading from Joel the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

A wake, you drunkards, and weep; And wail, all you drinkers of wine, Because of the new wine, For it has been cut off from your mouth. For a nation has come up against My land, Strong, and without number; His teeth are the teeth of a lion, And he has the fangs of a fierce lion. He has laid waste My vine, And ruined My fig tree; He has stripped it bare and thrown it away; Its branches are made white. Lament like a virgin girded with sackcloth For the husband of her youth. The grain offering and the drink offering Have been cut off from the house of the LORD; The priests mourn, who minister to the LORD. The field is wasted, The land mourns; For the grain is ruined, The new wine is dried up, The oil fails. Be ashamed, you farmers, Wail, you vinedressers, For the wheat and the barley; Because the harvest of the field has perished. The vine has dried up, And the fig tree

has withered; The pomegranate tree, The palm tree also, And the apple tree
All the trees of the field are withered; Surely joy has withered away from
the sons of men. Gird yourselves and lament, you priests; Wail, you who
minister before the altar; Come, lie all night in sackcloth, You who minister
to my God; For the grain offering and the drink offering Are withheld from
the house of your God. Consecrate a fast, Call a sacred assembly; Gather
the elders And all the inhabitants of the land Into the house of the LORD
your God, And cry out to the LORD. Alas for the day! For the day of the
LORD is at hand; It shall come as destruction from the Almighty.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

***The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of the Eve of Monday of Holy
Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 29:1,2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Give unto the Lord, O you mighty ones, Give unto the Lord glory and strength. Give unto the Lord the glory due to His name; Worship the Lord in the beauty of holiness. **Alleulia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 10:32-34

Now they were on the road, going up to Jerusalem, and Jesus was going before them; and they were amazed. And as they followed they were afraid. Then He took the twelve aside again and began to tell them the things that would happen to Him: "Behold, we are going up to Jerusalem, and the Son of Man will be betrayed to the chief priests and to the scribes; and they will condemn Him to death and deliver Him to the Gentiles; and they will mock Him, and scourge Him, and spit on Him, and kill Him. And the third day He will rise again."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Sixth Hour of Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

And while Christ our Lord and His disciples were on their way to Jerusalem, the twelve apostles came to Him and He started to tell them about the sufferings that will come upon him. He said, "Behold, you that are chosen and pure, we are going up to Jerusalem. The chief priests of the Jews, their elders and scribes, will rise together against the Son of Man. and they shall condemn Him to death and shall deliver Him to the Gentiles. And they shall mock Him and shall scourge Him and shall spit upon Him, and crucify Him on the cross; and on the third day He shall rise again."

You poor Israel, how dare you do that in your ignorance and crucify Jesus Christ, who saved you from slavery. You rewarded charity with evil. That is why your sins remain forever.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF EVE OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Micah 2:3-10

**A reading from the Micah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Therefore thus says the LORD: "Behold, against this family I am devising disaster, From which you cannot remove your necks; Nor shall you walk haughtily, For this is an evil time.

In that day one shall take up a proverb against you, And lament with a bitter lamentation, saying: "We are utterly destroyed! He has changed the heritage of my people; How He has removed it from me! To a turncoat He has divided our fields." ' Therefore you will have no one to determine boundaries by lot In the assembly of the LORD." Do not prattle," you say to those who prophesy. So they shall not prophesy to you; They shall not return insult for insult.

You who are named the house of Jacob: "Is the Spirit of the LORD restricted? Are these His doings? Do not My words do good To him who walks uprightly? "Lately My people have risen up as an enemy You pull off the robe with the garment From those who trust you, as they pass by, Like men returned from war. The women of My people you cast out From their pleasant houses; From their children You have taken away My glory forever." Arise and depart, For this is not your rest; Because it is defiled, it shall destroy, Yes, with utter destruction.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of the Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 8:2,1

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

I have called upon You, for You will hear me, O God; Incline Your ear to me, and hear my speech. Hear a just cause, O LORD, Attend to my cry. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 8:27-33

Now Jesus and His disciples went out to the towns of Caesarea Philippi; and on the road He asked His disciples, saying to them, "Who do men say that I am?" So they answered, "John the Baptist; but some say, Elijah; and others, one of the prophets." He said to them, "But who do you say that I am?" Peter answered and said to Him, "You are the Christ." Then He strictly warned them that they should tell no one about Him.

And He began to teach them that the Son of Man must suffer many things, and be rejected by the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and after three days rise again. He spoke this word openly. Then Peter took Him aside and began to rebuke Him. But when He had turned around and looked at His disciples, He rebuked Peter, saying, "Get behind Me, Satan! For you are not mindful of the things of God, but the things of men."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

While Jesus and His disciples were on the road to Caesarea Philippi, He started to talk to them overtly about what will happen to Him in Jerusalem. He must fulfill what is written: That the Son of Man will have lots of pains. He will be rejected from the the scribes and the elders of the Jews. And after the sufferings He will rise on the third day. This is the stone that the builders rejected as the scriptures say: "He will descend with great anger upon them and His rage will destroy them. He will pour the shame upon their faces because they rewarded charity with evil. And for those who obey Him, and believe in Him, He will give eternal happiness."

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THE ELEVENTH HOUR OF EVE OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Micah 3:1-4

**A reading from Micah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

And I said: "Hear now, O heads of Jacob, And you rulers of the house of Israel: Is it not for you to know justice? You who hate good and love evil; Who strip the skin from My people, And the flesh from their bones; Who also eat the flesh of My people, Flay their skin from them, Break their bones, And chop them in pieces Like meat for the pot, Like flesh in the caldron." Then they will cry to the LORD, But He will not hear them; He will even hide His face from them at that time, Because they have been evil in their deeds.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of the Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 18:17-18

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

He delivered me from my strong enemy, From those who hated me, For they were too strong for me. They confronted me in the day of my calamity. **Alleluia**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 17:19-23

Then the disciples came to Jesus privately and said, "Why could we not cast it out?" So Jesus said to them, "Because of your unbelief; for assuredly, I say to you, if you have faith as a mustard seed, you will say to this mountain, "Move from here to there,' and it will move; and nothing will be impossible for you. However, this kind does not go out except by prayer and fasting."

Now while they were staying in Galilee, Jesus said to them, "The Son of Man is about to be betrayed into the hands of men, and they will kill Him, and the third day He will be raised up." And they were exceedingly sorrowful.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Eleventh Hour of the Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Listen to the Merciful and Beneficent who is all of goodness and compassion. He praises prayer and honors fasting because they are the roots for all virtues. When His disciples asked Him, “Why could we not cast the demon out?” He said to them, “Because of your little faith, the demon would not come out. For truly I say to you, if you have faith, you will say to this mountain ‘Move from here to there,’ and it will move, and nothing will be impossible for you” for everything is possible to the believer.

So let us cherish a great hope and a true faith free of doubt, and let us be zealous in charity that surpasses everything; for He who loves accepts everything. Let us love fasting and pray consistently so that we may gain His promises.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

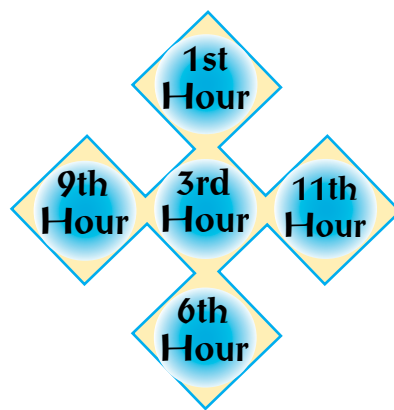
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CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



THE HOLY PASCHA OF MONDAY DAY

FIRST HOUR OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Genesis 1:1- 2:1-3

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. The earth was without form, and void; and darkness was on the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God was hovering over the face of the waters. Then God said, "Let there be light"; and there was light. And God saw the light, that it was good; and God divided the light from the darkness. God called the light Day, and the darkness He called Night. So the evening and the morning were the first day.

Then God said, "Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters." Thus God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament; and it was so. And God called the fir-

mament Heaven. So the evening and the morning were the second day. Then God said, "Let the waters under the heavens be gathered together into one place, and let the dry land appear"; and it was so.

And God called the dry land Earth, and the gathering together of the waters He called Seas. And God saw that it was good. Then God said, "Let the earth bring forth grass, the herb that yields seed, and the fruit tree that yields fruit according to its kind, whose seed is in itself, on the earth"; and it was so. And the earth brought forth grass, the herb that yields seed according to its kind, and the tree that yields fruit, whose seed is in itself according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. So the evening and the morning were the third day.

Then God said, "Let there be lights in the firmament of the heavens to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs and seasons, and for days and years; and let them be for lights in the firmament of the heavens to give light on the earth"; and it was so. Then God made two great lights: the greater light to rule the day, and the lesser light to rule the night. He made the stars also. God set them in the firmament of the heavens to give light on the earth, and to rule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the darkness. And God saw that it was good. So the evening and the morning were the fourth day.

Then God said, "Let the waters abound with an abundance of living creatures, and let birds fly above the earth across the face of the firmament of the heavens." So God created great sea creatures and every living thing

that moves, with which the waters abounded, according to their kind, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. And God blessed them, saying, "Be fruitful and multiply, and fill the waters in the seas, and let birds multiply on the earth." So the evening and the morning were the fifth day.

Then God said, "Let the earth bring forth the living creature according to its kind: cattle and creeping thing and beast of the earth, each according to its kind"; and it was so. And God made the beast of the earth according to its kind, cattle according to its kind, and everything that creeps on the earth according to its kind. And God saw that it was good.

Then God said, "Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over the cattle, over all the earth and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth." So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them. Then God blessed them, and God said to them, "Be fruitful and multiply; fill the earth and subdue it; have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over every living thing that moves on the earth." And God said, "See, I have given you every herb that yields seed which is on the face of all the earth, and every tree whose fruit yields seed; to you it shall be for food. Also, to every beast of the earth, to every bird of the air, and to everything that creeps on the earth, in which there is life, I have given every green herb for food"; and it was so. Then God saw everything that He had made, and in-

deed it was very good. So the evening and the morning were the sixth day. Thus the heavens and the earth, and all the host of them, were finished. And on the seventh day God ended His work which He had done, and He rested on the seventh day from all His work which He had done. Then God blessed the seventh day and sanctified it, because in it He rested from all His work which God had created and made.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 5:1-9

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Now let me sing to my Well-beloved A song of my Beloved regarding His vineyard: My Well-beloved has a vineyard On a very fruitful hill. He dug it up and cleared out its stones, And planted it with the choicest vine. He built a tower in its midst, And also made a winepress in it; So He expected it to bring forth good grapes, But it brought forth wild grapes.

"And now, O inhabitants of Jerusalem and men of Judah, Judge, please, between Me and My vineyard. What more could have been done to

My vineyard That I have not done in it? Why then, when I expected it to bring forth good grapes, Did it bring forth wild grapes? And now, please let Me tell you what I will do to My vineyard: I will take away its hedge, and it shall be burned; And break down its wall, and it shall be trampled down. I will lay it waste; It shall not be pruned or dug, But there shall come up briars and thorns. I will also command the clouds That they rain no rain on it."

For the vineyard of the Lord of hosts is the house of Israel, And the men of Judah are His pleasant plant. He looked for justice, but behold, oppression; For righteousness, but behold, a cry for help.

Woe to those who join house to house; They add field to field, till there is no place Where they may dwell alone in the midst of the land! In my hearing the Lord of hosts said, "Truly, many houses shall be desolate, Great and beautiful ones, without inhabitant.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 1:1-14

**A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may
his blessings be with us, Amen.**

All wisdom cometh from the Lord, And is with him forever. Who can count the sand of the sea, the drops of rain, and the days of eternity?

Who can search out the height of heaven, the breadth of the earth, the abyss, and wisdom?

Wisdom was created before all things, and the insight of prudence was from eternity. (The word of God most high is the fountain of wisdom; and her ways are everlasting commandments.) To whom has the root of wisdom been revealed? and who has come to know her greet deeds?

There is one who is wise and is feared exceedingly, He who sits upon His throne. The Lord Himself created wisdom. He saw and numbered her and poured her out on all His works. In the midst of all flesh according to His gift, and He provided her for those who love Him.

The fear of the Lord is glory and boasting, and gladness, and a crown of rejoicing. The fear of the Lord will cheer the heart, and will give gladness, joy, and long life. For those who fear the Lord, it shall be well to the utmost, and on the day of his death, he will be blessed.

The beginning of wisdom is to fear the Lord: and she was joined with the faithful in the womb. She constructed a foundation of life among men, and will be trusted among their seed.

The gratification of wisdom is to fear the Lord, and she intoxicates them with her fruits. She will fill every house of theirs with objects of desire and their storehouses with her harvest.

The fear of the Lord is a crown of wisdom, making peace and soundness of health to flourish. The Lord saw and numbered her, and poured out the power of comprehension; and He exalted the glory of those who hold fast to her.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Brethren, if we want to escape God's punishment and find mercy in his eyes, let us sit every evening alone by ourselves and search our souls for what we presented to our guardian angel to offer to the Lord.

Again, as the night goes by and a new day dawns and light prevails, let us search ourselves to know what we presented to our companion angel to offer to the Lord. Let it be beyond doubt that everyone of us, male or female, young or old, who was baptized in the name of the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit has been assigned to a designated angel until the day of his death to report to him every day what his assigned individual has done by day or by night. Not that God is unaware of what we have done. Heaven forbid! He is more knowledgeable about it. As is written, the eyes of the Lord are watching all the time everywhere on those who commit evil and on those who do good. Rather the angels are servants installed by the Creator of the universe for those who will inherit the salvation.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour: of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 71:18-19

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Blessed be the LORD God, the God of Israel, Who only does wondrous things! And blessed be His glorious name forever! **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

Mark 11:12-24

Now the next day, when they had come out from Bethany, He was hungry. And seeing from afar a fig tree having leaves, He went to see if perhaps He would find something on it. When He came to it, He found nothing but leaves, for it was not the season for figs. In response Jesus said to it, "Let no one eat fruit from you ever again." And His disciples heard it.

So they came to Jerusalem. Then Jesus went into the temple and began to drive out those who bought and sold in the temple, and overturned the tables of the moneychangers and the seats of those who sold doves. And He would not allow anyone to carry wares through the temple.

Then He taught, saying to them, "Is it not written, "My house shall be called a house of prayer for all nations'? But you have made it a "den of thieves."" And the scribes and chief priests heard it and sought how they might destroy Him; for they feared Him, because all the people were astonished at His teaching. When evening had come, He went out of the city.

Now in the morning, as they passed by, they saw the fig tree dried up from the roots. And Peter, remembering, said to Him, "Rabbi, look! The fig tree which You cursed has withered away." So Jesus answered and said to them, "Have faith in God. For assuredly, I say to you, whoever says to this mountain, "Be removed and be cast into the sea,' and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that those things he says will be done, he will have whatever he says. Therefore I say to you, whatever things you ask when you pray, believe that you receive them, and you will have them.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of The First Hour of Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth and adorned them with His spirit. He covered darkness and unveiled the light, and distinguished between them with new names. He called the light day and the darkness night. He created all these in the same day with wisdom and prudence.

On the second day, God created the firmament and separated between waters and waters. God established the water above the firmament and called them Heaven. On the third day, He gathered the waters and made the land appear over the waters. and He created all kinds of grass, plants, and fruit yielding trees. On the fourth day, God created the sun, the moon, and the multitude of stars. On the fifth day, God created the birds, the big whales, the farm animals.

On the sixth day, God created Adam, the first man, and a companion for him from his own flesh, male and female as designated and gave them dominion over all the creatures He created. God rested on the seventh day from all the work which He had done. These are the designs of the Creator and the Initiator of all creation.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 50

THIRD HOUR OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Isaiah 5: 20-30

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Woe to those who call evil good, and good evil; Who put darkness for light, and light for darkness; Who put bitter for sweet, and sweet for bitter! Woe to those who are wise in their own eyes, And prudent in their own sight! Woe to men mighty at drinking wine, Woe to men valiant for mixing intoxicating drink, Who justify the wicked for a bribe, And take away justice from the righteous man!

Therefore, as the fire devours the stubble, And the flame consumes the chaff, So their root will be as rottenness, And their blossom will ascend like dust; Because they have rejected the law of the LORD of hosts, And despised the word of the Holy One of Israel. Therefore the anger of the LORD is aroused against His people; He has stretched out His hand

against them And stricken them, And the hills trembled. Their carcasses were as refuse in the midst of the streets. For all this His anger is not turned away, But His hand is stretched out still.

He will lift up a banner to the nations from afar, And will whistle to them from the end of the earth; Surely they shall come with speed, swiftly. No one will be weary or stumble among them, No one will slumber or sleep; Nor will the belt on their loins be loosed, Nor the strap of their sandals be broken; Whose arrows are sharp, And all their bows bent; Their horses' hooves will seem like flint, And their wheels like a whirlwind. Their roaring will be like a lion, They will roar like young lions; Yes, they will roar And lay hold of the prey; They will carry it away safely, And no one will deliver. In that day they will roar against them Like the roaring of the sea. And if one looks to the land, Behold, darkness and sorrow; And the light is darkened by the clouds.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Jeremiah 9:12-19

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Who is the wise man who may understand this? And who is he to whom the mouth of the LORD has spoken, that he may declare it? Why does the land perish and burn up like a wilderness, so that no one can pass through? And the LORD said, "Because they have forsaken My law which I set before them, and have not obeyed My voice, nor walked according to it, but they have walked according to the dictates of their own hearts and after the Baals, which their fathers taught them," therefore thus says the LORD of hosts, the God of Israel: "Behold, I will feed them, this people, with wormwood, and give them water of gall to drink. I will scatter them also among the Gentiles, whom neither they nor their fathers have known. And I will send a sword after them until I have consumed them."

Thus says the LORD of hosts: "Consider and call for the mourning women, That they may come; And send for skillful wailing women, That they may come. Let them make haste And take up a wailing for us, That our eyes may run with tears, And our eyelids gush with water. For a voice of wailing is heard from Zion.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour: of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 122:1-2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

I was glad when they said to me, "Let us go into the house of the LORD." Our feet have been standing within your gates, O Jerusalem! Alleluia.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 11:11-19

And Jesus went into Jerusalem and into the temple. So when He had looked around at all things, as the hour was already late, He went out to Bethany with the twelve. Now the next day, when they had come out from Bethany, He was hungry. And seeing from afar a fig tree having leaves, He went to see if perhaps He would find something on it. When He came to it, He found nothing but leaves, for it was not the season for

figs. In response Jesus said to it, "Let no one eat fruit from you ever again." And His disciples heard it.

So they came to Jerusalem. Then Jesus went into the temple and began to drive out those who bought and sold in the temple, and overturned the tables of the money changers and the seats of those who sold doves. And He would not allow anyone to carry wares through the temple. Then He taught, saying to them, "Is it not written, "My house shall be called a house of prayer for all nations'? But you have made it a "den of thieves."" And the scribes and chief priests heard it and sought how they might destroy Him; for they feared Him, because all the people were astonished at His teaching. When evening had come, He went out of the city.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

The Exposition of the Third Hour of Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

On the evening of Hosanna Sunday, our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ went with His disciples outside the city. He felt hungry and said, “I want something to eat.” He saw a fig tree afar and went to it seeking some of its fruits. He found it fruitless. He condemned the tree and it dried from its roots. The disciples were taken by the incident and said to the Lord, “the fig tree withered.”

Keep faith in your hearts and you shall be granted your requests. Do not be surprised that by one single word, the fig tree dried from its roots up. Because, If you have faith in your hearts, you can transfer the mountain from its location.

Come all you ignorant and see what happened to the fig tree. and present the Lord with good fruits to save yourselves from the evil. Repent all you indolent so that you may receive forgiveness. Clean your faces with many tears because tears wipe out sins. Light your lamps with virtues so that their light may shine upon you in the Day of Judgment. Share the suffering with your brother and remember how the Lord suffered for our salvation.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 32:7-15

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

And the Lord said to Moses, "Go, get down! For your people whom you brought out of the land of Egypt have corrupted themselves. They have turned aside quickly out of the way which I commanded them. They have made themselves a molded calf, and worshiped it and sacrificed to it, and said, 'This is your god, O Israel, that brought you out of the land of Egypt!' " And the Lord said to Moses, "I have seen this people, and indeed it is a stiff-necked people! Now therefore, let Me alone, that My wrath may burn hot against them and I may consume them. And I will make of you a great nation." Then Moses pleaded with the Lord his God, and said: "Lord, why does Your wrath burn hot against Your people whom You have brought out of the land of Egypt with great power and with a mighty hand?

Why should the Egyptians speak, and say, 'He brought them out to harm them, to kill them in the mountains, and to consume them from the face of the earth'? Turn from Your fierce wrath, and relent from this harm to Your people. Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, Your servants, to whom You swore by Your own self, and said to them, 'I will multiply your descendants as the stars of heaven, and all this land that I have spoken of I give to your descendants, and they shall inherit it forever.' " So the Lord relented from the harm which He said He would do to His people.

And Moses turned and went down from the mountain, and the two tablets of the Testimony were in his hand. The tablets were written on both sides; on the one side and on the other they were written.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Wisdom of Solomon1: 1-9

A reading from the Wisdom of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Love righteousness, you rulers of the earth, think of the Lord with Uprightness, and seek him with sincerity of heart; because he is found by those who do not put him to the test, and manifests himself to those who do not distrust him. For perverse thoughts separate men from God, and

when his power is tested, it convicts the foolish; because wisdom will not enter a deceitful soul, nor dwell in a body enslaved to sin. For a holy and disciplined spirit will flee from deceit, and will rise and depart from foolish thoughts, and will be ashamed at the approach of unrighteousness.

For wisdom is a kindly spirit and will not free a blasphemer from the guilt of his words; because God is witness of his inmost feelings, and a true observer of his heart, and a hearer of his tongue. Because the Spirit of the Lord has filled the world, and that which holds all things together knows what is said; therefore no one who utters unrighteous things will escape notice, and justice, when it punishes, will not pass him by. For inquiry will be made into the counsels of an ungodly man, and a report of his words will come to the Lord, to convict him of his lawless deeds.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 122:4

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Where the tribes go up, The tribes of the Lord, To the Testimony of
Israel, To give thanks to the name of the Lord. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 2:13-17

Now the Passover of the Jews was at hand, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem. And He found in the temple those who sold oxen and sheep and doves, and the moneychangers doing business. When He had made a whip of cords, He drove them all out of the temple, with the sheep and the oxen, and poured out the changers' money and overturned the tables. And He said to those who sold doves, "Take these things away! Do not make My Father's house a house of merchandise!" Then His disciples remembered that it was written, "Zeal for Your house has eaten Me up."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

**The Exposition of The Sixth Hour of the Monday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

O Israel, God’s first children, what impudence did you commit and how insensitive are your priests. The place of forgiveness became a place of sin. The house of prayer and supplication became a den of thieves and a market place for cattle, sheep, and pigeon merchants and for currency exchangers. What profit is that unclean and corrupt and what injustice have you done.

When the Son of God saw all this done in His Father’s house, for they have turned it in to a den for thievery, bandits, the unjust and a house of trade, He toppled the seats of pigeon merchants and the tables of the currency exchangers and scattered their funds. As they watched Him do that, His disciples knew that it was thus written about Him, “the Zeal for Your house has consumed me.” That is why He did that with impunity.

Your reign is forever in heaven and on earth and Your fear, O Lord, has shaken the mountains. But Israel has erred and thus was denied God’s help.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Genesis 2:15-3:24

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Then the Lord God took the man and put him in the garden of Eden to tend and keep it. And the Lord God commanded the man, saying, "Of every tree of the garden you may freely eat; but of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil you shall not eat, for in the day that you eat of it you shall surely die." And the Lord God said, "It is not good that man should be alone; I will make him a helper comparable to him." Out of the ground the Lord God formed every beast of the field and every bird of the air, and brought them to Adam to see what he would call them. And whatever Adam called each living creature, that was its name. So Adam gave names to all cattle, to the birds of the air, and to every beast of the field. But for Adam there was not found a helper comparable to him. And the Lord God caused a deep sleep to fall on Adam, and he slept; and He took one of his ribs, and closed

up the flesh in its place. Then the rib which the Lord God had taken from man He made into a woman, and He brought her to the man. And Adam said: "This is now bone of my bones And flesh of my flesh; She shall be called Woman, Because she was taken out of Man." Therefore a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and they shall become one flesh. And they were both naked, the man and his wife, and were not ashamed.

Now the serpent was more cunning than any beast of the field which the Lord God had made. And he said to the woman, "Has God indeed said, 'You shall not eat of every tree of the garden'?" And the woman said to the serpent, "We may eat the fruit of the trees of the garden; but of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God has said, 'You shall not eat it, nor shall you touch it, lest you die.' " Then the serpent said to the woman, "You will not surely die. For God knows that in the day you eat of it your eyes will be opened, and you will be like God, knowing good and evil." So when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree desirable to make one wise, she took of its fruit and ate. She also gave to her husband with her, and he ate. Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they knew that they were naked; and they sewed fig leaves together and made themselves coverings.

And they heard the sound of the Lord God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the Lord God among the trees of the garden. Then the Lord God called to Adam and said to him, "Where are you?" So he said, "I heard Your

voice in the garden, and I was afraid because I was naked; and I hid myself." And He said, "Who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten from the tree of which I commanded you that you should not eat?" Then the man said, "The woman whom You gave to be with me, she gave me of the tree, and I ate." And the Lord God said to the woman, "What is this you have done?" The woman said, "The serpent deceived me, and I ate." So the Lord God said to the serpent: "Because you have done this, You are cursed more than all cattle, And more than every beast of the field; On your belly you shall go, And you shall eat dust All the days of your life. And I will put enmity Between you and the woman, And between your seed and her Seed; He shall bruise your head, And you shall bruise His heel." To the woman He said: "I will greatly multiply your sorrow and your conception; In pain you shall bring forth children; Your desire shall be for your husband, And he shall rule over you." Then to Adam He said, "Because you have heeded the voice of your wife, and have eaten from the tree of which I commanded you, saying, 'You shall not eat of it': "Cursed is the ground for your sake; In toil you shall eat of it All the days of your life. Both thorns and thistles it shall bring forth for you, And you shall eat the herb of the field. In the sweat of your face you shall eat bread till you return to the ground, For out of it you were taken; For dust you are, And to dust you shall return."

And Adam called his wife's name Eve, because she was the mother of all living. Also for Adam and his wife the Lord God made tunics of skin, and clothed them.

Then the Lord God said, "Behold, the man has become like one of Us, to know good and evil. And now, lest he put out his hand and take also of the tree of life, and eat, and live forever"-- therefore the Lord God sent him out of the garden of Eden to till the ground from which he was taken. So He drove out the man; and He placed cherubim at the east of the garden of Eden, and a flaming sword which turned every way, to guard the way to the tree of life.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 40:1-5

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Comfort, yes, comfort My people!" Says your God. "Speak comfort to Jerusalem, and cry out to her, That her warfare is ended, That her iniquity is pardoned; For she has received from the Lord's hand Double for all her sins." The voice of one crying in the wilderness: "Prepare the way of the Lord; Make straight in the desert a highway for our God. Every valley shall be exalted And every mountain and hill brought low; The crooked places shall be made straight And the rough places smooth; The glory of the Lord shall be revealed, And all flesh shall see it together; For the mouth of the Lord has spoken."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 1:1-9

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

The proverbs of Solomon the son of David, king of Israel: To know wisdom and instruction, To perceive the words of understanding, To receive the instruction of wisdom, Justice, judgment, and equity; To give prudence to the simple, To the young man knowledge and discretion-- A wise man will hear and increase learning, And a man of understanding will attain wise counsel, To understand a proverb and an enigma, The words of the wise and their riddles. The fear of the Lord is the beginning of knowledge, But fools despise wisdom and instruction.

My son, hear the instruction of your father, And do not forsake the law of your mother; For they will be a graceful ornament on your head, And chains about your neck.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 65: 5 & 4

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

You will answer us, O God of our salvation, You who are the confidence
of all the ends of the earth,

Blessed is the man You choose, And cause to approach You, That he may
dwell in Your courts. **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

Matthew 21:23-27

Now when He came into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of
the people confronted Him as He was teaching, and said, "By what
authority are You doing these things? And who gave You this authority?"
But Jesus answered and said to them, "I also will ask you one thing, which if
you tell Me, I likewise will tell you by what authority I do these things: The

baptism of John--where was it from? From heaven or from men?" And they reasoned among themselves, saying, "If we say, 'From heaven,' He will say to us, 'Why then did you not believe him?' But if we say, 'From men,' we fear the multitude, for all count John as a prophet." So they answered Jesus and said, "We do not know." And He said to them, "Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Monday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

With Your impeccable hands O Lord, You created me and made me shine like crimson. You bestowed on me the comforts of paradise and the fruits of the trees. You awarded me the hegemony of your dominion over all creation under heaven. and made all things below the animals and beasts. You did not deprive me of respect and subordinated everything to me one commandment and I disobeyed You O my Lord and my God.

I ask of You O good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

When I saw that You were alone O Adam, when everything else was paired, I created from your bones someone modeled after you, who looks like you, and found it inappropriate to have you alone by yourself. I was concerned about you and gave you power over her and all creation to be under your dominion. You obeyed her and disregarded My instruction. You rejected My words and my commandment.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Remember me O Lord. From dust I am, and like the herbs of the field You gave me the prowess of Your power and diminished my humility. One tree I commanded you not to touch! Why did you disobey My commandment? You implicated the woman who I did not command as I did with you. You obeyed her, rejected My words, and then hid among the trees so that I do not see you.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

You desired divinity and wanted to be a creator like your Lord. From the fruits of the tree you distinguished between the good and the evil to become a God. Adam, where is the glory that was bestowed on you? You lost the clothes I dressed you with. With leaves of trees you covered your own nakedness. I created you and knew you before your were.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

From the beginning I informed you and instructed you with my commandments. "Of all the trees in paradise I told you about this particular tree. Its fruits bear the bitterness of death and that if you ate from it, death you suffer. I did not keep you ignorant about it but I informed you before this happens. You lent the women your ear and obeyed her. Therefore I shall bring the punishment upon you.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

O Adam from dust you are and to dust you shall return to chasten you from your transgressions. And you Eve, why did you do this and disobey My commandments? It was not that an angel or a bird talked to you about it but a serpent, beast by its nature and you listened to his advice.

Many shall be your sorrows and greet will be your weeping. I will create animosity between you and the serpent and between your descendants and hers. He will watch their heels and your descendant will crush his head.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

The Savior then summoned the serpent and cursed him and his nature saying, “Cursed are you among all the beasts. On your belly you shall, you shall travel and on the dust of the earth you shall feed because of the distrust you caused.

The enemy dwelt in you and you became a shelter for the evil. Because man listened to you, cursed shall be the whole earth with him.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

As for the man who is Adam, the first to dwell in paradise, He told him, “Because you listened to your spouse, I cursed the earth for your deeds. You will live heart saddened and the earth will grow for you thistles and spines.”

Then He told Eve, “In pains and agony you shall give births and you shall return to your spouse and he will dominate you and you shall have no rest in your life.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

Then God said, "Behold Adam became as one of Us, discerns between the right and the evil. I shall not leave him in paradise lest he should reach for the tree of life and eat of it."

He expelled Adam and his spouse from the paradise and assigned a cherub carrying a sword of fire to guard its gate.

I ask of You O Good One to have mercy upon me according to Your great mercy.

Where do I go from Your Spirit and where do I escape from Your face? If I ascended to the heights of heaven or descended to the lowest places, I find You there.

And Adam went to a lower place across from the gate of paradise to till the land and eat of its fruits where he was in the grasp of the Deceiver.

And Adam and Eve were condemned to the servitude of slavery, because he followed his whim. he and all his sons until the fullness of time.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF MONDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Isaiah 50:1-3

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Thus says the Lord: "Where is the certificate of your mother's divorce, Whom I have put away? Or which of My creditors is it to whom I have sold you? For your iniquities you have sold yourselves, And for your transgressions your mother has been put away. Why, when I came, was there no man? Why, when I called, was there none to answer? Is My hand shortened at all that it cannot redeem? Or have I no power to deliver? Indeed with My rebuke I dry up the sea, I make the rivers a wilderness; Their fish stink because there is no water, And die of thirst. I clothe the heavens with blackness, And I make sackcloth their covering."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 1:18-27

**A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may
his blessings be with us, Amen.**

To fear the Lord is the root of wisdom, and her branches are long life. Unjust anger cannot be justified, for anger tips the scale to one's ruin. Those who are patient stay calm until the right moment, and then cheerfulness comes back to them. They hold back their words until the right moment; then the lips of many tell of their good sense.

In the treasuries of wisdom are wise sayings, but godliness is an abomination to a sinner. If you desire wisdom, keep the commandments, and the Lord will lavish her upon you. For the fear of the Lord is wisdom and discipline, fidelity and humility are his delight. Do not disobey the fear of the Lord, do not approach him with a divided mind. Do not be a hypocrite before others, and keep watch over your lips. Do not exalt yourself, or you may fall and bring dishonor upon yourself. The Lord will reveal your secrets and overthrow you before the whole congregation, because you did not come in the fear of the Lord, and your heart was full of deceit.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Occasionally there are some deeds, which we may think are good while in God's eyes they are wicked. For example the unqualified tolerance of sinners in holy places may lead them to be indifferent to sin. The Lord did not plant good trees and bad trees in paradise but only good trees. He did not plant fruitless trees with bad fruits. Even man himself when he disobeyed the commandment, He was not indifferent about man's iniquity but expelled him from paradise.

From this we can see dear beloved, that the houses of the Lord should not be filled with bad and good people -as is the case in the world where the saints and sinners, the unjust and the impure mingle together. It is incumbent on us to remind those who come to the house of the Lord to behave appropriately.

I know that the whole earth is God's, but if we make His house just like the rest of the earth what is going to distinguish the house of the Lord from the rest. If I as a servant of God commit the same bad deeds as the wicked then I do not deserve to be called a servant of God. For we often sin and are unable to judge ourselves with the same standard we judge others. You see no one can fill your place with dirt unless

they notice your lack of interest in it. Just like the king's pages; they cannot let everyone in the king's house whether they honor the king's decree or whether they ignore them without the king's permission. If they deviate from this, they receive punishment.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 12: 3-4

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Consider and hear me, O Lord my God; Enlighten my eyes, Lest I sleep
the sleep of death; Lest my enemy say, "I have prevailed against him."
Alleluia.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 8: 51- 59

Most assuredly, I say to you, if anyone keeps My word he shall never see death." Then the Jews said to Him, "Now we know that You have a demon! Abraham is dead, and the prophets; and You say, 'If anyone keeps My word he shall never taste death.' Are You greater than our father Abraham, who is dead? And the prophets are dead. Whom do You make Yourself out to be?" Jesus answered, "If I honor Myself, My honor is nothing. It is My Father who honors Me, of whom you say that He is your God. Yet you have not known Him, but I know Him. And if I say, 'I do not know Him,' I shall be a liar like you; but I do know Him and keep His word. Your father Abraham rejoiced to see My day, and he saw it and was glad." Then the Jews said to Him, "You are not yet fifty years old, and have You seen Abraham?" Jesus said to them, "Most assuredly, I say to you, before Abraham was, I AM." Then they took up stones to throw at Him; but Jesus hid Himself and went out of the temple, going through the midst of them, and so passed by.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

**The Exposition of the Eleventh Hour of Monday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

O shining True Light that fills the earth, I mean Jesus the True Light that shines for all nations except the Jews for they strayed away from Him. and did not look at Him.

When He reveal'd Himself to them and told them that those who believe in Him shall live forever, the ignorant breakers of the law accused Him that with Satan He exorcises Demons.

They said unto Him, "Abraham died and the prophets thereafter, how is it possible that those who believe in You never die?" He replied, "If I honor Myself, My honor is nothing. He glorifies Me."

They answered, "You think you are greater than our patriarch Abraham and his descendants who all died? You are not even fifty years old. How could you have seen Abraham?" The Savior said, "Assuredly before Abraham was, I am."

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

We, God’s new nations, believe in Him and observe His commandments. and confess by word and in the depth of our hearts that the True Word, the Omnipotent and Righteous, is Eternal with the Comforting Holy Spirit .

Despite all that He did to teach them, the contrary, unjust, and foolish rejected this great blessing and the many miracles He performed among them. They did not realize that He was their Savior of the prophecies. They renounced Him, rejected Him, and strayed away from God.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

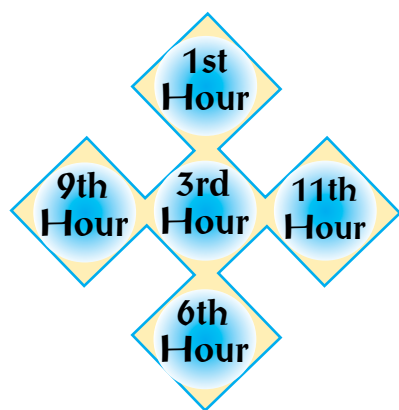
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CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



THE HOLY PASCHA OF TUESDAY EVE

FIRST HOUR OF EVE OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Zechariah 1:1-6

**A reading from Zechariah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

In the eighth month of the second year of Darius, the word of the Lord came to Zechariah the son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo the prophet, saying, "The Lord has been very angry with your fathers. Therefore say to them, 'Thus says the Lord of hosts: "Return to Me," says the Lord of hosts, "and I will return to you," says the Lord of hosts. Do not be like your fathers, to whom the former prophets preached, saying, 'Thus says the Lord of hosts: "Turn now from your evil ways and your evil deeds." ' But they did not hear nor heed Me," says the Lord." Your fathers, where are they? And the prophets, do they live forever? Yet surely My words and My statutes, Which I commanded My servants the prophets, Did they not overtake your fathers? "So they returned and said: 'Just as the Lord of hosts determined to

do to us, According to our ways and according to our deeds, So He has dealt with us.”

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour: of the Eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Psalm 62: 7 & 2

In God is my salvation and my glory; The rock of my strength, And my refuge, is in God. He only is my rock and my salvation; He is my defense; I shall not be moved. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 13: 23-30

Then one said to Him, "Lord, are there few who are saved?" And He said to them, "Strive to enter through the narrow gate, for many, I say to you, will seek to enter and will not be able. When once the Master of the house has risen up and shut the door, and you begin to stand outside and knock at the door, saying, 'Lord, Lord, open for us,' and He will answer and say to you, 'I do not know you, where you are from,' then you will begin to say, 'We ate and drank in Your presence, and You taught in our streets.' But He will say, 'I tell you I do not know you, where you are from. Depart from Me, all you workers of iniquity.' There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth, when you see Abraham and Isaac and Jacob and all the prophets in the kingdom of God, and yourselves thrust out. They will come from the east and the west, from the north and the south, and sit down in the kingdom of God. And indeed there are last who will be first, and there are first who will be last."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The First Hour of Eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

On His way to Jerusalem with His disciples, some one asked our Savior, “are there few are saved.” Our Savior replied saying, “Strive to enter through the narrow gate, lest you should come and knock on the door and say, “O Lord open (the door) for us,” and He shall answer from inside and say unto you, “I do not know you, where are you from? Depart away all you wrongful, peccants to the place of weeping and the gnashing of teeth.

Many of the gentiles will come from the east and the west and will nestle into the bosom of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven, but you will be relegated outside, dominated by your profanity. Repent and make amends, that your sins may be taken away.”

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF EVE OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Malachi 1 :1-9

**A reading from Malachi the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

The burden of the word of the Lord to Israel by Malachi." I have loved you," says the Lord." Yet you say, 'In what way have You loved us?' Was not Esau Jacob's brother?" Says the Lord." Yet Jacob I have loved; But Esau I have hated, And laid waste his mountains and his heritage For the jackals of the wilderness." Even though Edom has said, "We have been impoverished, But we will return and build the desolate places," Thus says the Lord of hosts: "They may build, but I will throw down; They shall be called the Territory of Wickedness, And the people against whom the Lord will have indignation forever. Your eyes shall see, And you shall say, 'The Lord is magnified beyond the border of Israel.'

"A son honors his father, And a servant his master. If then I am the Father, Where is My honor? And if I am a Master, Where is My reverence? Says the Lord of hosts To you priests who despise My name. Yet you say, 'In what way have we despised Your name?' "You offer defiled food on My altar. But say, 'In what way have we defiled You?' By saying, 'The table of the Lord is contemptible.' And when you offer the blind as a sacrifice, Is it not evil? And when you offer the lame and sick, Is it not evil? Offer it then to your governor! Would he be pleased with you? Would he accept you favorably?" Says the Lord of hosts.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour: of the Eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted ***the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel*** on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 28:9 & 2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Consider and hear me, O Lord my God; Enlighten my eyes, Lest I sleep
the sleep of death; "But I have trusted in Your mercy; My heart shall
rejoice in Your salvation. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 13: 31- 35

In that very day some Pharisees came, saying to Him, "Get out and depart from here, for Herod wants to kill You." And He said to them, "Go, tell that fox, 'Behold, I cast out demons and perform cures today and tomorrow, and the third day I shall be perfected.' Nevertheless I must journey today, tomorrow, and the day following; for it cannot be that a prophet should perish outside of Jerusalem." O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, the one who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her! How often I wanted to gather your children together, as a hen gathers her brood under her wings, but you were not willing! See! Your house is left to you desolate; and assuredly, I say to you, you shall not see Me until the time comes when you say, 'Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord!'

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Third Hour of the eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

On this day some people came and told Him that king Herod wants to kill him saying, “Teacher, get out of here and leave this area because this irreverent Herod wants to kill You.” Jesus said to them, “Go and tell this wicked fox that I will heal many today and tomorrow and in the coming days. It is written that no prophet shall perish outside Jerusalem.

O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, the one who kills the prophets and stones those that are sent to you! How often I wanted to gather your children together but you were not willing. Behold your house will be desolate forever.

For those who hear Me I say, from now on you shall not see Me until you all say in one voice, ‘Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord God.’”

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF EVE OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Hosea 4:15- 5:7

**A reading from Hosea the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Though you, Israel, play the harlot, Let not Judah offend. Do not come up to Gilgal, Nor go up to Beth Aven, Nor swear an oath, saying, 'As the Lord lives' - "For Israel is stubborn Like a stubborn calf; Now the Lord will let them forage Like a lamb in open country." Ephraim is joined to idols, Let him alone. Their drink is rebellion, They commit harlotry continually. Her rulers dearly love dishonor. The wind has wrapped her up in its wings, And they shall be ashamed because of their sacrifices."

Hear this, O priests! Take heed, O house of Israel! Give ear, O house of the king! For yours is the judgment, Because you have been a snare to Mizpah And a net spread on Tabor. The revolvers are deeply involved in slaughter, Though I rebuke them all. I know Ephraim, And Israel is not

hidden from Me; For now, O Ephraim, you commit harlotry; Israel is defiled." They do not direct their deeds Toward turning to their God, For the spirit of harlotry is in their midst, And they do not know the Lord. The pride of Israel testifies to his face; Therefore Israel and Ephraim stumble in their iniquity; Judah also stumbles with them." With their flocks and herds They shall go to seek the Lord, But they will not find Him; He has withdrawn Himself from them. They have dealt treacherously with the Lord, For they have begotten pagan children. Now a New Moon shall devour them and their heritage.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of the Eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted *the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel* on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 29:1,2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

He is my refuge and my fortress; My God, in Him I will trust." Surely He shall deliver you from the snare of the fowler And from the perilous pestilence. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 21:34- 38

But take heed to yourselves, lest your hearts be weighed down with carousing, drunkenness, and cares of this life, and that Day come on you unexpectedly. For it will come as a snare on all those who dwell on the face of the whole earth. Watch therefore, and pray always that you may be counted worthy to escape all these things that will come to pass, and to stand before the Son of Man."

And in the daytime He was teaching in the temple, but at night He went out and stayed on the mountain called Olivet. Then early in the morning all the people came to Him in the temple to hear Him.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Sixth Hour of Eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

As an attending physician, Jesus was treating us free. He reminds us that excessive eating taxes the heart and saps the power from the body.

In a parallel way, engrossment in worldly concerns could bring on us vicious passions, cause us to stray away from the fear of God. The wicked (Satan) can overwhelm us, drive us away from the path of salvation, diminish the awareness of our soul’s salvation, and subject us to the dominion of death just as the prey falls in the trap. Be alert and present fruits worthy of righteousness and atonement so that you may stand in front of our Judge and Savior Jesus.

He was teaching the public in the temple. By night, He rested on the Mount of Olives. By day, He went down to Jerusalem where people gathered early to listen to His teachings that are replete with righteousness. Those who heard him, hurried to drink from the spring of His sweet water. As the Book that testifies to His coming says: “He is the healthy, nourishing food for those who believe in Him.”

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF EVE OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Hosea 10:12-11:2

**A reading from the Hosea the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Sow for yourselves righteousness; Reap in mercy; Break up your fallow ground, For it is time to seek the Lord, till He comes and rains righteousness on you. You have plowed wickedness; You have reaped iniquity. You have eaten the fruit of lies, Because you trusted in your own way, In the multitude of your mighty men. Therefore tumult shall arise among your people, And all your fortresses shall be plundered As Shalman plundered Beth Arbel in the day of battle-- A mother dashed in pieces upon her children. Thus it shall be done to you, O Bethel, Because of your great wickedness. At dawn the king of Israel Shall be cut off utterly."

When Israel was a child, I loved him, And out of Egypt I called My son. As they called them, So they went from them; They sacrificed to the Baals, And burned incense to carved images.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of the Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 33: 10- 11

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

The Lord brings the counsel of the nations to nothing; He makes the plans of the peoples of no effect. The counsel of the Lord stands forever, The plans of His heart to all generations. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 11: 37-52

And as He spoke, a certain Pharisee asked Him to dine with him. So He went in and sat down to eat. When the Pharisee saw it, he marveled that He had not first washed before dinner. Then the Lord said to him,

"Now you Pharisees make the outside of the cup and dish clean, but your inward part is full of greed and wickedness. Foolish ones! Did not He who made the outside make the inside also? But rather give alms of such

things as you have; then indeed all things are clean to you. But woe to you Pharisees! For you tithe mint and rue and all manner of herbs, and pass by justice and the love of God. These you ought to have done, without leaving the others undone. Woe to you Pharisees! For you love the best seats in the synagogues and greetings in the marketplaces. Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you are like graves which are not seen, and the men who walk over them are not aware of them."

Then one of the lawyers answered and said to Him, "Teacher, by saying these things You reproach us also." And He said, "Woe to you also, lawyers! For you load men with burdens hard to bear, and you yourselves do not touch the burdens with one of your fingers. Woe to you! For you build the tombs of the prophets, and your fathers killed them. In fact, you bear witness that you approve the deeds of your fathers; for they indeed killed them, and you build their tombs. Therefore the wisdom of God also said, 'I will send them prophets and apostles, and some of them they will kill and persecute,' that the blood of all the prophets which was shed from the foundation of the world may be required of this generation, from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah who perished between the altar and the temple. Yes, I say to you, it shall be required of this generation. Woe to you lawyers! For you have taken away the key of knowledge. You did not enter in yourselves, and those who were entering in you hindered."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Listen to the merciful, compassionate, the patient One, who has great mercy when He catechizes us to be clean not only in our bodies but also in our hearts.

The Pharisee who invited Jesus to dinner was puzzled at Him when He ate the bread without washing His hands. The Omniscient teacher said to him, "You Pharisees cleanse the outside of the cup but inside you are full of promiscuity, plunder, depredation and injustices."

Give alms and just judgment and everything will be clean unto you. Let us be kind to God's creations. Thus we may purify ourselves, bodies, and souls, of all the filth of sins.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF EVE OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Amos 5:6-14

**A reading from Micah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Seek the Lord and live, Lest He break out like fire in the house of Joseph, And devour it, With no one to quench it in Bethel-- You who turn justice to wormwood, And lay righteousness to rest in the earth!"

He made the Pleiades and Orion; He turns the shadow of death into morning And makes the day dark as night; He calls for the waters of the sea And pours them out on the face of the earth; The Lord is His name. He rains ruin upon the strong, So that fury comes upon the fortress. They hate the one who rebukes in the gate, And they abhor the one who speaks uprightly. Therefore, because you tread down the poor And take grain taxes from him, Though you have built houses of hewn stone, Yet you

shall not dwell in them; You have planted pleasant vineyards, But you shall not drink wine from them. For I know your manifold transgressions And your mighty sins: Afflicting the just and taking bribes; Diverting the poor from justice at the gate. Therefore the prudent keep silent at that time, For it is an evil time. Seek good and not evil, so that you may live.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of the Eve of Monday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 122:4

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Where the tribes go up, The tribes of the Lord, To the Testimony of
Israel, To give thanks to the name of the Lord. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 13:32-14:2

But of that day and hour no one knows, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father. Take heed, watch and pray; for you do not know when the time is. It is like a man going to a far country, who left his house and gave authority to his servants, and to each his work, and commanded the doorkeeper to watch. Watch therefore, for you do not know when the master of the house is coming--in the evening, at midnight, at the crowing of the rooster, or in the morning-- lest, coming suddenly, he find you sleeping. And what I say to you, I say to all: Watch!"

After two days it was the Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread. And the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might take Him by trickery and put Him to death. But they said, "Not during the feast, lest there be an uproar of the people."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Eleventh Hour of the Eve of Tuesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

You alone, the Omniscient God, has the knowledge of everything before its being; the epochs, the years, times, and the past generation. Listen to our Savior, who with His divine mouth proclaims.

“But of that day and that hour no one knows, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father knows it.” Watch at all times because you do not know when it shall be.

Lest he makes a surprise visit and finds you asleep. Be careful and safeguard against hidden traps.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

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6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

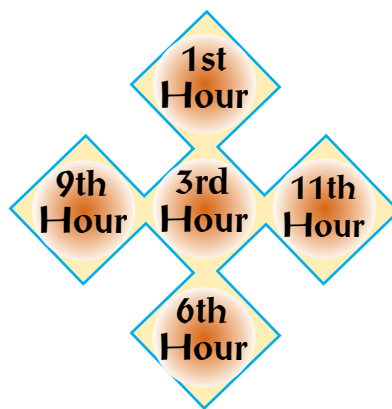
See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



THE HOLY PASCHA OF TUESDAY DAY

FIRST HOUR OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 19:1-9

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

In the third month after the children of Israel had gone out of the land of Egypt, on the same day, they came to the Wilderness of Sinai. For they had departed from Rephidim, had come to the Wilderness of Sinai, and camped in the wilderness. So Israel camped there before the mountain.

And Moses went up to God, and the Lord called to him from the mountain, saying, "Thus you shall say to the house of Jacob, and tell the children of Israel: 'You have seen what I did to the Egyptians, and how I bore you on eagles' wings and brought you to Myself. Now therefore, if you will indeed obey My voice and keep My covenant, then you shall be a special treasure to Me above all people; for all the earth is Mine. And you shall be to Me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.' These are the words which you shall speak to the children of Israel."

So Moses came and called for the elders of the people, and laid before them all these words which the Lord commanded him. Then all the people answered together and said, "All that the Lord has spoken we will do." So Moses brought back the words of the people to the Lord. And the Lord said to Moses, "Behold, I come to you in the thick cloud, that the people may hear when I speak with you, and believe you forever." So Moses told the words of the people to the Lord.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Job 23:2- 24:25

A reading from Job the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Iven today my complaint is bitter; My hand is listless because of my groaning. Oh, that I knew where I might find Him, That I might come to His seat! I would present my case before Him, And fill my mouth with arguments. I would know the words which He would answer me, And understand what He would say to me. Would He contend with me in His great power? No! But He would take note of me. There the upright could reason with Him, And I would be delivered forever from my Judge." Look, I go forward, but He is not there, And backward, but I cannot perceive Him; When He works on the left hand, I cannot behold Him; When He turns to the right hand, I cannot see Him..

But He knows the way that I take; When He has tested me, I shall come forth as gold. My foot has held fast to His steps; I have kept His way and not turned aside. I have not departed from the commandment of His lips; I have treasured the words of His mouth More than my necessary food." But He is unique, and who can make Him change? And whatever His soul desires, that He does. For He performs what is appointed for me, And many such things are with Him. Therefore I am terrified at His presence; When I consider this, I am afraid of Him. For God made my heart weak, And the Almighty terrifies me; Because I was not cut off from the presence of darkness, And He did not hide deep darkness from my face."

Since times are not hidden from the Almighty, Why do those who know Him see not His days? "Some remove landmarks; They seize flocks violently and feed on them; They drive away the donkey of the fatherless; They take the widow's ox as a pledge. They push the needy off the road; All the poor of the land are forced to hide. Indeed, like wild donkeys in the desert, They go out to their work, searching for food. The wilderness yields food for them and for their children. They gather their fodder in the field And glean in the vineyard of the wicked. They spend the night naked, without clothing, And have no covering in the cold. They are wet with the showers of the mountains, And huddle around the rock for want of shelter."

Some snatch the fatherless from the breast, And take a pledge from the poor. They cause the poor to go naked, without clothing; And they take away the sheaves from the hungry. They press out oil within their walls, And tread winepresses, yet suffer thirst. The dying groan in the city, And the

souls of the wounded cry out; Yet God does not charge them with wrong."

There are those who rebel against the light; They do not know its ways Nor abide in its paths. The murderer rises with the light; He kills the poor and needy; And in the night he is like a thief. The eye of the adulterer waits for the twilight, Saying, 'No eye will see me'; And he disguises his face. In the dark they break into houses, which they marked for themselves in the daytime; They do not know the light. For the morning is the same to them as the shadow of death; If someone recognizes them, They are in the terrors of the shadow of death." They should be swift on the face of the waters, Their portion should be cursed in the earth, So that no one would turn into the way of their vineyards. As drought and heat consume the snow waters, So the grave consumes those who have sinned. The womb should forget him, The worm should feed sweetly on him; He should be remembered no more, And wickedness should be broken like a tree. For he preys on the barren who do not bear, And does no good for the widow." But God draws the mighty away with His power; He rises up, but no man is sure of life. He gives them security, and they rely on it; Yet His eyes are on their ways. They are exalted for a little while, Then they are gone. They are brought low; They are taken out of the way like all others; They dry out like the heads of grain." Now if it is not so, who will prove me a liar, And make my speech worth nothing?"

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Hosea 4: 1-8

**A reading from Hosea the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Hear the word of the Lord, You children of Israel, For the Lord brings a charge against the inhabitants of the land: "There is no truth or mercy Or knowledge of God in the land. By swearing and lying, Killing and stealing and committing adultery, They break all restraint, With bloodshed upon bloodshed. Therefore the land will mourn; And everyone who dwells there will waste away With the beasts of the field And the birds of the air; Even the fish of the sea will be taken away."

Now let no man contend, or rebuke another; For your people are like those who contend with priest. Therefore you shall stumble in the day; The prophet also shall stumble with you in the night; And I will destroy your mother. My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge. Because you have rejected knowledge, I also will reject you from being priest for Me; Because you have forgotten the law of your God, I also will forget your children." The more they increased, The more they sinned against Me; I will change their glory into shame. They eat up the sin of My people; They set their heart on their iniquity.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Let me inform you of two matters. Those for whom the heaven rejoiced for because of their repentance on earth will not suffer sadness or pain in the place they are destined to inherit. As for those whom heavens did not rejoice for because they did not atone for their sins and did not repent for their inequities on earth, they will find neither joy nor comfort in that place.

Because those who revel in pleasures and delights will enjoy neither happiness nor comfort in Heaven. Have You not heard his saying Blessed are those who mourn because they shall be comforted. Also those who do not rejoice on earth shall rejoice in heavens or have not you read, "Woe to you who laugh now for you shall weep and mourn.

"Isn't this the time when the meek is vested with power. And he who is not strong will say 'I am strong' when he yields his heart to the Written Word. As the prophet says, "Many are those whose repeated adultery has weakened their bodies, and they shall be weakened at heart as well."

As the Book says about those, "They will be devastated by their own profanity." As for those who struggle with courage it was said about them, "Hasten and straighten yourself to be a companion of God who preaches the Word of Truth."

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour: of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 120:2, 6 & 7

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Deliver my soul, O Lord, from lying lips And from a deceitful tongue.
My soul has dwelt too long With one who hates peace I am for
peace; But when I speak, they are for war. **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

John 8:21-29

Then Jesus said to them again, "I am going away, and you will seek Me, and will die in your sin. Where I go you cannot come." So the Jews said, "Will He kill Himself, because He says, 'Where I go you cannot come'?" And He said to them, "You are from beneath; I am from above. You are of this world; I am not of this world. Therefore I said to you that you will die in your sins; for if you do not believe that I am He, you will die in your sins."

Then they said to Him, "Who are You?" And Jesus said to them, "Just what I have been saying to you from the beginning. I have many things to say and to judge concerning you, but He who sent Me is true; and I speak to the world those things, which I heard from Him." They did not understand that He spoke to them of the Father. Then Jesus said to them, "When you lift up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am He, and that I do nothing of Myself; but as My Father taught Me, I speak these things. And He who sent Me is with Me. The Father has not left Me alone, for I always do those things that please Him."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

The Exposition of the First Hour of Tuesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

And Israel came to Mount Rephidim after three months in the wilderness. Then the Israelites came out of Egypt and Mount Sinai to this place. Moses came and stood in the presence of God. He called and spoke to him saying, “This is what you tell to the house of Jacob and report to the sons of Israel.” You have seen the many deeds I have inflicted on the Egyptians and how I carried you with My soaring power as if you were on the wings of eagles.

Keep My laws and commandments; take heed to My words and carry out My will, for I have chosen you from among the nations, for I have the earth and the sea as well. You will be My kingdom, a chosen people and a holy nation.

And Moses came back and told the people all what God has said. The public cheered in one voice saying: “Whatever God wills, we will observe.” Moses then told the Omniscient that the people adhered to His orders.

But Israel turned back, Jacob retreated, and the sons of Israel strayed away. God’s Commandments became as if they were not, and His instructions ignored. Thus God delivered them into the hands of hateful enemies, and subjugated them to strangers once again. He humiliated them before the nations and they lived in eternal shame and disgrace.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Deuteronomy 8:11- 20

**A reading from the book of Deuteronomy of Moses the Prophet may
his blessings be with us, Amen.**

Beware that you do not forget the Lord your God by not keeping His commandments, His judgments, and His statutes which I command you today, lest when you have eaten and are full, and have built beautiful houses and dwell in them; and when your herds and your flocks multiply, and your silver and your gold are multiplied, and all that you have is multiplied; when your heart is lifted up, and you forget the Lord your God who brought you out of the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage; who led you through that great and terrible wilderness, in which were fiery serpents and scorpions and thirsty land where there was no water; who brought water for you out of the flinty rock; who fed you in the wilderness with manna, which your fathers did not know, that He might humble you and that He

might test you, to do you good in the end-- then you say in your heart, 'My power and the might of my hand have gained me this wealth. ' And you shall remember the Lord your God, for it is He who gives you power to get wealth, that He may establish His covenant which He swore to your fathers, as it is this day. Then it shall be, if you by any means forget the Lord your God, and follow other gods, and serve them and worship them, I testify against you this day that you shall surely perish. As the nations, which the Lord destroys before you, so you shall perish, because you would not be obedient to the voice of the Lord your God.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 1:1-14

A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

My child, when you come to serve the Lord, prepare yourself for testing. Set your heart right and be steadfast, and do not be impetuous in time of calamity. Cling to him and do not depart, so that your last days may be prosperous. Accept whatever befalls you, and in times of humiliation be patient. For gold is tested in the fire, and those found acceptable, in the furnace of humiliation. Trust in him, and he will help you; make your ways straight, and hope in him. You who fear the Lord, wait for his mercy; do

not stray, or else you may fall. You who fear the Lord, trust in him, and your reward will not be lost. You who fear the Lord, hope for good things, for lasting joy and mercy.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Job 27: 2 – 28: 2

A reading from the book of Job the Righteous may his blessings be with us, Amen.

As God lives, who has taken away my justice, And the Almighty, who has made my soul bitter, As long as my breath is in me, And the breath of God in my nostrils, My lips will not speak wickedness, Nor my tongue utter deceit. Far be it from me That I should say you are right; till I die I will not put away my integrity from me. My righteousness I hold fast, and will not let it go; my heart shall not reproach me as long as I live.

"May my enemy be like the wicked, And he who rises up against me like the unrighteous. For what is the hope of the hypocrite, Though he may gain much, If God takes away his life? Will God hear his cry When trouble comes upon him? Will he delight himself in the Almighty? Will he always call on God?

"I will teach you about the hand of God; What is with the Almighty I will not conceal. Surely all of you have seen it; Why then do you behave with complete nonsense? "This is the portion of a wicked man with God, And the heritage of oppressors, received from the Almighty: If his children are multiplied, it is for the sword; And his offspring shall not be satisfied with bread. Those who survive him shall be buried in death, And their widows shall not weep, Though he heaps up silver like dust, And piles up clothing like clay-- He may pile it up, but the just will wear it, And the innocent will divide the silver. He builds his house like a moth, Like a booth which a watchman makes. The rich man will lie down, But not be gathered up; He opens his eyes, And he is no more. Terrors overtake him like a flood; A tempest steals him away in the night. The east wind carries him away, and he is gone; it sweeps him out of his place. It hurls against him and does not spare; He flees desperately from its power. Men shall clap their hands at him, and shall hiss him out of his place.

"Surely there is a mine for silver, And a place where gold is refined. Iron is taken from the earth, And copper is smelted from ore.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

1 Kings 19:9-14

A reading from the book of Kings the First may his blessings be with us, Amen.

And behold, the word of the Lord came to him, and He said to him, "What are you doing here, Elijah?" So he said, "I have been very zealous for the Lord God of hosts; for the children of Israel have forsaken Your covenant, torn down Your altars, and killed Your prophets with the sword. I alone am left; and they seek to take my life." Then He said, "Go out, and stand on the mountain before the Lord." And behold, the Lord passed by, and a great and strong wind tore into the mountains and broke the rocks in pieces before the Lord, but the Lord was not in the wind; and after the wind an earthquake, but the Lord was not in the earthquake; and after the earthquake a fire, but the Lord was not in the fire; and after the fire a still small voice. So it was, when Elijah heard it, that he wrapped his face in his mantle and went out and stood in the entrance of the cave. Suddenly a voice came to him, and said, "What are you doing here, Elijah?" And he said, "I have been very zealous for the Lord God of hosts; because the children of Israel have forsaken Your covenant, torn down Your altars, and killed Your prophets with the sword. I alone am left; and they seek to take my life."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour: of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 119: 154- 155

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Plead my cause and redeem me; Revive me according to Your word.
Salvation is far from the wicked, For they do not seek Your statutes.
Alleluia.

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

Matthew 23: 37- 24: 2

Jerusalem, Jerusalem, the one who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her! How often I wanted to gather your children together, as a hen gathers her chicks under her wings, but you were not willing! See! Your house is left to you desolate; for I say to you, you shall see Me no more till you say, 'Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord!' "Then Jesus went out and departed from the temple, and His disciples came up to show Him the buildings of the temple. And Jesus said to them, "Do you not see all these things? Assuredly, I say to you, not one stone shall be left here upon another, that shall not be thrown down."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

**The Exposition of the Third Hour of Tuesday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

Several times, the Lord said “O Jerusalem, I wanted to gather your children as the hen gathers her chicks under her wings, and you would not. Behold, I leave your house for you desolate forever.”

When the disciples heard the prophecy of the prophet and of the Savior, they showed him the temple, the venerated stones, and sanctuaries. He responded to them saying: “There will not be two stones together.”

Truly this happened forty years after the ascension of our Lord. The Romans came, devastated the city, and demolished the temple, which remains thus to this day. One million and two hundred thousand Jewish men were killed by the sword. They were rebuked by God’s wrath and His damnation covered their faces.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Ezekiel 21:3-13

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet, may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

And say to the land of Israel, 'Thus says the Lord: "Behold, I am against you, and I will draw My sword out of its sheath and cut off both righteous and wicked from you. Because I will cut off both righteous and wicked from you, therefore My sword shall go out of its sheath against all flesh from south to north, that all flesh may know that I, the Lord, have drawn My sword out of its sheath; it shall not return anymore." Sigh therefore, son of man, with a breaking heart, and sigh with bitterness before their eyes. And it shall be when they say to you, 'Why are you sighing?' that you shall answer, 'Because of the news; when it comes, every heart will melt, all hands will be feeble, every spirit will faint, and all knees will be weak as water. Behold, it is coming and shall be brought to pass,' says the Lord God." Again the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

"Son of man, prophesy and say, 'Thus says the Lord!' Say: 'A sword, a sword is sharpened And also polished! Sharpened to make a dreadful slaughter, Polished to flash like lightning! Should we then make mirth? It despises the scepter of My Son, As it does all wood. And He has given it to be polished, That it may be handled; This sword is sharpened, and it is polished To be given into the hand of the slayer.' "Cry and wail, son of man; For it will be against My people, Against all the princes of Israel. Terrors including the sword will be against My people; Therefore strike your thigh." Because it is a testing, And what if the sword despises even the scepter? The scepter shall be no more," says the Lord God.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 4:20- 5:2

A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Watch for the opportune time, and beware of evil, and do not be ashamed to be yourself. For there is a shame that leads to sin, and there is a shame that is glory and favor.

Do not show partiality, to your own harm, or deference, to your downfall. Do not refrain from speaking at the proper moment, and do not hide your

wisdom. For wisdom becomes known through speech, and education through the words of the tongue.

Never speak against the truth, but be ashamed of your ignorance. Do not be ashamed to confess your sins, and do not try to stop the current of a river. Do not subject yourself to a fool, or show partiality to a ruler. Fight to the death for truth, and the Lord God will fight for you.

Do not be reckless in your speech, or sluggish and remiss in your deeds. Do not be like a lion in your home, or suspicious of your servants. Do not let your hand be stretched out to receive and closed when it is time to give. Do not rely on your wealth, or say, "I have enough." Do not follow your inclination and strength in pursuing the desires of your heart.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 1:1-9

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

The vision of Isaiah the son of Amoz, which he saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.

Hear, O heavens, and give ear, O earth! For the Lord has spoken: "I have nourished and brought up children, 'And they have rebelled against Me; The ox knows its owner And the donkey its master's crib; But Israel does not know, My people do not consider." Alas, sinful nation, A people laden with iniquity, A brood of evildoers, Children who are corrupters! They have forsaken the Lord, They have provoked to anger The Holy One of Israel, They have turned away backward. Why should you be stricken again? You will revolt more and more. The whole head is sick, And the whole heart faints. From the sole of the foot even to the head, There is no soundness in it, But wounds and bruises and putrefying sores; They have not been closed or bound up, Or soothed with ointment.

Your country is desolate, Your cities are burned with fire; Strangers devour your land in your presence; And it is desolate, as overthrown by strangers. So the daughter of Zion is left as a booth in a vineyard, As a hut in a garden of cucumbers, As a besieged city. Unless the Lord of hosts Had

left to us a very small remnant, We would have become like Sodom, We would have been made like Gomorrah.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 18: 48, 17

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

He delivers me from my enemies. You also lift me up above those who
rise against me;

You have delivered me from the violent man. He delivered me from my
strong enemy, From those who hated me, For they were too strong for me.
Alleluia.

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

John 8: 12- 20

Then Jesus spoke to them again, saying, "I am the light of the world. He who follows Me shall not walk in darkness, but have the light of life." The Pharisees therefore said to Him, "You bear witness of Yourself; Your witness is not true." Jesus answered and said to them, "Even if I bear witness of Myself, My witness is true, for I know where I came from and where I am going; but you do not know where I come from and where I am going. You judge according to the flesh; I judge no one. And yet if I do judge, My judgment is true; for I am not alone, but I am with the Father who sent Me. It is also written in your law that the testimony of two men is true. I am One who bears witness of Myself, and the Father who sent Me bears witness of Me." Then they said to Him, Where is Your Father?" Jesus answered, "You know neither Me nor My Father. If you had known Me, you would have known My Father also."

These words Jesus spoke in the treasury, as He taught in the temple; and no one laid hands on Him, for His hour had not yet come.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

**The Exposition of The Sixth Hour of the Tuesday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

The True God who came to the world says, “I am the Light of the world” and what He says is the truth, “he who follows Me shall not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life which will lead him to the way of the truth.”

Truly, You are the Light of the Father and the Person from His essence, whose glory shines with great luminescence over the creation unto eternity.

He drew us after Him, the estranged nation, to the knowledge of the truth in His name. He enlightened us with the light of His divinity, we who are sitting in the darkness and shadow of death.

As for the contrary, Jews who are His own; He relegated them to the darkness of Hell forever because they refused His words, rejected Him, and condemned Him to death. Let us praise His Holy name and exalt in glorifying Him.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
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Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Genesis 6: 5 -- 9: 7

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Then the Lord saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every intent of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually. And the Lord was sorry that He had made man on the earth, and He was grieved in His heart. So the Lord said, "I will destroy man whom I have created from the face of the earth, both man and beast, creeping thing and birds of the air, for I am sorry that I have made them." But Noah found grace in the eyes of the Lord.

This is the genealogy of Noah. Noah was a just man, perfect in his generations. Noah walked with God. And Noah begot three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. The earth also was corrupt before God, and the earth was filled with violence. So God looked upon the earth, and indeed it was corrupt; for all flesh had corrupted their way on the earth.

And God said to Noah, "The end of all flesh has come before Me, for the earth is filled with violence through them; and behold, I will destroy them with the earth." Make yourself an ark of gopher wood; make rooms in the ark, and cover it inside and outside with pitch. And this is how you shall make it: The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits, its width fifty cubits, and its height thirty cubits. You shall make a window for the ark, and you shall finish it to a cubit from above; and set the door of the ark in its side. You shall make it with lower, second, and third decks. And behold, I Myself am bringing floodwaters on the earth, to destroy from under heaven all flesh in which is the breath of life; everything that is on the earth shall die. But I will establish My covenant with you; and you shall go into the ark--you, your sons, your wife, and your sons' wives with you. And of every living thing of all flesh you shall bring two of every sort into the ark, to keep them alive with you; they shall be male and female. Of the birds after their kind, of animals after their kind, and of every creeping thing of the earth after its kind, two of every kind will come to you to keep them alive. And you shall take for yourself of all food that is eaten, and you shall gather it to yourself; and it shall be food for you and for them." Thus Noah did; according to all that God commanded him, so he did.

Then the Lord said to Noah, "Come into the ark, you and all your household, because I have seen that you are righteous before Me in this generation. You shall take with you seven each of every clean animal, a male and his female; two each of animals that are unclean, a male and his

female; also seven each of birds of the air, male and female, to keep the species alive on the face of all the earth. For after seven more days I will cause it to rain on the earth forty days and forty nights, and I will destroy from the face of the earth all living things that I have made." And Noah did according to all that the Lord commanded him.

Noah was six hundred years old when the floodwaters were on the earth. So Noah, with his sons, his wife, and his sons' wives, went into the ark because of the waters of the flood. Of clean animals, of animals that are unclean, of birds, and of everything that creeps on the earth, two by two they went into the ark to Noah, male and female, as God had commanded Noah.

And it came to pass after seven days that the waters of the flood were on the earth. In the six hundredth year of Noah's life, in the second month, the seventeenth day of the month, on that day all the fountains of the great deep were broken up, and the windows of heaven were opened. And the rain was on the earth forty days and forty nights. On the very same day Noah and Noah's sons, Shem, Ham, and Japheth, and Noah's wife and the three wives of his sons with them, entered the ark-- they and every beast after its kind, all cattle after their kind, every creeping thing that creeps on the earth after its kind, and every bird after its kind, every bird of every sort. And they went into the ark to Noah, two by two, of all flesh in which is the breath of life. So those that entered, male and female of all flesh, went in as God had commanded him; and the Lord shut him in.

Now the flood was on the earth forty days. The waters increased and lifted up the ark, and it rose high above the earth. The waters prevailed and greatly increased on the earth, and the ark moved about on the surface of the waters. And the waters prevailed exceedingly on the earth, and all the high hills under the whole heaven were covered. The waters prevailed fifteen cubits upward, and the mountains were covered. And all flesh died that moved on the earth: birds and cattle and beasts and every creeping thing that creeps on the earth, and every man. All in whose nostrils was the breath of the spirit of life, all that was on the dry land, died. So He destroyed all living things, which were on the face of the ground: man and cattle, creeping thing and bird of the air. They were destroyed from the earth. Only Noah and those who were with him in the ark remained alive. And the waters prevailed on the earth one hundred and fifty days.

Then God remembered Noah, and every living thing, and all the animals that were with him in the ark. And God made a wind to pass over the earth, and the waters subsided. The fountains of the deep and the windows of heaven were also stopped, and the rain from heaven was restrained. And the waters receded continually from the earth. At the end of the hundred and fifty days the waters decreased. Then the ark rested in the seventh month, the seventeenth day of the month, on the mountains of Ararat. And the waters decreased continually until the tenth month. In the tenth month, on the first day of the month, the tops of the mountains were seen.

So it came to pass, at the end of forty days, that Noah opened the window of the ark, which he had made. Then he sent out a raven, which kept

going to and fro until the waters had dried up from the earth. He also sent out from himself a dove, to see if the waters had receded from the face of the ground. But the dove found no resting place for the sole of her foot, and she returned into the ark to him, for the waters were on the face of the whole earth. So he put out his hand and took her, and drew her into the ark to himself. And he waited yet another seven days, and again he sent the dove out from the ark. Then the dove came to him in the evening, and behold, a freshly plucked olive leaf was in her mouth; and Noah knew that the waters had receded from the earth. So he waited yet another seven days and sent out the dove, which did not return again to him anymore. And it came to pass in the six hundred and first year, in the first month, the first day of the month, that the waters were dried up from the earth; and Noah removed the covering of the ark and looked, and indeed the surface of the ground was dry. And in the second month, on the twenty-seventh day of the month, the earth was dried.

Then God spoke to Noah, saying, "Go out of the ark, you and your wife, and your sons and your sons' wives with you. Bring out with you every living thing of all flesh that is with you: birds and cattle and every creeping thing that creeps on the earth, so that they may abound on the earth, and be fruitful and multiply on the earth." So Noah went out, and his sons and his wife and his sons' wives with him. Every animal, every creeping thing, every bird, and whatever creeps on the earth, according to their families, went out of the ark.

Then Noah built an altar to the Lord, and took of every clean animal and

of every clean bird, and offered burnt offerings on the altar. And the Lord smelled a soothing aroma. Then the Lord said in His heart, "I will never again curse the ground for man's sake, although the imagination of man's heart is evil from his youth; nor will I again destroy every living thing as I have done." While the earth remains, Seedtime and harvest, Cold and heat, winter and summer, And day and night Shall not cease."

So God blessed Noah and his sons, and said to them: "Be fruitful and multiply, and fill the earth. And the fear of you and the dread of you shall be on every beast of the earth, on every bird of the air, on all that move on the earth, and on all the fish of the sea. They are given into your hand. Every moving thing that lives shall be food for you. I have given you all things, even as the green herbs. But you shall not eat flesh with its life, that is, its blood. Surely for your lifeblood I will demand a reckoning; from the hand of every beast I will require it, and from the hand of man. From the hand of every man's brother I will require the life of man. "Whoever sheds man's blood, By man his blood shall be shed; For in the image of God He made man. And as for you, be fruitful and multiply; Bring forth abundantly in the earth and multiply in it."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 9:1-11

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Wisdom has built her house, She has hewn out her seven pillars; She has slaughtered her meat, She has mixed her wine, She has also furnished her table. She has sent out her maidens, She cries out from the highest places of the city, "Whoever is simple, let him turn in here!" As for him who lacks understanding, she says to him, "Come, eat of my bread And drink of the wine I have mixed. Forsake foolishness and live, And go in the way of understanding."

He who corrects a scoffer gets shame for himself, And he who rebukes a wicked man only harms himself. Do not correct a scoffer, lest he hate you; Rebuke a wise man, and he will love you. Give instruction to a wise man, and he will be still wiser; Teach a just man, and he will increase in learning." The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom, And the knowledge of the Holy One is understanding. For by me your days will be multiplied, And years of life will be added to you.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 40:9- 31

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

U Zion, You who bring good tidings, Get up into the high mountain;
O Jerusalem, You who bring good tidings, Lift up your voice with strength, Lift it up, be not afraid; Say to the cities of Judah, "Behold your God!" Behold, the Lord God shall come with a strong hand, And His arm shall rule for Him; Behold, His reward is with Him, And His work before Him. He will feed His flock like a shepherd; He will gather the lambs with His arm, And carry them in His bosom, And gently lead those who are with young.

Who has measured the waters in the hollow of His hand, Measured heaven with a span And calculated the dust of the earth in a measure? Weighed the mountains in scales And the hills in a balance? Who has directed the Spirit of the Lord, Or as His counselor has taught Him? With whom did He take counsel, and who instructed Him, And taught Him in the path of justice? Who taught Him knowledge, And showed Him the way of understanding? Behold, the nations are as a drop in a bucket, And are counted as the small dust on the scales; Look, He lifts up the isles as a very little thing. And Lebanon is not sufficient to burn, Nor its beasts sufficient for a burnt offering. All nations before Him are as nothing, And they are counted by Him less than nothing and worthless.

To whom then will you liken God? Or what likeness will you compare to Him? The workman molds an image, The goldsmith overspreads it with gold, And the silversmith casts silver chains. Whoever is too impoverished for such a contribution Chooses a tree that will not rot; He seeks for himself a skillful workman To prepare a carved image that will not totter. Have you not known? Have you not heard? Has it not been told you from the beginning? Have you not understood from the foundations of the earth? It is He who sits above the circle of the earth, And its inhabitants are like grasshoppers, Who stretches out the heavens like a curtain, And spreads them out like a tent to dwell in. He brings the princes to nothing; He makes the judges of the earth useless. Scarcely shall they be planted, Scarcely shall they be sown, Scarcely shall their stock take root in the earth, When He will also blow on them, And they will wither, And the whirlwind will take them away like stubble." To whom then will you liken Me, Or to whom shall I be equal?" says the Holy One. Lift up your eyes on high, And see who has created these things, Who brings out their host by number; He calls them all by name, By the greatness of His might And the strength of His power; Not one is missing.

Why do you say, O Jacob, And speak, O Israel: "My way is hidden from the Lord, And my just claim is passed over by my God"? Have you not known? Have you not heard? The everlasting God, the Lord, The Creator of the ends of the earth, Neither faints nor is weary. His understanding is unsearchable. He gives power to the weak, And to those who have no

might He increases strength. Even the youths shall faint and be weary, And the young men shall utterly fall. But those who wait on the Lord shall renew their strength; They shall mount up with wings like eagles, they shall run and not be weary, they shall walk and not faint.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Daniel 7:9-15

**A reading from Daniel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

I continued to watch until thrones were put in place, And the Ancient of Days was seated; His garment was white as snow, And the hair of His head was like pure wool. His throne was a fiery flame, Its wheels a burning fire; A fiery stream issued And came forth from before Him. A thousand thousands ministered to Him; Ten thousand times ten thousand stood before Him. The court was seated, And the books were opened." I watched then because of the sound of the pompous words which the horn was speaking; I watched till the beast was slain, and its body destroyed and given to the burning flame. As for the rest of the beasts, they had their dominion taken away, yet their lives were prolonged for a season and a time."

I was watching in the night visions, And behold, One like the Son of Man, Coming with the clouds of heaven! He came to the Ancient of Days, And they brought Him near before Him. Then to Him was given dominion and glory and a kingdom, That all peoples, nations, and languages should serve Him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion, Which shall not pass away, And His kingdom the one Which shall not be destroyed."

I, Daniel, was grieved in my spirit within my body, and the visions of my head troubled me.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 8: 1- 12

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Does not wisdom cry out, And understanding lift up her voice? She takes her stand on the top of the high hill, Beside the way, where the paths meet. She cries out by the gates, at the entry of the city, At the entrance of the doors: "To you, O men, I call, And my voice is to the sons of men. O you simple ones, understand prudence, And you fools, be of an understanding heart. Listen, for I will speak of excellent things, And from

the opening of my lips will come right things; For my mouth will speak truth; Wickedness is an abomination to my lips.

All the words of my mouth are with righteousness; Nothing crooked or perverse is in them. They are all plain to him who understands, And right to those who find knowledge. Receive my instruction, and not silver, And knowledge rather than choice gold; For wisdom is better than rubies, And all the things one may desire cannot be compared with her.

"I, wisdom, dwell with prudence, And find out knowledge and discretion.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

My brethren, let us do the will of God as long as we have time to do works for the Lord. Remember that death does not linger and we are destined to leave this world. Where are those that were before us? They are all laying in tombs. Let us be fruitful to be worthy of the grace of God which He bestowed upon us, as well as to Christians, to be likened to Jesus Christ, the true light. For we are not human. He is the master and we are

His slaves. He is the shepherd and we are his sheep under his guidance. He is born of the Father but we are His creation. Light of light, He died for us; we who are sinners. He gave himself up for us on the wood of the cross to grant us His kingdom. Slaves were to die for their master but the master accepted the shame and died for His slaves. That as he died, they die also with Him and as He is alive, they live with Him.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 25:1- 3

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

To You, O Lord, I lift up my soul. O my God, I trust in You; Let me not be ashamed.

Let not my enemies triumph over me. Let those be ashamed who deal treacherously without cause. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 24:3-35

Now as He sat on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to Him privately, saying, "Tell us, when will these things be? And what will be the sign of Your coming, and of the end of the age?" And Jesus answered and said to them: "Take heed that no one deceives you. For many will come in My name, saying, 'I am the Christ,' and will deceive many. And you will hear of wars and rumors of wars. See that you are not troubled; for all these things must come to pass, but the end is not yet. For nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. And there will be famines, pestilences, and earthquakes in various places. All these are the beginning of sorrows.

Then they will deliver you up to tribulation and kill you, and you will be hated by all nations for My name's sake. And then many will be offended, will betray one another, and will hate one another. Then many false prophets will rise up and deceive many. And because lawlessness will abound, the love of many will grow cold. But he who endures to the

end shall be saved. And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached in all the world as a witness to all the nations, and then the end will come.”

Therefore when you see the ‘abomination of desolation,’ spoken of by Daniel the prophet, standing in the holy place” (whoever reads, let him understand), then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains. Let him who is on the housetop not go down to take anything out of his house. And let him who is in the field not go back to get his clothes. But woe to those who are pregnant and to those who are nursing babies in those days! And pray that your flight may not be in winter or on the Sabbath. For then there will be great tribulation, such as has not been since the beginning of the world until this time, no, nor ever shall be. And unless those days were shortened, no flesh would be saved; but for the elect’s sake those days will be shortened. Then if anyone says to you, ‘Look, here is the Christ!’ or ‘There!’ do not believe it. For false christs and false prophets will rise and show great signs and wonders to deceive, if possible, even the elect. See, I have told you beforehand.

Therefore if they say to you, ‘Look, He is in the desert!’ do not go out; or ‘Look, He is in the inner rooms!’ do not believe it. For as the lightning comes from the east and flashes to the west, so also will the coming of the Son of Man be. For wherever the carcass is, there the eagles will be gathered together.”

Immediately after the tribulation of those days the sun will be darkened,

and the moon will not give its light; the stars will fall from heaven, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken.

Then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in heaven, and then all the tribes of the earth will mourn, and they will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory. And He will send His angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they will gather together His elect from the four winds, from one end of heaven to the other.” Now learn this parable from the fig tree: When its branch has already become tender and puts forth leaves, you know that summer is near. So you also, when you see all these things, know that it is near--at the doors! Assuredly, I say to you, this generation will by no means pass away till all these things take place. Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will by no means pass away.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

**The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Tuesday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

O Come, all you people of Jerusalem, to see Jesus on the Mount of Olives, to see Jesus of Nazareth, the Son of David, and the Word of the Father, sitting there surrounded by his inquiring disciples. They reminded Him of the size of the temple, the huge stone with which it was built, and how ornate it was.

Our very Merciful Savior who directs those who trust him and reassures their hearts about the future with His peace and knowledge, replied saying: “Do not let anyone mislead you about any matter when you face temptations.

For nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom; there will be earthquakes and pestilence in diverse places; there will be great afflictions and calamities on earth. Know that you will kill you and the nations will hate you. This they will inflict on you because you bear My name. Persevere so that you may be saved.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

- Exposition
1st Hour
- Exposition
3rd Hour
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6th Hour
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THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF TUESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Isaiah 30: 25- 30

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

There will be on every high mountain And on every high hill Rivers
and streams of waters, In the day of the great slaughter, When the
towers fall. 26 Moreover the light of the moon will be as the light of the
sun, And the light of the sun will be sevenfold, As the light of seven days,
In the day that the Lord binds up the bruise of His people And heals the
stroke of their wound.

Behold, the name of the Lord comes from afar, Burning with His anger, And
His burden is heavy; His lips are full of indignation, And His tongue like a
devouring fire. 28 His breath is like an overflowing stream, Which reaches
up to the neck, To sift the nations with the sieve of futility; And there shall
be a bridle in the jaws of the people, Causing them to err. You shall have

a song As in the night when a holy festival is kept, And gladness of heart as when one goes with a flute, To come into the mountain of the Lord, To the Mighty One of Israel. 30 The Lord will cause His glorious voice to be heard, And show the descent of His arm, With the indignation of His anger And the flame of a devouring fire, With scattering, tempest, and hailstones.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 6: 20- 7:4

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Hy son, keep your father's command, And do not forsake the law of your mother. Bind them continually upon your heart; Tie them around your neck. When you roam, they will lead you; When you sleep, they will keep you; And when you awake, they will speak with you. For the commandment is a lamp, And the law a light; Reproofs of instruction are the way of life, To keep you from the evil woman, From the flattering tongue of a seductress. Do not lust after her beauty in your heart, Nor let her allure you with her eyelids. For by means of a harlot a man is reduced to a crust of bread; And an adulteress will prey upon his precious life.

Can a man take fire to his bosom, And his clothes not be burned? Can one walk on hot coals, And his feet not be seared? So is he who goes in to his neighbor's wife; Whoever touches her shall not be innocent. People do not despise a thief If he steals to satisfy himself when he is starving. Yet when he is found, he must restore sevenfold; He may have to give up all the substance of his house. Whoever commits adultery with a woman lacks understanding; He who does so destroys his own soul. Wounds and dishonor he will get, And his reproach will not be wiped away. For jealousy is a husband's fury; Therefore he will not spare in the day of vengeance. He will accept no recompense, Nor will he be appeased though you give many gifts.

My son, keep my words, And treasure my commands within you. Keep my commands and live, And my law as the apple of your eye. Bind them on your fingers; Write them on the tablet of your heart. Say to wisdom, "You are my sister," And call understanding your nearest kin.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba John Chrysostom, may his blessings be with us. Amen.

I want to remind you with what I repeatedly reiterated to you concerning our communion with the Holy sacraments which is of Christ.

I see you in a state of extreme looseness, permissiveness, and an alarming audacity and lamentable recklessness. I weep over my condition and ask myself; Do these people really know for whom do they stand? Or do these people realize the power of this sacrament? At this thought I become angry reluctantly. If I could go away, I would have left your community out of distraughtness. If I scold one of you, he disregards my words and resents the reprimand as if I were unfair to him. I am amazed that you do not get angry at those who violate you and plunder your possessions as much as you are angry at me; I who am keen over your salvation. I dread the thought that God's wrath may be inflicted upon you because of your disregard of this great sacrament. Do you really know who is He you want to partake of? This is the Holy Body of God the Word, and His blood that he offered for our salvation. Anyone who partakes in it undeservingly will suffer abominable punishment; as was the case with Judas who betrayed God when he had communion with him without being worthy.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba John Chrysostom who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of Tuesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 12: 3-4

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Your throne, O God, is forever and ever; A scepter of righteousness is the scepter of Your kingdom.

Blessed is he who considers the poor; The Lord will deliver him in time of trouble. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 25:14- 26: 2

For the kingdom of heaven is like a man traveling to a far country, who called his own servants and delivered his goods to them. And to one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one, to each according to his own ability; and immediately he went on a journey.

Then he who had received the five talents went and traded with them,

and made another five talents. And likewise he who had received two gained two more also. But he who had received one went and dug in the ground, and hid his lord's money.

After a long time the lord of those servants came and settled accounts with them. So he who had received five talents came and brought five other talents, saying, 'Lord, you delivered to me five talents; look, I have gained five more talents besides them.' His lord said to him, 'Well done, good and faithful servant; you were faithful over a few things, I will make you ruler over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.' He also who had received two talents came and said, 'Lord, you delivered to me two talents; look, I have gained two more talents besides them.' His lord said to him, 'Well done, good and faithful servant; you have been faithful over a few things, I will make you ruler over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.'

Then he who had received the one talent came and said, 'Lord, I knew you to be a hard man, reaping where you have not sown, and gathering where you have not scattered seed. And I was afraid, and went and hid your talent in the ground. Look, there you have what is yours.' But his lord answered and said to him, 'You wicked and lazy servant, you knew that I reap where I have not sown, and gather where I have not scattered seed. So you ought to have deposited my money with the bankers, and at my coming I would have received back my own with interest.'

Therefore take the talent from him, and give it to him who has ten talents. For to everyone who has, more will be given, and he will have abundance; but from him who does not have, even what he has will be taken away. And cast the unprofitable servant into the outer darkness. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.'

"When the Son of Man comes in His glory, and all the holy angels with Him, then He will sit on the throne of His glory. All the nations will be gathered before Him, and He will separate them one from another, as a shepherd divides his sheep from the goats. And He will set the sheep on His right hand, but the goats on the left.

Then the King will say to those on His right hand, 'Come, you blessed of My Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world: for I was hungry and you gave Me food; I was thirsty and you gave Me drink; I was a stranger and you took Me in; I was naked and you clothed Me; I was sick and you visited Me; I was in prison and you came to Me.' Then the righteous will answer Him, saying, 'Lord, when did we see You hungry and feed You, or thirsty and give You drink? When did we see You a stranger and take You in, or naked and clothe You? Or when did we see You sick, or in prison, and come to You?' And the King will answer and say to them, 'Assuredly, I say to you, inasmuch as you did it to one of the least of these My brethren, you did it to Me.'

Then He will also say to those on the left hand, 'Depart from Me, you cursed, into the everlasting fire prepared for the devil and his angels: for I was hungry and you gave Me no food; I was thirsty and you gave Me no drink; I was a stranger and you did not take Me in, naked and you did not clothe Me, sick and in prison and you did not visit Me. 'Then they also will answer Him, saying, 'Lord, when did we see You hungry or thirsty or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison, and did not minister to You?' Then He will answer them, saying, 'Assuredly, I say to you, inasmuch as you did not do it to one of the least of these, you did not do it to Me. 'And these will go away into everlasting punishment, but the righteous into eternal life."

Now it came to pass, when Jesus had finished all these sayings, that He said to His disciples, "You know that after two days is the Passover, and the Son of Man will be delivered up to be crucified."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the Eleventh Hour of Tuesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Against You only have I sinned. O God Almighty, forgive me. In audacity, I have committed iniquities and I was negligent in obeying Your orders. You come in the power of Your glory with hosts of angels around You. You sit on the throne of Your kingdom O the righteous Judge. All the nations from all four corners of the earth assemble in front of You. Yet with Your one word, they split apart to the right and to the left. The sheep on Your right and the goats on Your left. Those on Your right will rejoice with You, as well as those virtuous who sought to please You and who observed Your commandments and fulfilled them all.

Those who fed You in Your hunger and gave You a drink in Your thirst; hosted You when You were a stranger in their homes; clothed You when You were naked; visited You when You were incarcerated. In Your sickness, they served You. Then they will rejoice in their good deeds and receive

- Exposition
1st Hour
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their rewards to the exclusion of the goats. The righteous inherit eternal life and the goats suffer. Listen O you foolish and fathom what you lost; that mercy prides itself over justice. Be merciful before you face judgment by the judgment by the Judge.

After our Savior concluded his talk, He told His disciples that Passover will come after two days and that the son of man will fulfill the prophecies; to be the sacrificial lamb and complete Passover to the fullness of times. O Christ our Lord, truly You have been the unblemished lamb sacrificed for the life of mankind. He is the lamb of God, the Father, who takes away the sins of the world.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

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Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

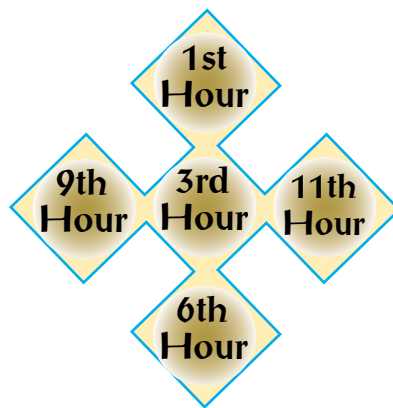
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CONCLUDING HYMN

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THE SHORT BLESSING

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THE HOLY PASCHA OF WEDNESDAY EVE

FIRST HOUR OF EVE OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Ezekiel 22: 17- 22

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

The word of the Lord came to me, saying, "Son of man, the house of Israel has become dross to Me; they are all bronze, tin, iron, and lead, in the midst of a furnace; they have become dross from silver. Therefore thus says the Lord God: 'Because you have all become dross, therefore behold, I will gather you into the midst of Jerusalem. As men gather silver, bronze, iron, lead, and tin into the midst of a furnace, to blow fire on it, to melt it; so I will gather you in My anger and in My fury, and I will leave you there and melt you. Yes, I will gather you and blow on you with the fire of My wrath, and you shall be melted in its midst. As silver is melted in the midst of a furnace, so shall you be melted in its midst; then you shall know that I, the Lord, have poured out My fury on you.' "

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Ezekiel 22: 23- 28

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

And the word of the Lord came to me, saying, "Son of man, say to her: 'You are a land that is not cleansed or rained on in the day of indignation.' The conspiracy of her prophets in her midst is like a roaring lion tearing the prey; they have devoured people; they have taken treasure and precious things; they have made many widows in her midst. Her priests have violated My law and profaned My holy things; they have not distinguished between the holy and unholy, nor have they made known the difference between the unclean and the clean; and they have hidden their eyes from My Sabbaths, so that I am profaned among them. Her princes in her midst are like wolves tearing the prey, to shed blood, to destroy people, and to get dishonest gain. Her prophets plastered them with untempered mortar, seeing false visions, and divining lies for them.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour: of the Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Psalm 59:16- 17

For You have been my defense And refuge in the day of my trouble.
To You, O my Strength, I will sing praises; For God is my defense,
My God of mercy. **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

Matthew 22:1-14

And Jesus answered and spoke to them again by parables and said: "The kingdom of heaven is like a certain king who arranged a marriage for his son, and sent out his servants to call those who were invited to the wedding; and they were not willing to come. Again, he sent out other servants, saying, 'Tell those who are invited, "See, I have prepared my dinner; my oxen and fatted cattle are killed, and all things are ready. Come to the wedding." ' But they made light of it and went their ways, one to his

own farm, another to his business. And the rest seized his servants, treated them spitefully, and killed them. But when the king heard about it, he was furious. And he sent out his armies, destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city. Then he said to his servants, 'The wedding is ready, but those who were invited were not worthy. Therefore go into the highways, and as many as you find, invite to the wedding.' So those servants went out into the highways and gathered together all whom they found, both bad and good. And the wedding hall was filled with guests.

But when the king came in to see the guests, he saw a man there who did not have on a wedding garment. So he said to him, 'Friend, how did you come in here without a wedding garment?' And he was speechless. Then the king said to the servants, 'Bind him hand and foot, take him away, and cast him into outer darkness; there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.' For many are called, but few are chosen."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The First Hour of Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

That king who held the marriage feast invited the guests to the banquet, is God the Father. His Son is Jesus Christ our Savior.

The feast is the world to which he came, and was incarnated from the Theotokos and was among the people as one of them.

The servants He commissiond to carry His message are the prophets who preceded Him preaching to the nations His imminent coming.

The nations, however, neglected the matter and rejected their message; they went each one his own way; the one to his field, the other to his business, and the rest killed the messengers.

The king became enraged, sent his troops, disciplined these killers, and burned their town. Who were those who were invited to the real banquet which was for God the Word, but the contrary antipathetic Jews, whose names were eliminated from the Book of Life.

He, God the Father, sent others and commanded them, to go in the streets

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

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6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

and to invite everyone they find, when they did that, they invited many who were good and many who were bad, until they had a full house.

The King came in to inspect the guests; He saw someone who was not appropriately attired for the occasion. He asked him, “Friend how did you get in without the proper dress?” The man was speechless and embarrassed and the servants shoved him out to the outer darkness.

Who is this individual, but Judas, who lost his heavenly garment and became dressed with damnation which seeped as water into his stomach because he denied His master’s blessings and dared to betray Him. He was thus estranged from his master’s, glory and his priesthood was given to another.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF EVE OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Amos 5:18- 27

**A reading from Amos the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Woe to you who desire the day of the Lord! For what good is the day of the Lord to you? It will be darkness, and not light. It will be as though a man fled from a lion, And a bear met him! Or as though he went into the house, Leaned his hand on the wall, And a serpent bit him! Is not the day of the Lord darkness, and not light? Is it not very dark, with no brightness in it?

"I hate, I despise your feast days, And I do not savor your sacred assemblies. Though you offer Me burnt offerings and your grain offerings, I will not accept them, Nor will I regard your fattened peace offerings. Take away from Me the noise of your songs, For I will not hear the melody of your

stringed instruments. But let justice run down like water, And righteousness like a mighty stream.”

Did you offer Me sacrifices and offerings In the wilderness forty years, O house of Israel? You also carried Sikkuth your king And Chiun, your idols, The star of your gods, Which you made for yourselves. Therefore I will send you into captivity beyond Damascus,” Says the Lord, whose name is the God of hosts.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour: of the Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 65:4

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Blessed is he whom You choose, and help, he shall dwell in Your courts. Holy is Your temple, wondrous in righteousness. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 24: 36- 51

"But of that day and hour no one knows, not even the angels of heaven, but My Father only. But as the days of Noah were, so also will the coming of the Son of Man be. For as in the days before the flood, they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noah entered the ark, and did not know until the flood came and took them all away, so also will the coming of the Son of Man be. Then two men will be in the field: one will be taken and the other left. Two women will be grinding at the mill: one will be taken and the other left.

Watch therefore, for you do not know what hour your Lord is coming. But know this, that if the master of the house had known what hour the thief would come, he would have watched and not allowed his house to be broken into. Therefore you also be ready, for the Son of Man is coming at an hour you do not expect."

Who then is a faithful and wise servant, whom his master made ruler over his household, to give them food in due season? Blessed is that servant

whom his master, when he comes, will find so doing. Assuredly, I say to you that he will make him ruler over all his goods. But if that evil servant says in his heart, 'My master is delaying his coming,' and begins to beat his fellow servants, and to eat and drink with the drunkards, the master of that servant will come on a day when he is not looking for him and at an hour that he is not aware of, and will cut him in two and appoint him his portion with the hypocrites. There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Third Hour of the eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Contemplate, you who exalt the Lord, the kindness of Christ our God; observe how he calls his chosen, who fulfill his will. prudent and honest servants.

In mean those who preserve his commandments, and look forward to their awards, those who remain awake and alert, that they may receive the promised rewards.

As the Bible asserts, that those servant, whose master makes a surprise visit and finds them awake, are blessed. Assuredly I say: He will make His servant ruler over His property.

So for He whom He finds derelict in his duties, and neglecting them often, one day, his Master will make a surprise visit, repudiate him, and make his lot with the hypocrites, in the place of darkness and suffering.

Let us awake and be alert in anticipation of the day of the Lord, so that we may rejoice with Him in His dwelling place and receive his clemencies and mercies.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

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- Exposition 3rd Hour
- Exposition 6th Hour
- Exposition 9th Hour
- Exposition 11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF EVE OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Jeremiah 16: 9- 13

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

For thus says the Lord of hosts, the God of Israel: "Behold, I will cause to cease from this place, before your eyes and in your days, the voice of mirth and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride."

And it shall be, when you show this people all these words, and they say to you, 'Why has the Lord pronounced all this great disaster against us? Or what is our iniquity? Or what is our sin that we have committed against the Lord our God?' then you shall say to them, 'Because your fathers have forsaken Me,' says the Lord; 'they have walked after other gods and have served them and worshiped them, and have forsaken Me and not kept My law. And you have done worse than your fathers, for

behold, each one follows the dictates of his own evil heart, so that no one listens to Me. Therefore I will cast you out of this land into a land that you do not know, neither you nor your fathers; and there you shall serve other gods day and night, where I will not show you favor.'

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of the Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 102:1,2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Hear my prayer, O Lord, And let my cry come to You. In the day that I
call, answer me speedily. **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

Matthew 25: 1- 13

Then the kingdom of heaven shall be likened to ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. Now five of them were wise, and five were foolish. Those who were foolish took their lamps and took no oil with them, but the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps. But while the bridegroom was delayed, they all slumbered and slept. And at midnight a cry was heard: 'Behold, the bridegroom is coming; go out to meet him!' Then all those virgins arose and trimmed their lamps. And the foolish said to the wise, 'Give us some of your oil, for our lamps are going out.' But the wise answered, saying, 'No, lest there should not be enough for us and you; but go rather to those who sell, and buy for yourselves.'

And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went in with him to the wedding; and the door was shut. Afterward the other virgins came also, saying, 'Lord, Lord, open to us!' But he answered and said, 'Assuredly, I say to you, I do not know you.' Watch therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour in which the Son of Man is coming.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Sixth Hour of Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Behold these virtues and parables that our Lord of Glory, Jesus, the source of every grace, and good, has told us; He who granted mankind to partake in His kingdom to partake in His kingdom. Listen, think, and understand and know His blessed parables, for the sake of the prudent virgins who were mentioned in the Bible and were likened to his kingdom.

Ten virgins, five foolish and five wise, said the Lord. As He tells us, there was no distinction between them as virgins; but they differed in their deeds. Thus, He praised and blessed the wise five virgins because they were earnest and prudent. They filled their lanterns with oil and kept the surplus in their containers. As for the foolish virgins, they were lackadaisical and did not prepare their lanterns.

When they all woke up at the given time to proceed with their procession ahead of the bridegroom, their lanterns became useless at the wedding time and were unable to accompany the bridegroom. Those who were prepared, accompanied him to the wedding and the somnolent ones stayed outside.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

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1st Hour

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THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

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CONCLUDING HYMN

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THE SHORT BLESSING

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NINTH HOUR OF EVE OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Hosea 9: 14 - 10:2

**A reading from Hosea the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Give them, O Lord-- What will You give? Give them a miscarrying womb and dry breasts!

"All their wickedness is in Gilgal, For there I hated them. Because of the evil of their deeds I will drive them from My house; I will love them no more. All their princes are rebellious. Ephraim is stricken, Their root is dried up; They shall bear no fruit. Yes, were they to bear children, I would kill the darlings of their womb." My God will cast them away, Because they did not obey Him; And they shall be wanderers among the nations.

Israel empties his vine; He brings forth fruit for himself. According to the multitude of his fruit He has increased the altars; According to the bounty of his land They have embellished his sacred pillars. Their heart is divided;

Now they are held guilty. He will break down their altars; He will ruin their sacred pillars.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of the Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 22: 20- 21

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Deliver Me from the sword, My precious life from the power of the dog. Save Me from the lion's mouth And from the horns of the wild oxen! **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 23: 29- 36

Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! Because you build the tombs of the prophets and adorn the monuments of the righteous, and say, 'If we had lived in the days of our fathers, we would not have been partakers with them in the blood of the prophets.' Therefore you are witnesses against yourselves that you are sons of those who murdered the prophets. Fill up, then, the measure of your fathers' guilt. Serpents, brood of vipers! How can you escape the condemnation of hell? Therefore, indeed,

I send you prophets, wise men, and scribes: some of them you will kill and crucify, and some of them you will scourge in your synagogues and persecute from city to city, that on you may come all the righteous blood shed on the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zechariah, son of Berechiah, whom you murdered between the temple and the altar. Assuredly, I say to you, all these things will come upon this generation.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Christ paints a sad picture of the conduct and the compartment of the Pharisees. He admonishes them in an unmistakable way for carrying on the same questionable traditions of their predecessors and even surpassed them.

The predecessors slew the prophets and saints. Their successors built the tombs of these prophets. They were the snakes born of serpents. They will not escape their deeds, They will be charged with the blood of these saints; from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah, whom they slew between the sanctuary and the altar. All these preceding tribulation will fall on this generation because they all had conspired to kill the Son of God.

That is why God scattered them all over the earth, their enemies dominated them, their heritage was given to others, and their dwellings became desolate.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

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11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF EVE OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Wisdom of Solomon 7: 24- 30

A reading from the Wisdom of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Wisdom is more mobile than any motion; because of her pureness she pervades and penetrates all things. For she is a breath of the power of God, and a pure emanation of the glory of the Almighty; therefore nothing defiled gains entrance into her. For she is a reflection of eternal light, a spotless mirror of the working of God, and an image of his goodness. Although she is but one, she can do all things, and while remaining in herself, she renews all things; in every generation she passes into holy souls and makes them friends of God, and prophets; for God loves nothing so much as the person who lives with wisdom. She is more beautiful than the sun, and excels every constellation of the stars. Compared with the light she is found to be superior, for it is succeeded by the night, but against wisdom evil does not prevail.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of the Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 57: 1

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Be merciful to me, O God, be merciful to me! For my soul trusts in You;
And in the shadow of Your wings I will make my refuge, Until these
calamities have passed by. **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

John 11: 55- 57

And the Passover of the Jews was near, and many went from the country up to Jerusalem before the Passover, to purify themselves. Then they sought Jesus, and spoke among themselves as they stood in the temple, "What do you think--that He will not come to the feast?" Now both the chief priests and the Pharisees had given a command, that if anyone knew where He was, he should report it, that they might seize Him.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Eleventh Hour of the Eve of Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

It was the tradition of all Jews, that as it became near the days of the Passover, the multitudes go up the mountain from the hamlets to Jerusalem to purge themselves. When they ascended the mountain as usual they did not see Jesus go up. They said to one another that maybe He will not come to the feast.

The hypocrites were conniving their vicious, the Pharisees, and the Elders had asked the people to lead them to His location, if it were known, in order to arrest Him.

O what foolishness and stupidity of these evil people who wanted to bait the Omnipotent, the source of all power. Because of their opposition, He will chain them and assign them to Hell, the place of suffering.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE

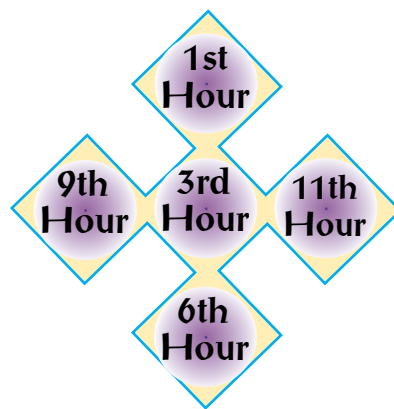
See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



THE HOLY PASCHA OF WEDNESDAY DAY

FIRST HOUR OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 17: 1- 7

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Then all the congregation of the children of Israel set out on their journey from the Wilderness of Sin, according to the commandment of the Lord, and camped in Rephidim; but there was no water for the people to drink. Therefore the people contended with Moses, and said, "Give us water, that we may drink." And Moses said to them, "Why do you contend with me? Why do you tempt the Lord?" And the people thirsted there for water, and the people complained against Moses, and said, "Why is it you have brought us up out of Egypt, to kill us and our children and our livestock with thirst?" So Moses cried out to the Lord, saying, "What shall I do with this people? They are almost ready to stone me!" And the Lord said to Moses, "Go on before the people, and take with you some of the elders of Israel. Also take in your hand your rod

with which you struck the river, and go. Behold, I will stand before you there on the rock in Horeb; and you shall strike the rock, and water will come out of it, that the people may drink." And Moses did so in the sight of the elders of Israel. So he called the name of the place Massah and Meribah, because of the contention of the children of Israel, and because they tempted the Lord, saying, "Is the Lord among us or not?"

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 3: 5- 14

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Trust in the Lord with all your heart, And lean not on your own understanding; In all your ways acknowledge Him, And He shall direct your paths. Do not be wise in your own eyes; Fear the Lord and depart from evil. It will be health to your flesh, And strength to your bones. Honor the Lord with your possessions, And with the first fruits of all your increase; So your barns will be filled with plenty, And your vats will overflow with new wine. My son, do not despise the chastening of the Lord, Nor detest His correction; For whom the Lord loves He corrects, Just as a father the son in whom he delights. Happy is the man who finds wisdom, And the

man who gains understanding; For her proceeds are better than the profits of silver, And her gain than fine gold.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Hosea 5: 13 - 6: 3

**A reading from Hosea the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

When Ephraim saw his sickness, And Judah saw his wound, Then Ephraim went to Assyria And sent to King Jareb; Yet he cannot cure you, Nor heal you of your wound. For I will be like a lion to Ephraim, And like a young lion to the house of Judah. I, even I, will tear them and go away; I will take them away, and no one shall rescue. I will return again to My place till they acknowledge their offense. Then they will seek My face; In their affliction they will earnestly seek Me."

Come, and let us return to the Lord; For He has torn, but He will heal us; He has stricken, but He will bind us up. After two days He will revive us; On the third day He will raise us up, That we may live in His sight. Let us know, Let us pursue the knowledge of the Lord. His going forth is estab-

lished as the morning; He will come to us like the rain, Like the latter and former rain to the earth.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sircah 1:16 - 2:15

A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

To fear the Lord is the beginning of wisdom; she is created with the faithful in the womb. He rained down knowledge and discerning comprehension, and he exalted the glory of those who held her fast. Unrighteous anger cannot be justified, for a man's anger tips the scale to his ruin. A patient man will endure until the right moment, and then joy will burst forth for him. He will hide his words until the right moment, and the lips of many will tell of his good sense. In the treasuries of wisdom are wise sayings, but godliness is an abomination to a sinner. If you desire wisdom, keep the commandments, and the Lord will supply it for you. Do not disobey the fear of the Lord; do not approach him with a divided mind. Be not a hypocrite in men's sight, and keep watch over your lips. Do not exalt yourself lest you fall, and thus bring dishonor upon yourself. The Lord will reveal your secrets. My son, if you come forward to serve

the Lord, prepare yourself for temptation. For gold is tested in the fire, and acceptable men in the furnace of humiliation. You who fear the Lord, wait for his mercy; and turn not aside, lest you fall. Consider the ancient generations and see: who ever trusted in the Lord and was put to shame? Or who ever persevered in the fear of the Lord and was forsaken? Or who ever called upon him and was overlooked? Woe to timid hearts and to slack hands, and to the sinner who walks along two ways! Woe to you who have lost your endurance! What will you do when the Lord punishes you? Those who fear the Lord will not disobey his words, and those who love him will be filled with the law. O son, help your father in his old age, My son, perform your tasks in meekness; then you will be loved by those whom God accepts. Whoever loves danger will perish by it. A stubborn mind will be burdened by troubles, and the sinner will heap sin upon sin. The affliction of the proud has no healing, for a plant of wickedness has taken root in him. The mind of the intelligent man will ponder a parable, and an attentive ear is the wise man's desire. Water extinguishes a blazing fire: so almsgiving atones for sin.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Tell you this and confirm it. Do not imagine that after cutting the wheat from the chaff that the sinners will have relief. I say to you that according to the testimony of the Books. As for the angels and archangels they will remain silent. So also will the saints be. And the judgment for God will be decisive and final in the day where they pick out the evil doers from among the righteous; the time when the sinners are thrown in to the hearth of burning fire. Does God need a counselor or a companion to advise him like us? What can God forget that someone else may remember? Or can ask God about anything else other than these words. That it may be said in one voice: "Your rules are just O Lord who rewards everyone according to his deeds." It is not us who would remind God of these things. It is rather He, the Father of all mercies, who remembers.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

***The Doxology of the First Hour: of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May
its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 51:4 & 33:10

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

That You may be found just when You speak, and blameless when You judge.

The Lord brings the counsel of the nations to nothing; He makes the plans of the peoples of no effect. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 11: 46- 57

But some of them went away to the Pharisees and told them the things Jesus did. Then the chief priests and the Pharisees gathered a council and said, "What shall we do? For this Man works many signs. If we let Him alone like this, everyone will believe in Him, and the Romans will come and take away both our place and nation." And one of them, Caiaphas, being high priest that year, said to them, "You know nothing at all, nor

do you consider that it is expedient for us that one man should die for the people, and not that the whole nation should perish." Now this he did not say on his own authority; but being high priest that year he prophesied that Jesus would die for the nation, and not for that nation only, but also that He would gather together in one the children of God who were scattered abroad.

Then, from that day on, they plotted to put Him to death. Therefore Jesus no longer walked openly among the Jews, but went from there into the country near the wilderness, to a city called Ephraim, and there remained with His disciples.

And the Passover of the Jews was near, and many went from the country up to Jerusalem before the Passover, to purify themselves. Then they sought Jesus, and spoke among themselves as they stood in the temple, "What do you think-- that He will not come to the feast?" Now both the chief priests and the Pharisees had given a command, that if anyone knew where He was, he should report it, that they might seize Him.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

**The Exposition of the First Hour of Wednesday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

As the Pharisees gathered together and said one to one another, “What can we do? This man is doing many miracles and supernatural things. If we leave him alone all the people will believe in him; then the Romans will replace us. One of them, who is Caiaphas, the chief priest of the Jews said: “It is expedient for you that one man should die for the people and that the whole nation should not perish.”

And from then on they conspired to kill Jesus. Jesus went into the wilderness and stayed there with his disciples. And it was about the time of the feast of the Jews, the Jews who sought to kill Him.

Verily it was a fulfillment of the prophesy of Isaiah: “Wail on a nation full of evil.” A brood of evil doers. Children who are corrupt. For the ox knows its owner, and the donkey its master, but Israel does not know that I am his creator. Therefore, they shall be with their children in Hell their home forever.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 13: 17- 22

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Then it came to pass, when Pharaoh had let the people go, that God did not lead them by way of the land of the Philistines, although that was near; for God said, "Lest perhaps the people change their minds when they see war, and return to Egypt." So God led the people around by way of the wilderness of the Red Sea. And the children of Israel went up in orderly ranks out of the land of Egypt. And Moses took the bones of Joseph with him, for he had placed the children of Israel under solemn oath, saying, "God will surely visit you, and you shall carry up my bones from here with you."

So they took their journey from Succoth and camped in Etham at the edge of the wilderness. And the Lord went before them by day in a pillar of cloud to lead the way, and by night in a pillar of fire to give them light,

so as to go by day and night. He did not take away the pillar of cloud by day or the pillar of fire by night from before the people.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 22: 7- 18

A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Whoever teaches a fool is like one who glues potsherds together, or who rouses a sleeper from deep slumber. Whoever tells a story to a fool tells it to a drowsy man; and at the end he will say, "What is it?" Weep for the dead, for he has left the light behind; and weep for the fool, for he has left intelligence behind. Weep less bitterly for the dead, for he is at rest; but the life of the fool is worse than death. Mourning for the dead lasts seven days, but for the foolish or the ungodly it lasts all the days of their lives. Do not talk much with a senseless person or visit an unintelligent person. Stay clear of him, or you may have trouble, and be spattered when he shakes himself off. Avoid him and you will find rest, and you will never be wearied by his lack of sense. What is heavier than lead? And what is its name except "Fool"? Sand, salt, and a piece of iron are easier to bear

than a stupid person. A wooden beam firmly bonded into a building is not loosened by an earthquake; so the mind firmly resolved after due reflection will not be afraid in a crisis. A mind settled on an intelligent thought is like stucco decoration that makes a wall smooth. Fences set on a high place will not stand firm against the wind; so a timid mind with a fool's resolve will not stand firm against any fear.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Job 27: 16 – 28: 2

A reading from the book of Job the Righteous may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Even if he should gather silver as dust, and prepare gold as clay, all these things shall the righteous gain, and the true-hearted shall possess His wealth. And his house is gone like moths, and like a spider's web. The rich man shall lie down, and shall not continue: he has opened his eyes, and he is no more. Pains have come upon him as water, and darkness has carried him away by night. For there is a place for the silver, where it comes, and a place for the gold, where it is refined.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 4:4-27, 5:1-4

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon may his blessings be with us, Amen.

My son, Let our speech be fixed in your heart, keep our commandments, forget them not: and do not neglect the speech of my mouth. And forsake it not, and it shall cleave to you: love it, and it shall keep you. Secure it, and it shall exalt you: honor it, that it may embrace you; that it may give unto your head a crown of grace, and may cover you with a crown of delight. Hear, my son, and receive my words, and the years of your life shall be increased, that the resources of your life may be many. For I teach you the ways of wisdom; and I cause you to go in right paths. For when you go, your steps shall not be hindered; and when you run, you shall not be distressed. Take hold of my instruction; do not let it go, but keep it for yourself, for your life. Go not in the ways of the ungodly, neither covet the ways of transgressors. In whatever place they shall pitch their camp, do not go there; but turn from them, and pass away. For they cannot sleep, unless they have done evil: their sleep is taken away, and they rest not. For these live upon the bread of ungodliness, and are drunken with the wine of transgression. But the ways of the righteous shine like light; they go on and shine, until the day has fully come. But the ways of the ungodly are like darkness; they know not how they stumble.

My son, attend to my speech, and incline your ear to my words, that your fountains may not fail you; keep them in your heart. For they are life to

those that find them, and health to all their flesh. Keep your heart with the utmost care, for out of these are the issues of life. Remove from you a deceitful mouth, and put far away from you unjust lips. Let your eyes look right on, and let your eyelids assent to just things. Make straight paths for your feet, and order your ways rightly. Turn not aside to the right hand, nor to the left, but turn away your foot from an evil way: A for God knows the ways on the right hand, but those on the left are crooked: B and He will make your ways straight, and will guide your steps in peace.

My son, attend to my wisdom, and incline your ear to my words; that you may keep good understanding, and the discretion of my lips gives you a charge. Give no heed to a worthless woman, for honey drops from the lips of a harlot, who for a season pleases your palate; but afterwards you will find her more bitter than gall, and sharper than a two-edged sword.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour: of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 41: 6 & 1

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

And if he comes to see me, he speaks lies; his heart gathers iniquity to itself; when he goes out, he tells it.

Blessed is he who considers the poor; the Lord will deliver him in time of trouble. **Alleluia**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 22: 1- 6

Now the Feast of Unleavened Bread drew near, which is called Passover. And the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might kill Him, for they feared the people.

Then Satan entered Judas, surnamed Iscariot, who was numbered among the twelve. So he went his way and conferred with the chief priests and captains, how he might betray Him to them. And they were glad, and agreed to give him money. So he promised and sought opportunity to betray Him to them in the absence of the multitude.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

**The Exposition of the Third Hour of Wednesday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

When the feast of the unleavened bread, which is the Passover of the Jews was near, the scribes and the chief priests sought a way to kill Jesus. However, they did not know what to do because they feared the public.

But Satan found himself a place in the heart of his companion, Judas Iscariot, who was counted among the disciples but was Satan as the Lord described him. He went to the chief priests and the Sadducees to make a deal to deliver Jesus to them.

The evil natured disciple discussed with his evil friends how to deliver to them the Savior of the World. They were more than pleased and paid him silver so that he may deliver Him to them in absence of the people.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 14:13-15:1

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet, may his blessings be with us, Amen.

And Moses said to the people, "Do not be afraid. Stand still, and see the salvation of the Lord, which He will accomplish for you today. For the Egyptians whom you see today, you shall see again no more forever. The Lord will fight for you, and you shall hold your peace."

And the Lord said to Moses, "Why do you cry to Me? Tell the children of Israel to go forward. But lift up your rod, and stretch out your hand over the sea and divide it. And the children of Israel shall go on dry ground through the midst of the sea. And I indeed will harden the hearts of the Egyptians, and they shall follow them. So I will gain honor over Pharaoh and over all his army, his chariots, and his horsemen. Then the Egyptians shall know that I am the Lord, when I have gained honor for Myself over

Pharaoh, his chariots, and his horsemen." And the Angel of God, who went before the camp of Israel, moved and went behind them; and the pillar of cloud went from before them and stood behind them. So it came between the camp of the Egyptians and the camp of Israel. Thus it was a cloud and darkness to the one, and it gave light by night to the other, so that the one did not come near the other all that night.

Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and the Lord caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all that night, and made the sea into dry land, and the waters were divided. So the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea on the dry ground, and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left. And the Egyptians pursued and went after them into the midst of the sea, all Pharaoh's horses, his chariots, and his horsemen. Now it came to pass, in the morning watch, that the Lord looked down upon the army of the Egyptians through the pillar of fire and cloud, and He troubled the army of the Egyptians. And He took off their chariot wheels, so that they drove them with difficulty; and the Egyptians said, "Let us flee from the face of Israel, for the Lord fights for them against the Egyptians."

Then the Lord said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the sea, that the waters may come back upon the Egyptians, on their chariots, and on their horsemen." And Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and when the morning appeared, the sea returned to its full depth, while the Egyptians

were fleeing into it. So the Lord overthrew the Egyptians in the midst of the sea. Then the waters returned and covered the chariots, the horsemen, and all the army of Pharaoh that came into the sea after them. Not so much as one of them remained. But the children of Israel had walked on dry land in the midst of the sea, and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left.

So the Lord saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians, and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the seashore. Thus Israel saw the great work which the Lord had done in Egypt; so the people feared the Lord, and believed the Lord and His servant Moses.

Then Moses and the children of Israel sang this song to the Lord, and spoke, saying: "I will sing to the Lord, For He has triumphed gloriously!

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 48:1-6

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Hear these words, you house of Jacob, who are called by the name of Israel, and have come forth out of Judah, who swear by the name of the Lord God of Israel, making mention of it, but not with truth, nor with righteousness; maintaining also the name of the holy city, and staying themselves on the God of Israel; the Lord of hosts is His name. The former things I have already declared; and they that have proceeded out of My mouth, and it became well known; I wrought suddenly, and the events came to pass. I know that you are stubborn, and your neck is an iron sinew, and your forehead bronze. And I told you of old what would be before it came upon you; I made it known to you, lest you should say, My idols have done it for me; and should say, My graven and molten images have commanded me. You have heard all this, but you have not known; yet I have made known to you the new things from henceforth.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 23: 7- 14

A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Listen, my children, to instruction concerning the mouth; the one who observes it will never be caught. Sinners are overtaken through their lips; by them the reviler and the arrogant are tripped up. Do not accustom your mouth to oaths, nor habitually utter the name of the Holy One; for as a servant who is constantly under scrutiny will not lack bruises, so also the person who always swears and utters the Name will never be cleansed from sin. The one who swears many oaths is full of iniquity, and the scourge will not leave his house. If he swears in error, his sin remains on him, and if he disregards it, he sins doubly; if he swears a false oath, he will not be justified, for his house will be filled with calamities. There is a manner of speaking comparable to death; may it never be found in the inheritance of Jacob! Such conduct will be far from the godly, and they will not wallow in sins. Do not accustom your mouth to coarse, foul language, for it involves sinful speech. Remember your father and mother when you sit among the great, or you may forget yourself in their presence, and behave like a fool through bad habit; then you will wish that you had never been born, and you will curse the day of your birth.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

***The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May
its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 83: 2 & 5

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

For behold, Your enemies make a tumult; And those who hate You
have lifted up their head.

For they have consulted together with one consent; They form a confederacy
against You. **Alleluia.**

**May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to
hear Your Holy Gospel.**

**A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure
Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.**

John 12:1-8

Then, six days before the Passover, Jesus came to Bethany, where Lazarus was who had been dead, whom He had raised from the dead. There they made Him a supper; and Martha served, but Lazarus was one of those who sat at the table with Him. Then Mary took a pound of very costly oil of spikenard, anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped His feet with her hair. And the house was filled with the fragrance of the oil. Then one of His disciples, Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, who would betray Him, said, "Why was this fragrant oil not sold for three hundred denari and given to the poor?" This he said, not that he cared for the poor, but because he was a thief, and had the money box; and he used to take what was put in it. But Jesus said, "Let her alone; she has kept this for the day of My burial. For the poor you have with you always, but Me you do not have always."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of The Sixth Hour of the Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Christ our Lord came to Bethany six days before Passover. They regaled him at the residence of Mary and Martha her sister. Among those present was Lazarus, whom He resurrected from the dead. Martha his sister was serving them, and Lazarus her brother was sitting with him. Mary then brought one pound of an expensive nard and she anointed his feet and wiped them with her hair.

Judas Iscariot was filled with evil envy and asked cunningly; his heart full of bitterness, deceit and hypocrisy: “Would it not have been better if this oil would have been sold for 300 Denarii and given to the poor?” it was not his love and concern for the poor that prompted him to say this, but because he was a thief, and as he had the money box he used to take what was put in it.

The Savior responded saying: “Do not trouble the woman for she has done that for My burial. The poor you always have with you, but you do not have always Me.” Let us come close to the Lord, run our tears down his feet and ask him for his forgiveness according to his abundant mercy.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Genesis 24: 1- 9

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Now Abraham was old, well advanced in age; and the Lord had blessed Abraham in all things. So Abraham said to the oldest servant of his house, who ruled over all that he had, "Please, put your hand under my thigh, and I will make you swear by the Lord, the God of heaven and the God of the earth, that you will not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I dwell; but you shall go to my country and to my family, and take a wife for my son Isaac." And the servant said to him, "Perhaps the woman will not be willing to follow me to this land. Must I take your son back to the land from which you came?" But Abraham said to him, "Beware that you do not take my son back there. The Lord God of heaven, who took me from my father's house and from the land of my family, and who spoke to me and swore to me, saying, 'To your

descendants I give this land,' He will send His angel before you, and you shall take a wife for my son from there. And if the woman is not willing to follow you, then you will be released from this oath;

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Numbers 20:1-13

A reading from the book of Numbers of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Then the children of Israel, the whole congregation, came into the Wilderness of Zin in the first month, and the people stayed in Kadesh; and Miriam died there and was buried there. Now there was no water for the congregation; so they gathered together against Moses and Aaron. And the people contended with Moses and spoke, saying: "If only we had died when our brethren died before the Lord! Why have you brought up the assembly of the Lord into this wilderness, that we and our animals should die here? And why have you made us come up out of Egypt, to bring us to this evil place? It is not a place of grain or figs or vines or pomegranates; nor is there any water to drink."

So Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly to the door of the tabernacle of meeting, and they fell on their faces. And the glory of the Lord appeared to them. Then the Lord spoke to Moses, saying, "Take the rod; you and your brother Aaron gather the congregation together. Speak to the rock before their eyes, and it will yield its water; thus you shall bring water for them out of the rock, and give drink to the congregation and their animals." So Moses took the rod from before the Lord as He commanded him. And Moses and Aaron gathered the assembly together before the rock; and he said to them, "Hear now, you rebels! Must we bring water for you out of this rock?" Then Moses lifted his hand and struck the rock twice with his rod; and water came out abundantly, and the congregation and their animals drank. Then the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, "Because you did not believe Me, to hallow Me in the eyes of the children of Israel, therefore you shall not bring this assembly into the land which I have given them." This was the water of Meribah, because the children of Israel contended with the Lord, and He was hallowed among them.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 1: 10- 33

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

My son, if sinners entice you, Do not consent. If they say, "Come with us, Let us lie in wait to shed blood; Let us lurk secretly for the innocent without cause; Let us swallow them alive like Sheol, And whole, like those who go down to the Pit; We shall find all kinds of precious possessions, We shall fill our houses with spoil; Cast in your lot among us, Let us all have one purse"-- My son, do not walk in the way with them, Keep your foot from their path; For their feet run to evil, And they make haste to shed blood. Surely, in vain the net is spread In the sight of any bird; But they lie in wait for their own blood, They lurk secretly for their own lives. So are the ways of everyone who is greedy for gain; It takes away the life of its owners.

Wisdom calls aloud outside; She raises her voice in the open squares. She cries out in the chief concourses, At the openings of the gates in the city She speaks her words: "How long, you simple ones, will you love simplicity? For scorners delight in their scorning, And fools hate knowledge. Turn at my rebuke; Surely I will pour out my spirit on you; I will make my words known to you.

Because I have called and you refused, I have stretched out my hand and no one regarded, because you disdained all my counsel, And would have none of my rebuke, I also will laugh at your calamity; I will mock

when your terror comes, When your terror comes like a storm, And your destruction comes like a whirlwind, When distress and anguish come upon you. "Then they will call on me, but I will not answer; They will seek me diligently, but they will not find me. Because they hated knowledge And did not choose the fear of the Lord, They would have none of my counsel And despised my every rebuke. Therefore they shall eat the fruit of their own way, And be filled to the full with their own fancies. For the turning away of the simple will slay them, And the complacency of fools will destroy them; But whoever listens to me will dwell safely, And will be secure, without fear of evil."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 59: 1- 17

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Behold, the Lord's hand is not shortened, That it cannot save; Nor His ear heavy, That it cannot hear. But your iniquities have separated you from your God; And your sins have hidden His face from you, So that He will not hear. For your hands are defiled with blood, And your fingers with iniquity; Your lips have spoken lies, Your tongue has muttered perversity. No one calls for justice, Nor does any plead for truth. They trust in empty words and speak lies; They conceive evil and bring forth iniquity. They hatch vipers' eggs and weave the spider's web; He who eats of their eggs dies, And from that which is crushed a viper breaks out. Their webs will not become garments, Nor will they cover themselves with their works; Their works are works of iniquity, And the act of violence is in their hands. Their feet run to evil, And they make haste to shed innocent blood; Their thoughts are thoughts of iniquity; Wasting and destruction are in their paths. The way of peace they have not known, And there is no justice in their ways; They have made themselves crooked paths; Whoever takes that way shall not know peace.

Therefore justice is far from us, Nor does righteousness overtake us; We look for light, but there is darkness! For brightness, but we walk in blackness! We grope for the wall like the blind, And we grope as if we had no eyes; We stumble at noonday as at twilight; We are as dead men in desolate places. We all growl

like bears, And moan sadly like doves; We look for justice, but there is none; For salvation, but it is far from us. For our transgressions are multiplied before You, And our sins testify against us; For our transgressions are with us, And as for our iniquities, we know them: In transgressing and lying against the Lord, And departing from our God, Speaking oppression and revolt, Conceiving and uttering from the heart words of falsehood. Justice is turned back, And righteousness stands afar off; For truth is fallen in the street, And equity cannot enter. So truth fails, And he who departs from evil makes himself a prey. Then the Lord saw it, and it displeased Him That there was no justice.

He saw that there was no man, And wondered that there was no intercessor; Therefore His own arm brought salvation for Him; And His own righteousness, it sustained Him. For He put on righteousness as a breastplate, And a helmet of salvation on His head.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Zechariah 11:11-14

**A reading from Zechariah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

So it was broken on that day. Thus the poor of the flock, who were watching me, knew that it was the word of the Lord. Then I said to them, "If it is agreeable to you, give me my wages; and if not, refrain." So they weighed out for my wages thirty pieces of silver. And the Lord said to me, "Throw it to the potter"--that princely price they set on me. So I took the thirty pieces of silver and threw them into the house of the Lord for the potter. Then I cut in two my other staff, Bonds, that I might break the brotherhood between Judah and Israel.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

I will tell you two things. Those who repented on earth and had the heaven rejoice for their repentance, will have everlasting joy in heaven. But those who did not repent on earth will neither have joy nor rest in that place. Till when will you be lazy?

I implore you, have tears while you still can and especially if you have works that are deserve tearing for. The saints are praying for you and your salvation.

Blessed is he who is full of tears for himself here for he will be saved from the crying and gnashing of teeth and instead will have heavenly joy.

My brethren, let us awake before the door of repentance is closed and then we ask and hear "I do not know you" and worst things if we keep our sinful path.

We conclude the homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

***The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of Wednesday of Holy Pascha. May
its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy
Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 41: 5- 7

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

My enemies have spoken evil against me, against me they devised my hurt.

And if he came to see me, his heart spoke vainly; he gathered iniquity to himself. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 26:3-16

Then the chief priests, the scribes, and the elders of the people assembled at the palace of the high priest, who was called Caiaphas, and plotted to take Jesus by trickery and kill Him. But they said, "Not during the feast, lest there be an uproar among the people."

And when Jesus was in Bethany at the house of Simon the leper, a woman came to Him having an alabaster flask of very costly fragrant oil, and she poured it on His head as He sat at the table. But when His disciples saw it, they were indignant, saying, "Why this waste? For this fragrant oil might have been sold for much and given to the poor." But when Jesus was aware of it, He said to them, "Why do you trouble the woman? For she has done a good work for Me. For you have the poor with you always, but Me you do not have always. For in pouring this fragrant oil on My body, she did it for My burial. Assuredly, I say to you, wherever this gospel is preached in the whole world, what this woman has done will also be told as a memorial to her."

Then one of the twelve, called Judas Iscariot, went to the chief priests and said, "What are you willing to give me if I deliver Him to you?" And they counted out to him thirty pieces of silver. So from that time he sought opportunity to betray Him.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

The mystery of your incarnation you have concealed in our body, O Christ our God. For Abraham the great patriarch the father of all nations fathomed in great faith that God the Word shall be incarnated from his seed. When he saw that his days on earth were decreasing and that God had blessed him, he summoned his honest and loyal head servant and said to him:

“Put your hand under my thigh because I will ask you to swear by the Lord of heavens that you will not betroth for my son Isaac a wife from this land on which I dwell. But go to the land of my fathers and take for him a wife from there, from my tribe and from my father’s race. Take this matter very seriously.”

The servant asked prudently, Master what if the woman refused to come with me to this land? Would you rather see me come back with your son Isaac and serve him until I can bring her back?

Abraham said, “be careful not to do that, if she does not come with you then you are innocent.” The servant put his hand (under his master’s thigh) and swore to him to keep his promise.

At the fullness of time, God fulfilled this covenant that He pledged to our father Abraham, and Christ by whom all nations are blessed came from his descendants.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF WEDNESDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Isaiah 28:16- 29

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Therefore thus says the Lord God: "Behold, I lay in Zion a stone for a foundation, A tried stone, a precious cornerstone, a sure foundation; Whoever believes will not act hastily. Also I will make justice the measuring line, And righteousness the plummet; The hail will sweep away the refuge of lies, And the waters will overflow the hiding place. Your covenant with death will be annulled, And your agreement with Sheol will not stand; When the overflowing scourge passes through, Then you will be trampled down by it. As often as it goes out it will take you; For morning by morning it will pass over, And by day and by night; It will be a terror just to understand the report." For the bed is too short to stretch out on, And the covering so narrow that one cannot wrap himself in it. For the Lord will

rise up as at Mount Perazim, He will be angry as in the Valley of Gibeon-- That He may do His work, His awesome work, And bring to pass His act, His unusual act. Now therefore, do not be mockers, Lest your bonds be made strong; For I have heard from the Lord God of hosts, A destruction determined even upon the whole earth.

Give ear and hear my voice, Listen and hear my speech. Does the plowman keep plowing all day to sow? Does he keep turning his soil and breaking the clods? When he has leveled its surface, Does he not sow the black cummin And scatter the cummin, Plant the wheat in rows, The barley in the appointed place, And the spelt in its place? For He instructs him in right judgment, His God teaches him. For the black cummin is not threshed with a threshing sledge, Nor is a cartwheel rolled over the cummin; But the black cummin is beaten out with a stick, And the cummin with a rod. Bread flour must be ground; Therefore he does not thresh it forever, Break it with his cartwheel, Or crush it with his horsemen. This also comes from the Lord of hosts, Who is wonderful in counsel and excellent in guidance.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Severus, may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Brethren, I remind you the admonishment concerning the sinner, and those who reject the law and the commandments of life. Because our Lord warned them saying: Stay away from me and into eternal fire. What comfort do they expect?

There is the valley of tears; the tears that can bring no comfort. Who can intercede for the sinners in that day when all the angels; Cherubim, and Seraphim keep quiet and neither the righteous nor the saints can mediate for mankind? The whole creation will be silent and the whole world will be under the Divine judgment.

This is the time of harvest. This is the time to pull the net ashore to sort the good fish from the bad ones. This is the day when the sinners will be told 'Go dwell in Hell forever'.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Severus, who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of Wednesday of Holy Pascha.

May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 6: 2, 3 & 69:17

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Have mercy on me, O Lord, for my bones are troubled. My soul also is greatly troubled.

And do not hide Your face from Your servant, For I am in trouble; Hear me speedily. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 12: 27- 36

Now My soul is troubled, and what shall I say? 'Father, save Me from this hour'? But for this purpose I came to this hour. Father, glorify Your name." Then a voice came from heaven, saying, "I have both glorified it and will glorify it again."

Therefore the people who stood by and heard it said that it had thundered. Others said, "An angel has spoken to Him." Jesus answered and said, "This voice did not come because of Me, but for your sake.

Now is the judgment of this world; now the ruler of this world will be cast out. And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all peoples to Myself." This He said, signifying by what death He would die.

The people answered Him, "We have heard from the law that the Christ remains forever; and how can You say, 'The Son of Man must be lifted up'? Who is this Son of Man?" Then Jesus said to them, "A little while longer the light is with you. Walk while you have the light, lest darkness overtake you; he who walks in darkness does not know where he is going. While you have the light, believe in the light, that you may become sons of light." These things Jesus spoke, and departed, and was hidden from them.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the Eleventh Hour of Wednesday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Let us contemplate the plans of God the Word who has the power over death and the life to every one of us is from Him. However, because he was incarnated in our human form, he agonized over what had to be done and showed troubles and weakness.

The Savior said: "Now is my soul troubled, and what shall I say? 'Father, save me from this hour'? No, for this purpose I came to this hour." Yes truly, He came to the world so that He may suffer for our salvation. To lift from Hades the first man that He created and to return the first man to his original home he and his descendants, according to His great mercy.

Let us plead with Him earnestly and ask of Him persistently to partake in the glory of His kingdom and to enforce our faith in His Holy Name till the last breath.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



THE HOLY PASCHA OF GREAT THURSDAY EVE

FIRST HOUR OF EVE OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 25

Ezekiel 43: 5- 11

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

The Spirit lifted me up and brought me into the inner court; and behold, the glory of the Lord filled the temple. Then I heard Him speaking to me from the temple, while a man stood beside me.

And He said to me, "Son of man, this is the place of My throne and the place of the soles of My feet, where I will dwell in the midst of the children of Israel forever. No more shall the house of Israel defile My holy name, they nor their kings, by their harlotry or with the carcasses of their kings on their high places. When they set their threshold by My threshold, and their doorpost by My doorpost, with a wall between them and Me, they defiled My holy name by

the abominations which they committed; therefore I have consumed them in My anger. Now let them put their harlotry and the carcasses of their kings far away from Me, and I will dwell in their midst forever.”

Son of man, describe the temple to the house of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their iniquities; and let them measure the pattern. And if they are ashamed of all that they have done, make known to them the design of the temple and its arrangement, its exits and its entrances, its entire design and all its ordinances, all its forms and all its laws. Write it down in their sight, so that they may keep its whole design and all its ordinances, and perform them.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour: of the Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Psalm 69: 1 & 16

Save me, O God! For the waters have come up to my neck. Turn to me according to the multitude of Your tender mercies. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 10: 17- 21

Therefore My Father loves Me, because I lay down My life that I may take it again. No one takes it from Me, but I lay it down of Myself. I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again. This command I have received from My Father.”

Therefore there was a division again among the Jews because of these sayings. And many of them said, “He has a demon and is mad. Why do you listen to Him?” Others said, “These are not the words of one who has a demon. Can a demon open the eyes of the blind?”

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The First Hour of Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Christ our Lord, Master and King reveals His divinity and dominion. The God who prevails over all hegemony and power in heaven and on earth. That is why He tells us: “My Father loves Me and I humble Myself to earn it. No one can force the cross on Me, but only through My own will that I humble Myself, and that I have the power to take it away.”

There developed a schism among the Jews, because of these words that He told them. The hypocrites among them said, “He is crazy, do not listen to Him?” Others said, “These are not the words of a possessed man. Crazy people cannot open the eyes of someone born blind.

Truly He is the light for the faithful hearts except for the contrary Jews, whom he blinded the vision of their hearts and their eyes so that they may not see with their eyes and that they may not understand with their hearts and return to Him with true love, great hope, and total honesty that He may forgive their sins so as to save them of their transgressions.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF EVE OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Amos 4: 4- 13

A reading from Amos the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.

[This is what the Lord God says,]

Come to Bethel and transgress, At Gilgal multiply transgression; Bring your sacrifices every morning, Your tithes every three days. Offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving with leaven, Proclaim and announce the freewill offerings; For this you love, You children of Israel!" Says the Lord God."

Also I gave you cleanness of teeth in all your cities. And lack of bread in all your places; Yet you have not returned to Me," Says the Lord." I also withheld rain from you, When there were still three months to the harvest. I made it rain on one city, I withheld rain from another city. One part was rained upon, And where it did not rain the part withered. So two or three

cities wandered to another city to drink water, But they were not satisfied; Yet you have not returned to Me," Says the Lord." I blasted you with blight and mildew. When your gardens increased, Your vineyards, Your fig trees, And your olive trees, The locust devoured them; Yet you have not returned to Me," Says the Lord." I sent among you a plague after the manner of Egypt; Your young men I killed with a sword, Along with your captive horses; I made the stench of your camps come up into your nostrils; Yet you have not returned to Me," Says the Lord." I overthrew some of you, As God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, And you were like a firebrand plucked from the burning; Yet you have not returned to Me," Says the Lord."

Therefore thus will I do to you, O Israel; Because I will do this to you, Prepare to meet your God, O Israel!" For behold, He who forms mountains, And creates the wind, Who declares to man what his thought is, And makes the morning darkness, Who treads the high places of the earth- The Lord God of hosts is His name.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour: of the Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 55: 21 & 1

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

His words were softer than oil, Yet they were drawn swords. Give ear to my prayer, O God, And do not hide Yourself from my supplication. Alleluia.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 14: 3- 11

And being in Bethany at the house of Simon the leper, as He sat at the table, a woman came having an alabaster flask of very costly oil of spikenard. Then she broke the flask and poured it on His head. But there were some who were indignant among themselves, and said, "Why was this fragrant oil wasted? For it might have been sold for more than three hundred denarii and given to the poor." And they criticized her sharply. But Jesus said, "Let her alone. Why do you trouble her? She has done a good work for

Me. For you have the poor with you always, and whenever you wish you may do them good; but Me you do not have always. She has done what she could. She has come beforehand to anoint My body for burial. Assuredly, I say to you, wherever this gospel is preached in the whole world, what this woman has done will also be told as a memorial to her."

Then Judas Iscariot, one of the twelve, went to the chief priests to betray Him to them. And when they heard it, they were glad, and promised to give him money. So he sought how he might conveniently betray Him.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Third Hour of the eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

The woman poured the precious spikenard over the Lord’s feet and wiped them with her hair because of her loyalty and great love. Thus she earned for herself good dividends and her name filled the earth. The diciples spread the word about her deed in all corners of the earth. Her name is honored in all generations, and mentioned by all the faithful.

Behold these spiritual gifts and the high esteem she gained. Let us be filled with zeal over her virtues and love of the Lord with all our hearts. Not like Judas who became infuriated by her good deed. This cost him his evil thoughts that led him to betray his Master.

And the silver he received as a price of the precious blood of Jesus Christ will perish with him in hell. His name disappeared in a single generation and he was denied descendants on earth.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF EVE OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Amos 3:1- 11

**A reading from Amos the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Hear this word that the Lord has spoken against you, O children of Israel, against the whole family which I brought up from the land of Egypt, saying: "You only have I known of all the families of the earth; Therefore I will punish you for all your iniquities."

Can two walk together, unless they are agreed? Will a lion roar in the forest, when he has no prey? Will a young lion cry out of his den, if he has caught nothing? Will a bird fall into a snare on the earth, where there is no trap for it? Will a snare spring up from the earth, if it has caught nothing at all? If a trumpet is blown in a city, will not the people be afraid? If there is calamity in a city, will not the Lord have done it? Surely the Lord God

does nothing, Unless He reveals His secret to His servants the prophets. A lion has roared! Who will not fear? The Lord God has spoken! Who can but prophesy?

"Proclaim in the palaces at Ashdod, And in the palaces in the land of Egypt, and say: 'Assemble on the mountains of Samaria; See great tumults in her midst, And the oppressed within her. For they do not know to do right,' Says the Lord, 'Who store up violence and robbery in their palaces.' "Therefore thus says the Lord God: "An adversary shall be all around the land; He shall sap your strength from you, And your palaces shall be plundered."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of the Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 140:1,2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Deliver me, O Lord, from evil men; Preserve me from violent men,
who plan evil things in their hearts; They continually gather together
for war. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 12:36-43

These things Jesus spoke, and departed, and was hidden from them. But although He had done so many signs before them, they did not believe in Him, that the word of Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spoke: "Lord, who has believed our report? And to whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed?" Therefore they could not believe, because Isaiah said again: "He has blinded their eyes and hardened their hearts, Lest they should see with their eyes, Lest they should understand with their hearts and turn, So that I should heal them." These things Isaiah said when he saw His glory and spoke of Him.

Nevertheless even among the rulers many believed in Him, but because of the Pharisees they did not confess Him, lest they should be put out of the synagogue; for they loved the praise of men more than the praise of God.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Sixth Hour of Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Isaiah the prophet by the Spirit chastizes the sons of Israel, for their foolishness and rebukes them outright because of the vileness of their deeds and their sins. They rejected the miracles that Immanuel made, rejected His words full of grace and leaned towards myths and vagaries and rejected the glory of His divinity.

O great prophet (Isaiah), chastise these disobedient children and fruitless trees for they have emulated their fathers and followed on their heels: O Lord who believes our words?

And Your arm, O Lord, to whom has it been announced? The voice of the Lord is His Only Begotten Son who appeared in the flesh to the sons of Israel. He showed in them His mercy and His justice and nevertheless they did not obey Him and did not believe in Him. How could they believe; Isaiah prophesized about them and said: "I blind their eyes, harden their hearts, deafen their ears and their understanding altogether."

Listen O Israel, no one else will save you from God’s wrath but Jesus the Savior of the world He who made the two into one by His Incarnation. The Light has come to His own and His own loved the darkness and the Gentiles accepted His commandments and became His nation everywhere. They experience His mercy and His immeasurable grace that He bestowed on them.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF EVE OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Ezekiel 20:27-33

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Therefore, son of man, speak to the house of Israel, and say to them, 'Thus says the Lord God: "In this too your fathers have blasphemed Me, by being unfaithful to Me. When I brought them into the land concerning which I had raised My hand in an oath to give them, and they saw all the high hills and all the thick trees, there they offered their sacrifices and provoked Me with their offerings. There they also sent up their sweet aroma and poured out their drink offerings. Then I said to them, 'What is this high place to which you go?' So its name is called Bamah to this day."

'Therefore say to the house of Israel, 'Thus says the Lord God: "Are you defiling yourselves in the manner of your fathers, and committing harlotry

according to their abominations? For when you offer your gifts and make your sons pass through the fire, you defile yourselves with all your idols, even to this day. So shall I be inquired of by you, O house of Israel?

As I live," says the Lord God, "I will not be inquired of by you. What you have in your mind shall never be, when you say, 'We will be like the Gentiles, like the families in other countries, serving wood and stone.'"

"As I live," says the Lord God, "surely with a mighty hand, with an outstretched arm, and with fury poured out, I will rule over you."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of the Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted *the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel* on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Psalm 7: 1- 2

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

 Lord my God, in You I put my trust; Save me from all those who persecute me; And deliver me, Lest they tear me like a lion. **Alleluia**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 10:29-38

"My Father, who has given them to Me, is greater than all, and no one is able to snatch them out of My Father's hand. I and My Father are one."

Then the Jews took up stones again to stone Him. Jesus answered them, "Many good works I have shown you from My Father. For which of those works do you stone Me?" The Jews answered Him, saying, "For a good work we do not stone You, but for blasphemy, and because You, being a Man, make Yourself God." Jesus answered them, "Is it not written in your law, 'I said, "You are gods" '? If He called them gods, to whom the word of God came (and the Scripture cannot be broken), do you say of Him whom the Father sanctified and sent into the world, 'You are blaspheming,' because I said, 'I am the Son of God'? If I do not do the works of My Father, do not believe Me; but if I do, though you do not believe Me, believe the works, that you may know and believe that the Father is in Me, and I in Him."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

O you foolish obstinate, corrupt and contrary people, listen to the Merciful with His Divine mouth praise the faithful saying; “What the Father has given Me is more precious than all the things on earth, and no one can take them away from My Father’s hand. I and the Father are one with the Holy Spirit without separation.”

When the Jews in their envy picked the rocks to stone Him, He responded to them in modesty saying: I did among you good deeds from My Father. What do you stone Me for, when I seek your salvation? Know and be certain you foolish Jews that I am in My Father and My Father is in Me.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (Πορρο)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF EVE OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Jeremiah 8:4-9

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Thus says the Lord: "Will they fall and not rise? Will one turn away and not return? Why has this people slidden back, Jerusalem, in a perpetual backsliding? They hold fast to deceit, They refuse to return. I listened and heard, But they do not speak aright. No man repented of his wickedness, Saying, 'What have I done?' Everyone turned to his own course, As the horse rushes into the battle." Even the stork in the heavens Knows her appointed times; And the turtledove, the swift, and the swallow observe the time of their coming. But My people do not know the judgment of the Lord." How can you say, 'We are wise, And the law of the Lord is with us'? Look, the false pen of the scribe certainly works falsehood. The wise men are ashamed, They are dismayed and taken. Behold, they have rejected the word of the Lord; So what wisdom do they have?

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour: of the Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 62: 7 & 6

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

In God is my salvation and my glory; and my refuge, is in God. He is my defense; I shall not be greatly moved. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 12: 44- 50

Then Jesus cried out and said, "He who believes in Me, believes not in Me but in Him who sent Me. And he who sees Me sees Him who sent Me. I have come as a light into the world, that whoever believes in Me should not abide in darkness. And if anyone hears My words and does not believe, I do not judge him; for I did not come to judge the world but to save the world. He who rejects Me, and does not receive My words, has that which judges him--the word that I have spoken will judge him in the last

day. For I have not spoken on My own authority; but the Father who sent Me gave Me a command, what I should say and what I should speak. And I know that His command is everlasting life. Therefore, whatever I speak, just as the Father has told Me, so I speak.”

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Eleventh Hour of the Eve of Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Our Savior the Son of the living God said, “I am the Light of the world. He who believes in Me and accepts My words will not be in the darkness. He who denies Me and does not want to listen to My words or to obey them, I will not judge Him, but the words I said will. Because what I have say is from the Father who sent Me. He gave Me the commandment of what to say and what to tell.”

We believe that You are the omnipotent Word of God the benevolent Father, (and that You have power over all, and nothing is impossible with You).

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

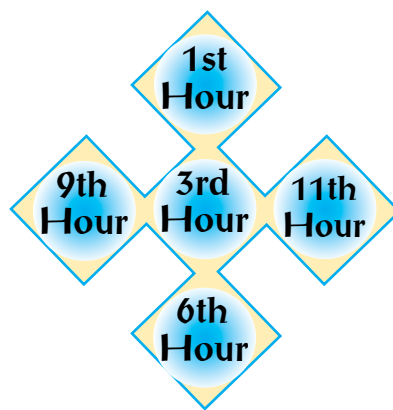
See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

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THE SHORT BLESSING

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THE HOLY PASCHA OF GREAT THURSDAY DAY

FIRST HOUR OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 17: 8- 16

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Now Amalek came and fought with Israel in Rephidim. And Moses said to Joshua, "Choose us some men and go out, fight with Amalek. Tomorrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the rod of God in my hand." So Joshua did as Moses said to him, and fought with Amalek. And Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill. And so it was, when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed; and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed. But Moses' hands became heavy; so they took a stone and put it under him, and he sat on it. And Aaron and Hur supported his hands, one on one side, and the other on the other side; and his hands were steady until the going down of the sun. So Joshua defeated Amalek and his people with the edge of the sword.

Then the Lord said to Moses, "Write this for a memorial in the book and recount it in the hearing of Joshua, that I will utterly blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven." And Moses built an altar and called its name, The-Lord-Is-My-Banner; for he said, "Because the Lord has sworn: the Lord will have war with Amalek from generation to generation."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Exodus 15:23-16:3

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

So Moses brought up the children of Israel from the Red Sea, and brought them into the wilderness of Shur; and they went three days in the wilderness, and found no water to drink. And they came to Marah, and they could not drink the water of Marah, for it was bitter; therefore he named the name of that place, Bitterness. And the people murmured against Moses, saying, What shall we drink? And Moses cried to the Lord, and the Lord showed him a tree, and he cast it into the water, and the water was sweetened. There He established to him ordinances and judgments,

and there He tested him, and said, If you will indeed hear the voice of the Lord your God, and do the things pleasing before Him, and will heed His commands, and keep all His ordinances, no disease which I have brought upon the Egyptians will I bring upon you, for I am the Lord your God that heals you. And they came to Elim, where there were twelve fountains of water and seventy stems of palm trees; and they camped there by the waters.

And they departed from Elim, and all the congregation of the children of Israel came to the Wilderness of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai; and on the fifteenth day, in the second month after their departure from the land of Egypt, all the congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron. And the children of Israel said to them, Would we had died smitten by the Lord in the land of Egypt, when we sat by the fleshpots, and ate bread to the full! For you have brought us out into this wilderness, to slay all this congregation with hunger.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 58:1-11

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Try aloud, spare not; Lift up your voice like a trumpet; Tell My people their transgression, And the house of Jacob their sins. Yet they seek Me daily, And delight to know My ways, As a nation that did righteousness, And did not forsake the ordinance of their God. They ask of Me the ordinances of justice; They take delight in approaching God. 'Why have we fasted,' they say, 'and You have not seen? Why have we afflicted our souls, and You take no notice?' "In fact, in the day of your fast you find pleasure, And exploit all your laborers. Indeed you fast for strife and debate, And to strike with the fist of wickedness. You will not fast as you do this day, To make your voice heard on high. Is it a fast that I have chosen, A day for a man to afflict his soul? Is it to bow down his head like a bulrush, And to spread out sackcloth and ashes? Would you call this a fast, And an acceptable day to the Lord? "Is this not the fast that I have chosen: To loose the bonds of wickedness, To undo the heavy burdens, To let the oppressed go free, And that you break every yoke? Is it not to share your bread with the hungry, And that you bring to your house the poor who are cast out; When you see the naked, that you cover him, And not hide yourself from your own flesh?

Then your light shall break forth like the morning, Your healing shall spring forth speedily, And your righteousness shall go before you; The

glory of the Lord shall be your rear guard. Then you shall call, and the Lord will answer; You shall cry, and He will say, 'Here I am.' "If you take away the yoke from your midst, The pointing of the finger, and speaking wickedness, If you extend your soul to the hungry And satisfy the afflicted soul, Then your light shall dawn in the darkness, And your darkness shall be as the noonday. The Lord will guide you continually, And satisfy your soul in drought.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Ezekiel 18:20-32

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

[The Lord says,] The soul who sins shall die. The son shall not bear the guilt of the father, nor the father bear the guilt of the son. The righteousness of the righteous shall be upon himself, and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon himself. "But if a wicked man turns from all his sins which he has committed, keeps all My statutes, and does what is lawful and right, he shall surely live; he shall not die. None of the transgressions which he has committed shall be remembered against him; because of the righteousness which he has done, he shall live. Do I have any pleasure at all that the wicked should die?" says the Lord God, "and not that he should turn from his ways and live? "But when a righteous man turns

away from his righteousness and commits iniquity, and does according to all the abominations that the wicked man does, shall he live? All the righteousness which he has done shall not be remembered, because of the unfaithfulness of which he is guilty and the sin which he has committed, because of them he shall die.

"Yet you say, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' Hear now, O house of Israel, is it not My way which is fair, and your ways which are not fair? When a righteous man turns away from his righteousness, commits iniquity, and dies in it, it is because of the iniquity which he has done that he dies. Again, when a wicked man turns away from the wickedness which he committed, and does what is lawful and right, he preserves himself alive. Because he considers and turns away from all the transgressions which he committed, he shall surely live; he shall not die. Yet the house of Israel says, 'The way of the Lord is not fair.' O house of Israel, is it not My ways which are fair, and your ways which are not fair? "Therefore I will judge you, O house of Israel, every one according to his ways," says the Lord God. "Repent, and turn from all your transgressions, so that iniquity will not be your ruin. Cast away from you all the transgressions which you have committed, and get yourselves a new heart and a new spirit. For why should you die, O house of Israel? For I have no pleasure in the death of one who dies," says the Lord God. "Therefore turn and live!

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba St. John Chrysostom, may his blessings be with us. Amen.

This is the day when we approach the Holy Communion. Let us all proceed with purity and let each one examine himself before partaking of the body and blood of Christ that he may not condemnation. For it is not man that gives the body and the blood but Christ who was crucified for us and is with us on this table in a mystery. This is he who has the power and the grace says, this is my body. And as the Word that proceeded from his mouth once since the beginning that said, be fruitful, multiply and fill all the earth. As His words were in the beginning and did not pass away so are His words on that table. It is existing in churches on this day and until the second coming completing the work of every oblation.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba St. John Chrysostom who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

***The Doxology of the First Hour: of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha.
May its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29



THE PRAYER OF RAISING OF THE MORNING INCENSE

- ✠ The priest opens the curtain of the sanctuary.
- ✠ The priest says “Our Father...”
- ✠ The Thanksgiving Prayer.
- ✠ Verses of the Cymbals.
- ✠ Psalm 51. (Have mercy upon me.....).
- ✠ Litany of the Sick and then Litany of the Oblations
- ✠ The Gloria (Let us praise with the angels saying...)
- ✠ Holy God, Holy Mighty... who was born, Holy God ... who was crucified... and Holy God ... who was crucified, then Our Father ...
- ✠ The Doxologies
- ✠ The Priest offers incense around the congregation in the nave of the church without putting his hand or the cross on their heads, and that is for the kiss of Judas.
- ✠ Introduction to the Creed
- ✠ The Creed is recited. (till “...was incarnate and became man.” then concluded by “Yes we believe in the Holy Spirit..”
- ✠ Φ† ΝΑΙ ΝΑΝ (O God have mercy on us)
- ✠ ΚΕ. ΚΕ. ΚΕ. (Lord have mercy, 3 times) in the long tune.

Then the congregation is chanting the following in a sorrowful tune:

HYMN OF THE CROSS

This is He who presented himself on the cross; an acceptable sacrifice for the salvation of our race.

His good Father inhaled His sweet aroma in the evening on Golgotha.

Blessed are You truly: with Your Good Father: and the Holy Spirit: for You have come and save us. Have mercy on us.

THE PAULINE EPISTLE^{*}

The Introduction & Conclusion are chanted "In a sorrowful tune"

Ephesus 2: 13- 18

A reading from the Epistle of our teacher Paul to the Ephesians. May his blessing be with us. Amen.

But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off have been brought near by the blood of Christ. 14 For He Himself is our peace, who has made both one, and has broken down the middle wall of separation, 15

^{*} *This Reading does not exist in some Books*

having abolished in His flesh the enmity, that is, the law of commandments contained in ordinances, so as to create in Himself one new man from the two, thus making peace, 16 and that He might reconcile them both to the two, thus making peace, 16 and that He might reconcile them both to God in one body through the cross, thereby putting to death the enmity. 17 And He came and preached peace to you who were afar off and to those who were near. 18 For through Him we both have access by one Spirit to the Father.

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

THE PRAXIS

The Introduction is chanted "In a sorrowful tune"

Acts 1: 15- 20

A reading from the Acts of our fathers the pure apostles, who were invested with the Grace of the Holy Spirit. May their holy blessing be with us all. Amen.

And in those days Peter stood up in the midst of the disciples altogether the number of names was about a hundred and twenty, and said, "Men and brethren, this Scripture had to be fulfilled, which the Holy Spirit

spoke before by the mouth of David concerning Judas, who became a guide to those who arrested Jesus; for he was numbered with us and obtained a part in this ministry.” (Now this man purchased a field with the wages of iniquity; and falling headlong, he burst open in the middle and all his entrails gushed out. And it became known to all those dwelling in Jerusalem; so that field is called in their own language, Akel Dama, that is, Field of Blood.) “For it is written in the book of Psalms: ‘Let his dwelling place be desolate, And let no one live in it’; and ‘Let another take his office.’

The word of the LORD shall grow, shall be multiplied, shall be mighty, and shall be confirmed in the holy Church of God. Amen.

PRAXIS CONCLUSION

The deacons conclude the Praxis by this hymn in a sorrowful tune

Let his dwelling place be desolate (3), And let no one live in it’; and ‘Let another take his office.

The word of the LORD shall grow, shall be multiplied, shall be mighty, and shall be confirmed in the holy Church of God. Amen.

The deacons are chanting the following, while proceeding the church in the opposite direction, starting towards the south

Judas breaker of the law.

Refrain:

Judas [6 times] breaker of the law.

With silver you have sold Christ to the Jews, who have broken the law. But those who have broken the law took Christ. They nailed Him on the Cross in kranion.

Refrain:

Barabas, the thief, and the condemned, was set free and the master, the judge, they crucified. They pierced a spear in Your side; and as a thief they nailed You on the cross. And they laid you in a tomb. O You who raised Lazarus from the tomb.

Refrain:

Because as Jonah stayed three days in the belly of the whale; likewise, our Savior stayed three days. And after he died, they sealed the tomb.

Refrain:

Truly He rose, but the soldiers were not aware; that truly, the Savior of the world has risen, He who suffered and died for our sake O Lord, glory be to You. Amen.

Agios is prayed in the Paschal tune

First: Holy God, Holy Mighty... who was born,

Second & third: Holy God who was crucified...

Then Continued: Glory be to the Father and

*The priest prays the **Litany of the Gospel***

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted *the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel* on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 55: 21 & 12 (*long tune*)

From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.

His words were softened above oil, (Alleluia). And they are arrows.
For if an enemy reviled me, i would have endured it; and if one
hating me boasted against me, i would have hidden from him. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 22: 7- 13

Then came the Day of Unleavened Bread, when the Passover must be killed. And He sent Peter and John, saying, "Go and prepare the Passover for us, that we may eat." So they said to Him, "Where do You want us to prepare?" And He said to them, "Behold, when you have entered the city, a man will meet you carrying a pitcher of water; follow him into the house which he enters. Then you shall say to the master of the house, 'The Teacher says to you, "Where is the guest room where I may eat the Passover with My disciples?"' Then he will show you a large, furnished upper room; there make ready." So they went and found it just as He had said to them, and they prepared the Passover.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the First Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

The disciples said, “The day of Passover is drawing near, O Lord. Tell us where to prepare for You. You are our Passover, O Jesus Christ.”

He sent two of His disciples, Peter and John, and He told them, “Go to this town and You will find a man carrying a jar of water. Follow his footsteps to the place where he goes in. Go see the owner of the house and tell him, “The Lord says, ‘where is the place where I celebrate Passover.’” He will show you an upper room, which is vacant but furnished. Make preparation for Passover there. They did as the Lord said.

Come along all you nations and rejoice, God the Word is our Passover. The first Passover lamb delivered the people from the servitude of Pharaoh. The new Passover is the Son of God who saves the world from corruption. In so many forms he prepared the world from sunrise to sunset for eternal salvation. He lifted us to the heights of His mercy and compassion. He manifested the greatness of His grace that he bestowed on all the creation. He carried our load and granted us His righteousness.

- Exposition 1st Hour
- Exposition 3rd Hour
- Exposition 6th Hour
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Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

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CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 32: 30- 33: 5

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Now it came to pass on the next day that Moses said to the people, "You have committed a great sin. So now I will go up to the Lord; perhaps I can make atonement for your sin." Then Moses returned to the Lord and said, "Oh, these people have committed a great sin, and have made for themselves a god of gold! Yet now, if You will forgive their sin-- but if not, I pray, blot me out of Your book which You have written." And the Lord said to Moses, "Whoever has sinned against Me, I will blot him out of My book. Now therefore, go, lead the people to the place of which I have spoken to you. Behold, My Angel shall go before you. Nevertheless, in the day when I visit for punishment, I will visit punishment upon them for their sin." So the Lord plagued the people because of what they did with the calf which Aaron made.

Then the Lord said to Moses, "Depart and go up from here, you and the people whom you have brought out of the land of Egypt, to the land of which I swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, saying, 'To your descendants I will give it. 'And I will send My Angel before you, and I will drive out the Canaanite and the Amorite and the Hittite and the Perizzite and the Hivite and the Jebusite. Go up to a land flowing with milk and honey; for I will not go up in your midst, lest I consume you on the way, for you are a stiff-necked people." And when the people heard this bad news, they mourned, and no one put on his ornaments. For the Lord had said to Moses, "Say to the children of Israel, 'You are a stiffnecked people. I could come up into your midst in one moment and consume you.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 24: 1- 11

**A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may
his blessings be with us, Amen.**

Wisdom praises herself, and tells of her glory in the midst of her people. In the assembly of the Most High she opens her mouth, and in the presence of his hosts she tells of her glory: "I came forth from the mouth of the Most High, and covered the earth like a mist. I dwelt in the highest heavens, and my throne was in a pillar of cloud. Alone I compassed the vault of heaven and traversed the depths of the abyss. Over waves of the sea, over all the earth, and over every people and nation I have held sway. Among all these I sought a resting place; in whose territory should I abide? "Then the Creator of all things gave me a command, and my Creator chose the place for my tent. He said, "Make your dwelling in Jacob, and in Israel receive your inheritance.' Before the ages, in the beginning, he created me, and for all the ages I shall not cease to be. In the holy tent I ministered before him, and so I was established in Zion. Thus in the beloved city he gave me a resting place, and in Jerusalem was my domain.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Zechariah 9: 11- 14

**A reading from Zechariah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

As for you also, Because of the blood of your covenant, I will set your prisoners free from the waterless pit.

Return to the stronghold, You prisoners of hope. Even today I declare That I will restore double to you.

For I have bent Judah, My bow, Fitted the bow with Ephraim, And raised up your sons, O Zion, Against your sons, O Greece, And made you like the sword of a mighty man.”

Then the Lord will be seen over them, And His arrow will go forth like lightning. The Lord God will blow the trumpet, And go with whirlwinds from the south.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 30: 2- 6

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Surely I am more stupid than any man, And do not have the understanding of a man. I neither learned wisdom Nor have knowledge of the Holy One. Who has ascended into heaven, or descended? Who has gathered the wind in His fists? Who has bound the waters in a garment? Who has established all the ends of the earth? What is His name, and what is His Son's name, If you know? Every word of God is pure; He is a shield to those who put their trust in Him. Do not add to His words, Lest He rebuke you, and you be found a liar.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour: of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha.

May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted *the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel* on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 94: 21 & 23

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

They gather together against the life of the righteous, And condemn innocent blood. He has brought on them their own iniquity, And shall cut them off in their own wickedness; The Lord our God shall cut them off. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 26: 17- 19

Now on the first day of the Feast of the Unleavened Bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying to Him, "Where do You want us to prepare for You to eat the Passover?" And He said, "Go into the city to a certain man, and say to him, 'The Teacher says, "My time is at hand; I will keep the Passover at your house with My disciples.'" So the disciples did as Jesus had directed them; and they prepared the Passover.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the Third Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

And on the next day, Moses addressed the whole group of the sons of Israel: “You have sinned in front of the Lord and made an ox (to worship instead of the Lord). Now I will have to go and mediate for your behalf so that He may grant you His mercy and forgive your sins.”

The prophet went back to God and prostrated himself in front of Him saying: “O merciful and patient Lord, forgive Your people’s sins. If You elect not to forgive them, please wipe my name from the Book of Life.”

The Lord said to him; “Those who sinned are those whom I would remove their names from the Book of Life.” The people knew how severe this is and, they wept in great lamentations.

And the Lord said; “You, My people, are a ruthless, stiff-necked and evildoers. I will surely strike you with severe inflictions and decimate you.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

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9th Hour

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THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Jeremiah 7:2-15

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet, may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Hear the word of the Lord, all you of Judah who enter in at these gates to worship the Lord!’ Thus says the Lord of hosts, the God of Israel: “Amend your ways and your doings, and I will cause you to dwell in this place. Do not trust in these lying words, saying, ‘The temple of the Lord, the temple of the Lord, the temple of the Lord are these.’ For if you thoroughly amend your ways and your doings, if you thoroughly execute judgment between a man and his neighbor, if you do not oppress the stranger, the fatherless, and the widow, and do not shed innocent blood in this place, or walk after other gods to your hurt, then I will cause you to dwell in this place, in the land that I gave to your fathers forever and ever.

“Behold, you trust in lying words that cannot profit. Will you steal, murder,

commit adultery, swear falsely, burn incense to Baal, and walk after other gods whom you do not know, and then come and stand before Me in this house which is called by My name, and say, 'We are delivered to do all these abominations'? Has this house, which is called by My name, become a den of thieves in your eyes? Behold, I, even I, have seen it," says the Lord. "But go now to My place which was in Shiloh, where I set My name at the first, and see what I did to it because of the wickedness of My people Israel. And now, because you have done all these works," says the Lord, "and I spoke to you, rising up early and speaking, but you did not hear, and I called you, but you did not answer, therefore I will do to the house which is called by My name, in which you trust, and to this place which I gave to you and your fathers, as I have done to Shiloh. And I will cast you out of My sight, as I have cast out all your brethren--the whole posterity of Ephraim.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Ezekiel 20:39-44

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

As for you, O house of Israel," thus says the Lord God: "Go, serve every one of you his idols--and hereafter--if you will not obey me; but profane My holy name no more with your gifts and your idols. For on My holy mountain, on the mountain height of Israel," says the Lord God, "there all the house of Israel, all of them in the land, shall serve Me; there I will accept them, and there I will require your offerings and the first fruits of your sacrifices, together with all your holy things. I will accept you as a sweet aroma when I bring you out from the peoples and gather you out of the countries where you have been scattered; and I will be hallowed in you before the Gentiles. Then you shall know that I am the Lord, when I bring you into the land of Israel, into the country for which I raised My hand in an oath to give to your fathers. And there you shall remember your ways and all your doings with which you were defiled; and you shall loathe yourselves in your own sight because of all the evils that you have committed. Then you shall know that I am the Lord, when I have dealt with you for My name's sake, not according to your wicked ways nor according to your corrupt doings, O house of Israel," says the Lord God.' "

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Sirach 23: 7- 14

A reading from the Wisdom of Joshua son of Sirach the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Who pities a snake charmer when he is bitten, or all those who go near wild animals? So no one pities a person who associates with a sinner and becomes involved in the other's sins. He stands by you for a while, but if you falter, he will not be there. An enemy speaks sweetly with his lips, but in his heart he plans to throw you into a pit; an enemy may have tears in his eyes, but if he finds an opportunity he will never have enough of your blood. If evil comes upon you, you will find him there ahead of you; pretending to help, he will trip you up. Then he will shake his head, and clap his hands, and whisper much, and show his true face. Whoever touches pitch gets dirty, and whoever associates with a proud person becomes like him.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

***The Doxology of the Sixth Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha.
May its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 31:18 & 13

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Let the lying lips be put to silence, which speak insolent things proudly and contemptuously against the righteous. For I hear the slander of many; While they take counsel together against me, They scheme to take away my life. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 14:12-16

Now on the first day of Unleavened Bread, when they killed the Passover lamb, His disciples said to Him, "Where do You want us to go and prepare, that You may eat the Passover?" And He sent out two of His disciples and said to them, "Go into the city, and a man will meet you carrying a pitcher of water; follow him. Wherever he goes in, say to the master of the house, 'The Teacher says, "Where is the guest room in which I may eat the Passover with My disciples?" ' Then he will show you a large upper room, furnished and prepared; there make ready for us." So His disciples went out, and came into the city, and found it just as He had said to them; and they prepared the Passover.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

The Exposition of the Sixth Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

O Israel, listen to the voice of Adonai, the Lord Almighty; Let everyone purge himself of his sins and iniquities, for you have maculated My Holy Name with your idols and your perfid deeds.

Then I will accept you on My holy mountain and you shall worship Me in that place. I will be sanctified in you and will raise you above all nations. And you will know that I am the Lord God and that there is no other gods in heaven and earth. The seas and everything that lives therein, worship Me. All under My dominion and seek mercy from Me.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Genesis 22: 1- 19

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Now it came to pass after these things that God tested Abraham, and said to him, "Abraham!" And he said, "Here I am." Then He said, "Take now your son, your only son Isaac, whom you love, and go to the land of Moriah, and offer him there as a burnt offering on one of the mountains of which I shall tell you." So Abraham rose early in the morning and saddled his donkey, and took two of his young men with him, and Isaac his son; and he split the wood for the burnt offering, and arose and went to the place of which God had told him. Then on the third day Abraham lifted his eyes and saw the place afar off. And Abraham said to his young men, "Stay here with the donkey; the lad and I will go yonder and worship, and we will come back to you." So Abraham took the wood of the burnt offering and laid it on Isaac his son; and he took the fire in his hand, and a knife,

and the two of them went together. But Isaac spoke to Abraham his father and said, "My father!" And he said, "Here I am, my son." Then he said, "Look, the fire and the wood, but where is the lamb for a burnt offering?" And Abraham said, "My son, God will provide for Himself the lamb for a burnt offering." So the two of them went together.

Then they came to the place of which God had told him. And Abraham built an altar there and placed the wood in order; and he bound Isaac his son and laid him on the altar, upon the wood. And Abraham stretched out his hand and took the knife to slay his son. But the Angel of the LORD called to him from heaven and said, "Abraham, Abraham!" So he said, "Here I am." And He said, "Do not lay your hand on the lad, or do anything to him; for now I know that you fear God, since you have not withheld your son, your only son, from Me." Then Abraham lifted his eyes and looked, and there behind him was a ram caught in a thicket by its horns. So Abraham went and took the ram, and offered it up for a burnt offering instead of his son. And Abraham called the name of the place, The-LORDWill- Provide; as it is said to this day, "In the Mount of the LORD it shall be provided."

Then the Angel of the LORD called to Abraham a second time out of heaven, and said: "By Myself I have sworn, says the LORD, because you have done this thing, and have not withheld your son, your only son-- blessing I will bless you, and multiplying I will multiply your descendants as the stars of the heaven and as the sand which is on the seashore; and your descendants shall possess the gate of their enemies. In your seed all the nations of the earth shall be blessed, because you have obeyed My voice.

"So Abraham returned to his young men, and they rose and went together to Beersheba; and Abraham dwelt at Beersheba.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 61: 1- 6

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon Me, Because the LORD has anointed Me To preach good tidings to the poor; He has sent Me to heal the brokenhearted, To proclaim liberty to the captives, And the opening of the prison to those who are bound; To proclaim the acceptable year of the LORD, And the day of vengeance of our God; To comfort all who mourn, To console those who mourn in Zion, To give them beauty for ashes, The oil of joy for mourning, The garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness; That they may be called trees of righteousness, The planting of the LORD, that He may be glorified."

And they shall rebuild the old ruins, They shall raise up the former desolations, And they shall repair the ruined cities, The desolations of many generations. Strangers shall stand and feed your flocks, and the sons of the foreigner shall

be your plowmen and your vinedressers. But you shall be named the priests of the LORD, They shall call you the servants of our God. You shall eat the riches of the Gentiles, and in their glory you shall boast.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Genesis 14: 17- 20

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

And the king of Sodom went out to meet him at the Valley of Shaveh (that is, the King's Valley), after his return from the defeat of Chedorlaomer and the kings who were with him. Then Melchizedek king of Salem brought out bread and wine; he was the priest of God Most High. And he blessed him and said: "Blessed be Abram of God Most High, Possessor of heaven and earth;

And blessed be God Most High, Who has delivered your enemies into your hand." And he gave him a tithe of all.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Job 27: 2- 28: 13

A reading from the book of Job the Righteous may his blessings be with us, Amen.

As God lives, who has taken away my justice, And the Almighty, who has made my soul bitter, As long as my breath is in me, And the breath of God in my nostrils, My lips will not speak wickedness, Nor my tongue utter deceit. Far be it from me That I should say you are right; till I die I will not put away my integrity from me. My righteousness I hold fast, and will not let it go; My heart shall not reproach me as long as I live.

"May my enemy be like the wicked, And he who rises up against me like the unrighteous. For what is the hope of the hypocrite, Though he may gain much, If God takes away his life? Will God hear his cry When trouble comes upon him? Will he delight himself in the Almighty? Will he always call on God?

"I will teach you about the hand of God; What is with the Almighty I will not conceal. Surely all of you have seen it; Why then do you behave with complete nonsense? "This is the portion of a wicked man with God, And the heritage of oppressors, received from the Almighty: If his children are multiplied, it is for the sword; And his offspring shall not be satisfied with bread. Those who survive him shall be buried in death, And their widows shall not weep, Though he heaps up silver like dust, And piles up clothing like clay-- He may pile it up, but the just will wear it, And the innocent will divide the silver. He builds his house like a moth, Like

a booth which a watchman makes. The rich man will lie down, But not be gathered up; He opens his eyes, And he is no more. Terrors overtake him like a flood; A tempest steals him away in the night. The east wind carries him away, and he is gone; It sweeps him out of his place. It hurls against him and does not spare; He flees desperately from its power. Men shall clap their hands at him, And shall hiss him out of his place.

"Surely there is a mine for silver, And a place where gold is refined. Iron is taken from the earth, And copper is smelted from ore. Man puts an end to darkness, And searches every recess For ore in the darkness and the shadow of death. He breaks open a shaft away from people; In places forgotten by feet They hang far away from men; They swing to and fro. As for the earth, from it comes bread, But underneath it is turned up as by fire; Its stones are the source of sapphires, And it contains gold dust. That path no bird knows, Nor has the falcon's eye seen it. The proud lions have not trodden it, Nor has the fierce lion passed over it. He puts his hand on the flint; He overturns the mountains at the roots. He cuts out channels in the rocks, And his eye sees every precious thing. He dams up the streams from trickling; What is hidden he brings forth to light.

"But where can wisdom be found? And where is the place of understanding? Man does not know its value, Nor is it found in the land of the living.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

There may be works that we think are right while they are evil in God's sight. That is we do keep evil amongst us, and therefore sinning in the holy places. For God did not plant fruitful and unfruitful trees in the paradise. Those whom He had put in the paradise were driven out when they disobeyed Him.

Dear brethren, from this, know that God's places should not be full of faithful believers and unfaithful ones. The world is full of sinners, the unjust, saints, and the unclean; those that sin, he does not leave but takes away. I know that the entire earth is of the Lord, but if this is His house along with the earth, then those who live in it shall live with Him. For this, we should fear him and keep his commandments.

If once we fall in one of these, let us cry and mourn before Him that when he sees us as the woman who washed his feet with her tears, He may call to us saying, "your sins are forgiven, your faith has healed you, go in peace."

My brethren, you have seen that faith leads to salvation. Those who do not have the desire to keep God's commandment and do not have fervor

in filling their mind with the Spirit; those whom he witnessed before but yet did not know the truth; those with no faith shall fall in every awful deed and shall destroy their souls. As it is written that the wise hear advice but the foolish shall fall on their faces.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

***The Doxology of the Ninth Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha.
May its blessing be with us. Amen.***

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 41: 5- 7

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want. He makes me to lie down in green pastures; He leads me beside the still waters. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 26:3-16

Now on the first day of the Feast of the Unleavened Bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying to Him, "Where do You want us to prepare for You to eat the Passover?" And He said, "Go into the city to a certain man, and say to him, "The Teacher says, "My time is at hand; I will keep the Passover at your house with My disciples."" ' So the disciples did as Jesus had directed them; and they prepared the Passover.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the Ninth Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

And when Abraham became elevated in the God’s eyes above all other people, the Lord appeared to him and said, “Abraham, Abraham whom I love, obey My words and do My will. Take your dear son Isaac and offer him to Me a sacrifice on a mountain.”

Abraham did as the Lord said. He took his beloved son, two of his servants, a donkey, and went on. When he saw the mountain afar, he left the two servants and the donkey with them and said, “I shall go there with my son to pray and come back.”

He loaded the kindling on his only son and carried the knife and the fire. They went up the mountain to the place that the Lord Almighty designated.

Isaac said to his father Abraham: “Here is the fire where is the lamb?” Abraham said to him, “My son, the Lord will arrange a sacrificial lamb that pleases Him.”

- Exposition
1st Hour
- Exposition
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- Exposition
9th Hour
- Exposition
11th Hour

Then he gathered stones, and built an altar, and stacked the firewood on the altar. Before he lit it, he tied boy's hands and feet and put him on the wood. The boy said: Here, "I am your sacrifice that you offer, father."

When Abraham held the knife and started to proceed to fulfill the offering, the Lord shouted and said:

"Abraham, hold your hand and do not touch your son, for I verified your love towards Me. Isaac, your beloved son, shall grow and multiply.

And as you did not hesitate to offer your first born, I shall bless you and your descendants. Your sons shall be like the stars and will be as numerous as the sand."

Abraham looked behind him and saw a sheep tied with its horns to a tree of Safak. He untied Isaac and slew the sheep instead of him. And the Lord Almighty blessed Abraham because he found him acceptable in all his deeds.

And the old man (Abraham) returned and went back with the two servants and his son.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

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1st Hour

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THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

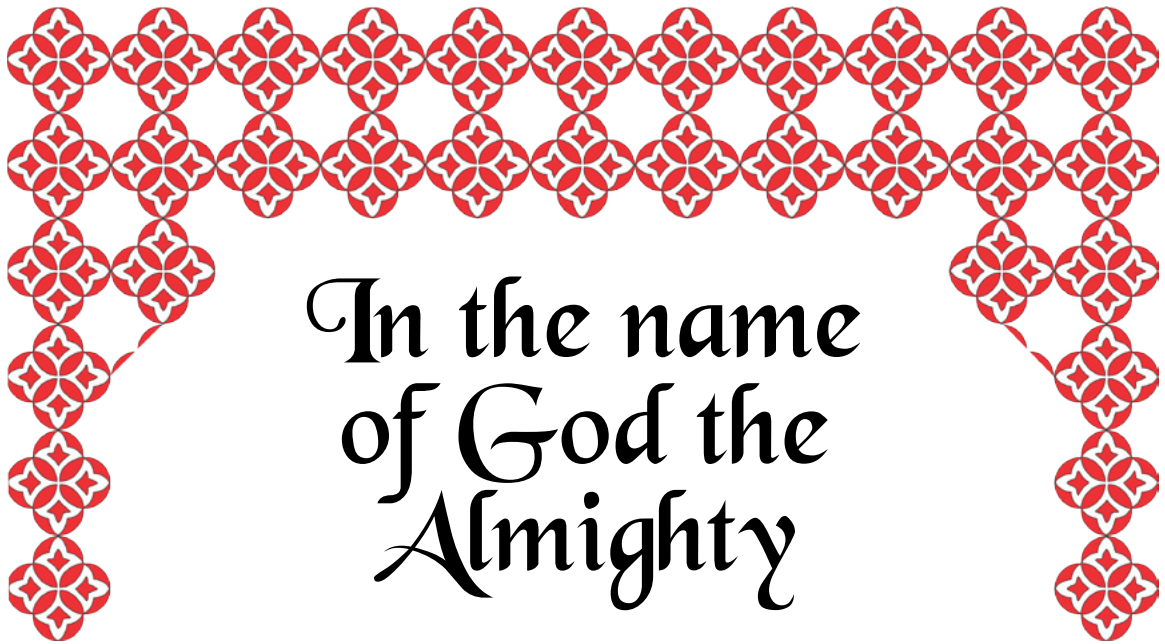
See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



In the name
of God the
Almighty

The Liturgy of the Blessing of the Water of the Great Thursday

After the conclusion of the offering of the morning incense, a basin is filled with water and placed in the middle of the nave of the church. A set of candles is placed on either side of the basin. The priest and deacons put on their liturgical garments and go toward the basin.

The service starts with the following prayers:

- ✠ Bessed are You in truth
- ✠ Have mercy on us,
- ✠ Our Father Who art...
- ✠ Thanksgiving prayer
- ✠ Verses of Cymbals
- ✠ O King of Peace...
- ✠ Glory be... , Now and ever...
- ✠ Our Father Who art...
- ✠ Psalm 50, Have mercy on me...
- ✠ Alleluia, Glory be to You O Lord.

PROPHECIES

Genesis 18: 1- 23

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Then the LORD appeared to him by the terebinth trees of Mamre, as he was sitting in the tent door in the heat of the day. So he lifted his eyes and looked, and behold, three men were standing by him; and when he saw them, he ran from the tent door to meet them, and bowed himself to the ground, and said, "My Lord, if I have now found favor in Your sight, do not pass on by Your servant. Please let a little water be brought, and wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree. And I will bring a morsel of bread that you may refresh your hearts. After that you may pass by, inasmuch as you have come to your servant." They said, "Do as you have said." So Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah and said, "Quickly, make ready three measures of fine meal; knead it and make cakes." And Abraham ran to the herd, took a tender and good calf, gave it to a young man, and he hastened to prepare it. So he took butter and milk and the calf, which he had prepared, and set it before them; and he stood by them under the tree as they ate.

Then they said to him, "Where is Sarah your wife?" So he said, "Here, in the tent." And He said, "I will certainly return to you according to the time

of life, and behold, Sarah your wife shall have a son." (Sarah was listening in the tent door, which was behind him.) Now Abraham and Sarah were old, well advanced in age; and Sarah had passed the age of childbearing. Therefore Sarah laughed within herself, saying, "After I have grown old, shall I have pleasure, my lord being old also?" And the LORD said to Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh, saying, "Shall I surely bear a child, since I am old? 'Is anything too hard for the LORD? At the appointed time I will return to you, according to the time of life, and Sarah shall have a son." But Sarah denied it, saying, "I did not laugh," for she was afraid. And He said, "No, but you did laugh!"

Then the men rose from there and looked toward Sodom, and Abraham went with them to send them on the way. And the LORD said, "Shall I hide from Abraham what I am doing, since Abraham shall surely become a great and mighty nation, and all the nations of the earth shall be blessed in him? For I have known him, in order that he may command his children and his household after him, that they keep the way of the LORD, to do righteousness and justice, that the LORD may bring to Abraham what He has spoken to him. "And the LORD said, "Because the outcry against Sodom and Gomorrah is great, and because their sin is very grave, I will go down now and see whether they have done altogether according to the outcry against it that has come to Me; and if not, I will know." Then the men turned away from there and went toward Sodom, but Abraham still stood before the LORD. And Abraham came near and said, "Would You

also destroy the righteous with the wicked? so that the righteous should be as the wicked;

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Proverbs 9: 1- 11

A reading from the Proverbs of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Wisdom has built her house, She has hewn out her seven pillars; She has slaughtered her meat, She has mixed her wine, She has also furnished her table. She has sent out her maidens, She cries out from the highest places of the city, "Whoever is simple, let him turn in here!" As for him who lacks understanding, she says to him, "Come, eat of my bread and drink of the wine I have mixed. Forsake foolishness and live, and go in the way of understanding.

"He who corrects a scoffer gets shame for himself, and he who rebukes a wicked man only harms himself. Do not correct a scoffer, lest he hate you; Rebuke a wise man, and he will love you. Give instruction to a wise man, and he will be still wiser; Teach a just man, and he will increase

in learning. "The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom, and the knowledge of the Holy One is understanding. For by me your days will be multiplied, and years of life will be added to you.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Exodus 14, 15

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

When Israel crossed the Red Sea, they walked through dry land in the midst of the sea, and their enemies went into the sea and the LORD brought upon them the water of the sea.

Israel and all the house of Jacob were saved. They danced and sang this song: Let us sing to the Lord, for He is very greatly glorified.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Joshua 1, 2

A reading from Joshua son of Nun, the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Joshua and all the people went over Jordan, they treaded on stones that were immersed in the water. Their feet strengthened and they defeated their enemies.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 4:2-4

A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

And in that day God shall shine gloriously in counsel on the earth, to exalt and glorify the remnant of Israel. And it shall be, that the remnant left in Zion, and the remnant left in Jerusalem, even all that are appointed to life in Jerusalem, shall be called holy. For the Lord shall wash away the filth of the sons and daughters of Zion, and shall purge out the blood from the midst of them, with the spirit of judgment, and the spirit of burning.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 55: 1- 13 - 56:1

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

You that thirst, go to the water, and all that have no money, go and buy; and eat and drink wine and milk without money or price. Why do you value at the price of money, and give your labor for that which will not satisfy? Harken to Me, and you shall eat that which is good, and your soul shall feast itself on good things. Give heed with your ears, and follow My ways; hearken to Me, and your soul shall live in prosperity; and I will make with you an everlasting covenant, the sure mercies of David. Behold I have made him a testimony among the Gentiles, a prince and commander to the Gentiles. Nations which know you not shall call upon you, and peoples which are not acquainted with you shall flee to you for refuge, for the sake of the Lord your God, the Holy One of Israel; for He has glorified you.

Seek the Lord, and when you find Him, call upon Him; and when He draws near to you, let the ungodly leave his ways, and the transgressor his counsels; and let him return to the Lord, and he shall find mercy; for He shall abundantly pardon your sins. For My counsels are not as your counsels, nor are My ways as your ways, says the Lord. But as the heaven is distant from the earth, so is My way distant from your ways, and your thoughts from My mind. For as the rain shall come down, or snow from heaven, and shall not return until it has saturated the earth, and it bring forth and bud, and give seed to the sower, and bread for food; so shall My word be,

whatever shall proceed out of My mouth, it shall by no means return to Me void, until all the things which I willed have been accomplished; and I will make your ways prosperous, and will effect My commands. For you shall go forth with joy, and shall be taught with gladness; for the mountains and the hills shall exalt to welcome you with joy, and all the trees of the field shall applaud with their branches. And instead of the bramble shall come up the cypress, and instead of the nettle shall come up the myrtle; and the Lord shall be for a name, and for an everlasting sign, and shall not fail.

Thus says the Lord: Keep justice, and do righteousness; for My salvation is about to come, and My mercy to be revealed.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Ezekiel 36:25-29

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Then I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you shall be clean; I will cleanse you from all your filthiness and from all your idols. I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will take the heart of stone out of your flesh and give you a heart of flesh. I will put My Spirit within you and cause you to walk in My statutes, and you will keep My judgments and do them. Then you shall dwell in the land that I gave to your fathers; you shall be My people, and I will be your God. I will deliver you from all your uncleanness.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Ezekiel 47: 1- 9

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Then he brought me back to the door of the temple; and there was water, flowing from under the threshold of the temple toward the east, for the front of the temple faced east; the water was flowing from under the right side of the temple, south of the altar. He brought me out by way of the north gate, and led me around on the outside to the outer gateway that faces east; and there was water, running out on the right side. And when the man went out to the east with the line in his hand, he measured one thousand cubits, and he brought me through the waters; the water came up to my ankles. Again he measured one thousand and brought me through the waters; the water came up to my knees. Again he measured one thousand and brought me through; the water came up to my waist. Again he measured one thousand, and it was a river that I could not cross; for the water was too deep, water in which one must swim, a river that could not be crossed.

He said to me, "Son of man, have you seen this?" Then he brought me and returned me to the bank of the river. When I returned, there, along the bank of the river, were very many trees on one side and the other. Then he said to me: "This water flows toward the eastern region, goes down into the valley, and enters the sea. When it reaches the sea, its waters are healed. And it shall be that every living thing that moves, wherever the rivers go, will live. There will be a very great multitude of fish, because these waters go there; for they will be healed, and everything will live wherever the river goes.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda the Archimandrite may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Brethren, we must humble ourselves in front of He who suffered on our behalf. We must fear Him who poured the water in a bowl and washed the feet of His disciples with his flawless hands. Let us perform deeds that deserve this great humility that He carried out for our sake. Let us repent for our sins that we committed. Because if we do not repent, they will speak of us in heaven as those who love sin. For what else do we gain if we are cast out of heaven, forced to face the judgment and are rejected for our sins. We will be judged twice, not because we have sinned without knowledge but because of what we did with knowledge was worse than what we did without knowledge. Not only because we have sinned, but also because we did not repent.

Why can't the sheep know the voice of the real shepherd the giver of life and take refuge in Him? He who purchased it with His blood, took care of it, and gave Himself up for it. He who gave us His Body to eat and His Blood to drink, Jesus Christ our Lord and Savior, the Son of God, who dwells in the highest forever.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Shenouda, the Archimandrite who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

Congregation:

We worship you: O Christ with Your good Father and the Holy Spirit: for You have Baptized and save us. (have mercy on us).

The priest offers incense without kissing and the deacon reads the Pauline Epistle in the Annual tune

THE PAULINE EPISTLE

1 Timothy 4: 9 - 5: 10

A reading from the First Epistle of our teacher St. Paul to his disciple Timothy, His blessings be upon us, Amen.

This is a faithful saying and worthy of all acceptance. For to this end we both labor and suffer reproach, because we trust in the living God, who is the Savior of all men, especially of those who believe. These things command and teach.

Let no one despise your youth, but be an example to the believers in word, in conduct, in love, in spirit, in faith, in purity. Till I come, give attention to reading, to exhortation, to doctrine. Do not neglect the gift that is in you, which was given to you by prophecy with the laying on of the hands of the eldership. Meditate on these things; give yourself entirely to them, that your progress may be evident to all. Take heed to yourself and to the

doctrine. Continue in them, for in doing this you will save both yourself and those who hear you.

Do not rebuke an older man, but exhort him as a father, younger men as brothers, older women as mothers, younger women as sisters, with all purity.

Honor widows who are really widows. But if any widow has children or grandchildren, let them first learn to show piety at home and to repay their parents; for this is good and acceptable before God. Now she who is really a widow, and left alone, trusts in God and continues in supplications and prayers night and day. But she who lives in pleasure is dead while she lives. And these things command, that they may be blameless. But if anyone does not provide for his own, and especially for those of his household, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever. Do not let a widow under sixty years old be taken into the number, and not unless she has been the wife of one man, well reported for good works: if she has brought up children, if she has lodged strangers, if she has washed the saints' feet, if she has relieved the afflicted, if she has diligently followed every good work..

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

The congregation chanted the following In Annual Tune:

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal,

❖ *The 1st; Who was born....., and*

❖ *the 2nd & 3rd; Who was crucified*

The priest prays the litany of the Gospel, and the Psalm and the Gospel are read in the annual tune.

PSALM AND GOSPEL

Reader:

Stand up in the fear of God and listen to the Holy Gospel.

A reading from the gospel according to our teacher saint John, the evangelist. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Psalm 51: 7, 10

From the Psalms of our teacher David the prophet & the king. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Purge me with hyssop, and I shall be clean; Wash me, and I shall be whiter than snow. Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a steadfast spirit within me. **Alleluia**

Blessed is He who comes in the name of the LORD. Our LORD, God, Saviour and King of us all, Jesus Christ, the Son of the living God to whom be glory forever. Amen.

John 13: 1- 17

Now before the Feast of the Passover, when Jesus knew that His hour had come that He should depart from this world to the Father, having loved His own who were in the world, He loved them to the end. And supper being ended, the devil having already put it into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray Him, Jesus, knowing that the Father had given all things into His hands, and that He had come from God and was going to God, rose from supper and laid aside His garments, took a towel and girded Himself. After that, He poured water into a basin and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel with which He was girded. Then He came to Simon Peter. And Peter said to Him, "Lord, are You washing my feet?" Jesus answered and said to him, "What I am doing you do not understand now, but you will know after this." Peter said to Him, "You shall never wash my feet!" Jesus answered him, "If I do not wash you, you have no part with Me." Simon Peter said to Him, "Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head!" Jesus said to him, "He who is bathed needs only to wash his feet, but is completely clean; and you are clean, but not all of you. "For He knew who would betray Him; therefore He said, "You are not all clean."

So when He had washed their feet, taken His garments, and sat down again, He said to them, "Do you know what I have done to you? You call Me Teacher and Lord, and you say well, for so I am. If I then, your Lord and Teacher, have washed your feet, you also ought to wash one another's feet. For I have given you an example, that you should do as I have done to you. Most assuredly, I say to you, a servant is not greater than his master; nor is he who is sent greater than he who sent him. If you know these things, blessed are you if you do them.

Congregation:

Glory be to God forever. Amen.

The priest raises the cross along with lit candles and prays:

Φ† ΝΑΙ ΝΑΝ ΘΕΩΟΥΝΑΙ ΕΡΟΝ...(O God have mercy upon us, grant us your mercy).

The congregation responds with Κῆριε ἔλεησον in the long tune with the cymbals for 10 times.

GOSPEL RESPONSE

Congregation:

Jesus Christ is He; Yesterday, Today and Forever: One Iconum: We Worship and Glorify Him.

For blessed is the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit, the perfect Trinity. We worship Him and glorify Him.

The priest then recites the following 7 Litanies:

- ❖ Litany of the Sick
- ❖ Litany of the Travelers
- ❖ Litany of the air of heaven
- ❖ Litany of the Ruler
- ❖ Litany of the Departed.
- ❖ Litany of the Oblations.
- ❖ Litany of the Catechumen

THE LITANY

The congregation replies Lord have mercy after every supplication.

- ◆ Lord, who girded Himself with a towel and covered the nakedness of Adam, and granted us the garment of sonship to God, ***We ask You, Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord, who became man because of His love to mankind; and with His love girded Himself with a towel and washed away the dirt of our sins, ***We ask You, O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord, who became prepared for us the path of life through washing the feet of His pure chosen Apostles, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord, Christ our God, who walked on the water and through His love to mankind, washed the feet of His disciples, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord who is clothed with light and who girded Yourself with a towel and washed the feet of Your disciples, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord have mercy upon us all according to the multitude of Your mercies, ***We ask of Your goodness O Lord to have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord, the Almighty Christ our God, the giver of all Divine gifts to those who minister to Your Holy name, who brings up, nourishes and looks after all through His love, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***

- ◆ O Lord who gathered the waters in one place and limited them above the heavens, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord who measured the waters with His hand, and the heavens with His span and the whole earth with His fist, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ O Lord who turned all the sources of water into rivers with His Holy will and incomprehensible love for mankind, and who prepared everything to serve us, and created everything from nothing, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ And now, O righteous and giver from the richness of His great love to mankind, the God of mercy, visit the earth and water it to being forth-good fruit, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ May the earth bring forth good fruit through Your goodness, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ Give rejoicing to the face of the earth, renew it and raise the waters of the Nile up to its measure, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ Bless the crown of this year with Your goodness and may every place in our country bring forth good fruit and bless its fruit, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ Give rejoicing to all the cities of our country out of Your goodness, ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***

- ◆ O God, save Your people, bless Your inheritance, visit the whole world with Your mercies and compassion. Uplift the Christians with the power of Your life-giving cross. ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***
- ◆ Give peace, strength and safety to all countries out of Your goodness. Grant us fruitfulness and endow mercy upon all the poor of Your people and give rejoicing to the hearts through the supplication of Your pure mother, the Virgin Mary and St. John the Baptist, and our fathers the Apostles. ***We ask you O Christ our God, hear us and have mercy upon us.***

*The priest raises the cross-lighted with candles. And says “Lord have mercy”. The entire Congregation cry out, saying, “**Lord have mercy**” 100 times.*

Afterwards the priest pray the three long Litanies:

- ❖ Litany of the *Peace*
- ❖ Litany of the *Fathers*
- ❖ Litany of the *Gatherings*

Then the congregation says the Creed. then the folowing Aspasmos Adam

ASPASMOS ADAM

Congregation:

Rejoice and be glad O human race, For God so loved the world :

that He gave His only begotten Son, that the believers may have everlasting life.

ANOTHER ASPASMOS ADAM

Congregation:

Our fathers the Apostles preached the Gospel of Jesus Christ to the nations.

Their voices is gone out through all the earth, and their words to the ends of the world.

We ask you, O Son of God: to keep the life of our patriarch: Pope Abba (.....), the chief priest: confirm him on his throne.

And his partner in the liturgy, our holy, righteous father, Abba (.....) the bishop. (metropolitan) Confirm him upon his throne.

That we may praise you with the Cherubim: and the Seraphim: crying out saying:

Holy, Holy, Holy: O Lord the Almighty (Pantocrator): Heaven and earth are full: of Your glory and honor.

Deacon:

Offer. offer. offer. in order. Stand with trembling. Look towards the East.
Let us attend.

The congregation chants: Through the intercessions of the Theotokos,

THE LITURGY OF THE WATER

The Priest blesses the water with the cross, saying:

Priest:

The love of God the Father and the grace of His only-begotten Son, our LORD, God, and Savior Jesus Christ, and the communion and the gift of the Holy Spirit, be with you all.

Congregation:

And with your spirit.

The Priest blesses the water for the second time, and says:

Priest:

Lift up your hearts.

Congregation:

We have them with the LORD.

Priest:

Let us give thanks to the LORD.

The Priest blesses the water for the third time, and says:

Congregation:

It is meet and right

Priest:

Worthy and just, worthy and just, worthy and just, truly You are worthy You, glorify You, worship You, and thank You at all times, for all your works you have done for us. You alone are the true God, existing from the beginning, who formed water from His heights. Who made the water in the firmament that blesses Your holy name. O King of all creation, Lord Jesus Christ, we worship You. You who sits on the throne of Your glory and are worship by all the holy powers.

Deacon:

You, who are seated, stand.

Priest:

For the angels, the archangels, the principalities, the authorities, the thrones, the dominions, all the serving spirits, and all the innumerable hosts of angels, stand before You in fear and trembling, praising Your majesty.

Deacon:

Look towards the East.

Priest:

You are He around whom stand the righteous powers, the Cherubim and the Seraphim, glorifying you three times at all times. And we also make use worthy to praise You with them and bless you with the voices of glory saying:

Congregation:

The Cherubim worship You, and the Seraphim glorify You, proclaiming and saying:

Holy, Holy, Holy, is the LORD of hosts. Heaven and earth are full of Your holy glory.

The priest blesses the water with the cross three times, saying each time, "Agios."

Priest:

Agios, Agios, Agios.

Holy, Holy, are You O Lord and Holy in all things. For You are the True Holy God, Jesus Christ, the First-born of all creation;

Who dwells in the glory of His majesty, in Him the fullness of the Divinity dwells bodily. You did not consider it robbery to be equal to God, Your Father, but with Your good will You came to earth taking the form of a servant becoming man in truth; You were incarnate in the undefiled womb of the Holy Theotokos, Saint Mary.

You who was clothed in purity and never sinned, offered Yourself up to the holy cross for our salvation. You gave us this example, for after supper You arose, took a towel and girded Yourself and poured water into a basin, and began to wash Your disciples' feet; and wiped them with the towel with which You were girded, You have given them the ordinance of love and humility and the remembrance of Your love for man for You said to them, "If I, your Lord and Master have washed your feet, then you also ought to wash one another's feet. As much as I have done it unto you so you ought to do to one another."

You have ordered them to follow Your commandments and statutes for You have said, "love one another; by this shall all men know you are my disciples because you love one another." You also have taught us love and unity; and You has reconciled us with Your Father. Through Your love and compassion for mankind, You have crowned our freedom by the example of washing the

disciples' feet. When Peter exalted Your Divinity and refused saying, "You shall never wash my feet," he heard Your answer, "If I do not wash you, You have no part with me," but he cried sincerely saying, "Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head!" and he also heard Your divine voice which is full of truth saying, "He who is bathed needs only to wash his feet, but is completely clean."

Therefore, we ask of You our Lord Jesus Christ to make us worthy and present in our midst as You were with Your disciples, the holy apostles.

The Priest blesses the water saying the following and the congregation responds with Amen:

Priest:

- ✠ O You Who has blessed at that time, now also bless, (Amen).
- ✠ Purify this water to be for the healing, (Amen).
- ✠ A Holy water, (Amen).
- ✠ A water for the remission of sins, (Amen).
- ✠ A water of purification, (Amen).
- ✠ A water for the salvation and health of our spirits, bodies and souls, (Amen).
- ✠ A purified gift, (Amen).

- ✠ Love for each other and purity of the senses, (Amen).
- ✠ To be worthy of Your Holy Virtue, teach us through Your love of mankind, (Amen).
- ✠ When we wash one another's feet, make us worthy of the inheritance of Your holy disciples, (Amen).
- ✠ Purify our inner man with the fruits of this Mystery, (Amen).
- ✠ Grant us the forgiveness of our sins through the indwelling of Your Holy Spirit to purify our spirits, bodies and souls from all defilement, unrighteousness and sin, (Amen).
- ✠ Grant us the authority to trample on serpents and scorpions and every power of the enemy, and do not permit any evil to overpower us, but grant us wise senses and behavior in sobriety; so that when we come before You, we will find compassion and mercy, (Amen).
- ✠ We ask You O True God, to send Your Holy Spirit the Paraclete upon us and this water, O You who created the water, O You, Jesus Christ our Lord, creator of all; who was crucified for us under Pontius Pilate and confessed saying: "I am the Son of God."
- ✠ We believe that You are truly the Son of God. Purify this water by the power of Your Holy Spirit to annul the deadly powers of the adversary against us. Rebuke all evil spirits, all sorcery, and all idol worshipping.

- ✠ May the power of the adversary flee from this water by the sign of Your Holy cross, O our God Jesus Christ.
- ✠ Bring it forth water for healing. (Amen).
- ✠ Water for purification. (Amen).
- ✠ Water for remission of sins, (Amen).
- ✠ Water for salvation, ((Amen)).

Make us worthy of sonship, that we may cry out towards Your Good Father and the Holy Spirit saying: Our Father Who art in heaven...

Congregation:

Our Father Who art in heaven;

The priest takes the cross, turns his face towards the East, and says the following first and the second Absolutions inaudibly to the Son.

THE FIRST ABSOLUTION

Priest: (inaudibly)

Yes, O LORD, the LORD who has given us the authority to tread on serpents and scorpions and upon all the power of the enemy, crush his heads beneath our feet speedily and scatter before us his every design of wickedness against us. For You are King of us all, O Christ our God, and unto You we send up the glory, the honour, and the worship with Your good Father and the Holy Spirit, the Giver of Life, who is of one essence with You, now and at all times and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Congregation:

In Christ Jesus our LORD.

Deacon:

Bow your heads to the LORD.

Congregation:

Before You, O LORD.

THE SECOND ABSOLUTION

Priest: (inaudibly)

You, O LORD, who bowed the heavens, You descended and became man for the salvation of mankind. You are He who sits upon the cherubim and the seraphim, and beholds those who are lowly. You also now, O our Master, are He to whom we lift up the eyes of our heart; the LORD who forgives our iniquities and saves our souls from corruption. We worship Your ineffable compassion, and we ask You to give us Your peace, for You have given us all things. Acquire us to Yourself, O God our Saviour, for we know none but You. Your holy name, we utter. Turn us, O God, unto the fear of You and the desire of You. Be pleased that we may abide in the enjoyment of Your good things. And those who have bowed their heads beneath Your hand, exalt them in [their] ways of life and adorn them with virtues. And may we all be worthy of Your kingdom in the heavens, through the good will of God, Your good Father, With whom You are blessed with the Holy Spirit, the Giver of Life, who is of one essence with You, now and at all times and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Deacon:

Let us attend in the fear of God. Amen.

The priest turns his face towards the west and signs the congregation with the cross in his hand and says:

Priest:

Peace be with all.

Congregation:

And with your spirit.

The priest now looks westward and, bowing his head, prays:

THE THIRD ABSOLUTION

Priest:

O Master, LORD Jesus Christ, the only-begotten Son and Logos (Word) of God the Father, who has broken every bond of our sins through His saving, life-giving sufferings; who breathed into the face of His holy disciples and saintly apostles, and said to them, "Receive the Holy Spirit. If you forgive the sins of any, they are forgiven; if you retain the sins of any, they are retained." You also now, O our Master, have given grace through Your holy apostles to those who for a time labour in the priesthood in Your holy Church to forgive sin upon the earth and to bind and to loose every bond of iniquity. Now also we ask and entreat Your goodness, O Lover of Mankind, for Your servants,

my fathers and my brethren,

and my weakness,

those who bow their heads before Your holy glory. Dispense to us Your mercy and loose every bond of our sins, and, if we have committed any sin against You knowingly or unknowingly, or through anguish of heart, or in deed or word, or from faint-heartedness, do O Master who knows the weakness of men, as a Good One and Lover of Mankind, O God, grant us the forgiveness of our sins, bless us,

purify us,

make us absolved,

and all Your people absolved.

Fill us with Your fear and straighten us unto Your holy good will, for You are our God, and the glory, the honour, the dominion, and the adoration are due unto You, together with Your good Father and the Holy Spirit, the Life-Giver, who is of one essence with You, now and at all times and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Deacon:

Saved. Amen. And with your spirit. In the fear of God, let us attend.

Congregation:

Amen. LORD have mercy. LORD have mercy. LORD have mercy.

The Priest blesses the water three times saying:

Priest:

Blessed be the LORD Jesus Christ, the Son of God; the sanctification is by the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Congregation:

One is the All-Holy Father, one is the All-Holy Son, one is the All-Holy Spirit. Amen.

At this point, They bring a clean tissue, it was moisture by the holy water of Laqqan by the priest and make a sign of the cross 3 times on the head of the highest rank of the priest as what St. John did with the Christ our Lord. Then the high priest takes the tissue and bless the priests, deacons and the congregation on the their heads. Meanwhile. The congregation sings Psalm 150 in ordinary tune.

PSALM 150

The congregation chanted the psalm 150 as usual in ordinary days.

Congregation:

Allelulia. Allelulia. Allelulia. Allelulia.

Praise God in all His saints.

*They then sing the following Psali according to the tune of **ΠΙΚΕΒΕΡΝΙΤΗΣ**, the annual tune.*

PSALI (LAQUAN DOXOLOGY)

- ✠ Our Clod laid aside His garments, took a towel and girded Himself. He poured water into a basin and washed the disciples' feet.
- ✠ When He came to Simon Peter to wash his feet, Simon Peter said, 'You shall never wash my feet.'
- ✠ Our Savior answered Simon Peter: "If I wash You not, You has no part with me."
- ✠ Simon Peter said unto Him: 'Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head,'
- ✠ He taught them saying: "I have washed your feet; you also ought to wash one another's feet."
- ✠ Intercede on our behalf, O our fathers, the apostles, and the seventy-two disciples, that He may forgive us our sins for He is blessed.

THANKSGIVING PRAYER AFTER BLESSING OF THE WATER

We give thanks unto You, O Master, Lord, God Almighty, upon every condition, for any condition and in whatever condition, for You have made us worthy to complete Yours Holy Example of the washing of feet at this hour. This You; Your Only-Begotten Son, our Lord, God, Teacher and Savior Jesus Christ, anointed and taught Your disciples.

We ask and entreat Your goodness O Lover of man, forgive our sins and have compassion on us, according to Your great mercy and grant peace on Your Holy Church. Keep us in peace and love with Your fear, alert us to all Your commandments in this generation and forever.

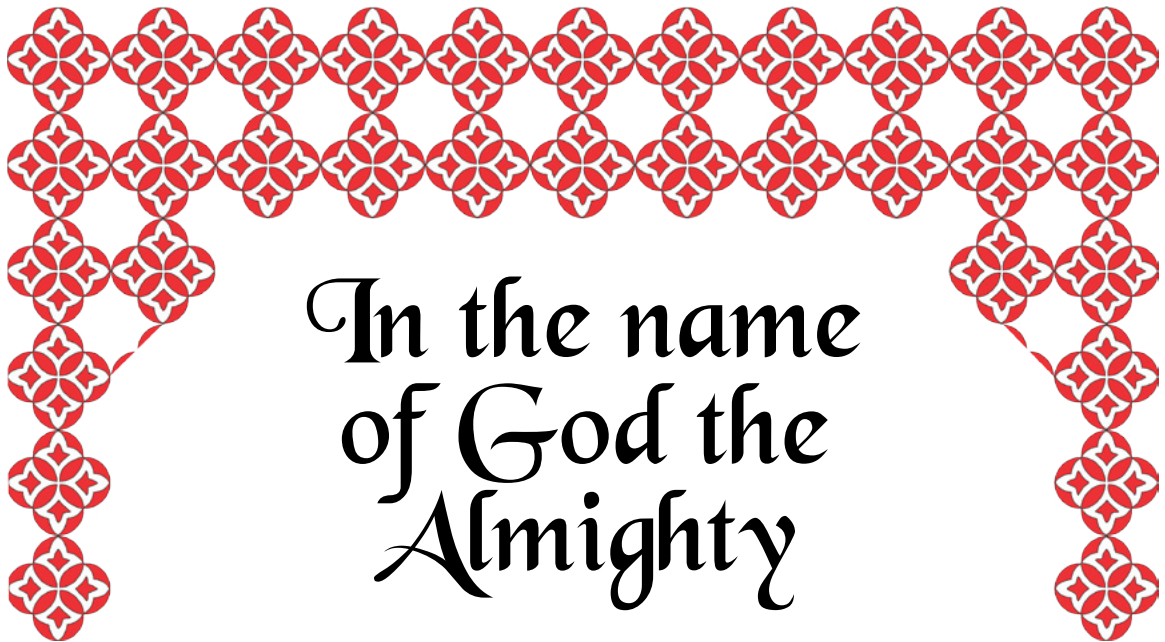
Make us all partakers of Your eternal blessings through Yours Only Begotten Son Jesus Christ our God, through whom glory, honor, dominion, and worship befit You with Him and the Holy Spirit both now and ever and unto the ages of ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba John Chrysostom may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Today, I behold many believers rushing to partake of the awesome mysteries that they may exceedingly benefit. Let me first advise you that you must walk in fear and righteousness as befitting these holy mysteries. My beloved, in this day our Lord Jesus was betrayed; if you then hear that He was betrayed, do not be disappointed. Let me tell you about whom you shall be disappointed in. Lament and cry over Judas who gave Him up. For He who was betrayed, sits on the right hand of the Father in heaven; and He is also King over all, in an everlasting kingdom. But he who gave Him up, descended into the depths of Hades; there he shall remain unto the end in anticipation of great grief and lament. It is over him you should say moan and lament. For our Lord taught us not to grieve over him who endures suffering, but rather to grieve over the evildoer. It is fit to bewail him who does evil more than he who accepts sufferings. Indeed, he who accepts sufferings is not evil, but rather he who does evil is wicked. For, being in sufferings leads us to the heavenly kingdom. But evil doing leads us to hell and into punishment. For it is said: "Blessed are they who are persecuted for righteousness' sake, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." But he who does evil, is worthy of punishment and sufferings.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba John Chrysostom who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.



In the name
of God the
Almighty

LITURGY OF THE COVENANT
THURSDAY

- ✠ The Lamb is offered without praying the Agpeya (hours prayers)
- ✠ Ἀλ̄ Φαι πε πιε̄ζουγ (This is the day) and
- ✠ Ὡθις ἀμην (Saved, Amen) are not chanted.
- ✠ The Priest offers incense around the congregation in the nave of the church without putting his hand or the cross on their heads, and
- ✠ The congregation chants Ἰενοῦωγτ ὡωοκ ὦ Π̄χς (We worship you O Christ).
- ✠ The Pauline Epistle is read in the annual tune while the priest goes around with the censer without kissing.

THE PAULINE EPISTLE

1 Corinthians 11:23- 34

A reading from the First Epistle of our teacher Paul to the Corinthians. May his blessing be with us. Amen.

For I received from the Lord that which I also delivered to you: that the Lord Jesus on the same night in which He was betrayed took bread; and when He had given thanks, He broke it and said, "Take, eat; this is My body which is broken for you; do this in remembrance of Me." In the same manner He also took the cup after supper, saying, "This cup is the new covenant in My blood. This do, as often as you drink it, in remembrance of

Me.” For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord’s death till He comes.

Therefore whoever eats this bread or drinks this cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner will be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord. But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of the bread and drink of the cup. For he who eats and drinks in an unworthy manner eats and drinks judgment to himself, not discerning the Lord’s body. For this reason many are weak and sick among you, and many sleep. For if we would judge ourselves, we would not be judged. But when we are judged, we are chastened by the Lord, that we may not be condemned with the world. Therefore, my brethren, when you come together to eat, wait for one another. But if anyone is hungry, let him eat at home, lest you come together for judgment. And the rest I will set in order when I come.

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

- ✧ The Catholic epistle and the Acts are not read.
- ✧ The Trisagion is said, the first for the nativity and the second and third for the crucifixion, and then
- ✧ The priest prays the litany of the Gospel.
- ✧ The Psalm is chanted in the joyful tune and concluded in the annual tune. Then
- ✧ The Gospel is then prayed in annual tune.

PSALM AND GOSPEL

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Reader:

Stand up in the fear of God and listen to the Holy Gospel.

A reading from the gospel according to our teacher saint Matthew, the evangelist. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Psalm 23:5 & 41:9

From the Psalms of our teacher David the prophet & the king. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies; Who ate my bread, has lifted up his heel against me. **Alleluia.**

Blessed is He who comes in the name of the LORD. Our LORD, God, Saviour and King of us all, Jesus Christ, the Son of the living God to whom be glory forever. Amen.

Matthew 26:20-29

When evening had come, He sat down with the twelve. Now as they were eating, He said, "Assuredly, I say to you, one of you will betray Me." And they were exceedingly sorrowful, and each of them began to say to Him, "Lord, is it I?" He answered and said, "He who dipped his hand with Me in the dish will betray Me. The Son of Man indeed goes just as it is written of Him, but woe to that man by whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It would have been good for that man if he had not been born." Then Judas, who was betraying Him, answered and said, "Rabbi, is it I?" He said to him, "You have said it."

And as they were eating, Jesus took bread, blessed and broke it, and gave it to the disciples and said, "Take, eat; this is My body." Then He took the cup, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, saying, "Drink from it, all of you. For this is My blood of the new covenant, which is shed for many for the remission of sins. But I say to you, I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on until that day when I drink it new with you in My Father's kingdom."

Congregation:

Glory be to God forever. Amen.

GOSPEL RESPONSE

Your body and Your blood; are for the forgiveness of sins; and a new covenant ; that you have given to your disciples.

We have been made worthy; to partake of the tree of life; the true body; and blood of God.

For blessed is the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit, the perfect Trinity. We worship Him and glorify Him.

- ✠ The priest continues with the three long litanies. The deacon says “**ΕΝ**
κοφια” Then the Creed is recited.
- ✠ The prayer of reconciliation is not prayed. The deacon says “Offer
offer...” and the congregation continues with **ΖΙΤΕΝ** **ΝΙΠΡΕCΒΙΑ** (Through
the intercessions).
- ✠ The Liturgy is continued as usual until the priest prays the Litany of
the oblations. After the deacon’s reponse, the Commemoration of the
Saints is not prayed and the congregation continues with **ΩCΠΕΡ ΗΝ**
(As it was).
- ✠ The liturgy is continued as usual until the end.
- ✠ During partaking of the holy communion, psalm 150 is not chanted but
the readings of the eleventh hour are started. When communion has
finished, the priest gives the final blessing without laying of the hands
and concludes the prayers.



ELEVENTH HOUR OF GREAT THURSDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Isaiah 52: 13 - 53: 12

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Behold, My Servant shall deal prudently; He shall be exalted and extolled and be very high. Just as many were astonished at you, So His visage was marred more than any man, And His form more than the sons of men; So shall He sprinkle many nations. Kings shall shut their mouths at Him; for what had not been told them they shall see, and what they had not heard they shall consider.

Who has believed our report? And to whom has the arm of the LORD been revealed? For He shall grow up before Him as a tender plant, and as a root out of dry ground. He has no form or comeliness; And when we see Him, There is no beauty that we should desire Him. He is despised and rejected by men, A Man of sorrows and acquainted with grief. And we hid, as it were, our faces from Him; He was despised, and we did not esteem Him.

Surely He has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows; Yet we esteemed Him stricken, Smitten by God, and afflicted. But He was wounded for our transgressions, He was bruised for our iniquities; The chastisement for our peace was upon Him, And by His stripes we are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray; We have turned, every one, to his own way; And the LORD has laid on Him the iniquity of us all. He was oppressed and He was afflicted, Yet He opened not His mouth; He was led as a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before its shearers is silent, So He opened not His mouth. He was taken from prison and from judgment, and who will declare His generation? For He was cut off from the land of the living; for the transgressions of My people He was stricken. And they made His grave with the wicked-- But with the rich at His death, Because He had done no violence, Nor was any deceit in His mouth.

Yet it pleased the LORD to bruise Him; He has put Him to grief. When You make His soul an offering for sin, He shall see His seed, He shall prolong His days, And the pleasure of the LORD shall prosper in His hand. He shall see the labor of His soul, and be satisfied. By His knowledge My righteous Servant shall justify many, For He shall bear their iniquities. Therefore I will divide Him a portion with the great, and He shall divide the spoil with the strong, Because He poured out His soul unto death, and He was numbered with the transgressors, And He bore the sin of many, And made intercession for the transgressors.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 19: 19 – 25

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

In that day there will be an altar to the Lord in the midst of the land of Egypt, and a pillar to the Lord at its border. And it will be for a sign and for a witness to the Lord of hosts in the land of Egypt; for they will cry to the Lord because of the oppressors, and He will send them a Savior and a Mighty One, and He will deliver them. Then the Lord will be known to Egypt, and the Egyptians will know the Lord in that day, and will make sacrifice and offering; yes, they will make a vow to the Lord and perform it. And the Lord will strike Egypt, He will strike and heal it; they will return to the Lord, and He will be entreated by them and heal them.

In that day there will be a highway from Egypt to Assyria, and the Assyrian will come into Egypt and the Egyptian into Assyria, and the Egyptians will serve with the Assyrians. In that day Israel will be one of three with Egypt and Assyria--a blessing in the midst of the land, whom the Lord of hosts shall bless, saying,

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Zechariah 12:11 - 14:1-3, 6-9

**A reading from Zechariah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

In that day there shall be a great mourning in Jerusalem, like the mourning at Hadad Rimmon in the plain of Megiddo. And the land shall mourn, every family by itself: the family of the house of David by itself, and their wives by themselves; the family of the house of Nathan by itself, and their wives by themselves; the family of the house of Levi by itself, and their wives by themselves; the family of Shimei by itself, and their wives by themselves; all the families that remain, every family by itself, and their wives by themselves.

"In that day a fountain shall be opened for the house of David and for the inhabitants of Jerusalem, for sin and for uncleanness. "It shall be in that day," says the Lord of hosts, "that I will cut off the names of the idols from the land, and they shall no longer be remembered. I will also cause the prophets and the unclean spirit to depart from the land. It shall come to pass that if anyone still prophesies, then his father and mother who begot him will say to him, 'You shall not live, because you have spoken lies in the name of the Lord.' And his father and mother who begot him shall thrust him through when he prophesies. "And it shall be in that day that every prophet will be ashamed of his vision when he prophesies; they will not wear a robe of coarse hair to deceive. But he will say, 'I am no prophet, I am a farmer; for a man taught me to keep cattle from my youth.' And one will

say to him, 'What are these wounds between your arms?''* Then he will answer, 'Those with which I was wounded in the house of my friends.'

"Awake, O sword, against My Shepherd, Against the Man who is My Companion," Says the Lord of hosts. "Strike the Shepherd, And the sheep will be scattered; Then I will turn My hand against the little ones. And it shall come to pass in all the land," Says the Lord, "That two-thirds in it shall be cut off and die, But one-third shall be left in it: I will bring the one-third through the fire, Will refine them as silver is refined, And test them as gold is tested. They will call on My name, And I will answer them. I will say, 'This is My people'; And each one will say, 'The Lord is my God.'

"Behold, the day of the Lord is coming, And your spoil will be divided in your midst. For I will gather all the nations to battle against Jerusalem; The city shall be taken, The houses rifled, And the women ravished. Half of the city shall go into captivity, But the remnant of the people shall not be cut off from the city. Then the Lord will go forth And fight against those nations, As He fights in the day of battle.

It shall come to pass in that day That there will be no light; The lights will diminish. It shall be one day Which is known to the Lord-- Neither day nor night. But at evening time it shall happen That it will be light. And in that day it shall be That living waters shall flow from Jerusalem, Half of them toward the eastern sea and half of them toward the western sea; In both summer and winter it shall occur. And the Lord shall be King over all the earth.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 28

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 50:17,18

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Seeing you hate instruction and cast My words behind you? When you saw a thief, you consented with him, and have been a partaker with adulterers. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 13: 21- 30

When Jesus had said these things, He was troubled in spirit, and testified and said, "Most assuredly, I say to you, one of you will betray Me. "Then the disciples looked at one another, perplexed about whom He spoke. Now there was leaning on Jesus' bosom one of His disciples, whom Jesus loved. Simon Peter therefore motioned to him to ask who it was of whom He spoke. Then, leaning back on Jesus' breast, he said to Him, "Lord, who is it?" Jesus answered, "It is he to whom I shall give a piece of bread when I

have dipped it. " And having dipped the bread, He gave it to Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon. Now after the piece of bread, Satan entered him. Then Jesus said to him, "What you do, do quickly. "But no one at the table knew for what reason He said this to him. For some thought, because Judas had the moneybox, that Jesus had said to him, "Buy those things we need for the feast," or that he should give something to the poor.

Having received the piece of bread, he then went out immediately. And it was night.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

The Exposition of the Eleventh Hour of Great Thursday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

The Sun of Righteousness shined upon us and His rays reached all nations of the world; Jesus Christ, the true light, Who shines to everyone coming to the world. The life-giving Bread came from heaven and nourished all creation.

From the beginning of times, He prepared a table in the wilderness and nourished the people with manna for forty years, “They ate and died,” so says the Lord.

On the eve of that day in which they ate the unleavened bread of Passover, our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ sat there in the upper chamber of Zion with His disciples to celebrate the New Passover, which is His very body, that He gave them as a sacrament, and the precious blood, which is superior than the blood of offerings.

Our Savior took the bread, blessed it, broke it, divided it, and gave it to His

disciples saying: Take you eat from this you all. This is My body that I divide for you and for many for the remission of sins.

After that He took the cup, mixed the wine with water, and handed it to them saying: Drink from it all of you for this is My blood of the new covenant which is shed for many to be given for the remission of sins. Every time you eat of this bread and drink of this cup you proclaim (preach) My death, confess My resurrection, and remember Me till I come.

He is the Passover of our salvation. The real Lamb, Christ our Savior said: I say to you I will not drink of this fruit of this vine until that day when I drink it new with you in kingdom of My Father.

The Lord said: I say to you, one of you will betray Me, and deliver Me to the enemies. And they began to think, each one of them, saying: Who dares do that?

He answered and said: He who dipped his hand in the dish with Me will betray Me. Then Judas, one of those present, said: Is it I? He said to him: You have said it. You have intended evil in your contrainess and dared to commit a grave transgression, because the Son of God came to save the first man from corruption.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

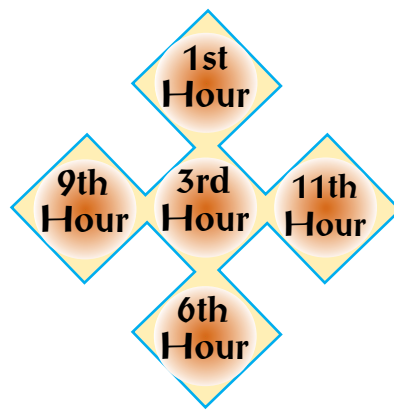
See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



THE HOLY PASCHA OF GOOD FRIDAY EVE

FIRST HOUR OF EVE OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Jeremiah 8: 17 - 9:6

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

For behold, I will send serpents among you, Vipers which cannot be charmed, And they shall bite you," says the Lord.

I would comfort myself in sorrow; My heart is faint in me. Listen! The voice, The cry of the daughter of my people From a far country: "Is not the Lord in Zion? Is not her King in her?" "Why have they provoked Me to anger With their carved images-- With foreign idols?" "The harvest is past, The summer is ended, And we are not saved!" For the hurt of the daughter of my people I am hurt. I am mourning; Astonishment has taken hold of me. Is there no balm in Gilead, Is there no physician there? Why then is there no recovery For the health of the daughter of my people?

Oh, that my head were waters, And my eyes a fountain of tears, That I might weep day and night For the slain of the daughter of my people! Oh, that I had in the wilderness A lodging place for travelers; That I might leave my people, And go from them! For they are all adulterers, An assembly of treacherous men. "And like their bow they have bent their tongues for lies. They are not valiant for the truth on the earth. For they proceed from evil to evil, And they do not know Me," says the Lord. "Everyone take heed to his neighbor, And do not trust any brother; For every brother will utterly supplant, And every neighbor will walk with slanderers. Everyone will deceive his neighbor, And will not speak the truth; They have taught their tongue to speak lies; They weary themselves to commit iniquity. Your dwelling place is in the midst of deceit; Through deceit they refuse to know Me," says the Lord.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour of the Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Psalm 102:1 & 8

Hear my prayer, O LORD, and let my cry come to You. My enemies
reproach me all day long; Those who deride me swear an oath against
me. Alleluia.

First Chapter of Paraclete

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 13:33-14:25

Little children, I shall be with you a little while longer. You will seek Me; and as I said to the Jews, 'Where I am going, you cannot come,' so now I say to you. A new commandment I give to you, that you love one another; as I have loved you, that you also love one another. By this all will know that you are My disciples, if you have love for one another."

Simon Peter said to Him, "Lord, where are You going?" Jesus answered him, "Where I am going you cannot follow Me now, but you shall follow Me afterward." Peter said to Him, "Lord, why can I not follow You now? I will lay down my life for Your sake." Jesus answered him, "Will you lay down your life for My sake? Most assuredly, I say to you, the rooster shall not crow till you have denied Me three times.

"Let not your heart be troubled; you believe in God, believe also in Me. In My Father's house are many mansions; if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you. And if I go and prepare a place for

you, I will come again and receive you to Myself; that where I am, there you may be also. And where I go you know, and the way you know."

Thomas said to Him, "Lord, we do not know where You are going, and how can we know the way?" Jesus said to him, "I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Me. "If you had known Me, you would have known My Father also; and from now on you know Him and have seen Him." Philip said to Him, "Lord, show us the Father, and it is sufficient for us." Jesus said to him, "Have I been with you so long, and yet you have not known Me, Philip? He who has seen Me has seen the Father; so how can you say, 'Show us the Father'? Do you not believe that I am in the Father, and the Father in Me? The words that I speak to you I do not speak on My own authority; but the Father who dwells in Me does the works. Believe Me that I am in the Father and the Father in Me, or else believe Me for the sake of the works themselves. "Most assuredly, I say to you, he who believes in Me, the works that I do he will do also; and greater works than these he will do, because I go to My Father. And whatever you ask in My name, that I will do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son. If you ask anything in My name, I will do it.

"If you love Me, keep My commandments. And I will pray the Father, and He will give you another Helper, that He may abide with you forever-- the Spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive, because it neither sees Him nor knows Him; but you know Him, for He dwells with you and will be in you. I will not leave you orphans; I will come to

you. "A little while longer and the world will see Me no more, but you will see Me. Because I live, you will live also. At that day you will know that I am in My Father, and you in Me, and I in you. He who has My commandments and keeps them, it is he who loves Me. And he who loves Me will be loved by My Father, and I will love him and manifest Myself to him."

Judas (not Iscariot) said to Him, "Lord, how is it that You will manifest Yourself to us, and not to the world?" Jesus answered and said to him, "If anyone loves Me, he will keep My word; and My Father will love him, and We will come to him and make Our home with him. He who does not love Me does not keep My words; and the word which you hear is not Mine but the Father's who sent Me. "These things I have spoken to you while being present with you.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

Second Chapter of Paraclete

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 14:26-15:25

But the Helper, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in My name, He will teach you all things, and bring to your remembrance all things that I said to you.

Peace I leave with you, My peace I give to you; not as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid. You have heard Me say to you, 'I am going away and coming back to you.' If you loved Me, you would rejoice because I said, 'I am going to the Father,' for My Father is greater than I. And now I have told you before it comes, that when it does come to pass, you may believe. I will no longer talk much with you, for the ruler of this world is coming, and he has nothing in Me. But that the world may know that I love the Father, and as the Father gave Me commandment, so I do. Arise, let us go from here.

"I am the true vine, and My Father is the vinedresser. Every branch in Me that does not bear fruit He takes away; and every branch that bears fruit

He prunes, that it may bear more fruit. You are already clean because of the word which I have spoken to you. Abide in Me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abides in the vine, neither can you, unless you abide in Me.

I am the vine, you are the branches. He who abides in Me, and I in him, bears much fruit; for without Me you can do nothing. If anyone does not abide in Me, he is cast out as a branch and is withered; and they gather them and throw them into the fire, and they are burned. If you abide in Me, and My words abide in you, you will ask what you desire, and it shall be done for you. By this My Father is glorified, that you bear much fruit; so you will be My disciples. "As the Father loved Me, I also have loved you; abide in My love.

If you keep My commandments, you will abide in My love, just as I have kept My Father's commandments and abide in His love. These things I have spoken to you, that My joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be full.

This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you. Greater love has no one than this, than to lay down one's life for his friends. You are My friends if you do whatever I command you. No longer do I call you servants, for a servant does not know what his master is doing; but I have called you friends, for all things that I heard from My Father I have made known to you.

You did not choose Me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit, and that your fruit should remain, that whatever you ask the Father in My name He may give you. These things I command you, that you love one another.

"If the world hates you, you know that it hated Me before it hated you. If you were of the world, the world would love its own. Yet because you are not of the world, but I chose you out of the world, therefore the world hates you. Remember the word that I said to you, 'A servant is not greater than his master.' If they persecuted Me, they will also persecute you. If they kept My word, they will keep yours also. But all these things they will do to you for My name's sake, because they do not know Him who sent Me.

If I had not come and spoken to them, they would have no sin, but now they have no excuse for their sin. He who hates Me hates My Father also. If I had not done among them the works which no one else did, they would have no sin; but now they have seen and also hated both Me and My Father. But this happened that the word might be fulfilled which is written in their law, 'They hated Me without a cause.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

Third Chapter of Paraclete

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 15:26-16:33

But when the Helper comes, whom I shall send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth who proceeds from the Father, He will testify of Me. And you also will bear witness, because you have been with Me from the beginning.

"These things I have spoken to you, that you should not be made to stumble. They will put you out of the synagogues; yes, the time is coming that whoever kills you will think that he offers God service. And these things they will do to you because they have not known the Father nor Me. But these things I have told you, that when the time comes, you may remember that I told you of them. And these things I did not say to you at the beginning, because I was with you.

"But now I go away to Him who sent Me, and none of you asks Me, 'Where are You going?' But because I have said these things to you, sorrow has filled your heart. Nevertheless I tell you the truth. It is to your advantage that I go away; for if I do not go away, the Helper will

not come to you; but if I depart, I will send Him to you. And when He has come, He will convict the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment: of sin, because they do not believe in Me; of righteousness, because I go to My Father and you see Me no more; of judgment, because the ruler of this world is judged.

I still have many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now. However, when He, the Spirit of truth, has come, He will guide you into all truth; for He will not speak on His own authority, but whatever He hears He will speak; and He will tell you things to come. He will glorify Me, for He will take of what is Mine and declare it to you. All things that the Father has are Mine. Therefore I said that He will take of Mine and declare it to you. "A little while, and you will not see Me; and again a little while, and you will see Me, because I go to the Father."

Then some of His disciples said among themselves, "What is this that He says to us, 'A little while, and you will not see Me; and again a little while, and you will see Me'; and, 'because I go to the Father'?" They said therefore, "What is this that He says, 'A little while'? We do not know what He is saying." Now Jesus knew that they desired to ask Him, and He said to them, "Are you inquiring among yourselves about what I said, 'A little while, and you will not see Me; and again a little while, and you will see Me'? Most assuredly, I say to you that you will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice; and you will be sorrowful, but your sorrow will be turned into joy. A woman, when she is in labor, has sorrow because her hour has come; but as soon as she has given birth to the child, she no longer remembers the anguish, for joy that a human being has been

born into the world. Therefore you now have sorrow; but I will see you again and your heart will rejoice, and your joy no one will take from you. And in that day you will ask Me nothing. Most assuredly, I say to you, whatever you ask the Father in My name He will give you. Until now you have asked nothing in My name. Ask, and you will receive, that your joy may be full.

“These things I have spoken to you in figurative language; but the time is coming when I will no longer speak to you in figurative language, but I will tell you plainly about the Father. In that day you will ask in My name, and I do not say to you that I shall pray the Father for you; for the Father Himself loves you, because you have loved Me, and have believed that I came forth from God. I came forth from the Father and have come into the world. Again, I leave the world and go to the Father.”

His disciples said to Him, “See, now You are speaking plainly, and using no figure of speech! Now we are sure that You know all things, and have no need that anyone should question You. By this we believe that You came forth from God.” Jesus answered them, “Do you now believe? Indeed the hour is coming, yes, has now come, that you will be scattered, each to his own, and will leave Me alone. And yet I am not alone, because the Father is with Me. These things I have spoken to you, that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation; but be of good cheer, I have overcome the world.”

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

Fourth Chapter of Paraclete

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 17:1-26

Jesus spoke these words, lifted up His eyes to heaven, and said: "Father, the hour has come. Glorify Your Son, that Your Son also may glorify You, 2 as You have given Him authority over all flesh, that He should give eternal life to as many as You have given Him. 3 And this is eternal life, that they may know You, the only true God, and Jesus Christ whom You have sent. 4 I have glorified You on the earth. I have finished the work which You have given Me to do. 5 And now, O Father, glorify Me together with Yourself, with the glory which I had with You before the world was.

"I have manifested Your name to the men whom You have given Me out of the world. They were Yours, You gave them to Me, and they have kept Your word. 7 Now they have known that all things which You have given Me are from You. 8 For I have given to them the words which You have given Me; and they have received them, and have known surely that I came forth from You; and they have believed that You sent Me.

"I pray for them. I do not pray for the world but for those whom You have given Me, for they are Yours. 10 And all Mine are Yours, and Yours are Mine, and I am glorified in them. 11 Now I am no longer in the world, but these are in the world, and I come to You. Holy Father, keep through Your name those whom You have given Me, that they may be one as We are. 12 While I was with them in the world, I kept them in Your name. Those whom You gave Me I have kept; and none of them is lost except the son of perdition, that the Scripture might be fulfilled.

But now I come to You, and these things I speak in the world, that they may have My joy fulfilled in themselves. 14 I have given them Your word; and the world has hated them because they are not of the world, just as I am not of the world. 15 I do not pray that You should take them out of the world, but that You should keep them from the evil one. 16 They are not of the world, just as I am not of the world. 17 Sanctify them by Your truth. Your word is truth. 18 As You sent Me into the world, I also have sent them into the world. 19 And for their sakes I sanctify Myself, that they also may be sanctified by the truth.

"I do not pray for these alone, but also for those who will believe in Me through their word; 21 that they all may be one, as You, Father, are in Me, and I in You; that they also may be one in Us, that the world may believe that You sent Me. 22 And the glory which You gave Me I have given them, that they may be one just as We are one: 23 I in them, and You in Me; that they may be made perfect in one, and that the world may know that You have sent Me, and have loved them as You have loved Me.

"Father, I desire that they also whom You gave Me may be with Me where I am, that they may behold My glory which You have given Me; for You loved Me before the foundation of the world. 25 O righteous Father! The world has not known You, but I have known You; and these have known that You sent Me. 26 And I have declared to them Your name, and will declare it, that the love with which You loved Me may be in them, and I in them."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The First Hour of Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

And when He said, Our Lord Jesus Christ raised His eyes towards His Father and said, “Father, the hour is come, glorify Your Son in the world. I glorified You Father on the earth. when I fulfilled Your will.

And what You gave Me Father, I gave to them because I selected them from the world. And they accepted my word and knew that I came forth from You. I ask You for their sake and for the sake of all those who believe in Me through their word. I have chosen them from the world and I am coming to You and will leave them in the world.

When I was with them, I taught them and delivered Your words to them. Father the world did not know You and I knew You. Those who are with Me knew that You sent Me, that is why I taught them Your name O Father.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

The love You lavished on Me O Father, let it be always on them so that they may proclaim Your grace among the nations for I shall be in them.

Those are the commandments that our Savior gave to His disciples, whom He chose and sent to the world, to harvest for Him a big corp. These are the galaxies whose light filled the earth.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF EVE OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Ezekiel 36: 16 - 23

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Moreover the word of the Lord came to me, saying: 17 "Son of man, when the house of Israel dwelt in their own land, they defiled it by their own ways and deeds; to Me their way was like the uncleanness of a woman in her customary impurity. 18 Therefore I poured out My fury on them for the blood they had shed on the land, and for their idols with which they had defiled it. 19 So I scattered them among the nations, and they were dispersed throughout the countries; I judged them according to their ways and their deeds. 20 When they came to the nations, wherever they went, they profaned My holy name — when they said of them, 'These are the people of the Lord, and yet they have gone out of His land.' 21 But I had concern for My holy name, which the house of Israel had profaned among the nations wherever they went.

"Therefore say to the house of Israel, 'Thus says the Lord God: "I do not do this for your sake, O house of Israel, but for My holy name's sake, which you have profaned among the nations wherever you went. 23 And I will sanctify My great name, which has been profaned among the nations, which you have profaned in their midst; and the nations shall know that I am the Lord," says the Lord God, "when I am hallowed in you before their eyes.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour of the Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 55: 21 & 1

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Do not keep silent, O God of my praise! For the mouth of the wicked and the mouth of the deceitful have opened against me; They have also surrounded me with words of hatred, and fought against me without a cause. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 26:30-35

And when they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives. Then Jesus said to them, "All of you will be made to stumble because of Me this night, for it is written: 'I will strike the Shepherd, And the sheep of the flock will be scattered. But after I have been raised, I will go before you to Galilee.'" Peter answered and said to Him, "Even if all are made to stumble because of You, I will never be made to stumble." Jesus said to him, "Assuredly, I say to you that this night, before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times." Peter said to Him, "Even if I have to die with You, I will not deny You!" And so said all the disciples

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 14: 26- 31

And when they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives. Then Jesus said to them, "All of you will be made to stumble because of Me this night, for it is written: "I will strike the Shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered.' "But after I have been raised, I will go before you to Galilee." Peter said to Him, "Even if all are made to stumble, yet I will not be." Jesus said to him, "Assuredly, I say to you that today, even this night, before the rooster crows twice, you will deny Me three times." But he spoke more vehemently, "If I have to die with You, I will not deny You!" And they all said likewise.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 22: 31- 39

And the Lord said, "Simon, Simon! Indeed, Satan has asked for you, that he may sift you as wheat. But I have prayed for you, that your faith should not fail; and when you have returned to Me, strengthen your brethren." But he said to Him, "Lord, I am ready to go with You, both to prison and to death." Then He said, "I tell you, Peter, the rooster shall not crow this day before you will deny three times that you know Me."

And He said to them, "When I sent you without money bag, knapsack, and sandals, did you lack anything?" So they said, "Nothing." Then He said to them, "But now, he who has a money bag, let him take it, and likewise a knapsack; and he who has no sword, let him sell his garment and buy one. For I say to you that this which is written must still be accomplished in Me: 'And He was numbered with the transgressors. For the things concerning Me have an end.'" So they said, "Lord, look, here are two swords." And He said to them, "It is enough." Coming out, He went to the Mount of Olives, as He was accustomed, and His disciples also followed Him.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 18:1-2

When Jesus had spoken these words, He went out with His disciples over the Brook Kidron, where there was a garden, which He and His disciples entered. And Judas, who betrayed Him, also knew the place; for Jesus often met there with His disciples.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Third Hour of the eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

After they sang a hymn, they went out of Zion and ascended the Mount of Olives. Our Savior started to tell His disciples openly; “This night all of you will be made to stumble because of Me, and it will be fulfilled what was written about this time and all the saying of the prophets who said, ‘I will strike the Shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.’ After all of this, I will go before you to Galilee.”

Peter said in front of his brethren, “If they all deny You, I shall not, my Lord.” The Lord said to him, “Assuredly, I say to you, Peter, that this night, before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times. And when the rooster crows, you will realize what you have just done.” “If I was on the brink of death, I shall not deny You my Lord and God,” said Peter and the rest of the disciples with love.

This all happened so as to fulfill the prophecy of the prophet in the Psalms, saying, “O Lord do not ignore my praye, because the mouth of the sinners has spoken against me.” Who is that sinner other than Judas, the son of sin and corruption, who bought for himself a bad share with the silver of iniquity. He who sold His Master to the Gentiles, rejected grace, and gained sin.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF EVE OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Ezekiel 22: 23- 28

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

And the word of the Lord came to me, saying, "Son of man, say to her: 'You are a land that is not cleansed or rained on in the day of indignation.' The conspiracy of her prophets in her midst is like a roaring lion tearing the prey; they have devoured people; they have taken treasure and precious things; they have made many widows in her midst. Her priests have violated My law and profaned My holy things; they have not distinguished between the holy and unholy, nor have they made known the difference between the unclean and the clean; and they have hidden their eyes from My Sabbaths, so that I am profaned among them. Her princes in her midst are like wolves tearing the prey, to shed blood, to destroy people, and to get dishonest gain. Her prophets plastered them with untempered mortar, seeing false visions, and divining lies for them, saying, 'Thus says the Lord God,' when the Lord had not spoken.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Sixth Hour: of the Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 59:1, 69:20

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Deliver me from my enemies, O my God; Defend me from those who rise up against me. I looked for someone to take pity, but there was none; And for comforters, but I found none. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 26: 36- 46

Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and said to the disciples, "Sit here while I go and pray over there." And He took with Him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and He began to be sorrowful and deeply distressed. Then He said to them, "My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch with Me." He went a little farther and fell on His face, and prayed, saying, "O My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me; nevertheless, not as I will, but as You will." Then He

came to the disciples and found them asleep, and said to Peter, "What? Could you not watch with Me one hour? Watch and pray, lest you enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak." Again, a second time, He went away and prayed, saying, "O My Father, if this cup cannot pass away from Me unless I drink it, Your will be done." And He came and found them asleep again, for their eyes were heavy. So He left them, went away again, and prayed the third time, saying the same words. Then He came to His disciples and said to them, "Are you still sleeping and resting? Behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of Man is being betrayed into the hands of sinners. Rise, let us be going. See, My betrayer is at hand."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 14:32-42

Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and said to the disciples, "Sit here while I go and pray over there."

And He took with Him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and He began to be sorrowful and deeply distressed. Then He said to them, "My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch with Me." He went a little farther and fell on His face, and prayed, saying, "O My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me; nevertheless, not as I will, but as You will." Then He came to the disciples and found them asleep, and said to Peter, "What? Could you not watch with Me one hour? Watch and pray, lest you enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak." Again, a second time, He went away and prayed, saying, "O My Father, if this cup cannot pass away from Me unless I drink it, Your will be done." And He came and found them asleep again, for their eyes were heavy. So He left them, went away again, and prayed the third time, saying the same words. Then He came to His disciples and said to them, "Are you still sleeping and resting? Behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of Man is being betrayed into the hands of sinners. Rise, let us be going. See, My betrayer is at hand."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 22:40-46

When He came to the place, He said to them, "Pray that you may not enter into temptation." And He was withdrawn from them about a stone's throw, and He knelt down and prayed, saying, "Father, if it is Your will, take this cup away from Me; nevertheless not My will, but Yours, be done." Then an angel appeared to Him from heaven, strengthening Him. And being in agony, He prayed more earnestly. Then His sweat became like great drops of blood falling down to the ground. When He rose up from prayer, and had come to His disciples, He found them sleeping from sorrow. Then He said to them, "Why do you sleep? Rise and pray, lest you enter into temptation."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 18: 3- 9

Then Judas, having received a detachment of troops, and officers from the chief priests and Pharisees, came there with lanterns, torches, and weapons. Jesus therefore, knowing all things that would come upon Him, went forward and said to them, "Whom are you seeking?" They answered Him, "Jesus of Nazareth." Jesus said to them, "I am He." And Judas, who betrayed Him, also stood with them. Now when He said to them, "I am He," they drew back and fell to the ground. Then He asked them again, "Whom are you seeking?" And they said, "Jesus of Nazareth." Jesus answered, "I have told you that I am He. Therefore, if you seek Me, let these go their way," that the saying might be fulfilled which He spoke, "Of those whom You gave Me I have lost none."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of the Sixth Hour of Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Our Savior came down Mount of Olives and went to Gethsemane with His disciples. Then He told His disciples to wait there and took Peter together with the two brothers, the sons of Zebedee. Then He started to pray for the sufferings. He said to them, “My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch with Me.” He went a little farther and fell on His face and prayed saying, “O My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me, nevertheless, not as I will but as You will.”

Then He came back to His disciples and found them asleep in great sadness. He awoke Peter and said to His disciples, “What could you not watch with Me one hour? Watch and pray lest you enter into temptation.” The second time, He prayed again that if it is at all possible to let the cup pass from Him. In the third time, He prayed again. Then He came to His disciples and said to them, “Are you still sleeping and resting? Behold the hour is at hand and the Son of Man is being betrayed into the hands of sinners. Rise, let us be going. See, My betrayer is at hand.

Woe to you Judas, more than anyone else, because your sins have multiplied as those of your parents. You have rejected the blessing and loved damnation. It will be with you unto the age of ages.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

NINTH HOUR OF EVE OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Jeremiah 9: 7- 11

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Therefore thus says the Lord of hosts: "Behold, I will refine them and try them; For how shall I deal with the daughter of My people? Their tongue is an arrow shot out; It speaks deceit; One speaks peaceably to his neighbor with his mouth, But in his heart he lies in wait. Shall I not punish them for these things?" says the Lord. "Shall I not avenge Myself on such a nation as this?"

I will take up a weeping and wailing for the mountains, And for the dwelling places of the wilderness a lamentation, Because they are burned up, So that no one can pass through; Nor can men hear the voice of the cattle. Both the birds of the heavens and the beasts have fled; They are gone. "I will make Jerusalem a heap of ruins, a den of jackals. I will make the cities of Judah desolate, without an inhabitant."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Ezekiel 21: 28- 32

**A reading from Ezekiel the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

And you, son of man, prophesy and say, 'Thus says the Lord God concerning the Ammonites and concerning their reproach,' and say: 'A sword, a sword is drawn, Polished for slaughter, For consuming, for flashing--While they see false visions for you, While they divine a lie to you, To bring you on the necks of the wicked, the slain Whose day has come, Whose iniquity shall end. 'Return it to it sheath. I will judge you In the place where you were created, In the land of your nativity. I will pour out My indignation on you; I will blow against you with the fire of My wrath, And deliver you into the hands of brutal men who are skillful to destroy. You shall be fuel for the fire; Your blood shall be in the midst of the land. You shall not be remembered, For I the Lord have spoken.'"

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour: of the Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

Psalm 28:3,4 & 35:4

From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us, Amen.

Who speak peace to their neighbors, But evil is in their hearts. Give them according to their deeds, And according to the wickedness of their endeavors. **Alleluia.**

Let those be put to shame and brought to dishonor who seek after my life; Let those be turned back and brought to confusion who plot my hurt. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 26: 47-58

And while He was still speaking, behold, Judas, one of the twelve, with a great multitude with swords and clubs, came from the chief priests and elders of the people. Now His betrayer had given them a sign, saying, "Whomever I kiss, He is the One; seize Him." Immediately he went up to Jesus and said, "Greetings, Rabbi!" and kissed Him. But Jesus said to him, "Friend, why have you come?" Then they came and laid hands on Jesus and took Him. And suddenly, one of those who were with Jesus stretched out his hand and drew his sword, struck the servant of the high priest, and cut off his ear. But Jesus said to him, "Put your sword in its place, for all who take the sword will perish by the sword. Or do you think that I cannot now pray to My Father, and He will provide Me with more than twelve legions of angels? How then could the Scriptures be fulfilled, that it must happen thus?"

In that hour Jesus said to the multitudes, "Have you come out, as against a robber, with swords and clubs to take Me? I sat daily with you, teaching in the temple, and you did not seize Me. But all this was done that the Scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled." Then all the disciples forsook Him and fled.

And those who had laid hold of Jesus led Him away to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders were assembled. But Peter followed Him at a distance to the high priest's courtyard. And he went in and sat with the servants to see the end.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 14: 43-54

And immediately, while He was still speaking, Judas, one of the twelve, with a great multitude with swords and clubs, came from the chief priests and the scribes and the elders. Now His betrayer had given them a signal, saying, "Whomever I kiss, He is the One; seize Him and lead Him away safely." As soon as He had come, immediately he went up to Him and said to Him, "Rabbi, Rabbi!" and kissed Him. Then they laid their hands on Him and took Him. And one of those who stood by drew his sword and struck the servant of the high priest, and cut off his ear.

Then Jesus answered and said to them, "Have you come out, as against a robber, with swords and clubs to take Me? I was daily with you in the temple teaching, and you did not seize Me. But the Scriptures must be fulfilled." Then they all forsook Him and fled. Now a certain young man followed Him, having a linen cloth thrown around his naked body. And the young men laid hold of him, and he left the linen cloth and fled from them naked.

And they led Jesus away to the high priest; and with him were assembled all the chief priests, the elders, and the scribes. But Peter followed Him at a distance, right into the courtyard of the high priest. And he sat with the servants and warmed himself at the fire.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 22:47-55

And while He was still speaking, behold, a multitude; and he who was called Judas, one of the twelve, went before them and drew near to Jesus to kiss Him. But Jesus said to him, "Judas, are you betraying the Son of Man with a kiss?" When those around Him saw what was going to happen, they said to Him, "Lord, shall we strike with the sword?" And one of them struck the servant of the high priest and cut off his right ear. But Jesus answered and said, "Permit even this." And He touched his ear and healed him.

Then Jesus said to the chief priests, captains of the temple, and the elders who had come to Him, "Have you come out, as against a robber, with swords and clubs? When I was with you daily in the temple, you did not try to seize Me. But this is your hour, and the power of darkness."

Having arrested Him, they led Him and brought Him into the high priest's house. But Peter followed at a distance. Now when they had kindled a fire in the midst of the courtyard and sat down together, Peter sat among them.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 18: 10- 14

Then Simon Peter, having a sword, drew it and struck the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus. So Jesus said to Peter, "Put your sword into the sheath. Shall I not drink the cup which My Father has given Me?"

Then the detachment of troops and the captain and the officers of the Jews arrested Jesus and bound Him. And they led Him away to Annas first, for he was the father-in-law of Caiaphas who was high priest that year. Now it was Caiaphas who advised the Jews that it was expedient that one man should die for the people.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Ninth Hour of the Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

And while He was speaking with His disciples concerning His suffering, one of the twelve, who is Judas, came accompanied with great multitude armed with swords and clubs, and soldiers from the chief priests and the scribes.

His betrayer, the contrary and full of transgressions, had given them a sign saying; “Whomever I kiss, He is the one. Seize Him.”

He immediately went up to Jesus and said to Him, “Peace Lord,” and kissed Him. Jesus said to him, “How could you have the audacity to deliver Me with a kiss?”

And suddenly, one of those who were with Jesus, stretched out his hand, drew his sword, and struck the servant of the high priest and cut off his ear. Then Jesus said to him, “Put your sword in its sheath, for all who take the sword, by the sword will perish. I could, if I want to, bring in hosts of angels to fight for Me.”

When the disciples saw this, they escaped and left Him alone with the multitudes. Then they led Him away to Caiaphas, the high priest, where the scribes and the elders were assembled. Peter followed Him, at a distance, to the high priest’s courtyard.

Woe to you Judas, for you have met a punishment without parallel and doomed damnation on yourself. Your lot will be with the corrupt.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF EVE OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Isaiah 27: 11- 28: 15

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

When its boughs are withered, they will be broken off; the women come and set them on fire. For it is a people of no understanding; Therefore He who made them will not have mercy on them, And He who formed them will show them no favor.

12 And it shall come to pass in that day That the Lord will thresh, From the channel of the River to the Brook of Egypt; And you will be gathered one by one, O you children of Israel. 13 So it shall be in that day: The great trumpet will be blown; they will come, who are about to perish in the land of Assyria, and they who are outcasts in the land of Egypt, And shall worship the Lord in the holy mount at Jerusalem.

Woe to the crown of pride, to the drunkards of Ephraim, Whose glorious beauty is a fading flower which is at the head of the verdant valleys, To those who are overcome with wine! 2 Behold, the Lord has a mighty and strong one, Like a tempest of hail and a destroying storm, Like a flood of mighty waters overflowing, Who will bring them down to the earth with His hand. 3 The crown of pride, the drunkards of Ephraim, Will be trampled underfoot; 4 And the glorious beauty is a fading flower Which is at the head of the verdant valley, Like the first fruit before the summer, Which an observer sees; He eats it up while it is still in his hand. 5 In that day the Lord of hosts will be For a crown of glory and a diadem of beauty To the remnant of His people, 6 For a spirit of justice to him who sits in judgment, And for strength to those who turn back the battle at the gate.

7 But they also have erred through wine, and through intoxicating drink are out of the way; The priest and the prophet have erred through intoxicating drink, they are swallowed up by wine, they are out of the way through intoxicating drink; They err in vision, they stumble in judgment. 8 For all tables are full of vomit and filth; No place is clean. 9 "Whom will he teach knowledge? And whom will he make to understand the message? Those just weaned from milk? Those just drawn from the breasts? 10 For precept must be upon precept, precept upon precept, Line upon line, line upon line, Here a little, there a little."

11 For with stammering lips and another tongue He will speak to this people, 12 To whom He said, "This is the rest with which you may cause the weary to rest," And, "This is the refreshing"; yet they would not hear. 13 But the

word of the Lord was to them, "Precept upon precept, precept upon precept, Line upon line, line upon line, Here a little, there a little," That they might go and fall backward, and be broken and snared and caught.

14 Therefore hear the word of the Lord, you scornful men, who rule this people who are in Jerusalem, 15 because you have said, "We have made a covenant with death, and with Sheol we are in agreement. When the overflowing scourge passes through, It will not come to us, for we have made lies our refuge, and under falsehood we have hidden ourselves."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour of the Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted *the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel* on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 2:1-2 & 4-5

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Why do the nations rage, And the people plot a vain thing? The kings of the earth set themselves, And the rulers take counsel together, Against the Lord and against His Anointed: **Alleluia.**

He who sits in the heavens shall laugh; The Lord shall hold them in derision. Then He shall speak to them in His wrath, And distress them in His deep displeasure: **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 26: 59- 75

Now the chief priests, the elders, and all the council sought false testimony against Jesus to put Him to death, but found none. Even though many false witnesses came forward, they found none. But at last two false witnesses came forward and said, "This fellow said, 'I am able to destroy the temple of God and to build it in three days.' " And the high priest arose and said to Him, "Do You answer nothing? What is it these men testify gainst You?" But Jesus kept silent. And the high priest answered and said to Him, "I put You under oath by the living God: Tell us if You are the Christ, the Son of God!" Jesus said to him, "It is as you said. Nevertheless, I say to you, hereafter you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of the Power, and coming on the clouds of heaven." Then the high priest tore his clothes, saying, "He has spoken blasphemy! What further need do we have of witnesses! Look, now you have heard His blasphemy! What do you think?" They answered and said, "He is deserving of death." Then they spat in His face and beat Him; and others struck Him with the palms of their hands, saying, "Prophecy to us, Christ! Who is the one who struck You?"

Now Peter sat outside in the courtyard. And a servant girl came to him, saying, "You also were with Jesus of Galilee." But he denied it before them all, saying, "I do not know what you are saying." And when he had gone out to the gateway, another girl saw him and said to those who were there, "This fellow also was with Jesus of Nazareth." But again he denied with an oath, "I do not know the Man!" And a little later those who stood by came up and said to Peter, "Surely you also are one of them, for your speech betrays you." Then he began to curse and swear, saying, "I do not know the Man!" Immediately a rooster crowed. And Peter remembered the word of Jesus who had said to him, "Before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times." So he went out and wept bitterly.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 14: 55- 72

Now the chief priests and all the council sought testimony against Jesus to put Him to death, but found none. For many bore false witness against Him, but their testimonies did not agree. Then some rose up and bore false witness against Him, saying, "We heard Him say, 'I will destroy this temple made with hands, and within three days I will build another made without hands.' " But not even then did their testimony agree. And the high priest stood up in the midst and asked Jesus, saying, "Do You answer nothing? What is it these men testify against You?" But He kept silent and answered nothing. Again the high priest asked Him, saying to Him, "Are You the Christ, the Son of the Blessed?" Jesus said, "I am. And you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of the Power, and coming with the clouds of heaven." Then the high priest tore his clothes and said, "What further need do we have of witnesses? You have heard the blasphemy! What do you think?" And they all condemned Him to be deserving of death. Then some began to spit on Him, and to blindfold Him, and to beat Him, and to say to Him, "Prophecy!" And the officers struck Him with the palms of their hands.

Now as Peter was below in the courtyard, one of the servant girls of the high priest came. And when she saw Peter warming himself, she looked at him and said, "You also were with Jesus of Nazareth." But he denied it, saying, "I neither know nor understand what you are saying." And he went out on the porch, and a rooster crowed. And the servant girl saw him again, and began to say to those who stood by, "This is one of them." But he denied it again.

And a little later those who stood by said to Peter again, "Surely you are one of them; for you are a Galilean, and your speech shows it." Then he began to curse and swear, "I do not know this Man of whom you speak!" A second time the rooster crowed. Then Peter called to mind the word that Jesus had said to him, "Before the rooster crows twice, you will deny Me three times." And when he thought about it, he wept.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 22: 56- 65

And a certain servant girl, seeing him as he sat by the fire, looked intently at him and said, "This man was also with Him." But he denied Him, saying, "Woman, I do not know Him." And after a little while another saw him and said, "You also are of them." But Peter said, "Man, I am not!" Then after about an hour had passed, another confidently affirmed, saying, "Surely this fellow also was with Him, for he is a Galilean." But

Peter said, "Man, I do not know what you are saying!" Immediately, while he was still speaking, the rooster crowed. And the Lord turned and looked at Peter. And Peter remembered the word of the Lord, how He had said to him, "Before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times." So Peter went out and wept bitterly. Now the men who held Jesus mocked

Him and beat Him. And having blindfolded Him, they struck Him on the face and asked Him, saying, "Prophecy! Who is the one who struck You?" And many other things they blasphemously spoke against Him.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 18: 15- 27

And Simon Peter followed Jesus, and so did another disciple. Now that disciple was known to the high priest, and went with Jesus into the courtyard of the high priest. But Peter stood at the door outside. Then the other disciple, who was known to the high priest, went out and spoke to her who kept the door, and brought Peter in. Then the servant girl who kept the door said to Peter, "You are not also one of this Man's disciples, are you?" He said, "I am not." Now the servants and officers who had made a fire of coals stood there, for it was cold, and they warmed themselves. And Peter stood with them and warmed himself.

The high priest then asked Jesus about His disciples and His doctrine. Jesus answered him, "I spoke openly to the world. I always taught in synagogues and in the temple, where the Jews always meet, and in secret I have said nothing. Why do you ask Me? Ask those who have heard Me what I said to them. Indeed they know what I said." And when He had said these things, one of the officers who stood by struck Jesus with the palm of his hand, saying, "Do You answer the high priest like that?" Jesus answered him, "If I have spoken evil, bear witness of the evil; but if well, why do you strike Me?" Then Annas sent Him bound to Caiaphas the high priest.

Now Simon Peter stood and warmed himself. Therefore they said to him, "You are not also one of His disciples, are you?" He denied it and said, "I am not!" One of the servants of the high priest, a relative of him whose ear Peter cut off, said, "Did I not see you in the garden with Him?" Peter then denied again; and immediately a rooster crowed.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Evening Hours, see page 34

The Exposition of The Eleventh Hour of the Eve of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Listen to David, the king of Jerusalem, rebuke her dwellers saying, “Why do the nations rage, and the peoples meditate on vain things?

The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers gather together against the Lord and against His anointed.” David knew by inspiration of the Holy Spirit what would happen to Jerusalem, which became a corrupt forum in the house of the high priest.

They sought a false testimony against Jesus so that they might condemn Him to death. Many testified against Him but only the testimony of two of them concurred. These testified that He said, “Destroy the temple and I will rebuild it in three days.” The high priest asked Him, “Why don’t You reply.

If You are the Son of God, tell the truth.” “You said it.” replied Jesus. The high priest rent his robes and said; “We don’t need any testimony. He has uttered blasphemy and we heard it.”

During all this, Simon Peter was standing outside by the fire, warming himself up. A maid came up to him and said, “You also were with Jesus the Galilean,” He denied it.

Then another maid saw him and said to him, “You are also a Galilean,” Peter replied, “Not I.” Then the third time, another said to him, “I saw you with Him in the garden.” Peter said; “I don’t know what you are talking about.”

When the rooster crowed, Peter became aware of what he did, He went outside and wept bitterly.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

THE LITANIES

EVENING LITANIES

The priest prays the Evening Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy without kneeling. see page 43

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

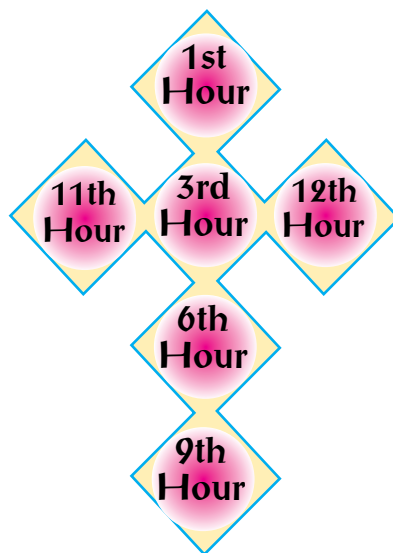
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CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



THE HOLY PASCHA OF GOOD FRIDAY DAY

FIRST HOUR OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Deuteronomy 8: 19- 9: 24

**A reading from the book of Deuteronomy of Moses the Prophet may
his blessings be with us, Amen.**

[Moses said to the Israelites,]

Testify against you this day that you shall surely perish. As the nations which the Lord destroys before you, so you shall perish, because you would not be obedient to the voice of the Lord your God.

"Hear, O Israel: You are to cross over the Jordan today, and go in to dispossess nations greater and mightier than yourself, cities great and fortified up to heaven, a people great and tall, the descendants of the Anakim, whom you know, and of whom you heard it said, 'Who can stand before the descendants of Anak?' Therefore understand today that the Lord your God is He who goes over before you as a consuming fire.

He will destroy them and bring them down before you; so you shall drive them out and destroy them quickly, as the Lord has said to you. Do not think in your heart, after the Lord your God has cast them out before you, saying, 'Because of my righteousness the Lord has brought me in to possess this land'; but it is because of the wickedness of these nations that the Lord is driving them out from before you. It is not because of your righteousness or the uprightness of your heart that you go in to possess their land, but because of the wickedness of these nations that the Lord your God drives them out from before you, and that He may fulfill the word which the Lord swore to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Therefore understand that the Lord your God is not giving you this good land to possess because of your righteousness, for you are a stiff-necked people.

"Remember. Do not forget how you provoked the Lord your God to wrath in the wilderness. From the day that you departed from the land of Egypt until you came to this place, you have been rebellious against the Lord. Also in Horeb you provoked the Lord to wrath, so that the Lord was angry enough with you to have destroyed you. When I went up into the mountain to receive the tablets of stone, the tablets of the covenant which the Lord made with you, then I stayed on the mountain forty days and forty nights. I neither ate bread nor drank water. Then the Lord delivered to me two tablets of stone written with the finger of God, and

on them were all the words which the Lord had spoken to you on the mountain from the midst of the fire in the day of the assembly. And it came to pass, at the end of forty days and forty nights, that the Lord gave me the two tablets of stone, the tablets of the covenant. Then the Lord said to me, 'Arise, go down quickly from here, for your people whom you brought out of Egypt have acted corruptly; they have quickly turned aside from the way which I commanded them; they have made themselves a molded image.' "Furthermore the Lord spoke to me, saying, 'I have seen this people, and indeed they are a stiff-necked people. Let Me alone, that I may destroy them and blot out their name from under heaven; and I will make of you a nation mightier and greater than they.' So I turned and came down from the mountain, and the mountain burned with fire; and the two tablets of the covenant were in my two hands.

And I looked, and behold, you had sinned against the Lord your God--had made for yourselves a molded calf! You had turned aside quickly from the way which the Lord had commanded you. Then I took the two tablets and threw them out of my two hands and broke them before your eyes. And I fell down before the Lord, as at the first, forty days and forty nights; I neither ate bread nor drank water, because of all your sin which you committed in doing wickedly in the sight of the Lord, to provoke Him to anger. For I was afraid of the anger and hot displeasure with which the Lord was angry with you, to destroy you. But the Lord listened to me

at that time also. And the Lord was very angry with Aaron and would have destroyed him; so I prayed for Aaron also at the same time. Then I took your sin, the calf which you had made, and burned it with fire and crushed it and ground it very small, until it was as fine as dust; and I threw its dust into the brook that descended from the mountain.

"Also at Taberah and Massah and Kibroth Hattaavah you provoked the Lord to wrath. Likewise, when the Lord sent you from Kadesh Barnea, saying, 'Go up and possess the land which I have given you,' then you rebelled against the commandment of the Lord your God, and you did not believe Him nor obey His voice. You have been rebellious against the Lord from the day that I knew you.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 1: 2- 9

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Hear, O heavens, and give ear, O earth! For the Lord has spoken: " I have nourished and brought up children, And they have rebelled against Me; The ox knows its owner And the donkey its master's crib; But Israel does not know, My people do not consider." Alas, sinful nation, A people laden with iniquity, A brood of evildoers, Children who are corrupters! They have forsaken the Lord, They have provoked to anger The Holy One of Israel, They have turned away backward. Why should you be stricken again? You will revolt more and more. The whole head is sick, And the whole heart faints. From the sole of the foot even to the head, There is no soundness in it, But wounds and bruises and putrefying sores; They have not been closed or bound up, Or soothed with ointment. Your country is desolate, Your cities are burned with fire; Strangers devour your land in your presence; And it is desolate, as overthrown by strangers. So the daughter of Zion is left as a booth in a vineyard, As a hut in a garden of cucumbers, As a besieged city. Unless the Lord of hosts Had left to us a very small remnant, We would have become like Sodom, We would have been made like Gomorrah.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 2:10-21

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

[Thus says the Lord,]

Enter into the rock, and hide in the dust, From the terror of the Lord
And the glory of His majesty. The lofty looks of man shall be
humbled, The haughtiness of men shall be bowed down, And the Lord
alone shall be exalted in that day.

For the day of the Lord of hosts Shall come upon everything proud and
lofty, Upon everything lifted up-- And it shall be brought low--Upon all
the cedars of Lebanon that are high and lifted up, And upon all the oaks of
Bashan; Upon all the high mountains, And upon all the hills that are lifted
up; Upon every high tower, And upon every fortified wall; Upon all the
ships of Tarshish, And upon all the beautiful sloops. The loftiness of man
shall be bowed down, And the haughtiness of men shall be brought low;
The Lord alone will be exalted in that day, But the idols He shall utterly
abolish. They shall go into the holes of the rocks, And into the caves of the
earth, From the terror of the Lord And the glory of His majesty, When
He arises to shake the earth mightily. In that day a man will cast away his
idols of silver And his idols of gold, Which they made, each for himself to
worship, To the moles and bats, To go into the clefts of the rocks, And into
the crags of the rugged rocks, From the terror of the Lord And the glory of
His majesty, When He arises to shake the earth mightily.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Jeremiah 22:29-23:6

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

O earth, earth, earth, Hear the word of the Lord! Thus says the Lord: 'Write this man down as childless, A man who shall not prosper in his days; For none of his descendants shall prosper, Sitting on the throne of David, And ruling anymore in Judah.' "

"Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of My pasture!" says the Lord. Therefore thus says the Lord God of Israel against the shepherds who feed My people: "You have scattered My flock, driven them away, and not attended to them. Behold, I will attend to you for the evil of your doings," says the Lord. "But I will gather the remnant of My flock out of all countries where I have driven them, and bring them back to their folds; and they shall be fruitful and increase. I will set up shepherds over them who will feed them; and they shall fear no more, nor be dismayed, nor shall they be lacking," says the Lord.

"Behold, the days are coming," says the Lord, "That I will raise to David a Branch of righteousness; A King shall reign and prosper, And execute

judgment and righteousness in the earth. In His days Judah will be saved,
And Israel will dwell safely.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

***Jeremiah 18:2-6, 20:3,6, 21:1**

Zechariah 11: 14

**A reading from Jeremiah & Zechariah the Prophets may his blessings be
with us, Amen.**

And Jeremiah said to Pashur, "You were resisting the truth for sometime with your father and your children who did sin worse than you. For they set a price to him who has no price, and grieved him who heals sickness and forgives sins. They took the price upon which the sons of Israel agreed, thirty pieces of silver. And gave it to the potter's house. As the Lord commanded me, so I say. The judgment of perdition will be upon them and their children forever, for they judged innocent blood.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

**This reading was taken from two prophecies: Jeremiah and Zechariah*

Isaiah 24:1-13

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Behold, the Lord makes the earth empty and makes it waste, Distorts its surface And scatters abroad its inhabitants. And it shall be: As with the people, so with the priest; As with the servant, so with his master; As with the maid, so with her mistress; As with the buyer, so with the seller; As with the lender, so with the borrower; As with the creditor, so with the debtor. The land shall be entirely emptied and utterly plundered, For the Lord has spoken this word. The earth mourns and fades away, The world languishes and fades away; The haughty people of the earth languish.

The earth is also defiled under its inhabitants, Because they have transgressed the laws, Changed the ordinance, Broken the everlasting covenant. Therefore the curse has devoured the earth, And those who dwell in it are desolate. Therefore the inhabitants of the earth are burned, And few men are left. The new wine fails, the vine languishes, All the merry-hearted sigh. The mirth of the tambourine ceases, The noise of the jubilant ends, The joy of the harp ceases. They shall not drink wine with a song; Strong drink is bitter to those who drink it. The city of confusion is broken down; Every house is shut up, so that none may go in. There is a cry for wine in the streets, All joy is darkened, The mirth of the land is gone. In the city desolation is left, And the gate is stricken with destruction. When it shall be thus in the midst of the land among the people, It shall be like the shaking of an olive tree.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Wisdom of Solomon 2: 12-22

A reading from the Wisdom of Solomon the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Let us lie in wait for the righteous man, because he is inconvenient to us and opposes our actions; he reproaches us for sins against the law, and accuses us of sins against our training. He professes to have knowledge of God, and calls himself a child of the Lord. He became to us a reproof of our thoughts; the very sight of him is a burden to us, because his manner of life is unlike that of others, and his ways are strange. We are considered by him as something base, and he avoids our ways as unclean; he calls the last end of the righteous happy, and boasts that God is his father. Let us see if his words are true, and let us test what will happen at the end of his life; for if the righteous man is God's child, he will help him, and will deliver him from the hand of his adversaries. Let us test him with insult and torture, so that we may find out how gentle he is, and make trial of his forbearance. Let us condemn him to a shameful death, for, according to what he says, he will be protected." Thus they reasoned, but they were led astray, for their wickedness blinded them, and they did not know the secret purposes of God, nor hoped for the wages of holiness, nor discerned the prize for blameless souls.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Job 12:17-13:1

**A reading from Job the righteous may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

He leads counselors away plundered, And makes fools of the judges.
He loosens the bonds of kings, And binds their waist with a belt.
He leads princes away plundered, And overthrows the mighty. He deprives
the trusted ones of speech, And takes away the discernment of the elders.
He pours contempt on princes, And disarms the mighty. He uncovers deep
things out of darkness, And brings the shadow of death to light. He makes
nations great, and destroys them; He enlarges nations, and guides them.
He takes away the understanding of the chiefs of the people of the earth,
And makes them wander in a pathless wilderness. They grope in the dark
without light, And He makes them stagger like a drunken man. "Behold,
my eye has seen all this, My ear has heard and understood it.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Zechariah 11: 11-14

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

So it was broken on that day. Thus the poor of the flock, who were watching me, knew that it was the word of the Lord. Then I said to them, "If it is agreeable to you, give me my wages; and if not, refrain." So they weighed out for my wages thirty pieces of silver. And the Lord said to me, "Throw it to the potter"--that princely price they set on me. So I took the thirty pieces of silver and threw them into the house of the Lord for the potter. Then I cut in two my other staff, Bonds, that I might break the brotherhood between Judah and Israel.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

***Micah 1:16-2:3**

**A reading from Micah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Make yourself bald and cut off your hair, Because of your precious children; Enlarge your baldness like an eagle, For they shall go from you into captivity. Woe to those who devise iniquity, And work out evil on their beds! At morning light they practice it, Because it is in the power of their hand. They covet fields and take them by violence, Also houses, and seize them. So they oppress a man and his house, A man and his inheritance. Therefore thus says the Lord: "Behold, against this family I am devising disaster, From which you cannot remove your necks; Nor shall you walk haughtily, For this is an evil time.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

**This reading does not exist in some books*

Micah 7: 1- 8

**A reading from Micah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Woe is me! For I am like those who gather summer fruits, Like those who glean vintage grapes; There is no cluster to eat Of the first-ripe fruit which my soul desires. The faithful man has perished from the earth, And there is no one upright among men. They all lie in wait for blood; Every man hunts his brother with a net. That they may successfully do evil with both hands-- The prince asks for gifts, The judge seeks a bribe, And the great man utters his evil desire; So they scheme together. The best of them is like a brier; The most upright is sharper than a thorn hedge; The day of your watchman and your punishment comes; Now shall be their perplexity.

Do not trust in a friend; Do not put your confidence in a companion; Guard the doors of your mouth From her who lies in your bosom. For son dishonors father, Daughter rises against her mother, Daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law; A man's enemies are the men of his own household.

Therefore I will look to the Lord; I will wait for the God of my salvation; My God will hear me. Do not rejoice over me, my enemy; When I fall, I will arise; When I sit in darkness, The Lord will be a light to me.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba St. John Chrysostom, may his blessings be with us. Amen.

Beloved brethren, what can we say about the transgression of Judas who has delivered his Master. It was said that one of the twelve, who is Judas Iscariot went to the chief priests and said to them; "How much do you want to pay and I will deliver Him to you? They bargained to pay him thirty pieces of silver." What great foolishness; rather, what a great infatuation with silver, which is the source of all evil. For when he desired it, he sold his good teacher and righteous master, thus, bringing destruction upon himself. How awful is the love of money. It invited every evil and is worse than Satan's manipulation. If the love of money possesses someone, it renders him captivated by it. They can no longer fathom themselves nor others. They will reject nature's laws and become anxious at heart. See how many blessings the love of silver took away from Judas, yet Christ was talking to them openly about the comforts of the kingdom of heaven and the horrors of hell. Everyone of them knew how terrible it would be, the sufferings of sinners would be. Christ also honored all those who strived for their soul's salvation.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba St. John Chrysostom who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

THE PAULINE EPISTLE

1 Corinthians 1:23-2:5

A reading from the First Epistle of our teacher Paul to the Corinthians. May his blessing be with us. Amen.

But we preach Christ crucified, to the Jews a stumbling block and to the Greeks foolishness, but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the power of God and the wisdom of God. Because the foolishness of God is wiser than men, and the weakness of God is stronger than men.

For you see your calling, brethren, that not many wise according to the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, are called. But God has chosen the foolish things of the world to put to shame the wise, and God has chosen the weak things of the world to put to shame the things which are mighty; and the base things of the world and the things which are despised God has chosen, and the things which are not, to bring to nothing the things that are, that no flesh should glory in His presence. But of Him you are in Christ Jesus, who became for us wisdom from God--and righteousness and sanctification and redemption-- that, as it is written, "He who glories, let him glory in the Lord."

And I, brethren, when I came to you, did not come with excellence of speech or of wisdom declaring to you the testimony of God. For I

determined not to know anything among you except Jesus Christ and Him crucified. I was with you in weakness, in fear, and in much trembling. And my speech and my preaching were not with persuasive words of human wisdom, but in demonstration of the Spirit and of power, that your faith should not be in the wisdom of men but in the power of God.

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

The Doxology of the First Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 27: 12 & 35:11, 12, 16

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

For false witnesses have risen against me, And such as breathe out violence. Fierce witnesses rise up; They ask me things that I do not know. They reward me evil for good; They gnashed at me with their teeth.
Alleluia.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 27:1-14

When morning came, all the chief priests and elders of the people plotted against Jesus to put Him to death. And when they had bound Him, they led Him away and delivered Him to Pontius Pilate the governor.

Then Judas, His betrayer, seeing that He had been condemned, was remorseful and brought back the thirty pieces of silver to the chief priests and elders, saying, "I have sinned by betraying innocent blood." And they said, "What is that to us? You see to it!" Then he threw down the pieces of silver in the temple and departed, and went and hanged himself. But the chief priests took the silver pieces and said, "It is not lawful to put them into the treasury, because they are the price of blood." And they consulted together and bought with them the potter's field, to bury strangers in. Therefore that field has been called the Field of Blood to this day. Then was fulfilled what was spoken by Jeremiah the prophet, saying, "And they took the thirty pieces of silver, the value of Him who was priced, whom they of the children of Israel priced, and gave them for the potter's field, as the Lord directed me."

Now Jesus stood before the governor. And the governor asked Him, saying, "Are

You the King of the Jews!" So Jesus said to him, "It is as you say." And while He was being accused by the chief priests and elders, He answered nothing. Then Pilate said to Him, "Do You not hear how many things they testify against You!" But He answered him not one word, so that the governor marveled greatly.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 15: 1- 5

Immediately, in the morning, the chief priests held a consultation with the elders and scribes and the whole council; and they bound Jesus, led Him away, and delivered Him to Pilate.

Then Pilate asked Him, "Are You the King of the Jews?" He answered and said to him, "It is as you say." And the chief priests accused Him of many things, but He answered nothing. Then Pilate asked Him again, saying, "Do You answer nothing? See how many things they testify against You!" But Jesus still answered nothing, so that Pilate marveled.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 22: 66 - 23: 12

As soon as it was day, the elders of the people, both chief priests and scribes, came together and led Him into their council, saying, "If You are the Christ, tell us." But He said to them, "If I tell you, you will by no means believe. And if I also ask you, you will by no means answer Me or let Me go. Hereafter the Son of Man will sit on the right hand of the power of God." Then they all said, "Are You then the Son of God?" So He said to them, "You rightly say that I am." And they said, "What further testimony do we need? For we have heard it ourselves from His own mouth."

Then the whole multitude of them arose and led Him to Pilate. And they began to accuse Him, saying, "We found this fellow perverting the nation, and forbidding to pay taxes to Caesar, saying that He Himself is Christ, a King." Then Pilate asked Him, saying, "Are You the King of the Jews?" He

answered him and said, "It is as you say." So Pilate said to the chief priests and the crowd, "I find no fault in this Man." But they were the more fierce, saying, "He stirs up the people, teaching throughout all Judea, beginning from Galilee to this place." When Pilate heard of Galilee, he asked if the Man were a Galilean. And as soon as he knew that He belonged to Herod's jurisdiction, he sent Him to Herod, who was also in Jerusalem at that time.

Now when Herod saw Jesus, he was exceedingly glad; for he had desired for a long time to see Him, because he had heard many things about Him, and he hoped to see some miracle done by Him. Then he questioned Him with many words, but He answered him nothing. And the chief priests and scribes stood and vehemently accused Him. Then Herod, with his men of war, treated Him with contempt and mocked Him, arrayed Him in a gorgeous robe, and sent Him back to Pilate. That very day Pilate and Herod became friends with each other, for previously they had been at enmity with each other.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 18: 28- 40

Then they led Jesus from Caiaphas to the Praetorium, and it was early morning. But they themselves did not go into the Praetorium, lest they should be defiled, but that they might eat the Passover. Pilate then went out to them and said, "What accusation do you bring against this Man?" They answered and said to him, "If He were not an evildoer, we would not have delivered Him up to you." Then Pilate said to them, "You take Him and judge Him according to your law." Therefore the Jews said to him, "It is not lawful for us to put anyone to death," that the saying of Jesus might be fulfilled which He spoke, signifying by what death He would die.

Then Pilate entered the Praetorium again, called Jesus, and said to Him, "Are You the King of the Jews?" Jesus answered him, "Are you speaking for yourself about this, or did others tell you this concerning Me?" Pilate answered, "Am I a Jew? Your own nation and the chief priests have delivered You to me. What have You done?" Jesus answered, "My kingdom is not of this world. If My kingdom were of this world, My servants would fight, so that I should not be delivered to the Jews; but now My kingdom is not from

here." Pilate therefore said to Him, "Are You a king then?" Jesus answered, "You say rightly that I am a king. For this cause I was born, and for this cause I have come into the world, that I should bear witness to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth hears My voice." Pilate said to Him, "What is truth?" And when he had said this, he went out again to the Jews, and said to them, "I find no fault in Him at all. "But you have a custom that I should release someone to you at the Passover. Do you therefore want me to release to you the King of the Jews?" Then they all cried again, saying, "Not this Man, but Barabbas!" Now Barabbas was a robber.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the First Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Early on Friday, the chief priests convened together and condemned the Savior so that they may deliver Him to Pilate to kill Him. When he saw what he did, Judas regretted what he did and returned the silver to the chief priests saying, “I have sinned in betraying innocent blood.” He went and hung himself adding a transgression to a transgressions. The chief priests took the silver and bought with it a potter’s field to bury strangers in. So that it may be fulfilled what had been spoken about the 30 pieces of Silver; the price of the Precious One.

They stood Jesus before Pilate, who asked Him, “Are you a king?” Jesus replied, “You have said so.” They accused Him a lot but He gave no answer. “Do you hear all this testimony?” Pilate asked. He did not open His mouth to utter a word. The governor wondered greatly at His calmness and silence.

How can the Lamb who came to take away the sins of the world open His mouth? Isaiah’s prophesied about Him saying; “By oppression and judgment He was taken away. O Jerusalem, you killer of prophets, your dwellers will weep for you today.” He is not a prophet but God, and His blood wips off the sins.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Exposition
12th Hour

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

THIRD HOUR OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Genesis 48: 1- 19

A reading from the book of Genesis of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Now it came to pass after these things that Joseph was told, "Indeed your father is sick"; and he took with him his two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim. And Jacob was told, "Look, your son Joseph is coming to you"; and Israel strengthened himself and sat up on the bed.

Then Jacob said to Joseph: "God Almighty appeared to me at Luz in the land of Canaan and blessed me, and said to me, 'Behold, I will make you fruitful and multiply you, and I will make of you a multitude of people, and give this land to your descendants after you as an everlasting possession.' And now your two sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, who were born to you in the land of Egypt before I came to you in Egypt, are mine; as Reuben and Simeon, they shall be mine. Your offspring whom you beget after

them shall be yours; they will be called by the name of their brothers in their inheritance. But as for me, when I came from Padan, Rachel died beside me in the land of Canaan on the way, when there was but a little distance to go to Ephrath; and I buried her there on the way to Ephrath (that is, Bethlehem)."

Then Israel saw Joseph's sons, and said, "Who are these?" And Joseph said to his father, "They are my sons, whom God has given me in this place." And he said, "Please bring them to me, and I will bless them." Now the eyes of Israel were dim with age, so that he could not see. Then Joseph brought them near him, and he kissed them and embraced them. And Israel said to Joseph, "I had not thought to see your face; but in fact, God has also shown me your offspring!" So Joseph brought them from beside his knees, and he bowed down with his face to the earth.

And Joseph took them both, Ephraim with his right hand toward Israel's left hand, and Manasseh with his left hand toward Israel's right hand, and brought them near him. Then Israel stretched out his right hand and laid it on Ephraim's head, who was the younger, and his left hand on Manasseh's head, guiding his hands knowingly, for Manasseh was the firstborn. And he blessed Joseph, and said: "God, before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac walked, The God who has fed me all my life long to this day, The Angel who has redeemed me from all evil, Bless the lads; Let my name be named upon them, And the name of my fathers Abraham and Isaac; And let them grow into a multitude in the midst of the earth."

Now when Joseph saw that his father laid his right hand on the head of Ephraim, it displeased him; so he took hold of his father's hand to remove it from Ephraim's head to Manasseh's head. And Joseph said to his father, "Not so, my father, for this one is the firstborn; put your right hand on his head." But his father refused and said, "I know, my son, I know.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 50: 4- 9

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

The Lord God has given Me The tongue of the learned, That I should know how to speak A word in season to him who is weary. He awakens Me morning by morning, He awakens My ear To hear as the learned. The Lord God has opened My ear; And I was not rebellious, Nor did I turn away. I gave My back to those who struck Me, And My cheeks to those who plucked out the beard; I did not hide My face from shame and spitting.

"For the Lord God will help Me; Therefore I will not be disgraced; Therefore I have set My face like a flint, And I know that I will not be

ashamed. He is near who justifies Me; Who will contend with Me? Let us stand together. Who is My adversary? Let him come near Me. Surely the Lord God will help Me; Who is he who will condemn Me? Indeed they will all grow old like a garment; The moth will eat them up.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 3: 9- 15

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Woe to their soul, for they have devised an evil counsel against themselves, saying against themselves, Let us bind the just, for he is burdensome to us; therefore shall they eat the fruits of their works. Woe to the transgressor! Evils shall happen to him according to the works of his hands. O My people, your exactors strip you, and extortioners rule over you; O My people, they that pronounce you blessed lead you astray, and pervert the path of your feet.

But now the Lord will stand up for judgment, and will enter into judgment with His people. The Lord Himself shall enter into judgment with the elders of the people, and with their rulers; but why have you set My

vineyard on fire, and why is the spoil of the poor in your houses? Why do you wrong My people, and shame the face of the poor?

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 63: 1- 7

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Who is this who comes from Edom, With dyed garments from Bozrah, This One who is glorious in His apparel, Traveling in the greatness of His strength!-- "I who speak in righteousness, mighty to save." Why is Your apparel red, And Your garments like one who treads in the winepress? I have trodden the winepress alone, And from the peoples no one was with Me. For I have trodden them in My anger, And trampled them in My fury; Their blood is sprinkled upon My garments, And I have stained all My robes. For the day of vengeance is in My heart, And the year of My redeemed has come. I looked, but there was no one to help, And I wondered That there was no one to uphold; Therefore My own arm brought salvation for Me; And My own fury, it sustained Me. I have trodden down the peoples in My anger, Made them drunk in My fury, And brought down their strength to the earth."

I will mention the loving kindnesses of the Lord And the praises of the Lord, According to all that the Lord has bestowed on us.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Amos 9:4-5,7-10

**A reading from Amos the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

[The Lord, the Almighty says,]

I will set My eyes on them for harm and not for good." The Lord God of hosts, He who touches the earth and it melts, And all who dwell there mourn; All of it shall swell like the River, And subside like the River of Egypt.

"Behold, the eyes of the Lord God are on the sinful kingdom, And I will destroy it from the face of the earth; Yet I will not utterly destroy the house of Jacob," Says the Lord. "For surely I will command, And will sift the house of Israel among all nations, As grain is sifted in a sieve; Yet not the smallest grain shall fall to the ground. All the sinners of My people shall die by the sword, Who say, 'The calamity shall not overtake nor confront us.'

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Job 29: 21-25, 30: 1-10

**A reading from Job the righteous, may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

When listened to me and waited, And kept silence for my counsel.
After my words they did not speak again, And my speech settled
on them as dew. They waited for me as for the rain, And they opened
their mouth wide as for the spring rain. If I mocked at them, they did not
believe it, And the light of my countenance they did not cast down. I
chose the way for them, and sat as chief; So I dwelt as a king in the army,
As one who comforts mourners.

"But now they mock at me, men younger than I, Whose fathers I disdained
to put with the dogs of my flock. Indeed, what profit is the strength of their
hands to me? Their vigor has perished. They are gaunt from want and
famine, Fleeing late to the wilderness, desolate and waste, Who pluck
mallow by the bushes, And broom tree roots for their food. They were
driven out from among men, They shouted at them as at a thief. They
had to live in the clefts of the valleys, In caves of the earth and the rocks.
Among the bushes they brayed, Under the nettles they nestled. They were
sons of fools, Yes, sons of vile men; They were scourged from the land.

"And now I am their taunting song; Yes, I am their byword. They abhor
me, they keep far from me; They do not hesitate to spit in my face.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Athanasius the Apostolic may his blessings be with us. Amen.

For Christ Himself came and died for us because of His love. For He did not only create us, who are sinners like Adam, but when we destroyed ourselves with sin, He came and suffered for us and revived us through His love. He came to us as a Physician manifesting Himself to us. He did not come to us who are sick but who are dead. Therefore He did not heal us, who are sick, but raised us from death that swallowed us. He freed us from its bonds. Christ the Lord died for us so that we may have life with Him forever. If the Lord did not share the human being in its sufferings, how would He save man? Death had fallen underneath the feet of Christ and was defeated and captured confusingly. Hades in its power was overcome when it heard the voice of the Lord calling the souls saying: Come out of your bonds, you who sit in darkness and in the shadows of death. Come out of your bonds, I give you life for I am the Christ, the Son of the Eternal God.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Athanasius the Apostolic who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

THE PAULINE EPISTLE

Colossians 2: 13- 15

A reading from the Epistle of our teacher Paul to the Colossians. May his blessing be with us. Amen.

And you, being dead in your sins and the uncircumcision of your flesh, has he made alive together with him, having forgiven you all trespasses; Blotting out the handwriting of ordinances that was against us, which was contrary to us, and took it out of the way, nailing it to his cross; And having spoiled principalities and powers, he made a show of them openly, triumphing over them in it.

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

The Doxology of the Third Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 38: 17& 22: 16

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

For I am ready to fall, And my sorrow is continually before me. For dogs have surrounded Me; The congregation of the wicked has enclosed Me. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 27:15-26

Now at the feast the governor was accustomed to releasing to the multitude one prisoner whom they wished. And at that time they had a notorious prisoner called Barabbas. Therefore, when they had gathered together, Pilate said to them, "Whom do you want me to release to you? Barabbas, or Jesus who is called Christ?" For he knew that they had handed Him over because of envy. While he was sitting on the judgment seat, his wife sent to him, saying, "Have nothing to do with that just Man, for I have suffered many things today in a dream because of Him." But the chief priests and elders persuaded the multitudes that they should ask for Barabbas and destroy Jesus. The governor answered and said to them, "Which of the two do you want me to release to you?" They said, "Barabbas!" Pilate said to them, "What then shall I do with Jesus who is called Christ?" They all said to him, "Let Him be crucified!" Then the governor said, "Why, what evil has He done?" But they cried out all the more, saying, "Let Him be crucified!" When Pilate saw that he could not prevail at all, but rather that a tumult was rising, he took water and washed his hands before the multitude, saying, "I am innocent of the blood of this just Person. You see to it."

And all the people answered and said, "His blood is on us and on our children." Then he released Barabbas to them; and when he had scourged Jesus, he delivered Him to be crucified.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 15: 6- 25

Now at the feast he was accustomed to releasing one prisoner to them, whomever they requested. And there was one named Barabbas, who was chained with his fellow rebels; they had committed murder in the rebellion. Then the multitude, crying aloud, began to ask him to do just as he had always done for them. But Pilate answered them, saying, "Do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?" For he knew that the chief priests had handed Him over because of envy. But the chief priests stirred up the crowd, so that he should rather release Barabbas to them. Pilate answered and said to them again, "What then do you want me to do

with Him whom you call the King of the Jews!" So they cried out again, "Crucify Him!" Then Pilate said to them, "Why, what evil has He done?" But they cried out all the more, "Crucify Him!" So Pilate, wanting to gratify the crowd, released Barabbas to them; and he delivered Jesus, after he had scourged Him, to be crucified.

Then the soldiers led Him away into the hall called Praetorium, and they called together the whole garrison. And they clothed Him with purple; and they twisted a crown of thorns, put it on His head, and began to salute Him, "Hail, King of the Jews!" Then they struck Him on the head with a reed and spat on Him; and bowing the knee, they worshiped Him. And when they had mocked Him, they took the purple off Him, put His own clothes on Him, and led Him out to crucify Him. Then they compelled a certain man, Simon a Cyrenian, the father of Alexander and Rufus, as he was coming out of the country and passing by, to bear His cross.

And they brought Him to the place Golgotha, which is translated, Place of a Skull. Then they gave Him wine mingled with myrrh to drink, but He did not take it. And when they crucified Him, they divided His garments, casting lots for them to determine what every man should take. Now it was the third hour, and they crucified Him.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 23: 13-25

Then Pilate, when he had called together the chief priests, the rulers, and the people, said to them, "You have brought this Man to me, as one who misleads the people. And indeed, having examined Him in your presence, I have found no fault in this Man concerning those things of which you accuse Him; no, neither did Herod, for I sent you back to him; and indeed nothing deserving of death has been done by Him. I will therefore chastise Him and release Him" for it was necessary for him to release one to them at the feast. And they all cried out at once, saying, "Away with this Man, and release to us Barabbas"-who had been thrown into prison for a certain rebellion made in the city, and for murder. Pilate, therefore, wishing to release Jesus, again called out to them. But they shouted, saying, "Crucify Him, crucify Him!" Then he said to them the third time, "Why, what evil has He done? I have found no reason for death in Him. I will therefore chastise Him and let Him go." But they were insistent, demanding with loud voices that He be crucified. And the voices of these men and of the chief priests prevailed. So Pilate gave sentence that it should be as they requested. And he released to them the

one they requested, who for rebellion and murder had been thrown into prison; but he delivered Jesus to their will.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 19: 1-12

So then Pilate took Jesus and scourged Him. And the soldiers twisted a crown of thorns and put it on His head, and they put on Him a purple robe. Then they said, "Hail, King of the Jews!" And they struck Him with their hands. Pilate then went again, and said to them, "Behold, I am bringing Him out to you, that you may know that I find no fault in Him." Then Jesus came out, wearing the crown of thorns and the purple robe. And Pilate said to them, "Behold the Man!" Therefore, when the chief priests and officers saw Him, they cried out, saying, "Crucify Him, crucify Him!" Pilate said to them, "You take Him and crucify Him, for I find no fault in Him." The Jews answered him, "We have a law, and according to our law He ought to die,

because He made Himself the Son of God." Therefore, when Pilate heard that saying, he was the more afraid, and went again into the Praetorium, and said to Jesus, "Where are You from?" But Jesus gave him no answer. Then Pilate said to Him, "Are You not speaking to me? Do You not know that I have power to crucify You, and power to release You?" Jesus answered, "You could have no power at all against Me unless it had been given you from above. Therefore the one who delivered Me to you has the greater sin." From then on Pilate sought to release Him, but the Jews cried out, saying, "If you let this Man go, you are not Caesar's friend. Whoever makes himself a king speaks against Caesar."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the Third Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

I am baffled with this great prophet Isaiah. He has seen by inspiration the passions of the Savior who is the Word of God. He said, “Who is He who comes from Adam, his cloth are red, and He is dressed in a magnificent robe and His mantle is from red blood as one who comes up from the press, and his clothes are stained by the blood of its vines.”

Truly these are the words of this prophet who revealed this before these days. Truly, He is the Word of God, our Savior Jesus. He wore the old flesh of Adam, the first creation. The sublime Divinity united with humanity.

An immutable mantle united with God the Word. He inflicted His wrath on the Jews and trampled over them in the press of His anger. He granted His mercy and grace to the Gentiles whom He made a new people. As for Israel, his foolishness will prevail on him forever.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Exposition
12th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

SIXTH HOUR OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Numbers 21: 1- 9

A reading from the book of Numbers of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

The king of Arad, the Canaanite, who dwelt in the South, heard that Israel was coming on the road to Atharim, then he fought against Israel and took some of them prisoners. So Israel made a vow to the Lord, and said, "If You will indeed deliver this people into my hand, then I will utterly destroy their cities." And the Lord listened to the voice of Israel and delivered up the Canaanites, and they utterly destroyed them and their cities. So the name of that place was called Hormah.

Then they journeyed from Mount Hor by the Way of the Red Sea, to go around the land of Edom; and the soul of the people became very discouraged on the way. And the people spoke against God and against Moses: "Why have you brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness?

For there is no food and no water, and our soul loathes this worthless bread." So the Lord sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and many of the people of Israel died. Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, "We have sinned, for we have spoken against the Lord and against you; pray to the Lord that He take away the serpents from us." So Moses prayed for the people. Then the Lord said to Moses, "Make a fiery serpent, and set it on a pole; and it shall be that everyone who is bitten, when he looks at it, shall live." So Moses made a bronze serpent, and put it on a pole; and so it was, if a serpent had bitten anyone, when he looked at the bronze serpent, he lived.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 53: 7- 12

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

He was led as a lamb to the slaughter, And as a sheep before its shearers is silent, So He opened not His mouth. He was taken from prison and from judgment, And who will declare His generation? For He was cut off from the land of the living; For the transgressions of My people He was stricken. And they made His grave with the wicked-- But with the rich at His death, Because He had done no violence, Nor was any deceit in His mouth.

Yet it pleased the Lord to bruise Him; He has put Him to grief. When You make His soul an offering for sin, He shall see His seed, He shall prolong His days, And the pleasure of the Lord shall prosper in His hand. He shall see the labor of His soul, and be satisfied. By His knowledge My righteous Servant shall justify many, For He shall bear their iniquities. Therefore I will divide Him a portion with the great, And He shall divide the spoil with the strong, Because He poured out His soul unto death, And He was numbered with the transgressors, And He bore the sin of many, And made intercession for the transgressors.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Isaiah 12: 2 - 13:10

**Also a reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Behold, God is my salvation, I will trust and not be afraid; 'For Yah, the Lord, is my strength and song; He also has become my salvation.' "Therefore with joy you will draw water From the wells of salvation. And in that day you will say: "Praise the Lord, call upon His name; Declare His deeds among the peoples, Make mention that His name is exalted. Sing to the Lord, For He has done excellent things; This is known in all the earth. Cry out and shout, O inhabitant of Zion, For great is the Holy One of Israel in your midst!"

"Lift up a banner on the high mountain, Raise your voice to them; Wave your hand, that they may enter the gates of the nobles. I have commanded My sanctified ones; I have also called My mighty ones for My anger-- Those who rejoice in My exaltation." The noise of a multitude in the mountains, Like that of many people! A tumultuous noise of the kingdoms of nations gathered together! The Lord of hosts musters The army for battle. They come from a far country, From the end of heaven-- The Lord and His weapons of indignation, To destroy the whole land.

Wail, for the day of the Lord is at hand! It will come as destruction from the Almighty. Therefore all hands will be limp, Every man's heart will melt, And they will be afraid. Pangs and sorrows will take hold of them; They will be in pain as a woman in childbirth; They will be amazed at one another; Their faces will be like flames.

Behold, the day of the Lord comes, Cruel, with both wrath and fierce anger, To lay the land desolate; And He will destroy its sinners from it. For the stars of heaven and their constellations Will not give their light; The sun will be darkened in its going forth, And the moon will not cause its light to shine.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Amos 8: 9- 12

**A reading from Amos the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

And it shall come to pass in that day," says the Lord God, "That I will make the sun go down at noon, And I will darken the earth in broad daylight; I will turn your feasts into mourning, And all your songs into lamentation; I will bring sackcloth on every waist, And baldness on every head; I will make it like mourning for an only son, And its end like a bitter day.

"Behold, the days are coming," says the Lord God, "That I will send a famine on the land, Not a famine of bread, Nor a thirst for water, But of hearing the words of the Lord. They shall wander from sea to sea, And from north to east; They shall run to and fro, seeking the word of the Lord, But shall not find it.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Sixth Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

- ✠ The candles are lighted before the icon of the crucifix. The priests uncover their heads, and offer incense before the icon three times.
- ✠ While offering incense, the priest prays the following inaudibly,

Priest:

First time:

We worship You, O Christ, and Your life-giving cross, that You were crucified on to deliver us from our sins.

Second time:

O my Lord Jesus Christ, who was crucified on the cross, trample down Satan under our feet.

Third time:

Hail to the cross, that Christ our King was crucified on, to deliver us from our sins.

Meanwhile, the congregation chant:

- ✠ This censer of pure gold, (Ταυροῦρη)
- ✠ This is He who offered himself, (Φαί ἐταρῆν ἐπὶ ὧνι)
- ✠ they ended with We worship you (Τενοῦωτ ὡωοκ)
- ✠ The pauline introduction hymn (Ἰεπιστολὴ ἡ τε πενταδ)

HYMN OF THE CENSER (LONG TUNE)

Congregation:

This censer of pure gold, bearing the aroma, is in the hands of Aaron the priest, offering up incense upon the altar.

HYMN OF THE CROSS

Congregation:

This is He who presented himself on the cross; an acceptable sacrifice for the salvation of our race.

His good Father inhaled His sweet aroma in the evening on Golgotha.

We worship you: O Christ with Your good Father and the Holy Spirit: for You have crucified and save us. (have mercy on us).

INTRODUCTION TO THE PAULINE EPISTLE

Congregation:

An epistle of our teacher St. Paul, may his holy blessing be with us. Amen.

Paul, the servant of our LORD Jesus Christ, called to be an apostle, appointed to the Gospel of God.

And they conclude with “The grace of God” . Then read the Pauline Epistle.

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

THE PAULINE EPISTLE

Galatians 6:14- 18

A reading from the Epistle of our teacher Paul to the Galatians. May his blessing be with us. Amen.

But God forbid that I should boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world. For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision nor uncircumcision avails anything, but a new creation. And as many as walk according to this rule, peace and mercy be upon them, and upon the Israel of God. From now on let no one trouble me, for I bear in my body the marks of the Lord Jesus. Brethren, the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Amen.

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

THE SIXTH HOUR LITANIES

THE REFRAIN

O You, Who on the sixth day and in the sixth hour was nailed to the cross, for the sin which our father Adam dared to commit in Paradise, tear the handwriting of our sins, O Christ our God, and save us.

Priest:

O You, Who on the sixth day and in the sixth hour was nailed to the cross, for the sin which our father Adam dared to commit in Paradise, tear the handwriting of our sins, O Christ our God, and save us.

The congregation replies with the refrain

Priest:

I cried to the Lord and He heard me. God hear my prayer, and do not refuse my petition. Be attentive to me and hear me.

The congregation replies with the refrain

Priest:

In the evening, in the morning, and at midday. I say my words, and He hears my voice and delivers my soul in peace.

Congregation:

Glory be to the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit

Priest:

O Jesus Christ, our God, who was nailed to the cross in the sixth hour, and killed sin by the tree, and by Your death You made alive the dead man, whom You created with Your own hands, and had died in sin. Put to death our pains by Your healing and life-giving passions, and by the nails with which You were nailed. Rescue our minds from thoughtlessness of the earthly deeds and worldly lusts, to the remembrance of Your heavenly commandments, according to Your compassion.

Congregation:

Now and forever and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Priest:

Since we have no favor, excuse, nor justification, because of our many sins, O Theotokos, the Mother of God, we plead through you to Him who was born of you, for your intercession is abundant, powerful, and acceptable to our Savior. O pure Mother, do not exclude us, sinners, from your intercession with Him who was born of you; for He is merciful and able to save us, because He suffered for our sake in order to deliver us. O Lord, let Your compassion reach us quickly, for we sincerely humbled ourselves. Help us, O God our Savior, for the sake of Your glorious name. O Lord, deliver us and forgive us our sins, for the sake of Your holy name.

Congregation:

Glory be to the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit

Priest:

Since we have no favor, excuse, nor justification, because of our many sins, O Theotokos, the Mother of God, we plead through you to Him who was born of you, for your intercession is abundant, powerful, and acceptable to our Savior. O pure Mother, do not exclude us, sinners, from your intercession with Him who was born of you; for He is merciful and able to save us, because He suffered for our sake in order to deliver us. O Lord, let Your compassion reach us quickly, for we sincerely humbled ourselves. Help us, O God our Savior, for the sake of Your glorious name. O Lord, deliver us and forgive us our sins, for the sake of Your holy name.

Congregation:

Now and forever and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Priest:

You wrought salvation in the midst of the whole world, O Christ our God, when You stretched out Your holy arms on the cross. Therefore, all nations cry out saying: “Glory be to You, O Lord.”

Congregation:

Glory be to the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit

Priest:

We worship Your incorruptible person, O good Lord, asking for the forgiveness of our sins, O Christ our God; for of Your own will You were pleased to be lifted up on the cross to deliver those whom You created from the bondage of the enemy. We cry out unto You and give thanks to You, O Savior, for You have filled everyone with joy when You came to save the world. O Lord glory be to You.

Congregation:

Now and forever and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Priest:

You are full of grace O Theotokos, the Mother of God, the holy virgin. We magnify you for through the cross of your Son, Hades was cast down, and Death was abolished! Assuredly, we were dead before, but now we are raised and made worthy to inherit eternal life and to attain the joy of Paradise. Therefore, we thankfully glorify the immortal Christ our God.

O ONLY-BEGOTTEN

O only-begotten Son, the eternal and immortal Word of God; who for our salvation did will to be incarnate of the holy Theotokos (and ever Virgin Mary)².

Who without change became man and was crucified, the Christ God. Trampled down death by death. One of the Holy Trinity, who is glorified with the Father and the Holy Spirit, save us.

(Holy)³ God, who being God, for our sake, became man without change.

(Holy)³ Mighty, who by weakness showed forth what is greater than power.

(Holy)³ Immortal, who was crucified for our sake, and endured death in His flesh, the Eternal and Immortal.

O Holy Trinity, have mercy on us.

(Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, who was crucified for us, have mercy on us.)³

Glory be to the Father, to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, both now, and ever, and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

The priest offered the Incense in front of the Gospel.

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted *the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel* on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 37: 21, 22 & 21:16,17,8,9

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

I am, the beloved, rejected as a despised dead man; for they nailed my flesh. Abandon me not, O my Master and my God. **Alleluia.**

They pierced My hands and My feet. They counted all My bones; and they observed and looked upon Me. They parted My garments among themselves, and cast lots for My clothing. they spoke with their lips, they shook the head, saying, He hoped in the Lord; let Him deliver Him, let Him save Him, because He takes pleasure in Him. **Alleluia.**

The Gospel is read and when it says “there was darkness over all the land...”, the candles and all lights are turned off

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 27: 27- 45

Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus into the Praetorium and gathered the whole garrison around Him. And they stripped Him and put a scarlet robe on Him. When they had twisted a crown of thorns, they put it on His head, and a reed in His right hand. And they bowed the knee before Him and mocked Him, saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!” Then they spat on Him, and took the reed and struck Him on the head. And when they had mocked Him, they took the robe off Him, put His own clothes on Him, and led Him away to be crucified.

Now as they came out, they found a man of Cyrene, Simon by name. Him they compelled to bear His cross.

And when they had come to a place called Golgotha, that is to say, Place of a Skull, they gave Him sour wine mingled with gall to drink. But when He had tasted it, He would not drink. Then they crucified Him,

and divided His garments, casting lots, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet: "They divided My garments among them, And for My clothing they cast lots." Sitting down, they kept watch over Him there. And they put up over His head the accusation written against Him: THIS IS JESUS THE KING OF THE JEWS. Then two robbers were crucified with Him, one on the right and another on the left.

And those who passed by blasphemed Him, wagging their heads and saying, "You who destroy the temple and build it in three days, save Yourself! If You are the Son of God, come down from the cross." Likewise the chief priests also, mocking with the scribes and elders, said, "He saved others; Himself He cannot save. If He is the King of Israel, let Him now come down from the cross, and we will believe Him. He trusted in God; let Him deliver Him now if He will have Him; for He said, 'I am the Son of God.'" Even the robbers who were crucified with Him reviled Him with the same thing.

Now from the sixth hour until the ninth hour *there was darkness over all the land.*

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 15: 26- 33

And the inscription of His accusation was written above: THE KING OF THE JEWS. With Him they also crucified two robbers, one on His right and the other on His left. So the Scripture was fulfilled which says, "And He was numbered with the transgressors." And those who passed by blasphemed Him, wagging their heads and saying, "Aha! You who destroy the temple and build it in three days, save Yourself, and come down from the cross!" Likewise the chief priests also, mocking among themselves with the scribes, said, "He saved others; Himself He cannot save. Let the Christ, the King of Israel, descend now from the cross, that we may see and believe." Even those who were crucified with Him reviled Him. Now when the sixth hour had come, there was darkness over the whole land until the ninth hour.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 23: 26- 44

Now as they led Him away, they laid hold of a certain man, Simon a Cyrenian, who was coming from the country, and on him they laid the cross that he might bear it after Jesus. And a great multitude of the people followed Him, and women who also mourned and lamented Him. But Jesus, turning to them, said, "Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep for Me, but weep for yourselves and for your children. For indeed the days are coming in which they will say, 'Blessed are the barren, wombs that never bore, and breasts which never nursed!' Then they will begin 'to say to the mountains, "Fall on us!" and to the hills, "Cover us!" 'For if they do these things in the green wood, what will be done in the dry?" There were also two others, criminals, led with Him to be put to death.

And when they had come to the place called Calvary, there they crucified Him, and the criminals, one on the right hand and the other on the left. Then Jesus said, "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they do." And they divided His garments and cast lots.

And the people stood looking on. But even the rulers with them sneered,

saying, "He saved others; let Him save Himself if He is the Christ, the chosen of God." The soldiers also mocked Him, coming and offering Him sour wine, and saying, "If You are the King of the Jews, save Yourself." And an inscription also was written over Him in letters of Greek, Latin, and Hebrew: THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS. Then one of the criminals who were hanged blasphemed Him, saying, "If You are the Christ, save Yourself and us." But the other, answering, rebuked him, saying, "Do you not even fear God, seeing you are under the same condemnation? And we indeed justly, for we receive the due reward of our deeds; but this Man has done nothing wrong." Then he said to Jesus, "Lord, remember me when You come into Your kingdom." And Jesus said to him, "Assuredly, I say to you, today you will be with Me in Paradise."

Now it was about the sixth hour, and there was darkness over all the earth until the ninth hour.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 19: 13- 27

When Pilate therefore heard that saying, he brought Jesus out and sat down in the judgment seat in a place that is called The Pavement, but in Hebrew, *Gabbatha*. Now it was the Preparation Day of the Passover, and about the sixth hour. And he said to the Jews, "Behold your King!" But they cried out, "Away with Him, away with Him! Crucify Him!" Pilate said to them, "Shall I crucify your King?" The chief priests answered, "We have no king but Caesar!" Then he delivered Him to them to be crucified. So they took Jesus and led Him away. And He, bearing His cross, went out to a place called the Place of a Skull, which is called in Hebrew, *Golgotha*, where they crucified Him, and two others with Him, one on either side, and Jesus in the center.

Now Pilate wrote a title and put it on the cross. And the writing was: JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS. Then many of the Jews read this title, for the place where Jesus was crucified was near the city; and it was written in Hebrew, Greek, and Latin. Therefore the chief priests of the Jews said to Pilate, "Do not write, 'The King of the Jews,' but, 'He said, 'I am the King of the Jews.'" ' " Pilate answered,

"What I have written, I have written." Then the soldiers, when they had crucified Jesus, took His garments and made four parts, to each soldier a part, and also the tunic. Now the tunic was without seam, woven from the top in one piece. They said therefore among themselves, "Let us not tear it, but cast lots for it, whose it shall be," that the Scripture might be fulfilled which says: "They divided My garments among them, And for My clothing they cast lots." Therefore the soldiers did these things.

Now there stood by the cross of Jesus His mother, and His mother's sister, Mary the wife of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene. When Jesus therefore saw His mother, and the disciple whom He loved standing by, He said to His mother, "Woman, behold your son!" Then He said to the disciple, "Behold your mother!" And from that hour that disciple took her to his own home.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Exposition
12th Hour

The Exposition of the Sixth Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

O you dwellers of Jerusalem, come and see. They crucified Jesus the Son of David on a cross. They dressed Him in a scarlet robe like the kings, and placed a crown of thorns on His head.

He adorned the heavens with the stars, created the earth and beautified it with flowers. They placed a reed in His right hand as a wise man and a teacher. They compelled a cross on Him as a conqueror.

The women who came to Jerusalem for the Passover wept and wailed when they saw Jesus. He looked at them and said; “Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep for Me. Rather, weep for yourselves because of the tribulation that will befall you. There will be days when you envy the barren who never gave birth, nursed, nor raised a child.

They will ask the mountains to fall on them, and the hills to cover them. For if they do this when the wood is green what will happen when it is dry.

When they came to the place called skull, they set the cross, and crucified Him.

They crucified with Him two criminals, one on His right and one on His left, so that the prophesy of the prophet may be fulfilled.

The soldiers took His clothes and cast lots to divide His garments. They inscribed on the cross over His head, in Hebrew, Greek, and Latin, "This is the king of the Jews."

The people stood by, watching, and the rulers mocked Him saying, "He saved others, let Him save Himself if He is the Christ, the chosen one."

The soldiers also mocked Him saying, "If you are the king of the Jews, save Yourself and come down off the cross."

One of the criminals railed at Him in front of everyone, saying; "If you are the Christ save Yourself and save us of this shame that we endure."

The other rebuked him saying; "Do you not fear God, since you are under the same sentence and condemnation? we deserve this punishment, but He is innocent and without blame."

Then he said to Jesus, "Remember me, O Lord in Your Kingdom." The Lord of Glory replied saying; "Today you will be with Me in Paradise."

There were women standing by the cross of our Savior, His mother, His mother's sister, Mary Clopas and Mary Magdalene.

When Jesus saw His mother and the disciple whom He loved standing near, He said to His mother, “Woman, behold your son!” Then He said to the disciple, “Behold your mother,” and from that hour the disciple took her to his own home as the Lord had said.

And from the sixth hour to ninth hour there was darkness on the whole earth.

O Lord who adorned the earth with flowers, they dressed You with a scarlet robe. and the skies with the stars, they put a crown of thorns on Your head.

You who have dominion over heaven and earth, they put a reed in Your hand. You who suspended the whole world with one word of Your mouth,

You were crucified on the cross. You were crucified for our sins and abolished the power of death by Your cross, O Omnipotent.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
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Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Exposition
12th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

Congregation:

(12 times in Long tone)

Amen. Lord Have Mercy.

Amen. Alleluia. Glory be to the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit unto the ages of all ages. Amen.

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

FAITHFULNESS OF THE THIEF ON THE RIGHT

Then the priest starts to read the faithfulness of the thief on the right

Priest:

Remember me O Lord when You come into Your Kingdom.

Remember me O my King when You come into Your Kingdom.

Remember me O Holy-One when You come into Your Kingdom.

The Trisagion is chanted in the tune of Pashca

REFRAIN

Congregation:

Remember me O Lord when You come into Your Kingdom.

Remember me O Holy-One when You come into Your Kingdom.

Remember me O Master when You come into Your Kingdom.

Priest:

O King of kings, Christ our God, Lord of Lords, as You remembered the thief who believed in You, on the cross, remember us also in Your kingdom.

REFRAIN

Who saw a thief believe in a king as this thief who through his faith stole the kingdom of heaven and the paradise of joy.

REFRAIN

Because of your deeds, O thief, you were hung on the cross as the condemned. Through your faith, you deserved the grace, joy, and the kingdom of heaven and the paradise of joy.

REFRAIN

Blessed are you O blessed thief and your good tongue by which you were truly made worthy of the kingdom of heaven and the paradise of joy.

REFRAIN

O blessed thief, what did you see and what did you observe, that you confessed the Crucified Christ in the flesh, the King of Heaven and God of all.

REFRAIN

You did not see Christ God glorified on Mount Tabor in the glory of His Father, but you saw Him hung in Ekranion, wherefore you cried out saying:

REFRAIN

You believed when you saw the heaven and the earth shake and the sun and moon darkened. When the dead rose, the rocks split, and the curtain of the altar was torn, wherefore you cried out saying:

REFRAIN

“Assuredly, I say to you,” said the Lord, “today you will be with Me in Paradise and inherit My kingdom.” The disciple denied and the thief cried out saying:

REFRAIN

Blessed are you O Demas, the thief more than everyone on the earth, for you have gained a way no one gained. All your life, you were a thief in Jerusalem’s forests and one word you said to the Lord and he sent you to paradise.

REFRAIN

When they crucified our Savior on the cross, they crucified two thieves with Him, one on His right and one on His left. And Demas, the thief on the right, cried out saying, “Remember me O Lord when You come into Your kingdom.” Our Savior said to Him, “Today you will be with Me in Paradise.”

REFRAIN

We ask Him who was crucified on the wood of the cross, shed His divine blood for us, and trampled death by His death to forgive us our sins and keep for us the life of our father the Patriarch Pope (.....) and his partner in the apostolic liturgy, our father the bishop Abba (.....) and my fathers who are gathered here in this church from the youngest to the oldest. Say all of you.

Congregation:

(Amen)³.

الشعب:

(آمين)^٣

The lights of the church and candles are lit to represent the end of darkness at the Ninth hour.

NINTH HOUR OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Jeremiah 11: 18 - 12: 13

**A reading from Jeremiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Now the Lord gave me knowledge of it, and I know it; for You showed me their doings. But I was like a docile lamb brought to the slaughter; and I did not know that they had devised schemes against me, saying, "Let us destroy the tree with its fruit, and let us cut him off from the land of the living, that his name may be remembered no more." But, O Lord of hosts, You who judge righteously, Testing the mind and the heart, Let me see Your vengeance on them, For to You I have revealed my cause. "Therefore thus says the Lord concerning the men of Anathoth who seek your life, saying, 'Do not prophesy in the name of the Lord, lest you die by our hand'-- therefore thus says the Lord of hosts: 'Behold, I will punish them. The young men shall die by the sword, their sons and their daughters shall die by

famine; and there shall be no remnant of them, for I will bring catastrophe on the men of Anathoth, even the year of their punishment.”

Righteous are You, O Lord, when I plead with You; Yet let me talk with You about Your judgments. Why does the way of the wicked prosper? Why are those happy who deal so treacherously? You have planted them, yes, they have taken root; They grow, yes, they bear fruit. You are near in their mouth But far from their mind. But You, O Lord, know me; You have seen me, And You have tested my heart toward You. Pull them out like sheep for the slaughter, And prepare them for the day of slaughter. How long will the land mourn, And the herbs of every field wither? The beasts and birds are consumed, For the wickedness of those who dwell there, Because they said, “He will not see our final end.”

“If you have run with the footmen, and they have wearied you, Then how can you contend with horses? And if in the land of peace, In which you trusted, they wearied you, Then how will you do in the floodplain of the Jordan? For even your brothers, the house of your father, Even they have dealt treacherously with you; Yes, they have called a multitude after you. Do not believe them, Even though they speak smooth words to you.

“I have forsaken My house, I have left My heritage; I have given the dearly beloved of My soul into the hand of her enemies. My heritage is to Me like a lion in the forest; It cries out against Me; Therefore I have hated it. My heritage is to Me like a speckled vulture; The vultures all around are against her. Come, assemble all the beasts of the field, Bring them to devour!

"Many rulers have destroyed My vineyard, They have trodden My portion underfoot; They have made My pleasant portion a desolate wilderness. They have made it desolate; Desolate, it mourns to Me; The whole land is made desolate, Because no one takes it to heart. The plunderers have come On all the desolate heights in the wilderness, For the sword of the Lord shall devour From one end of the land to the other end of the land; No flesh shall have peace. They have sown wheat but reaped thorns; They have put themselves to pain but do not profit. But be ashamed of your harvest Because of the fierce anger of the Lord."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Zechariah 14: 6-11

**A reading from Zechariah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

Thus the Lord my God will come, And all the saints with You. It shall come to pass in that day That there will be no light; The lights will diminish. It shall be one day Which is known to the Lord-- Neither day nor night. But at evening time it shall happen That it will be light. And in that day it shall be That living waters shall flow from Jerusalem, Half of them toward the eastern sea And half of them toward the western sea; In both summer and winter it shall occur. And the Lord shall be King over all the

earth. In that day it shall be-- "The Lord is one," And His name one. All the land shall be turned into a plain from Geba to Rimmon south of Jerusalem. Jerusalem shall be raised up and inhabited in her place from Benjamin's Gate to the place of the First Gate and the Corner Gate, and from the Tower of Hananeel to the king's winepresses. The people shall dwell in it; And no longer shall there be utter destruction, But Jerusalem shall be safely inhabited.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Joel 2:1-3 & 2:10-11

A reading from Joel the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Blow the trumpet in Zion, And sound an alarm in My holy mountain! Let all the inhabitants of the land tremble; For the day of the Lord is coming, For it is at hand: A day of darkness and gloominess, A day of clouds and thick darkness, Like the morning clouds spread over the mountains. A people come, great and strong, The like of whom has never been; Nor will there ever be any such after them, Even for many successive generations. A fire devours before them, And behind them a flame burns; The land is like the Garden of Eden before them, And behind them a desolate wilderness; Surely nothing shall escape them.

The earth quakes before them, The heavens tremble; The sun and moon grow dark, And the stars diminish their brightness. The Lord gives voice

before His army, For His camp is very great, For strong is the One who executes His word. For the day of the Lord is great and very terrible; Who can endure it?

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Ninth Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha. May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

The priests uncover their heads, and offer incense before the icon of the crucifix three times. and they pray the following inaudibly,

Priest:

First time:

We worship You, O Christ, and Your life-giving cross, that You were crucified on to deliver us from our sins.

Second time:

O my Lord Jesus Christ, who was crucified on the cross, trample down Satan under our feet.

Third time:

Hail to the cross, that Christ our King was crucified on, to deliver us from our sins.

Meanwhile, the congregation chants:

- ✧ *This censer of pure gold, (Ταμιανήν)*
- ✧ *This is He who offered himself, (Φαίεταρην ἐπέωμι)*
- ✧ *they ended with We worship you (Τενοῦώτ ἡμοκ)*
- ✧ *The pauline introduction hymn (Ἦ ἐπιστολὴ ἡντε πενσαδ)*

HYMN OF THE CENSER

Congregation:

The golden censer is the Virgin, her aroma is our Savior. She gave birth to Him; He saved us and forgave us our sins.

HYMN OF THE CROSS

Congregation:

This is He who presented himself on the cross; an acceptable sacrifice for the salvation of our race.

His good Father inhaled His sweet aroma in the evening on Golgotha.

We worship you: O Christ with Your good Father and the Holy Spirit: for You have crucified and save us. (have mercy on us).

INTRODUCTION TO THE PAULINE EPISTLE

Congregation:

For the resurrection of the dead who reposed in the faith of Christ, O Lord rest their souls all.

Paul, the servant of our LORD Jesus Christ, called to be an apostle, appointed to the Gospel of God.

Let this mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

THE PAULINE EPISTLE

Philippians 2: 4- 11

A reading from the Epistle of our teacher Paul to the Philippians. May his blessing be with us. Amen.

Let each of you look out not only for his own interests, but also for the interests of others. Let this mind be in you which was also in Christ Jesus, who, being in the form of God, did not consider it robbery to be equal with God, but made Himself of no reputation, taking the form of a bondservant, and coming in the likeness of men. And being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself and became obedient to the

point of death, even the death of the cross. Therefore God also has highly exalted Him and given Him the name which is above every name, that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of those in heaven, and of those on earth, and of those under the earth, and that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

The priest prays the verses of the Ninth hour

THE NINTH HOUR LITANIES

THE REFRAIN

O You, who tasted death in the flesh in the ninth hour for our sake, we the sinners, put to death our carnal lusts, O Christ, our God, and deliver us.

Priest:

O You, who tasted death in the flesh in the ninth hour for our sake, we the sinners, put to death our carnal lusts, O Christ, our God, and deliver us.

The congregation replies with the refrain

Priest:

Let my supplication come before You O Lord; give me understanding according to Your word. Let my prayer come before You and revive me according to Your word.

Congregation:

Glory be to the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit

Priest:

O Lord, who commended Your spirit into the hands of the Father when You were crucified at the ninth hour; and led the thief who was crucified with You into Paradise, do not neglect me, O Good One, nor reject me, I who am lost. Rather sanctify my soul, enlighten my understanding and allow me to partake of the grace of Your life-giving sacraments; so that when I taste Your goodness I may offer You praise unceasingly, longing for Your glory above all things O Christ our God, save us.

Congregation:

Now and forever and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Priest:

O righteous Lord, who was born of the Virgin and endured crucifixion for our sake. You conquered earth through Your death and manifested resurrection through Your resurrection. Lord, do not turn Your face away from those

whom you have created with Your own hands, but manifest Your love toward mankind, O Good One.

Accept the intercession of Your mother on our behalf. O Savior save us, a humble people. Do not forsake us nor deliver us eternally into the hands of our enemies. Do not revoke Your covenant nor take away Your mercy from us, for the sake of Abraham Your beloved, Isaac Your servant, and Israel Your saint.

Congregation:

Now and forever and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Priest:

When the thief saw the Prince of Life hanging on the cross he said, “Had not the One crucified with us, been God incarnate, the sun would not have hidden its rays, nor would the earth have quaked and trembled in fear.” But O Almighty One, who endures everything, remember me O Lord when You come into Your kingdom!”

Congregation:

Glory be to the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit

Priest:

O You, who accepted the confession of the thief on the cross, accept us also unto You, O Good One, even though we indeed justly deserve the condemnation of death as the due reward of our sins. We acknowledge and confess our sins with the thief, proclaiming and testifying to Your divinity saying, “Remember us O Lord, when You coming into Your kingdom!”

Congregation:

Now and forever and unto the age of all ages. Amen.

Priest:

When the Mother saw the Lamb and the Shepherd, the Savior of the world, hanging on the cross, she said as she wept, “As for the world, let it rejoice in receiving Salvation, but as for me, my inward parts are burning with pain within me, when I behold Your crucifixion which You are patiently enduring, for the sake of all, O my son and my God!”

The congregation prayed Agios in the Paschal tune

The priest offered the Incense in front of the Gospel.

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 69:1-2, 21

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

Save me, O God! For the waters have come up to my neck. I sink in deep mire, They also gave me gall for my food, and for my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 27:46-50

And about the ninth hour Jesus cried out with a loud voice, saying, "Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani?" that is, "My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?" Some of those who stood there, when they heard that, said, "This Man is calling for Elijah!" Immediately one of them ran and took a sponge, filled it with sour wine and put it on a reed, and offered it to Him to drink. The rest said, "Let Him alone; let us see if Elijah will come to save Him." And Jesus cried out again with a loud voice, and yielded up His spirit.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 15: 34- 37

And at the ninth hour Jesus cried out with a loud voice, saying, "Eloi, Eloi, lama sabachthani!" which is translated, "My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?" Some of those who stood by, when they heard that, said, "Look, He is calling for Elijah!" Then someone ran and filled a sponge full of sour wine, put it on a reed, and offered it to Him to drink, saying, "Let Him alone; let us see if Elijah will come to take Him down." And Jesus cried out with a loud voice, and breathed His last.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 23: 45- 46

Then the sun was darkened, and the veil of the temple was torn in two. And when Jesus had cried out with a loud voice, He said, "Father, 'into Your hands I commit My spirit.' " Having said this, He breathed His last.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 19:28-30

After this, Jesus, knowing that all things were now accomplished, that the Scripture might be fulfilled, said, "I thirst!" Now a vessel full of sour wine was sitting there; and they filled a sponge with sour wine, put it on hyssop, and put it to His mouth. So when Jesus had received the sour wine, He said, "It is finished!" And bowing His head, He gave up His spirit.

**Bow down before the Holy Gospel.
Glory be to God forever.**

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the Ninth Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

Before the sun Your name was and Your years will not vanish from generation to generation. I see you hung on the cross, O Almighty.

How can Your own creature do that to You, O You who summoned to Himself all those who are wounded and cured their wounds. O You the True Healer, You were hung on the wood as a criminal by the sinful who shouted with their evil voice saying; “We have no King but Caesar.”

At the ninth hour, our Savior was crucified, and he opened His mouth and shouted in Hebrew, “Eloi, Eloi, Loma Sabachthani? Which is “My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?”

And there was a great fear on those around Him. When the hour, (which He knew alone) had come, He said: “I am thirsty.” because He knew what was written for Him.

One ran and filled a sponge with vinegar, put it on a reed, and gave it to Him to drink. When He tasted the vinegar, He said, “It is fulfilled.” He meant what David the prophet and the king had said in the Psalms. Then He shouted

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
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Exposition
11th Hour

Exposition
12th Hour

with a great voice and gave up the Spirit. Who will preach the captives about who tasted death for them, and preceeded them to paradise to prepare the way for the kingdom.

Rejoice today, all you righteous, prophets, and patriarchs. The first man, the head, who was freed from sadness has been reborn in the new Man, who conquered death, terminated its pride, and broke its bitter thorn.

God is the Word, in its perfection, and went to Hades by the soul which He took from Adam’s nature and made it one with Himself. He lifted with Him the souls that were in captivty according to His great mercy.

The last enemy is Satan whom He chained with shackles. When the evil guards and the forces of darkness saw Him, they ran away from Him because they knew His great power. So He broke the doors of brass with His authority, and he crushed the bars of iron.

Those who were in captivity cried in one voice, “Blessed is your coming to save us.” He then took Adam by the hand and lifted him and his descendants with him and admitted them to paradise where there is comfort and joy.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

- Exposition
1st Hour
- Exposition
3rd Hour
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- Exposition
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11th Hour
- Exposition
12th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

ELEVENTH HOUR OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Exodus 12:1-14

A reading from the book of Exodus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

Now the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, saying, "This month shall be your beginning of months; it shall be the first month of the year to you. Speak to all the congregation of Israel, saying:

'On the tenth day of this month every man shall take for himself a lamb, according to the house of his father, a lamb for a household. And if the household is too small for the lamb, let him and his neighbor next to his house take it according to the number of the persons; according to each man's need you shall make your count for the lamb. Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male of the first year. You may take it from the sheep or from the goats. Now you shall keep it until the fourteenth day of the

same month. Then the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill it at twilight. And they shall take some of the blood and put it on the two doorposts and on the lintel of the houses where they eat it. Then they shall eat the flesh on that night; roasted in fire, with unleavened bread and with bitter herbs they shall eat it. Do not eat it raw, nor boiled at all with water, but roasted in fire--its head with its legs and its entrails. You shall let none of it remain until morning, and what remains of it until morning you shall burn with fire. And thus you shall eat it: with a belt on your waist, your sandals on your feet and your staff in your hand. So you shall eat it in haste. It is the Lord's Passover. For I will pass through the land of Egypt on that night, and will strike all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast; and against all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgment: I am the Lord. Now the blood shall be a sign for you on the houses where you are. And when I see the blood, I will pass over you; and the plague shall not be on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt. So this day shall be to you a memorial; and you shall keep it as a feast to the Lord throughout your generations. You shall keep it as a feast by an everlasting ordinance."

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Leviticus 23: 5- 12

A reading from the book of Leviticus of Moses the Prophet may his blessings be with us, Amen.

On the fourteenth day of the first month at twilight is the Lord's Passover. And on the fifteenth day of the same month is the Feast of Unleavened Bread to the Lord; seven days you must eat unleavened bread. On the first day you shall have a holy convocation; you shall do no customary work on it. But you shall offer an offering made by fire to the Lord for seven days. The seventh day shall be a holy convocation; you shall do no customary work on it.' "

And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying, "Speak to the children of Israel, and say to them: 'When you come into the land which I give to you, and reap its harvest, then you shall bring a sheaf of the firstfruits of your harvest to the priest. He shall wave the sheaf before the Lord, to be accepted on your behalf; on the day after the Sabbath the priest shall wave it. And you shall offer on that day, when you wave the sheaf, a male lamb of the first year, without blemish, as a burnt offering to the Lord.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

HOMILY

A Homily of our Holy Father Abba Athanasius the Apostolic may his blessings be with us. Amen.

It is written in the scriptures, if our souls are following the law of God, the powers of darkness will not overpower us. If we drift away from God, they will rule over us.

Brethren, who want to be saved, teach yourselves to float in the depth of God's richness and wisdom. Stretch your arms in the form of the Cross to cross the great sea of this life and go to God.

The hindering doubts are for those who live away from the commands of the universal church, I mean the disbelief, adultery, evil report and love of money that is the root of all evils. The sign of the Cross is spreaded over all the creation. If the sun does not emit its rays, it cannot glow; neither would the moon light. The birds in the sky, if they do not stretch out their wings they cannot fly, neither can the ships leave port if they do not unfold their sails.

The same happened with Moses the Archprophet, when Moses held up his arms, he defeated Amalek. Daniel was saved from the lions den, and Jonah from the fish's belly. Takla when they threw her to the lions, she was saved by the sign of the cross, also Susanna from the hands of the two old men, Judith from Holofernes and the three young men from the burning fiery furnace All those were saved by the sign of the Cross.

It was also said: let your dwelling be in one place, that is the Church, to be nourished by the words of the scriptures and by the heavenly bread and blood of Christ, and to be comforted all the time by the word of God.

We conclude the Homily of our Holy Father Abba Athanasius the Apostolic who enlightened our minds and our hearts. In the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, one God. Amen.

THE PAULINE EPISTLE

Galatians 3:1-6

**A reading from the First Epistle of our teacher Paul to the Galatians.
May his blessing be with us. Amen.**

T[you] before whose eyes Jesus Christ was clearly portrayed among you as crucified? This only I want to learn from you: Did you receive the Spirit by the works of the law, or by the hearing of faith? Are you so foolish? Having begun in the Spirit, are you now being made perfect by the flesh? Have you suffered so many things in vain--if indeed it was in vain? Therefore He who supplies the Spirit to you and works miracles among you, does He do it by the works of the law, or by the hearing of faith?—just as Abraham “believed God, and it was accounted to him for righteousness.”

The Grace of God the Father be with you all. Amen.

The Doxology of the Eleventh Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha.

May its blessing be with us. Amen.

“Thine is the Power...” on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

*The congregation chanted **the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel** on page 32*

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

Psalm 143: 6, 7 & 31: 5

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

I spread out my hands to You; Answer me speedily, O Lord; My spirit fails! Do not hide Your face from me, Lest I be like those who go down into the pit. **Alleluia.**

Into Your hand I commit my spirit, You have redeemed me, O Lord God of truth. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 27: 51- 56

Then, behold, the veil of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom; and the earth quaked, and the rocks were split, and the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints who had fallen asleep were raised; and coming out of the graves after His resurrection, they went into the holy city and appeared to many. So when the centurion and those with him, who were guarding Jesus, saw the earthquake and the things that had

happened, they feared greatly, saying, "Truly this was the Son of God!" And many women who followed Jesus from Galilee, ministering to Him, were there looking on from afar, among whom were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James and Joses, and the mother of Zebedee's sons.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 15:38-41

Then the veil of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom. So when the centurion, who stood opposite Him, saw that He cried out like this and breathed His last, he said, "Truly this Man was the Son of God!" There were also women looking on from afar, among whom were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James the Less and of Joses, and Salome, who also followed Him and ministered to Him when He was in Galilee, and many other women who came up with Him to Jerusalem.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 23:47-49

So when the centurion saw what had happened, he glorified God, saying, "Certainly this was a righteous Man!" And the whole crowd who came together to that sight, seeing what had been done, beat their breasts and returned. But all His acquaintances, and the women who followed Him from Galilee, stood at a distance, watching these things.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 19: 31- 37

Therefore, because it was the Preparation Day, that the bodies should not remain on the cross on the Sabbath (for that Sabbath was a high day), the Jews asked Pilate that their legs might be broken, and that they might be taken away. Then the soldiers came and broke the legs of the first and of the other who was crucified with Him. But when they came to Jesus and saw that He was already dead, they did not break His legs. But one of the soldiers pierced His side with a spear, and immediately blood and water came out. And he who has seen has testified, and his testimony is true; and he knows that he is telling the truth, so that you may believe. For these things were done that the Scripture should be fulfilled, "Not one of His bones shall be broken." And again another Scripture says, "They shall look on Him whom they pierced."

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

**The Exposition of the Eleventh Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha,
may its blessings be with us all. Amen.**

O Israel, the captive of the sins, look at how the Gentile centurion confessed the divinity of the Crucified. Not only him but also all those around exclaimed with him saying: Truly this was the Son of God.

Also the thief at the right knew His power and asked for His mercy, when he saw veil of the temple rent, the sun eclipsed, and the moon hid its face, and became red as blood, for the sake of its Creator.

The powers of heaven and multitudes of the stars fell to the earth.

The earth shook, the rocks split; the tombs opened, the dead resurrected and went into the city, and many recognized them.

When they saw that, they acknowledged the power of the crucified. But Israel was blinded; it could not see nor comprehend.

Because of the Sabbath, the bodies should not be left on the wood. Thus, they asked the governor to break their knees, so that they would die. They

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

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Exposition
12th Hour

broke those of the two thieves. But the Savior was already dead. One of the soldiers pierced Him with a spear in his right side. Out of His side came blood and water simultaneously. The truthful witness saw that and his testimony is true.

Thus the prophecies were fulfilled that none of His bones will be broken. It is also written: He will judge those who stabbed him.” The centurion went home mystified and glorifying the Lord. With His Suffering, Jesus the Savior, granted the world eternal salvation.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

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6th Hour

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Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

O KING OF PEACE (ΠΟΡΡΟ)

See page 50

CONCLUDING HYMN

See page 52

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54

TWELFTH HOUR OF GOOD FRIDAY

PROPHECIES

Introduction to the Prophecies, see page 27

Lamentations 3:1- 66

**A reading from the book of Lamentations of Jeremiah the Prophet
may his blessings be with us, Amen.**

1. **I** am the man who has seen affliction by the rod of His wrath. He has led me and made me walk In darkness and not in light. Surely He has turned His hand against me Time and time again throughout the day. He has aged my flesh and my skin, And broken my bones.
2. He has besieged me And surrounded me with bitterness and woe. He has set me in dark places Like the dead of long ago.
3. He has hedged me in so that I cannot get out; He has made my chain heavy. Even when I cry and shout, He shuts out my prayer. He has blocked my ways with hewn stone; He has made my paths crooked.

4. He has been to me a bear lying in wait, Like a lion in ambush. He has turned aside my ways and torn me in pieces; He has made me desolate.
5. He has bent His bow And set me up as a target for the arrow. He has caused the arrows of His quiver To pierce my loins. I have become the ridicule of all my people- - Their taunting song all the day. He has filled me with bitterness, He has made me drink wormwood.
6. He has also broken my teeth with gravel, And covered me with ashes. You have moved my soul far from peace; I have forgotten prosperity. And I said, "My strength and my hope Have perished from the Lord.
7. Remember my affliction and roaming, The wormwood and the gall. My soul still remembers And sinks within me. This I recall to my mind, Therefore I have hope.
8. Through the Lord's mercies we are not consumed, Because His compassions fail not. They are new every morning; Great is Your faithfulness. "The Lord is my portion," says my soul, "Therefore I hope in Him!"
9. The Lord is good to those who wait for Him, To the soul who seeks Him. It is good that one should hope and wait quietly For the salvation of the Lord. It is good for a man to bear The yoke in his youth.
10. Let him sit alone and keep silent, Because God has laid it on him; Let him put his mouth in the dust-- There may yet be hope. Let him give his cheek to the one who strikes him, And be full of reproach. For the Lord will not cast off forever.

11. Though He causes grief, Yet He will show compassion According to the multitude of His mercies. For He does not afflict willingly, Nor grieve the children of men.

12. To crush under one's feet All the prisoners of the earth, To turn aside the justice due a man Before the face of the Most High, Or subvert a man in his cause-- The Lord does not approve.

13. Who is he who speaks and it comes to pass, When the Lord has not commanded it? Is it not from the mouth of the Most High That woe and well-being proceed? Why should a living man complain, A man for the punishment of his sins?

14. Let us search out and examine our ways, And turn back to the Lord; Let us lift our hearts and hands To God in heaven. We have transgressed and rebelled; You have not pardoned.

15. You have covered Yourself with anger And pursued us; You have slain and not pitied. You have covered Yourself with a cloud, That prayer should not pass through.

16. You have made us an off scouring and refuse In the midst of the peoples. All our enemies Have opened their mouths against us. Fear and a snare have come upon us, Desolation and destruction. My eyes overflow with rivers of water For the destruction of the daughter of my people.

17. My eyes flow and do not cease, Without interruption, till the Lord from heaven Looks down and sees. My eyes bring suffering to my soul Because of all the daughters of my city.

18. My enemies without cause Hunted me down like a bird. They silenced my life in the pit And threw stones at me. The waters flowed over my head; I said, "I am cut off!"

19. I called on Your name, O Lord, From the lowest pit. You have heard my voice: "Do not hide Your ear From my sighing, from my cry for help." You drew near on the day I called on You, And said, "Do not fear!"

20. O Lord, You have pleaded the case for my soul; You have redeemed my life. O Lord, You have seen how I am wronged; Judge my case. You have seen all their vengeance, All their schemes against me.

21. You have heard their reproach, O Lord, All their schemes against me, The lips of my enemies And their whispering against me all the day.

22. Look at their sitting down and their rising up; I am their taunting song. Repay them, O Lord, According to the work of their hands. Give them a veiled heart; Your curse be upon them! In Your anger, Pursue and destroy them From under the heavens of the Lord.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

Jonah 1:10 – 2: 7

**A reading from Isaiah the Prophet may his blessings be with us,
Amen.**

The sailors were terrified when they heard this. "Oh, why did you do it!" they groaned. And since the storm was getting worse all the time, they asked him, "What should we do to you to stop this storm?" "Throw me into the sea," Jonah said, "and it will become calm again. For I know that this terrible storm is all my fault."

Instead, the sailors tried even harder to row the boat ashore. But the stormy sea was too violent for them, and they couldn't make it. Then they cried out to the LORD, Jonah's God. "O LORD," they pleaded, "don't make us die for this man's sin. And don't hold us responsible for his death, because it isn't our fault. O LORD, you have sent this storm upon him for your own good reasons." Then the sailors picked Jonah up and threw him into the raging sea, and the storm stopped at once! The sailors were awestruck by the LORD's great power, and they offered him a sacrifice and vowed to serve him. Now the LORD had arranged for a great fish to swallow Jonah. And Jonah was inside the fish for three days and three nights.

Then Jonah prayed to the LORD his God from inside the fish. He said, "I cried out to the LORD in my great trouble, and he answered me. I called to you from the world of the dead, and LORD, you heard me! You threw me into the ocean depths, and I sank down to the heart of the sea. I was

buried beneath your wild and stormy waves. Then I said, 'O LORD, you have driven me from your presence. How will I ever again see your holy Temple?' "I sank beneath the waves, and death was very near. The waters closed in around me, and seaweed wrapped itself around my head. I sank down to the very roots of the mountains. I was locked out of life and imprisoned in the land of the dead. But you, O LORD my God, have snatched me from the yawning jaws of death! "When I had lost all hope, I turned my thoughts once more to the LORD. And my earnest prayer went out to you in your holy Temple.

Glory be to the Holy Trinity our God unto the age of all ages, Amen.

The Doxology of the Twelfth Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha.

May its blessing be with us. Amen.

"Thine is the Power..." on page 29

PSALM AND GOSPEL

The congregation chanted *the introduction of the reading of the Holy Gospel* on page 32

We beseech our Lord ...

Priest:

A reading from the Holy Gospel according to Saint (.....).

Congregation:

Glory be to God.

**Psalm 88: 6 & 23: 4 &
45: 6, 8**

**From the Psalms of David the Prophet, may his blessing be with us,
Amen.**

You have laid me in the lowest pit, in darkness, in the depths. Though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, For You are with me. **Alleluia.**

Your throne, O God, is forever and ever; A scepter of righteousness is the scepter of Your kingdom. All Your garments are scented with myrrh and aloes and cassia. **Alleluia.**

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Matthew 27:57-61

Now when evening had come, there came a rich man from Arimathea, named Joseph, who himself had also become a disciple of Jesus. This man went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be given to him. When Joseph had taken the body, he wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, and laid it in his new tomb which he had hewn out of the rock; and he rolled a large stone against the door of the tomb, and departed. And Mary Magdalene was there, and the other Mary, sitting opposite the tomb.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Mark 15: 42 - 16: 1

Now when evening had come, because it was the Preparation Day, that is, the day before the Sabbath, Joseph of Arimathea, a prominent council member, who was himself waiting for the kingdom of God, coming and taking courage, went in to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus. Pilate marveled that He was already dead, and summoning the centurion, he asked him if He had been dead for some time. So when he found out from the centurion, he granted the body to Joseph. Then he bought fine linen, took Him down, and wrapped Him in the linen. And he laid Him in a tomb which had been hewn out of the rock, and rolled a stone against the door of the tomb. And Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of Jesus observed where He was laid. Now when the Sabbath was past, Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome bought spices, that they might come and anoint Him.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

Luke 23: 50- 56

Now behold, there was a man named Joseph, a council member, a good and just man. He had not consented to their decision and deed. He was from Arimathea, a city of the Jews, who himself was also waiting for the kingdom of God. This man went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus. Then he took it down, wrapped it in linen, and laid it in a tomb that was hewn out of the rock, where no one had ever lain before. That day was the Preparation, and the Sabbath drew near. And the women who had come with Him from Galilee followed after, and they observed the tomb and how His body was laid. Then they returned and prepared spices and fragrant oils. And they rested on the Sabbath according to the commandment

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

May God have mercy and compassion on us and make us worthy to hear Your Holy Gospel.

A reading according to Saint (.....), the Evangelist and the pure Disciple. May his blessings be with us all. Amen.

John 19: 38- 42

After this, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly, for fear of the Jews, asked Pilate that he might take away the body of Jesus; and Pilate gave him permission. So he came and took the body of Jesus. And Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came, bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred pounds. Then they took the body of Jesus, and bound it in strips of linen with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury. Now in the place where He was crucified there was a garden, and in the garden a new tomb in which no one had yet been laid. So there they laid Jesus, because of the Jews' Preparation Day, for the tomb was nearby.

Bow down before the Holy Gospel.

Glory be to God forever.

THE EXPOSITION

Introduction to the Exposition, see page 34

Daytime Hours, see page 35

The Exposition of the Twelfth Hour of Good Friday of Holy Pascha, may its blessings be with us all. Amen.

And when the evening had come, because it was the day of preparation, that is, the day before the Sabbath, a wealthy man called Joseph, a respected member of the council who was also himself looking for the kingdom of God, and another called Nicodemus, a God loving man, took courage. Joseph and their fathers took care of the bodies of saints.

And went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus, God the Logos. Pilate asked him, “Is He dead?” He was greatly amazed. Then he ordered the centurion to give the body to Joseph. Joseph the righteous then took the body and took care of it.

He brought a linen shroud, took Him down, and wrapped Him in the linen shroud. Nicodemus brought about 100 pounds of fragrant oil and embalmed Him according to the Jewish traditions.

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Exposition
12th Hour

They laid Him in a tomb tomb, which had just been hewn out of rock; it was never used before. They rolled a stone against the door of the tomb.

Then they rested on the Sabbath in observance of the commandment. Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of Jesus saw where He was laid.

Conclusion of Exposition, see page 35

Exposition
1st Hour

Exposition
3rd Hour

Exposition
6th Hour

Exposition
9th Hour

Exposition
11th Hour

Exposition
12th Hour

THE LITANIES

Introduction to the Daytime Litanies, See page 36

DAYTIME LITANIES

The priest prays the Morning Litany, after each part, the congregation responds with Lord have mercy and kneel. See page 37

- ✠ *After that the Litany was completed, high priest raises the cross and all the congregation begins to praise the Lord in a loud voice, crying out Kyrie Eleison (Lord have mercy) with performing Metanoia asking the Lord to forgive their sins,*
- ✠ *They do that in every direction, each one a hundred times, first at East, then west, then north, and finally south, and in every direction they turned and the priests turn with crosses too, with the icons and the censers.*
- ✠ *Then, when they finished turning in the four directions, they turn to the east and begin reciting Kyrie Eleison again in the long tune with the cymbal 12 times.*
- ✠ *Then the procession starts to go around the altar three times, then three times inside the church and ends with one more time around the altar. while they are chanting Kyrie Eleison.*
- ✠ *the priest begins the the Burial while the congregation chants the the Burial Hymn “Golgotha in Hebrew,...” (Γολγοθα ἡμετ θεβρεος).*

- ✠ *The presbyter gives the final blessing and covers the icon with a white linen cloth and places the cross over it and covers them with roses petals and spices and places next to them two candle stands one on each side representing two angels at the tomb of Christ.*
- ✠ *The priests, according to their ranks, start reading the first three psalms until they reach, “I lay down and slept.” Then the curtain of the altar is closed and the hundred and fifty psalms are read.*

GOLGOTHA - THE BURIAL HYMN

Golgotha in Hebrew, Kranion in Greek, the place where You were crucified Lord. You spread out Your hands, and two thieves were crucified with You; at Your right, and at Your left, You in the middle, O good Savior,

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

The thief at Your right cried out saying: *“Remember me, O my Lord, remember me, O my Savior, remember me, O my King, when You come into Your Kingdom.”*

The Lord answered him in a gentle voice saying: *“Today you shall be with Me in My Kingdom.”*

Now, and ever and unto the ages of the ages. Amen.

The righteous Joseph and Nicodemus came and took the body of Christ, embalmed Him, prepared Him, put Him in a tomb, singing to Him saying: *“Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, who was crucified for us, have mercy upon us.”*

Glory to the Father, to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Now, and ever and unto the ages of the ages. Amen.

Let us also worship Him saying: *“Have mercy on us, O God our Savior, who was crucified on the Cross, trample Satan under our feet.”*

Save us and have mercy on us.

Lord have mercy. Lord have mercy. Lord bless us. Amen. Bless me. Bless me. Lo, the repentance. Forgive me. Say the blessing.

THE SHORT BLESSING

See page 54



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